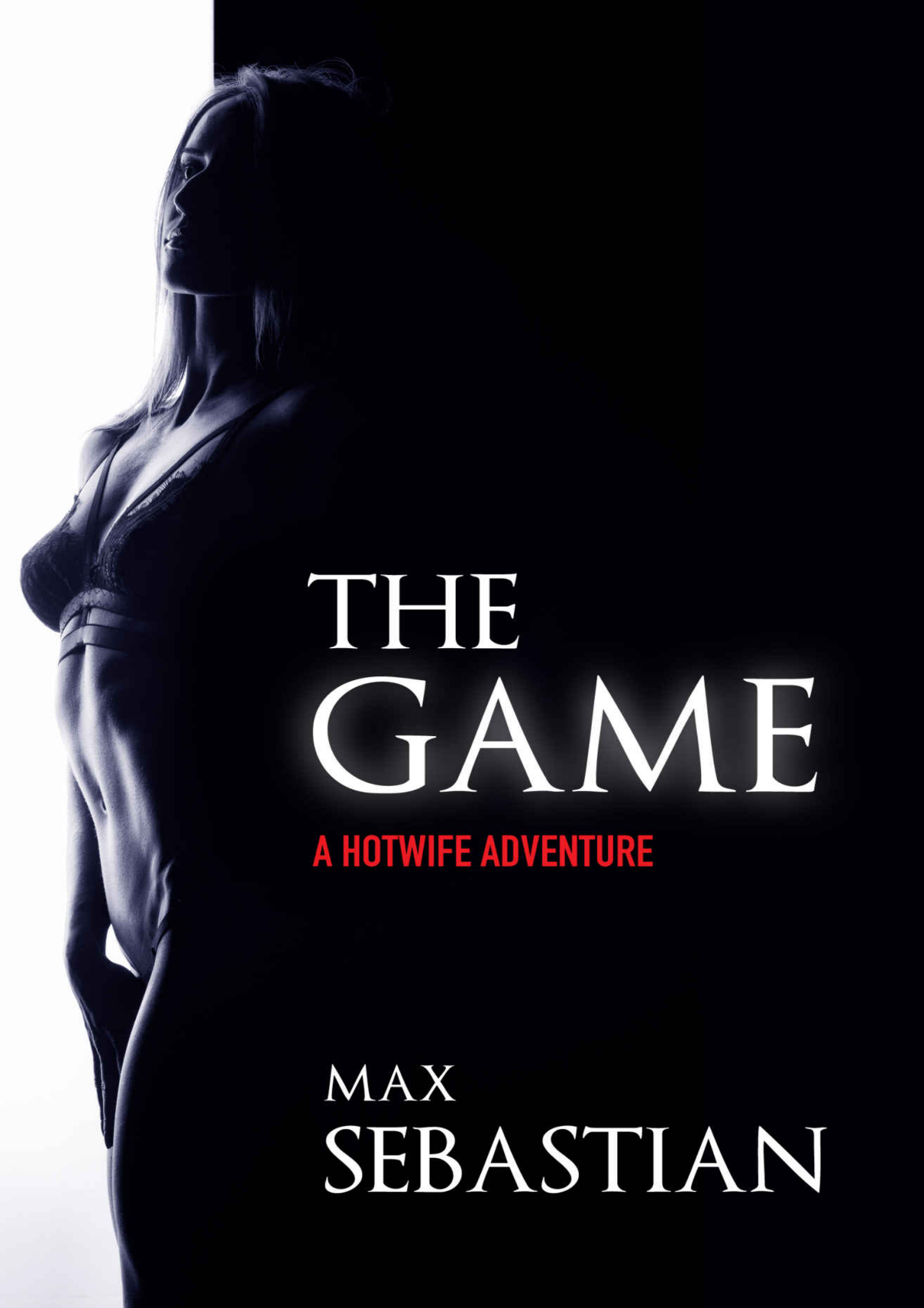




THE GAME

A HOTWIFE ADVENTURE

MAX
SEBASTIAN

The Game

A hotwife adventure

MAX SEBASTIAN

MaxSebastian.net

KW
PUBLISHING

The Game

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Foreword

Like many of my books, this is ultimately a story about communication between a husband and wife, and how it develops through the exploration of a central sexual fantasy, that of the wife being free to sleep with people other than her husband.

The Game involves a married couple who are professional communicators - journalists, no less - and yet both find it difficult to communicate with each other when it comes to sex. As is common in the wife-sharing fantasy, the husband's one condition for his wife if she wishes to sleep with other men is that she fulfill his side of the fantasy by sharing details of the encounter with him.

Yet what do they do if the wife finds it difficult to do that one thing - communicating the details of the encounter to her husband? And so they come up with the concept of The Game.

This story gets a little darker than my previous novels, as we explore the nature of power within the central relationship, and the relationships formed by the liberated wife. However, ultimately it shares the same values as my previous wife-sharing stories, so anyone who has enjoyed those should enjoy this one.

Many thanks for picking up this book, whether you've bought it or borrowed it, your contribution helps keep this particular author writing. Along with you, dear reader, I'd like to add a note of thanks to fellow authors Kenny Wright and Sean Geist, along with my editor Sarah P, and beta readers Anjali and Ian, for their invaluable assistance on this story.

Max Sebastian

London, December 2015

Part One:
Rules of the Game

Chapter One

It was a dark and stormy night.

Isn't that how these stories are supposed to start? Well, it was actually stormy — the humid summer heat that had hung around DC for weeks was breaking into a massive thunderstorm as I left work for the evening — and the heavy cloud cover provided a premature darkening of the evening sky.

I kind of like that feeling that a storm is coming. The air gets this yellowish tinge — and I've never heard a scientific explanation for that — and there's this ominous tone to the ether, you know it's going to really bucket down. Driving in heavy rain, though — particularly that heavy — has never been my favorite. And I had all kinds of doubts that my ancient Celica would even make it out to the suburbs the way that rain hit. There was a raging torrent pouring down the windshield as I crawled my way north up Connecticut Avenue.

I was just relieved to get home that night, as the real darkness set in. It didn't even bother me much that I got soaked from just walking from the car in the driveway to the porch of our small suburban house. I will admit to being a mite concerned that Izzie wasn't back yet, but she'd always been good at taking care of herself.

My phone was buzzing by the time I got in, but a quick glance at the caller ID and I just declined the call. Martin Townsend could wait until the morning to demand my copy. My deadline wasn't even until the following evening. Right now, I needed to get out of these clothes — and grab a couple of pills for the headache that always seemed to come when there was any kind of low pressure zone in the area.

Down to my boxers and a white vest, I found a towel in the bathroom to dry off my hair, and then opened the mirrored door of the little medical cabinet above the sink to find the Tylenol — all, as it happened, without turning on any lights.

What I saw when I opened the medical cabinet certainly made me wish I had turned on the lights. I almost didn't believe my eyes — and I

did, in fact, swivel on my heels and reach for the bathroom light switch.

No mistake. There on the middle shelf of the medical cabinet was a pristine, unopened box of condoms.

Oh Jesus.

I felt as though someone had just dropped a large, hot stone into my stomach. My heart rate quickened, I even became a little breathless just standing there looking at that blue and purple box of Durex “Extra Sensitive”.

At the same time, I felt myself becoming hard at the thought of what this might mean.

I picked it up. The plastic wrap was still around the box, unbroken. When did she buy these? I guess I didn’t open the medical cabinet that morning. Or for a while, in fact. Could have been days ago. Was she fooling around with me? Was she trying to send me a message? We hadn’t had sex for a few days, and I guess things weren’t quite as fiery as they had once been when we’d started dating, but there was really nothing wrong with our love life, not for a couple married five years.

Or was Izzie under the impression that it wasn’t good enough, that she wasn’t getting satisfaction?

And if so, was this merely some kind of signal that she was worried about us, somehow? Or was she actively thinking about taking up the ideas we’d talked about — what was it, a year before? Two? How time flew.

What I was clear about was that this — the box of condoms bought by a woman who’d been on birth control since college — had been one of our “clues” that would signal the start of The Game.

Jesus.

My heart fluttered. Had she been leaving me clues that I’d been missing? How long had this box of condoms been sitting there, waiting for me to find it? How far had she gone with The Game?

I put the thing back, closed the medical cabinet, and now hard as a rock, I started looking around — the bathroom, then the bedroom — scouring the scene for anything else I might have missed. Lights went on, of course, but I couldn’t find anything that seemed out of place, couldn’t spot anything else that we’d talked about all those months ago when we’d first come up, semi-jokingly I thought, with The Game before promptly dropping the idea.

I looked under the bed, I opened the wardrobe, I glanced in the laundry basket. Nothing unusual. Likewise with the chest of drawers,

although I did pause while searching Izzie's underwear draw. Was there new lingerie in there? A few items, certainly, I didn't recognize.

It was hardly definite, but still made my heart burn, still made my erect cock throb in my boxer shorts.

Was my wife having an affair? Was she cheating on me? I know I'd said to her, after that fateful dinner party at the Hudsons' place in Georgetown, that if she ever felt the dire need to sleep with another man, I'd be able to cope with it. But I thought the whole way The Game came about was that there was an implicit clause to that agreement which said she wouldn't hide anything from me, I would be made aware of what was going on.

That was the whole point of The Game.

Maybe this was her laying the groundwork, making me aware of what was going on. Nothing had happened yet, I was receiving the first clues.

Boy, was I hard. Clearly the reality was as arousing as the fantasy, then. I sat for a moment or two on the edge of the bed, savoring the feelings rushing through my body. I wasn't angry. I wasn't really jealous, at least I didn't think that was what I was feeling. There was a flicker of fear — from the possibility that I might lose her, I guess. That she might partake of her new lover and decide there were more advantages to spending the rest of her life with him. My rational self had an override for that fear, though. Izzie wasn't like that, Izzie wouldn't do that to me.

Our relationship was perfectly healthy.

I was excited, sitting there. I was buzzing with adrenalin. And, on the balance of things, I did find myself actively hoping that it was true, that Izzie had hit the "start" button on The Game, that she was intending to pursue some crush she might have on a guy at work, or wherever.

Where was she? It was getting late. I glanced at my phone, and there was no message from her. Was she with him, whoever he was? Was she on a date?

I felt my cock twitch at that thought. Suddenly, I was quite seriously craving my wife's body, my wife's kiss, my wife's sex — like I hadn't really in months. The thought of her dating someone else stirred the lust in me like nothing else.

I stood. I wanted to know. I wanted to be sure she hadn't done it yet — my paranoia wanted one last discussion with her, if we were truly going to go through with this. I opened the laundry basket, found her clothes from the previous evening on the top of the pile. Nothing out of the ordinary — just work clothes. Blue shirt, black pencil skirt, black hose, white bra, matching panties. She looked good in any clothes, of course,

but she hadn't made an effort to dress up. Her underwear was fairly plain. The lust surging through my veins made me press it to my face, breathing in her scent, her familiar sweet perfume, the hint of her sex. Her shirt smelled of her, of course, but there was no trace of a man's cologne.

In the rest of the laundry basket, there was nothing obvious, either. No special outfits designed for a date. She hadn't been to a black tie event for a couple weeks, so there was nothing like that here. No special date lingerie stashed down the bottom of the basket.

Maybe I was imagining it all.

The bottom line, though, was: what the hell were those condoms doing in the bathroom? I walked slowly downstairs, feeling strangely that my biggest fear now was that I'd been imagining all this, that Izzie hadn't had the idea to resurrect our talk of The Game now she'd come round to the benefits of it, that there was simply some rational explanation to the Durex box sitting in the bathroom.

My phone buzzed again as I sat at the little desk in the corner of the living room, firing up our shared desktop computer. Martin Townsend again. A deviant idea sprang to mind — but really, there was no way Izzie would be tempted by someone like Martin. Nevertheless, I accepted the call this time.

"Oscar. You home?"

"Uh-huh," I said.

"Power's gone out all over the city already. Crazy night — one little gust of wind, all the damn power cables go down."

"We still have power here," I reported dutifully as I watched our Dell firing up happily enough.

"Well, enough of the city. I'd tell you to stock up while you have it, but you know..."

"You seen Izzie tonight, Mart?" I asked him. I really wasn't thinking he'd call me to tell me my wife had been seen dating someone else, but I had to see if he knew anything before I started calling Izzie direct to ask where she was.

"She not covering the GOP debate tonight?"

A light dose of relief fizzed inside my chest at the recollection that, indeed, she had been due to report on the debate between candidates going for the Republican nomination for President — or as I now remembered, at least the undercard debate between candidates polling outside the top 10.

“Right, I remember,” I replied to Martin. “So — what did you want, Mart?”

“Want you to get round to Pepco, find out just what the hell is going on over there. Why we still have these power lines flapping about in the wind, instead of going through the ground.”

“Think it’s a minor issue known as ‘lack of investment’.”

“Yes, yes, clever dick. But it’s been five years since we investigated the suckers, time to needle them some more. If Facebook can invest in drones to make the Internet available in Outer Mongolia, why do we have the lights flickering on and off at the White House?”

“Sure, Marty. Think they have backup systems in the West Wing, but I can get you something.”

“You can hold off on that Shady Grove piece in the meanwhile.”

“Thanks.”

So, the first thing I had to do once the desktop had booted up was to fire off an email to my guy at Pepco, to set the ball rolling and all that. With that done, I was into Outlook to dip into Izzie’s emails. She might have an excuse for being out tonight, but that didn’t mean something wasn’t brewing for another night. My heart was still hopping like Jiminy Cricket, still optimistic I was going to find something to back up my theory.

If she was embarking on an affair, she wouldn’t leave any traces in her work email. But could she leave traces in her personal email. Would she use the email account she knew I had access to? I had to hope that if she was going to leave the box of condoms out as an obvious clue, she wasn’t going to try to hide her email correspondence with her new lover within some newly-created Gmail account. That she was following the rules of The Game.

Most of her recent emails were junk, which she hadn’t cleaned out yet. Then previous to those, a scattering of messages that weren’t unusual — Facebook alerts, receipts for various online shopping excursions, correspondence with her parents, her sisters.

And here, a few days back, was an email from someone called Jacob, no surname.

Great, I’ll see you Thursday evening, then. Looking forward to it. J

I caught my breath. Thursday evening — a date? That would be tomorrow. Below the one line message, I saw there was a history of messages sent between Izzie and this Jacob. I scrolled down, and read some from the bottom, scanning upwards from old to new messages.

Jacob: There's a place on T St, supposed to be wonderful. Great seafood.

Izzie: I love seafood :-)

Jacob: Then it's a date.

I drew in a gasp as my eyes fell on that word, "date".

Izzie: What's the dress code?

Jacob: Wear something small, something tight.

Izzie: Naughty. I'm not sure I own anything like that ;-)

Jacob: I bet you do, judging by what you wore on Dateline the other week :-P

Jesus. My hand fell into my lap as I read their flirty exchange. I couldn't stop myself grazing a fingertip along the length of my stiff shaft through my boxers. Was this the guy? Was this the man she was intending on seducing? She'd left these emails in her account, she hadn't deleted them — she had to remember I had access to it. She'd left the box of condoms in plain sight...

Izzie: You better book a table in the back if I'm going to wear something like that

Jacob: I'll have them reserve their most private booth

Izzie: Scandalous. I'm a married woman.

Jacob: And I'm chief of staff for an eminent congressman. You can trust me.

Izzie: That's not what I hear about Congress ;-)

This email exchange seemed even more of a confirmation than the box of condoms. God — and I really wanted this. It felt like Christmas morning, and I was getting the giant present under the tree.

Chapter Two

Outside, I heard a huge gust of wind flinging rain at the house. Turning to the window to check it out, I saw the headlights doing their utmost to penetrate the gloom as Izzie's tidy little Volkswagen drew up in the driveway in front of my car.

Shit. What should I do? Tell her I knew what was going on? How was it supposed to go in The Game? The whole thing had been devised because the two of us — professional communicators, would you believe it — found it impossible to open up to each other about the intimate subject of sex. Her Catholic upbringing, my New England childhood had engineered the pair of us to feel deeply uncomfortable about talking about intimate issues, even if we were perfectly happy stripping off and going to bed with each other.

The Game was entirely predicated on the assumption that when it came down to it, she would be too reluctant to come out with anything about her own sexual desires, and I would feel too awkward to inquire.

I clicked out of Izzie's email, and powered down the PC. On went the TV, and I made it onto the couch just in time to appear as though I'd been there a while, just lounging there watching CNN.

"Hey."

"Hey, you okay?" I asked her.

"Just wet. Jesus, this storm. You eat dinner?"

"Had a nibble on the way home," I lied. Truth was, I wasn't even remotely hungry. Just a raging mass of hormones — my cock was still hard in my boxers.

"Gonna take off these clothes," she said, dropping her bag by the desk at which I had just been sitting.

"Good idea. How was the debate?"

"Meh," she said as she started up the stairs. "A load of hot air, all nicely polished by their media trainers."

My pulse was still raised as I sat there waiting for her. Should I do something? Should I go up there, confront her? Demand to know if something was happening, if we really were starting the Game after all?

But I couldn't. That repressed part of me was more terrified of looking foolish, of going up there and embarrassing myself by suggesting this ridiculous fantasy of mine could be made real, than anything.

Izzie was my soulmate, after all. I was intending to spend the rest of my life with her. That fact alone made me reluctant to make a complete ass of myself in her presence.

But now, as I waited, I wondered if she was going to the bathroom medical cabinet to check whether I'd seen her clue. Damn it — was I supposed to have done something with the box of condoms? What had we said all those months ago? She could leave me clues like a box of condoms, and I could leave her evidence that I'd seen her clues, and was on board with it all. If she bought a box of condoms, since she'd need some if she was intending to take a new sexual partner, I would have to move the box so she could tell I'd seen them and approved.

I sat there on the couch wondering if I'd moved the box of condoms enough, if I'd actually put them back where I'd found them, so she wouldn't know I'd seen them and consented to this. Maybe I'd have to go up there later and move them more blatantly.

She was in her scarlet bathrobe when she came back down. She'd dried off her long auburn hair quickly, leaving it a little mussed from the towel, but she still looked searingly beautiful, the bathrobe tied around her waist to highlight her petite frame, dropping down to show most of her thighs.

"You still think Fiorina can step up to the big stage?" I asked her as she wandered quietly through to the kitchen area of our open plan lower floor.

"She was the best of the bunch tonight. But who knows, the way the polling's going."

She stood by the central island in our kitchen, drumming her fingertips on the counter silently. Was she anxious? Was she nervous about dealing with me, now that she was preparing to go on a date with this Jacob guy?

I watched her from the corner of my eye as she ran a hand through her hair, and glanced over at the TV, which was now showing a package summing up that evening's undercard debate, ahead of the main event. I felt a craving to go over there, to take her in my arms, to devour her. The thought that she might want to actually run with my dark little fantasy made her suddenly so irresistible.

"You okay?" I asked her, more an attempt at a prompt, rather than actively worrying about her.

"Just can't really decide if I'm hungry or not," she said with a smile.

She went to the refrigerator and pulled out half a cucumber, which made me think something Freudian was going through her mind. But with a knife and a cutting board, she took off a few slices and began snacking on them.

“What happened with your Shady Grove meeting?” she asked me.

I pulled myself up from the couch. I couldn’t just sit there. “The developers are going to sue,” I said.

“Of course.” She smiled as I walked toward her, as I sidled up to her, one arm wrapping around her waist, pulling her to me as I stood behind her, so I could kiss her cheek.

“I’ll probably be out of a job by the time the case is decided,” I said.

“Oh nonsense,” she said, but couldn’t stop smiling as I kissed her cheek again, then continued planting kisses down her neck.

“We can’t all be star political reporters,” I grinned. “And we know there’s big cutbacks on the way.”

She turned to me, one hand gripping my arm, and kissed my mouth. Her lips were so soft, so sweet. I could smell the rain on her, even over the lingering traces of her perfume. “You’re a fantastic journalist,” she said. “There’s no way they’d want to get rid of you.”

I shrugged as one of my hands found its way to cup one of her breasts over her thin satiny bathrobe. “It doesn’t matter. I’ll find something else.”

She kissed me again, and my hands slid around her waist, over her back, up to take in the slight dampness of her silky hair flowing over her shoulders. She moaned quietly as I leaned down to kiss her neck.

“This is nice,” she said softly. “I don’t normally get this every time I come home.”

I kissed her again, and now fumbled with the knot on her bathrobe cord, unfastening it, exposing her exquisite breasts. “I’m allowed to get horny when my beautiful wife gets home from work, aren’t I?” I smiled.

“Of course,” she grinned as I covered her stiff nipples with my palms. “It’s to be encouraged, in fact. I wish it rained more.”

Her scent swirled around me as I kissed her again, my hands slipping around to hold her cute behind. God I wanted her so badly. Could I really stand idly by while she dated another man? My cock throbbed in my boxer shorts: yes, apparently I could, or at least the horny part of me could. The part of me that loved the idea that other men wanted Izzie as badly as me, that she might have a little fun with them, but then always come home to me.

She squealed as I lifted her up, to place her butt on the kitchen counter, but then melted into me as I stood between her thighs to kiss her soft mouth, her breathing deepening as my kisses descended to her chest, to her breasts, to the velvet vale between her breasts, then up to her hard little buds.

“Mmm... maybe we need to close the blinds,” she said as I began peeling her bathrobe off her shoulders.

“Nobody can see. Not through this storm.”

“Oh... but what if somebody comes to the door... I don’t know... to ask for help because of the storm...”

“They won’t.”

“They could see in through our windows...”

She probably liked the idea that someone might see us. Sitting there on the island, her butt on the edge of the counter, she certainly wasn’t stopping me. She leaned back as I kissed my way down her stomach, her legs parted so I could stroke my face down over her smooth, soft skin to the waistband of her panties.

“Mmm... we’ve never done it here,” she moaned, lying down across the island now.

“No,” I said, inhaling her scent as I drew my mouth and nose over the warm, damp white cotton stretched over her mound. I could smell her arousal already, along with her usual fragrance.

“I like it,” she said, then sucked in her breath as I ran the tip of my tongue over her pussy, though the thin cotton of her underwear remained a barrier.

“Then stay put,” I ordered her, and now stood to peel her panties up over her thighs, her knees, her calves, as she held her legs aloft.

“Mmm... whatever my husband commands,” she smirked, but then closed her eyes, her head tilting back, as I descended on her naked form, as I kissed my way through the small patch of red fur on her mound, and down to the apex of her beautiful flower, filling my chest with her spicy scent.

She gasped as I pressed my mouth against her sex, and her body writhed under me.

“What are you... doing?” she murmured as I sucked on her pussy lips, as I coursed my tongue through her slippery folds.

“What does it look like I’m doing?” I asked, and then swirled the tip of my tongue gently around her clit, not yet touching it directly.

I felt her delicate hand touch down over my head as I began to lap at her increasingly wet pussy, as I sampled her delicious tangy flavor.

“Oh God...”

I loved the soft sound of her moaning and sighing under me, and that little tremor in her breathing, that staccato stutter as she coped with the sexual energy flowing through her body from her soaking pussy.

I’ll admit, normally when we slept together, I probably neglected this part of my duty to Izzie. Not because I didn’t enjoy it — I’d gladly spend all day with my head locked between her thighs if I could — but it was just one of those things that ended up falling by the wayside, when a married couple like us took our usual shortcuts in navigating our sexual congress, both of us usually trying to get to our climax as quickly as possible, instead of truly taking the time to appreciate it all.

Our lives were usually too stressed to really stop and take the time we should for each other, I always believed. But perhaps if we were starting The Game for real, it was time to challenge that approach.

Right now, I couldn’t get enough of my beautiful wife’s sweet pussy. Feasting on her, engorging myself on her, coating my face in her juices as I rubbed against her, as I sucked on her, as I slid my tongue inside her. Sensing that perhaps one day soon, this sweet pussy would be available for someone else to enjoy. The wickedness in that thought, the taboo-busting darkness only drove me on in devouring her.

Her sighs and moans turned into cries and whimpers, her breaths becoming irregular, her hands clamping down on my head, locking me to her as she rode my face to her shuddering climax.

“Where did that come from?” she said, out of breath and beaming from ear to ear, as she sat up, her cheeks flushed, the roots of her hair damp with perspiration.

“I don’t know... I just had a craving for some fresh Izzie,” I said, kissing her mouth, my hands finding their way back to her behind, so I could lift her up off the counter again, depositing her back down on the ground.

“Mmm...” she grinned, “You should let me know every time you get a craving like that.”

“Come on,” I lightly slapped her ass. “Upstairs. Now.”

“My,” she flashed her eyes at me, but started walking toward the stairs. “Aren’t we demanding tonight?”

I followed her, drinking the sight of her naked body in as we went up the stairs, and by the time we got to the first floor, my hands were already reaching for her, touching those pert buttocks.

“What has gotten into you?” she grinned, pulling off my remaining clothes as we reached the bedroom.

“I just need a little quality time with my honey,” I said, crawling onto the bed.

Now it was her turn to drink me in with her eyes, especially my stiff prick standing aloft as I lay on my back, ready for her.

“Okay...” she said, placing her hands on my thighs as she climbed onto the bed herself, to kneel between my legs.

I guess when you’re married, you develop a routine, and even sex can become part of that routine. That’s the way it was for us, or that was the way it had become. It was usually saved for the weekend, or at least the weekends where one or other of us weren’t off on assignment, when we were knocking around the house together. Maybe a quiet afternoon on the couch would turn into something, or just the act of going to bed early for once, without the pressing need to get up early in the morning.

Any break from the routine is seen as unusual. It might even require explanation. My sudden need to make love to Izzie in the middle of the week, early enough that neither of us had even had a proper supper yet, was definitely a break from the routine.

I kind of liked that she was intrigued by why I was suddenly feeling so amorous, though.

She knelt between my thighs and ran her hand over my shaft, saying quietly, “My God, you’re so hard...”

Then she was ducking down to kiss around the base of my cock, her hot breath dancing over my sensitive skin, her velvet cheeks brushing against my shaft.

“I have a hot, naked babe between my legs...” I attempted by way of an explanation. I had to concede, though, that ordinarily, the familiarity of my wife’s nude form meant I’d probably only get halfway or two thirds of the way to full rigidity on visual stimulation alone.

This time, she hadn’t had to even really touch me for me to be at one hundred percent.

Well, the thought of that box of condoms in the bathroom, the recall of that flirty conversation in her email did that. The thought of her taking my fantasy and running with it, actually wanting to try out the strange Game that we’d once concocted without really believing she’d ever do it — it all pumped extra testosterone into my blood.

I moaned as she gripped my shaft in her hands and kissed the tip of my cock before stretching her lips around it, sinking down on it. The heat of her mouth was irresistible around my manhood. Her silver wedding ring glinted in the light from the bathroom as she pumped my cock.

She looked up at me with a mischievous look even as she continued to suck on me, and stroke me in her hands. She was amused at me for my unexpected horniness, though she was enjoying every moment of it.

It didn't last too long, however. She wanted more, after I'd warmed her up in the kitchen. She crawled further up my body, straddling my hips, the smooth skin of her shaven legs gliding against my thighs, the searing heat of her pussy touching down against my shaft.

God, she looked amazing sitting astride me, my naughty red-haired wife. I ran my hands over the curve of her behind, her waist, her lower back, up to those sensational breasts so prominent on her ribs, peaked with pebble-like nipples.

Was I really going to give this up to another man? Well, it would only be temporary, only a loan. And then she'd come back more desirable than ever, my wicked little minx — sullied, sexy, satisfied.

“Oh... wait,” she said, suddenly leaping off me, off the bed.

She slipped into the bathroom for a moment, and I heard her open the medical cabinet. Was now really the time to check I'd seen her clue?

But she came out holding up a single condom, puzzling me in the process.

“I changed my birth control,” she said, climbing back onto the bed, straddling my thighs this time, so she could hold my pole in her hands. “The doctor says we have to use condoms for a couple weeks, you know, so there's no chance of anything getting through during the transition.”

My stomach lurched at hearing her explanation.

I was, it has to be said, disappointed.

“That's what they're for?” I asked her as she tore open the condom packet, and started rolling the cool latex down my shaft.

“Well what did you think they were for?” she asked with a wry grin, lifting herself up on her knees to guide the tip of my sheathed cock to her pussy.

She paused, just the tip of my hardness inside her.

“Wait...” she said, tilting her head, puzzled, “You saw the box of condoms in the bathroom... you thought... you thought it was part of that Game? That I wanted to do... that?”

There was no doubt what she was referring to with the word ‘that’.

She was blushing, fiercely.

“Well what was I supposed to think?” I said. “You've always been on birth control, we've never needed condoms. And suddenly, there they are?”

She wasn't angry at me, it was more that she was surprised — shocked, even. That I had leapt to the conclusion that she might want to play The Game. That I had assumed it. And that the idea really did turn me on —

“Wait — that's what's got you all wound up and horny?” she said, and now slid down on my hardness, taking me inside her.

“You know it's my fantasy.”

“Yeah, but a fantasy. Right up until I went in that bathroom just now, you thought it was real, didn't you? You thought I was... playing. Aren't I supposed to leave more clues than just a box of condoms?”

She began slowly riding me, and it seemed to me that the way her nipples were just so hard, and the way her chest was now flushed — and the way she was just so damn wet down there — was she responding to the thought that I'd believed her to be playing The Game?

“I checked your email,” I said.

“So?”

“Who's Jacob?”

She looked at me for a moment or two, blank. Then something seemed to click, and she relaxed into a sigh. “Oh, Jake. Congressman's Chief of Staff Jake?”

If I'd been a political reporter like her, perhaps I would have known which particular Congressmen's Chief of Staff was called Jake or Jacob. I wasn't, so I didn't.

Izzie smiled. “I forgot about that. He's quite... flirty, isn't he?”

“And you are with him. You have a date lined up for tomorrow night?”

She laughed, and I felt it in the tremor rippling through her tight pussy. “Oh, it's just dinner. And he's just a contact, that's all. He's promised me a copy of the confidential proposals Hillary has for tax reform.”

She paused again, then added, “But I guess I can see how you might take it if you were snooping.”

That little line came with an impish grin. Snooping was allowed in our relationship — always had been. Ever since we'd started dating, and Izzie's conversation had included queries about how this meeting or that meeting of mine had gone — when I'd never ever told her about the meetings in the first place. “We're journalists, what're you gonna do?” had been her response to my startled suggestion that she'd somehow managed to get into my email account. “And you know, having my name as your password is pretty predictable,” she'd added.

It was true, we were both journalists, we liked being in full receipt of all the facts possible. We liked finding stuff out ourselves if we weren't

going to remember to tell each other every little detail about our lives.

And we'd never had any secrets from each other.

Izzie liked prying into my email, she liked reading the vague attempts at short fiction I'd tried, thinking about the future and a career away from journalism. She liked finding out the inner thoughts I disguised in my writing — about her, about life, about everything. I had nothing much to hide, other than the occasional sappy thought about how much I loved her — and it turned out she liked reading that kind of thing, too.

To be honest, I'd delved into her email a little here and there, mostly in those early days when we were dating, rather than married. But these days I rarely did — I just didn't have time to snoop, or the motivation particularly. I knew she still liked to monitor what I was up to behind the scenes, however.

"So you really thought I was going out on a date with Jake on Thursday?" she asked me. "And that I'd left you clues so that you would know what was going on — and so I would be clear to sleep with him if I wanted to?"

She was picking up her pace a little, bouncing on my hardness, and with that glint in her eyes, it reminded me of how she'd been after we'd first come up with the concept of The Game. Despite her reluctance to ever actually play the game, the idea of being free to sleep with other men as well as her husband, without any associated guilt, had appealed to her. She just never believed I'd actually be as into the idea if we ever actually crossed the line and made it real.

"It was an easy conclusion to jump to," I protested.

"Interesting," she said, sitting up as she rode me to brush her long red locks back over her shoulders. "So what would you have done if I hadn't brought out this condom, if I hadn't told you why I bought them?"

"I would have fucked you anyway," I answered her.

She leaned back, supporting her body with her hands behind her, so that as I looked down my chest, I could see my sheathed cock disappearing inside her, see her sweet pussy, her pink pussy lips, her patch of red down. I could watch our penetration — and maybe imagine it was another man thrusting into her, a man wearing a condom because he wasn't her husband.

"But you would have done that believing that I was intending to sleep with another guy. Maybe even Jake, maybe even tomorrow night?"

I popped out of her — in that position, it was easy to slip out. For a moment or two she just sat there, pulling on my shaft with her hands.

"I guess I would," I said.

She grinned. "I can't believe it," she said. "You really thought it was real, didn't you?"

She leaned forward to grab my head, kissing me forcefully. I mumbled an affirmative "Uh-huh" as she sucked on my face, her breasts rubbing against my chest, her hot snatch pressing down on my erection.

"And you were so turned on," she said in an awed whisper. "The way you took me in the kitchen... and God, you were so hard..."

I held her tight in my arms and rolled her over onto her back.

"You know I have that fantasy," I said, lying over her, kissing her mouth and then down her neck, her chest, her breasts.

"But you thought it was real," she breathed as I knelt up to slide the head of my cock inside her pussy once again, gazing at me in the eyes. "You thought I was actually planning on cheating on you... and you still wanted me..."

Sweating as I plunged into her, amid thrusts, I said, "I've told you... haven't I?... I don't... have a problem... with you... enjoying yourself... with whoever..."

She looked up at me in pure wonderment, panting as I squeezed my hardness inside her tight, wet channel. "But you might say that..." she said, "Doesn't necessarily mean... you'll be okay with it... if it really did happen..."

"Only, now I guess I've shown I'd be okay with it."

She nodded, but somehow appeared a little dazed. "More than okay," she said.

Izzie turned over under me, and I gave her space to go onto all fours. Behind her, I ducked down for another taste of her succulent pussy, loving how she moaned as my lips connected with her there, sounding slightly startled, surprised at my hunger for her.

Her pussy was flushed, puffy, and very wet after my penetration. How would I perceive it if we were playing The Game, and she had actually been with another guy before I came to her like this? But imagining that only made me want her more. She squealed as I squeezed her buttocks in my hands and pressed my mouth and my tongue over her sex, I could taste the condom but it didn't put me off.

Then I knelt up, guided the tip of my cock to her entrance, and slid straight in. The two of us were wordless, merely panting for breath, as I held her waist and thrust into her, her petite frame rocking back and forth as I connected with her, her arms collapsing so her head sank into the pillows.

Reaching back under her, between her thighs, she touched her clit as I fucked her. Was she imagining how it would be to actually play The Game? For her to have another man behind her, fucking her like this? The first other man to have her in years?

Whatever she was thinking of, she came quickly, her moans turning to shrill cries, her body shaking under me. Somehow, I didn't come myself. It was all still going through my mind —

She turned over again, onto her back once again, raising her legs and holding her knees up to her chest. She was done, but I wasn't. She seemed content, her breathing even softening, easing, recovering her breath as I slid back inside her pussy.

“So if I understand you rightly,” she said, seeming surprisingly calm, though I was still panting and sweating and thrusting into her, “you really do want us to play The Game, right? For real.”

I tried to act calm, in the circumstances. To appear as though I was giving her my considered opinion, not some reaction to the fact that I was currently in the process of getting laid.

I said, “I think I've always wanted it.”

She said, “Interesting.”

With that, I slammed into her hard. I said, more of a grunt than anything, “Does that mean you want to try it?”

She looked deep in my eyes and nodded, which made me come deep inside her, within our protection.

Chapter Three

Dinner at the Hudsons' envy-inducing red-brick townhouse in Georgetown always provoked interesting discussions, but on that particular evening a couple years back, it was one of the more memorable ones.

There were usually a good dozen of us seated around their huge dining room table, most of us from Columbia back in the day, with a few spouses and partners added to the mix — those who could stomach so many media types in one room. Izzie, being a media type herself, had always thrived in such conditions.

On this particular evening, we were gossiping about one of those media rumors that circulated widely among our industry, but likely as not would never actually make it to the general public. Believe it or not, there are some secrets that the media will, as a homogenous mass, clam up about, even without a court injunction. In this case, the fact that a reporter from the Washington Times had slept with a source purely to get the story was probably only of interest to DC-based journalists anyway, so there wouldn't be any benefit to anyone to run the story publicly.

But, it did throw up an interesting question for our dinner party: would you sleep with a source if it meant getting your hands on the most fantastic story?

Of course, the straight-down-the-line ethical answer was, certainly not. But then again, the straight-down-the-line ethical approach was never to pay for a story, never to even buy someone lunch just to get a story — but no reporter was going to flinch from a little inducement here and there if it meant bagging a hot exclusive.

Our discussion veered into talking about the wider field of adultery as Izzie spoke up as one of the few women willing to state categorically that she would sleep with a source if the importance of the story justified it, and if there really was no other solution.

“And if my source doesn't turn my stomach,” she'd added, to much mirth from around the rest of the table.

“So what does your husband have to say about that?” came the booming voice of John Hudson, our host and probably the most successful among us since he had his own late-night show on CNN.

“Oh, but we were talking hypothetically,” Izzie insisted. “We weren’t hypothetically being married while considering the question, were we?”

She looked across at me almost apologetically, for suggesting she might be willing to cheat on me just to get a story if it was a decent enough scoop.

Funny, but I looked at her, sitting across the table from me — since the Hudsons liked to split up couples if any should appear around their dinner table — and suddenly the thought popped into my mind that if Izzie were to cheat on me to get a good story... maybe I wouldn’t be so angry about it.

In fact, looking at her sitting there in a figure-hugging white dress that could probably cause drivers to lose concentration and drive into the Potomac, I found myself thinking that actually it might be quite interesting if Izzie were to be tempted into an adulterous liaison for the purposes of her journalism. Or for any other purposes, for that matter. Why did I have thoughts like that?

While I was having those particular thoughts, I think I experienced the first inappropriate erection I’d had in years. Perhaps even since I was an adolescent.

“Would you leave her, Oscar?” came the question from Michael Angeles, a staffer on a finance magazine the name of which escapes me. “If she cheated on you to get a story?”

Somebody else chipped in: “Maybe you could sleep with someone to get a story, even the score?” It may have been Harry Tybalt, a producer at a local TV news show.

There was much laughter, loosened by the strong red the Hudsons had been circulating during our meal of elaborately roasted duck on a bed of melt-in-the-mouth vegetables.

I guess I’d had as much plonk as the next guy, as I felt very relaxed about it all. I said quite casually, “Oh, I’d never leave her.”

Izzie beamed affectionately at me from across the table.

Marie McCoy, a dark-haired mischief-maker who was one of Izzie’s best friends from college, and also a New York Times correspondent posted on Capitol Hill, leaned over to me to say: “That’s sweet, honey, but don’t you think now she knows that, she’ll feel she can just go out and cheat on you?”

“Of course not!”

“I mean, you just said you’d stay with her, right? What’s stopping her from doing it?”

Marie’s wavering eyebrows suggested that if it was her, and her husband pledged to stand by her side if she ever decided to cheat on him, she would be straight out there hitting the bars and restaurants to find a guy with which to do exactly that.

“She’s got carte blanche!” John Hudson roared with laughter. “She knows you’ll forgive her!”

Izzie piped up, “Uh... there would be something to stop me doing it — guilt. I wouldn’t actually want to hurt my husband.”

A pitying look from my wife now, that she’d opened our cosy marriage to this hypothetical onslaught.

Marie chuckled, and said to Izzie, “But if you were really tempted — like by the most gorgeous guy in the world. Or the biggest dick. And you knew at the end of the day if Oscar found out, he’d still want to save your marriage...”

“That would be kind of cynical, wouldn’t it?” Izzie replied.

“Oscar, you’d have to rethink your whole pledge to stand by her if she did that, right?” asked Michael.

I heaved a sigh that quietly called on everyone to drop the subject and move on, but felt pressured to give an answer. “I don’t know... I love her,” I said. “If she felt so tempted that she’d go against her whole sense of guilt just to do it... I don’t know... I think I’d have to feel it was worth it, too.”

Marie was cackling, and shoving an elbow into Izzie’s side. “Sounds to me like you have the green light to sleep with whoever you want, girl!”

“I wouldn’t. That’s the point of marriage, isn’t it?” Izzie said.

The thing is, Izzie was saying that as a good wife, but I could see the wheels turning inside her mind. I think if she was presented with the right kind of story offer, it might be hard for her to turn down a little dodgy dealing like that. The thing is, I’ve always been a bit of a journeyman when it comes to journalism. I work hard, I do my best, I give good coverage in my specialist areas — but I accept I’ve peaked with a reporter’s job at the Messenger. I’ll give you an accurate account of anything that’s going on in the world of business, if it falls in my plate, if I luck out with one of my contacts. But I’m not that ruthless kind of reporter who will bring down governments. I don’t have that spark of ambition that will have me tearing White House policies apart to uncover

scandalous problems — or meet in underground parking lots with shady figures to get information to depose Presidents.

Izzie is the ambitious kind of reporter, always has been. I've often wondered how far she'd go if she caught the possibility of a major exclusive at the end.

There at the dinner table, I got the distinct impression — just from her eyes — that if she were truly tempted by the right kind of scoop, she might go for the whole adultery deal. And strangely enough, that kind of excited me.

Both of us seemed oddly silent for the rest of that dinner, I can tell you. We'd pipe up if directly challenged, but if you were really paying attention, based on past performance you'd definitely say we were muted.

I think I was a little shocked, to be honest, that looking at Izzie and imagining her taking some kind of deal that required her to sleep with some besuited source in an anonymous hotel room somewhere downtown, actually started to turn me on. If I thought about it too much, my pants started to become a little tight and I'd have to shift in my seat to get comfortable again.

I think she was, perhaps, debating with herself as to whether she really would cheat on her husband if the best scoop of her career really necessitated it. And how she should factor in the assertion I'd made that if she really had to do something like that, I would stand by her, I wouldn't want to lose her.

Was she thinking that when it all came down to it, she might be tempted to flout her wedding vows for the right story? God, I found myself sitting at that table wishing she would.

*

We took a taxi home to the apartment we'd had at the time in Bethesda, in the north-west of the city. And for a fair way up through Chevy Chase, we were both silent. I was thinking about how sheltered an upbringing I'd had up in New Hampshire. I hadn't even known anyone until I reached high school whose parents were split up — and my parents were solid as a rock.

Perhaps if I'd come from a broke home, I'd think very differently about the prospect of turning a blind eye to my wife being tempted into

adultery to attain an exclusive.

But there I was, and it wasn't just that I was theoretically on board with turning a blind eye to Izzie fooling around a little: right now, it seemed to have graduated into actual sexual arousal concerning the prospect. And I didn't want to turn a blind eye, I wanted to know actual details of my wife's infidelity.

It made her more desirable in my eyes.

We were probably ten, fifteen minutes from home when Izzie suddenly broke the silence in the back of that cab.

"You'd really let me?" she said.

"Let you?" I prompted her, since I wasn't party to her thought process before she'd finally opened her mouth.

"If a seriously good story required it," she said, "and I was seriously tempted to take another guy up on his offer... you're really saying you'd... forgive me?"

"Forgive you?"

"You'd stand by me, though. You wouldn't want to end our marriage?"

I chuckled, trying to make light of it, though my heart was thumping away in my chest and my cock was feeling pretty fat in my pants. "Are you saying you've got a source all lined up ready to sleep with?"

"No. But you seemed remarkably relaxed about the idea... I mean, I don't think I know any guys who would be that... understanding."

Understanding. I felt my prick throbbing between my thighs. The word seemed to suggest that in Izzie's eyes, there really would be an occasion where it would be appropriate to sleep with a source.

"I guess I'm not like other guys," I said.

"You don't care?" there was an edge to her voice. I didn't like it — but I could see why it was there.

"It's not that..." I sighed. "It's not that I don't care. It's... I'm not sure why... but it just seems... I don't know... kinda hot to me."

My stumbling explanation silenced her for a moment.

Then she said, "'Kinda hot'?"

Another sigh from this direction. I'd never been good at talking about my feelings. At talking about anything vaguely risqué. Izzie neither.

"I don't know... thinking of you that way... you know, breaking the rules, being a bad girl... I guess it turns me on a little."

There in the darkness, I was blushing like a schoolgirl. I hoped sincerely that our driver couldn't hear our conversation. He had some radio station on up there, offering some kind of music — I never had any idea about music — so hopefully it covered our discussion.

“It turns you on, thinking of me cheating on you to get a story?” she said quietly. Perhaps she’d been thinking the same thing about our driver.

Suddenly I felt her hand crawling over my thigh, then sweep slowly up to my crotch — only for her fingers to spread across the stiffness I was fostering under my pants.

“Jesus!” she gasped. “You really aren’t kidding!”

“I guess it would just... I don’t know... make you seem a more interesting person...”

“You’re saying I’m boring?”

“Not at all. You’re an interesting person already — you know that. This would just make you... more fascinating.”

I don’t think she was really offended at my suggestion that infidelity would make her more interesting. She had left her hand conspicuously on my erection, and was gently stroking it in the darkness.

“Adultery makes a person fascinating?” she said, her tone neutral. Inquiring, not really judging. “You’d want me to do it, even if it wasn’t only to get a story, huh?”

I added, “It’s just... I guess... it’s just exciting. Thinking of you being bad.”

“Even with some other guy?”

“Even with some other guy. I can’t really explain it. I never thought about it before. It’s just hot.”

“It would be hot if you found out, you mean?”

“Well, I suppose if I didn’t know about it, it couldn’t be a turn-on.”

I couldn’t complain at having her stroking my cock in there. It felt good, and the risk of being caught only made it feel better. My guess is she wasn’t expecting much of a performance from me after all the wine I’d had that evening, but here I was, hard as granite. She wanted to keep it going until we could get home.

After a brief pause, she broke the silence again. “I couldn’t ever do it to you. You know that, right?”

“Because of the guilt?”

“It would eat me up inside. Knowing I was going behind your back, hurting you.”

“What if there was no guilt?”

She laughed at that. “Well, then I’d be a sociopath, right? And I’d be able to do anything. I’d probably be in jail right now.”

“If you knew it was a turn-on for me, though. Then there’d be no guilt, right?”

She was silent again, but now her fingers were fumbling with my belt, with my fly. She pulled open my pants, and slipped her hand in my underwear, to grasp hold of my cock directly.

“But it would only be a turn-on if you knew about it?” she said.

“Right.” I moaned as her fingers curled around my bare cock.

“So I’d have to tell you about it. How much detail would you need?”

“Much as possible.”

“See, I’m not sure I could do that. I mean, if the other guy didn’t want you to know...”

“He’d be stealing my wife — you’d be worried about his feelings?”

“And anyway, I think it would be weird for me. To report back to you what was going on. I mean, I’ve never been good at... well, talking about that kind of thing.”

“You wouldn’t have to write a poem about it.”

God, her hand felt good. I really didn’t want to come in that taxi before we got home, before I could really make use of this erection.

“What, I’d come home and say ‘I did it’, and that would be enough for you?”

“If it came to it,” I said. “But you could find other ways of letting me know about what was going on — if you weren’t happy talking about it.”

“Other ways?”

“I don’t know... write a journal. Or... leave me clues to what’s going on.”

“Clues?”

It was hard to concentrate on our conversation, the way she was manhandling me in the back of that taxi. My own hand wandered over her smooth, warm thigh, perhaps it could be some kind of distraction for me, so I could avoid going over the edge. Izzie didn’t stop me. She even parted her legs a little more, so my fingers could slip steadily up under her dress, to find her panties already damp.

She moaned as I began to stroke her there.

I said, “Well... you know... if I saw you’d bought a box of condoms, I’d know you didn’t need them for us. So I’d know something was going on.”

“Okay. Box of condoms, check.”

“If you bought some fancy new underwear for your date,” I suggested. “I mean...”

She joked, “I never buy fancy new underwear for you? Oh, I’m sorry honey...” But it was kind of true. We were married. I wasn’t expecting it.

“Well, you know, if it wasn’t Valentine’s Day, or my birthday or whatever...”

“Okay. So new lingerie. Check.”

“If you were out for the night, leaving me no explanation.”

“Might be suspicious.”

“Maybe I look in your email and find you’ve been chatting to some guy. And you’ve arranged a date. And maybe you’ve booked a hotel somewhere else in the city for one night only.”

“Okay,” she giggled, “I could see those could be clues. And that would be enough for you? To turn you on?”

“If there wasn’t any doubt. Maybe you’d come up with other clues.”

“And then you’d be okay about me sleeping with some other guy?”

“Don’t see why not. If you came back to me after.”

“And you’d still want me? We’d still sleep together?”

A couple of my fingers slipped under the soaking cotton of her panties, to dip into her burning-hot pussy, drawing a quiet gasp from her.

“Of course,” I said. “More than ever.”

She pulled my hard cock free of my pants, and it seemed so exposed there in the cab. I had to assume the driver wasn’t going to see.

Then she said, “And this would, what, mean you had permission to sleep with whoever you wanted to, as well?”

“Not at all. It would all be about appreciating you. I... I just like the idea of you having an extraordinary sex life.”

“A sex life that didn’t just involve you?”

“It would hardly be extraordinary if it was only me.”

“And I’d just leave you a breadcrumb trail, and that would be okay? I guess you’d want to spy on us.”

“Maybe.”

“You wouldn’t get jealous? If I brought him home some time. Tipped you off so you could watch.”

Okay, that was a little dangerous to hear. That was putting me at risk of coming all over the taxi. I wasn’t sure what the fine would be for that kind of mess. Probably get arrested, for that matter.

“Maybe...” I groaned.

“Pervert,” she said, grinning in the darkness as she gripped my cock tightly.

I brought my hand up to my mouth, tasted her arousal. “You’d get to sleep with your guy, guilt-free,” I said.

“You’d be horrified!” she laughed. “If we really played that kind of game, as soon as you figured something was about to happen, you’d be,

like, ‘stop, stop, stop!’”

“I don’t think I would.”

Izzie twisted in her seat, and dropped her head down into my lap to — my God! — take me in her mouth for a moment or two. Then, she was back up, sitting straight, moaning contentedly at her brief taste of cock.

“We’d have to have a safe word,” she said.

“Look at you, Ms Fifty Shares of Grey.”

“Knew you read that book.”

“Read it, still hated it. I’m not into the whole hitting women thing.”

“It’s not... look, I’m not getting into that again.”

“So what would the safe word be?”

“How about ‘Christian’.”

I groaned at that. I was not going to blurt out “Christian” to her or anyone else. But now we were pulling up into our street, finally. I had to quickly pull my pants together again, even though my manhood was rather sizably in the way.

The driver seemed none the wiser for our little indiscretion during the journey as I paid him. We stood and watched him drive away.

“You’re crazy, you know that?” she said. “I’d never cheat on you!”

“It wouldn’t be cheating if you let me in on the secret,” I said.

She grabbed my hand, pulled me to her.

“Shut up — just fuck me, pervert,” she said with a wicked grin.

*

Thursday morning, as she headed out to work, Izzie told me she’d be late back that night.

“I know,” I said. “You have that hot date. Jacob, wasn’t it?”

She smirked. “I told you, didn’t I? He’s just a contact. He’s got a confidential report for me.”

I was lounging on the couch in sweatpants, though the TV was off, as were all the lights — the power cut had expanded to include our house at some point during the night. I was using my cell phone to download some background info to my laptop ahead of my ten o’clock coffee meeting with my guy at the local power company, Pepco. It was kind of nice sitting there in peace for once.

Izzie, on the other hand, looked especially good in a gray twill jacket, white shirt and tight black pants. She’d brushed her red hair particularly

straight, and seemed to me to be wearing more make-up than usual, particularly around her deep brown eyes. Date-ready?

“You look nice,” I said, getting up to give her a proper farewell. “For your non-date, I mean.”

A brief eye-roll at that. “When I’m going on a date, you’ll be able to tell,” she said. God, something about the way she said it — or the way she used the word ‘when’ — made me almost immediately rock-hard.

“You do feel differently about it, now, then?” I asked her. Using the word ‘it’ was a classic hallmark of our inability to really talk detail on intimate subjects. A favorite go-to word. I don’t feel like it tonight. It’s been ages since we’ve done it. You’re in the mood for it right now?

Only this time, ‘it’ didn’t just refer to sex in general.

She gave a shy smile, which only made my cock harder still in my pants. “I guess I have a different opinion about it,” she admitted. “I can see it might not be such a threat to us. Might even have certain... advantages.”

I smiled, approaching her. She turned her head so I could kiss her on her cheek, so I definitely wouldn’t mess up her lipstick with the normal peck on the mouth. She smelled extra good, too. Her special perfume.

“So have fun tonight,” I said, trying to be casual, though my chest was all fluttery again.

She smiled, her eyes running all over my face, seeing the hope in my expression, and responding with a touch of mild surprise, still, and perhaps also quiet delight.

“He’s just a contact,” she said.

“Of course,” I grinned. “But if you feel like — “

She shook her head. “If we’re going to play The Game — if we’re really going to play it — then it won’t be for a while. I have to get my new birth control sorted, remember?”

I nodded. She was right. True, she could use condoms to sleep with someone else, but both of us would feel safer with that extra level of protection if this really were to happen.

“And if I’m really going to do this — you can’t hate me if it turns out you don’t like it.”

“I’d never hate you.”

“You’d tell me to stop.”

“Of course. If need be.”

She nodded, and gave me a wicked grin.

Chapter Four

It was a fairly busy day — I kind of liked working on a story that was really affecting people in the city. After my coffee meeting with my Pepco guy, Harold Mortensen, I dodged the fallen branches on my way into the office, where I hit the phones to gain the official view from the power company that had, a few years back, borne the title as most hated company in America.

In quiet moments, though, I found my mind wandering to Izzie's evening meeting with the Congressman's aide. I was actually hoping something might come of it, other than just some report about a candidate for the Democratic nomination.

My logic, though, told that while Izzie had always been quite flirty with people to get information out of them, when it came to actually dating guys, she was quite picky. I remember when we were first working together at the Hartford Tribune, just how many guys were after her — and though she never made any of them think they didn't have a shot, she held out against all actual date offers as far as co-workers were concerned.

It took until we were no longer working together before she would consider dating me, for example, during the long hiatus before we both ended up in Washington working for the Messenger. And even then, our dating had been the result of one of her friends deciding to matchmake us, since she'd always said we were 'perfect for each other', and Izzie had had a long series of disappointments as far as dating men was concerned.

Still. I remained optimistic when it came to 10pm, and her old Beetle pulled into the driveway once again — late for just a meeting with a contact, I was supposing.

She was still looking good in the same outfit she'd been rocking that morning as she came in the door.

"Hey — power not back on?" was the first thing she said, since our house like every house on the street — in the neighborhood — was dark. I had a few candles out here and there, and had been tapping away on my

laptop on the couch thanks to the illuminated keyboard and the light from the screen.

“Not yet. Middle of tomorrow, if we’re lucky. If not at the weekend,” I said, stepping up to greet her. “So how’d the date go?”

In the light of the candles, I saw her eyes roll, but she was smiling all the same. “What would you do if I said I gave in to him?” she grinned. “What would you do if I told you we ended up going to a motel somewhere outside the Beltway?”

I laughed, but under the surface wanted it to be true. I brushed my hands through her hair, and cradled her head in my palms to draw her in for a kiss. “I’d probably want to take you upstairs,” I said.

“Uh-huh?” she beamed, and led me in another kiss. “And what would you want to do with me up there?”

“Come on,” I said, grabbing her hand, pulling her to the stairs. “I’ll show you.”

I guess it was as good a thing as any to do when there was no power.

“So you had fun with him?” I asked her, as we pulled together, hands roaming all over each other, foreheads touching together, noses crushing together, lips sucking on lips, tongues dancing together.

“Uh-huh,” she said, tearing off her jacket, while I fumbled with the fly of her pants.

I could taste the zesty dry white wine on her breath, and as I drew in deep breaths laced with her perfume, I tried to tell whether she’d really been with someone or not, though I knew for the most part this was role-play.

We’d done a fair amount of role-play after we’d initially invented the concept of The Game. It was fun.

“You want me to shower right now?” she asked, teasing me, suggesting something had happened.

“No,” I kissed her neck, and I could detect a hint of cigar smoke in her scent. It was something for my imagination to hang onto.

Then she was sitting in my lap as I perched on the edge of the bed, pressing herself down on the hardness inside my pants as she held my head and kissed me. I let my imagination run wild, picturing her meeting with some faceless Capitol Hill aide, sneaking away with him in the night.

“I should freshen up...” she murmured.

“Stay here,” I insisted.

She pulled off my shirt, and then we were both unfastening the buttons on hers, making me think of that old adage, “too many cooks...” Off it

came, though, and her bra, too. I held her sweet breasts in my hands as she began rocking her hips over me, rubbing herself against my hardness.

“Was he... good?” I asked. I guess I did wish we were better at talking dirty with each other. It was just awkward. So we left it as brief as possible, usually.

“Very,” she grinned as I kissed down her cheek and down her neck, kneading her breasts in my palms.

Funnily enough, our concise sex talk might actually have helped the role-play seem more real, when we did it. It spurred the imagination, after all, and role-play is all about spurring the imagination.

Right now, simply telling me her new lover had been very good sent my imagination reeling, picturing her in the throes of passion with her faceless guy, his strong body lying over her, driving inside her.

“It doesn’t bother you?” she said, her breathing deepening.

“What would be the point if he wasn’t good?”

She beamed, and kissed me again, though now she was slipping down onto the floor, kneeling in front of me, working to unfasten my belt, then drag my pants down off my legs. She stroked the bulge in my boxer shorts, gazing into my eyes — and somehow it seemed more intense than when we’d role-played before.

She was looking at me to tell if I really would be on board if we were playing The Game for real. It wasn’t just a pure hypothetical any more, she had actually hinted that it could happen.

“You’re not jealous, then?” she said.

“No.”

She pulled the waistband of my boxers down to reveal my hard cock, and licked slowly from base to tip, once, twice. Then her tongue was swirling around the head of my cock.

“You’re not freaked out I’ve... been... with someone else?”

She had to have felt my hardness throbbing in her hands at that. She giggled. She dragged my boxers down and off, then her licking of my shaft soon turned to sucking on my tip, and bobbing down on my hardness. I looked down on her as she sucked on me, her hands brushing her hair out of her face as she did so, and could imagine she might do this with someone else, if she were out there being unfaithful.

She was moaning quietly, elated at how hard I was in her hand, in her mouth.

She pulled herself up to kiss my mouth, and it just seemed wicked that she’d just been using that on my cock — and maybe, in our little scene, on somebody else’s cock.

“So I come home, after my date...” she said, “...and you can tell from kissing me... that it’s really happened?”

“Uh-huh,” I replied.

Izzie climbed up my body, clambering back onto the bed, pushing me back down, straddling my hips, kissing my mouth forcefully, pressing herself down on my hard cock. She was panting a little now, and I got the distinct impression that it turned her on, that I fantasized about making love to her after she’d just been with someone else.

She pushed my hands down onto her breasts while she kissed me, unsubtle in what she wanted, and as I cupped her soft mounds, my fingers and thumbs finding their way to her stiff nipples, I felt one of her hands close around my cock between her thighs, and start to pump me.

“Another man has been inside me,” she said, “and now I’m with you...”

This was perhaps the dirtiest I’d ever heard her talk in bed. It was up there, anyway. But it was more than just her trying to sow the seeds of my imagination this time: she was putting questions out there to confirm I would be okay with this kind of scenario in real life.

I sat up, and pressed my face between her breasts, kissing her there, and up to take her sensitive buds in my mouth, one by one.

“It only makes me want you more than ever,” I said.

Now I held her hips, and lifted her while lying down, pushing myself under her, between her thighs. She let out a quiet squeal, but got the gist of what I was doing. As I lay on my back, she shuffled up me, and moved so her knees were on the mattress either side of my head.

I pulled her down to me, kissing her inner thighs, her sex touching down against my mouth and nose, though her white panties were in the way.

I breathed her in, the spicy scent of her arousal overpowering her perfume. She sighed as she felt the heat of my mouth on her, and then moaned as I pulled her panties to the side sufficient to open her slippery flower to my enjoyment.

Her flavor, her scent was intoxicating to me. Tangy, salty, musky. In my imagination, perhaps there was the hint of latex from another man’s condom. The faint smell of a cologne that wasn’t mine. The vague traces of him on her — just enough to really emphasize her wickedness, her depravity, her infidelity.

Izzie moaned as I lapped at her juices, and now leaned back to hold my stiff shaft, to pump me for a while, at least until things between her

thighs became a little too intense. Then she was more focused on her own pleasure, and I was fine with that.

She hopped up for a moment to remove her panties, but then she returned to me, holding my hands as I gripped her thighs over me, sighing, panting, her body heaving as I ate her, as I flicked my tongue over her soaking pussy lips, over her sensitive clit, then wedged my face into her body to suck on her and press my tongue gently inside her.

When I reached up to touch her breasts, it sent her over the edge, her body trembling, her breathing becoming jagged, irregular, rocked by cries as she came forcefully over me. I had the most beautiful view of her I could possibly get as I lapped at her copious juices, gazing up over her flat stomach, her breasts, those sensationally hard nipples, and her pretty face riven with the tension of an all-out climax.

She took a moment to compose herself, and climbed down to lie over me again, smiling so sweetly, loving me, adoring the depraved streak in me.

“That’s what you’d want to do to me after my date?” she said, beaming as she kissed my mouth, her hips now gyrating as she lay over me, so I could feel her hot pussy stroking my hardness.

“Definitely,” I said.

“Even if I’d gone all the way with him?”

“It’s only sex.”

“Mmm...” she grinned, and now lifted herself up and off, before plucking a condom from her bedside table, tearing open the packet before running the sheath down over my hardness. “There,” she said, and climbed on me once again, positioning herself to take the tip of my cock inside her.

I held her tightly in my arms and sat up, my legs dangling over the edge of the bed, and I was pumping my hips to thrust my cock deep inside her as we kissed. She held onto my neck and rode me, her own hips jerking and jumping as she fucked me hard, panting away, sighing and groaning and crying as she did.

I was hardly your fittest guy, but the adrenalin flooding my system turned me into a titan. I held her and lifted her, and stood to turn her, to drop her on the bed on her back so I could mount her, lay between her legs and shove myself back inside her forcefully, taking possession of her.

She squealed in delight, and then continued her moaning and her writhing under me as I took her, imagining her to be the nymphomaniac unfaithful wife of my fantasy, the dirty, naughty wench to be tamed.

She was whimpering and yelping by the time I came to my conclusion, shooting my come deep inside her, albeit protected by a thin sheath of latex.

God, it was getting better and better between us. And I could see it in her eyes afterward, as we just held each other for ages, my softening cock still inside her, that she was viewing this fantasy of mine as the conduit for these kind of passions. Things between us had always been good — but never that good. Or at least, not since the last time we'd been role-playing these kind of taboo-busting thoughts.

What would it be like to play The Game for real?

"I'm not going to tell you, when it starts," she said after a while, after we'd both recovered our breaths.

"No," I said. "You don't have to."

"You'll have to pay attention. Because it seems to me the rules have changed slightly."

I raised an eyebrow at that. "How so?"

She smiled. "You remember how this started? We said I'd have to leave you clues so you'd know what was going on — so that I could avoid guilt when I was dating someone else."

"I remember," I said.

"I was a little concerned maybe you'd miss my clues. Then I'd be going ahead with it, and you might not know it was happening."

"Right."

"Only, now I get the feeling I wouldn't feel so guilty about dating someone, even if you miss my clues."

"That so?"

"Because I'd know it would still turn you on when you did find out. And you wouldn't be pissed at me for doing it."

"No, I wouldn't. I'd be happy you had some fun."

She grinned. "So it really is a game, right? I leave you clues, and you really better not miss them, or you'll miss out on all the fun from your wife being unfaithful."

I laughed, "I'll have to be very careful not to miss anything."

She kissed me. "I think we'll have to play it by ear. I'd hate for you to miss all the fun..."

While Izzie wasn't intending to rush into anything, we were fairly feverish in our desires for each other over the next couple of weeks. Put it this way, during that time we got through a large box of condoms and had to buy another.

Once that box was gone, Izzie was of the opinion she was protected enough that we could continue without the assistance of Mr Durex.

And I was of the opinion that from what Izzie had said, the Game could start at any time.

Chapter Five

The sexual tension between us was unbelievable for a few weeks. It was the anticipation, more than anything. Early on, she came home one night from work and found me on our desktop computer checking out her email, her Facebook account, our joint bank account online.

Creepy behavior for a normal husband, I agree, but we had an open book as far as sensitive information in our relationship — Izzie had started it, and I had followed suit, and now there was nothing remarkable about us checking out what the other was up to. Normally, though, it was so unremarkable that I rarely bothered checking out her inner secrets. But now the Game had started, I dipped in each evening briefly when I got home from work, just to make sure I wasn't missing anything.

To start with, it was just exciting to snoop on my wife with the idea in mind that she could be misbehaving, she could be laying the groundwork for an affair. And even though she wasn't, most of the time Izzie was just plain flirty with guys anyway, so it fed my fantasies.

Izzie: Hey hon, would you be the sweetest guy in the world and tell me where Congressman Vito is on the healthcare Bill?

Scott: Sure — I could tell you over a drink or two at the Panacea.

Izzie: Mmm... they have a cocktail that makes me warm all over...

Scott: I'll buy you two ;-)

Izzie: You free tonight?

Scott: Sure. 7pm?

Izzie: Sounds like a date x

Oh, it sounded like a date, but this was always the way Izzie was with certain contacts. She had most young male Capitol Hill staffers — and plenty of older ones, too — eating out of her hand. I used to tease her about it, about how she used her female charms to get ahead, but she always just threw back in my face how Washington's so male-biased. And I knew she had concerns about going any further than drinks with her regular contacts in Washington — these guys liked to brag, even if they were bedding someone's wife.

Anyway. One evening she came home and for the first time in a long while found me glancing at her Facebook account. There was instantly fire in her eyes.

“So it really is happening, huh?” she said, sounding almost as though she was in disbelief.

“Uh-huh,” I said. “Isn’t it?”

She seemed shocked. We’d talked it all over, but she really was surprised that I actually accepted that we were really playing The Game.

“So how does it go?” she asked. “I mean, how does it start?”

I shrugged, and clicked to log out of her Facebook account. “You’re basically a single woman,” I said. “As far as dealing with other guys, anyway.”

“Single.” She seemed to mull the word over in her mouth, as though tasting a special wine or whiskey.

“You do as you like, as though you were, anyway.”

“Okay...”

“So what would you do if you were still single?” I asked her, standing up to approach her. “Or if you were newly single.”

“Wow, that is a question,” she said. “It’s been so long since I was single. I’m not sure...”

I wrapped my arms around her. “You don’t have to rush into anything, you know. You do what you want to. At your pace. Whatever makes you comfortable.”

She kissed me. “And as far as... you know... is concerned... I’m single?”

“Uh-huh.”

Her hand found its way to my crotch, where she found my cock already hard inside my pants. She said, “Well I guess if I’m single, I’m going to have to go out a hell of a lot more than I do now.”

I smiled at that, along with the way she was stroking me through my pants. “Are you saying being married to me has stopped you from going out at night?”

She grinned. “No,” she said, “if I wanted us to go out, I’d tell you. I do tell you. We go out, sometimes.”

“We do.”

“But if you want me to get laid,” she said, the fire in her eyes positively roaring now, “I’m going to have to step it up, right?”

“I guess so.”

With that she dropped to her knees and pulled my hardness out of my pants, and into her mouth. This was how it was in the beginning. She

seemed to want reassurance that we really were playing the Game. That she really could respond to a man's advances if she wanted to, she really could invite a guy out on a date if it tickled her fancy. She really could take someone to a motel for an illicit encounter if she so desired. I'd give her the reassurance, and we'd soon end up in bed as she worked through the realization of what being an effective single woman meant.

It took a while for her to warm up to it, though. To actually do something.

That didn't mean there weren't early signals from her playing of the Game.

The next day, she joined the gym. She was late home from work, and our joint bank account showed her paying a gym registration fee when I checked. Then she came home in sweats, fresh from a workout.

"You joined the gym?"

"Uh-huh."

"Because we're... playing?"

"Uh-huh."

"You don't need to join a gym," I said. "You're seriously hot already."

"Thanks," she smiled. "But you know... it just boosts my confidence."

"Okay..."

"And there are so many hot guys in the gym."

"Right..."

"And besides, I want to be as fit as I can for when... you know... it happens..."

There was that word, 'it', again. It got me going. It got both of us going — I joined her in the shower after that, shortly after I'd helped tear off her workout clothes, and for a while neither of us were getting any cleaner under the warm flow of water.

At the weekend, she had to go out shopping for clothes in which she could better portray herself as a single woman on nights out.

She cleared out a load of old clothes to make space in the wardrobe — and also, I noticed, she cleared out her underwear drawer, filling it with new bras and panties, not to mention some special lingerie.

She bought new perfume, she started wearing more make-up than usual.

She waxed her bikini line.

All of these little clues were easy enough for me to observe — and each time I noticed something, it only drove me to want her more, and usually ended up with us both in bed working out our anticipation

excitement. But none of them in themselves suggested that anything was actually going to happen.

Her emails with a number of guys were still flagrantly flirtatious — but then they had been before. She wasn't suggesting drinks, or a night out, with any of them.

I even played the stalker, and drove by her gym occasionally, to see if anything was happening while she worked out. She was flirty with a couple of guys, and that was hot to watch — seeing them ogling her in her skin-tight lycra when she wasn't looking, seeing her smile at them when she caught them, seeing her arching her back and pushing out her chest when she was chatting with them. But there was that polite awkwardness about her that suggested she wasn't going to act on any of it.

Izzie started going out a couple of nights each week with her friends, or people from work, and that was definitely something different. Each time she'd tell me she was going to be late home, I'd be waiting at home, hoping that something would happen while she was out. Each time she came home and it had been an innocent evening in a restaurant, or in a bar, or some kind of interview for work.

"I don't feel like I can do much when I'm with my friends," she said after a while, when I'd asked if she was enjoying her new social freedoms. "And I really don't want to do anything in front of people from work."

The point was that our playing of the Game was a secret, and a secret that we did not want to share with our friends and family. Izzie didn't want to go out on her own, and she wasn't in a hurry to try out any kind of online dating websites after the complete debacle that the website Ashley Madison turned into over the summer, where hackers who seemed to want to turn America into some kind of puritanical nightmare decided to steal the website's database of members, and publish the details to expose millions of potential adulterers.

For a while, we rode the tension that existed between us, the spark arising every time we considered the fact that Izzie could, at any time, date someone other than me. But after a while with no opportunities arising, things seemed to settle down again.

I almost took my eye off the ball.

And then something changed, to kickstart the Game after all.

Part Two:
Playing the Game

Chapter Six

What happened came completely out of the blue: our friend Marie McCoy caught her husband, Gerry, in the throes of passion with his secretary one afternoon when she was unexpectedly home to change her clothes owing to an unfortunate incident with a Caesar salad an hour before she was due to go on CBS News.

The New York Times correspondent was horrified, of course, but not necessarily surprised. She moved out and into a hotel — at her husband's expense — while looking to pursue a divorce as quickly as possible. Getting a divorce out of state appeared the swiftest option, and the State of Nevada's required six weeks of separation was about as quick as it got.

In the meantime, Marie drowned her sorrows with her friends, and, more often than not, with Izzie in particular.

Actually, the term drowning her sorrows didn't quite do justice to her — she seemed to take the collapse of her marriage very well.

"He wasn't the man I thought I'd married," she explained to me once when she came round to ours for dinner one evening. "So it's probably better we weren't married at all."

Marie coped with the whole thing with carefully concealed anger, but otherwise just seemed to want to move on with her life. She had plenty of potential, after all — she was pretty, intelligent, with an impressive job — and she was only 31, so there was plenty of time even if she wanted to have kids.

One night Izzie came home after a late one with Marie, and said to me: "I want to tell her."

"Tell her? Tell her what?"

"About the Game. About what we're doing. "

After things had settled down between us, this reminder that we were actually supposed to be playing the Game put a little lead in my pencil. I was in bed at that time, having put down my copy of the latest John Grisham doorstopper in order to watch my beautiful wife undress from her evening out.

Watching her removing her shirt, and then slipping out of her skirt, made me suddenly wonder if I'd been missing anything — if Izzie had done something on one of her nights out and I hadn't picked up any of the signs. It was something about her unfamiliar underwear — well, all her underwear was unfamiliar these days — that made me feel sudden insecurity. If she was being unfaithful, that was fine, but I damn well wanted to know about it.

“You want to tell her that?”

Aware how closely I was watching her strip, Izzie took her time peeling off her black bra and matching thong.

“She doesn't show it, but she's been so miserable, I said she should just go out and meet some guys, but she says she needs some single friends to do it with.”

“And you want to tell her you're single?”

“Something like that,” she grinned, and slipped under the covers, only to find me hard and waiting for her.

“I don't see why not,” I said. “You trust her not to tell anyone else?”

“Of course.”

Izzie straddled me under the bedsheets, and pressed her pussy against my hardness, before starting up a rhythm to stroke it along my length.

“So you'll be like single girls going out to have fun, huh?”

“I should imagine so,” she said, pushing herself forward to drop her beautiful breasts over my face, and brush me with her soft, smooth skin.

“I guess it's fine by me...” I said, and she was clearly delighted with my support, rewarding me by sinking down, taking my cock deep inside her.

The day after that, a fresh box of condoms appeared in our bathroom, and this time there was absolutely no reason why Izzie would need to use them with her husband.

*

The box was unopened when I first discovered it. It was another clue that might not necessarily mean anything was definitely going to happen, but thus far it was the biggest turn-on yet for me. The suggestion was that one day, probably soon, she would be tearing open one of these little packets, to roll it down the stiff cock of another man before taking him inside her.

It made me shiver with fear and excitement.

Then a couple of days later, Izzie was due to go out for another evening of cocktails with Marie in their favorite haunts downtown, and I came home to find the box of condoms had been opened — and by my count, three were missing.

I was instantly hard at the discovery, and breathing a little irregularly.

Had anything happened already? I was certain the box had been unopened that morning. I was also fairly certain it could be no coincidence that Izzie had taken out three condoms just before her night out with Marie. She was due to tell her, tonight, that she had this quasi-single status, after all.

The stiffness in my pants, and the shock at seeing the condom box opened, engineered a paranoia that started putting ideas into my head about Izzie slipping off to a motel somewhere with some guy she'd met at work, or wherever. Or maybe she'd even brought some guy back here, knowing I would still be at work.

But the logical part of me held to the idea that Izzie was just being prudent, playing it safe in case anything did happen if her night out with Marie turned wild.

It could also have been Izzie leaving me an obvious clue to watch closely, because she was more and more of the belief that something might happen in this damn Game, sooner rather than later.

Nevertheless, I searched the bedroom for more clues, I searched the living room, too, in case anything had happened down there. There was no sign of anything, certainly no used condoms carefully stashed in the garbage. It was eight o'clock in the evening, and knowing that my Izzie was out at a bar somewhere, armed with three condoms, meant I couldn't actually concentrate on anything. I couldn't watch TV, I couldn't read, I couldn't even play video games. I certainly couldn't pull open my laptop and try to do some work. I had time to search the house for more clues, but there was nothing obvious.

For a moment, I sat down on the sofa and tried to calm down. This was the crux of the Game, wasn't it? I wanted my wife to go out and be a devil, but neither of us were comfortable about talking about the intimate details of such things. So I would have to wait until it was all over, and hope there were signs to confirm something had happened.

I guess, I wanted something to happen more than I wanted to be there when it happened. But at the same time, I wanted to know.

I glanced at the little coffee table between the sofa and the large-screen TV. Izzie had left her iPad there on the stack of magazines. It struck me

as slightly odd, because she usually took it with her wherever she went — even on a night out.

I picked it up. Perhaps the battery had died, and she'd decided to shed the weight. Yet Izzie was always very good at keeping her iPad charged up.

I touched the button in the corner of the device and turned it on. The tablet screen lit up almost immediately to display a map, in the middle of which was a green circle around a little image of an iPhone.

Jesus. I drew in a deep breath: Izzie had left the "Find My iPhone" application on. And knowing her, it was more than just an accident.

This damn thing was showing me her precise location, right now. Assuming her iPhone hadn't been stolen, she was apparently at a bar not far from Dupont Circle.

I waited, unsure what to do - debating with myself whether I should act on this particular clue, or wait for Izzie to come home after her night out. Part of me figured that she had gone out specifically to let her hair down — and that was why she didn't want to carry the weight of a tablet with her. She'd have to leave it somewhere if she wanted to go dancing, after all. But the way she'd left it out on the coffee table — with the iPhone-tracking app open and ready to be found — did suggest she wanted me to track her.

It was nine o'clock by the time I clambered into my car, my decision made. This was the game that we were playing: if she didn't intend for me to follow her to find out what she was up to, she should have told me to keep my distance.

*

Perched atop a bar stool opposite Marie, Izzie was wearing a blue and black dress that was so revealing it quite took my breath away. Ordinarily there was no way she'd wear something like that — I'd even have hazarded a guess she wouldn't be comfortable being seen in it.

The neckline plunged so deep, enough of her creamy breasts were exposed that the imagination could fill in virtually everything that was covered. She certainly wasn't wearing a bra, and could almost have foregone anything at all above her waist, there was so much cleavage showing.

At the back, the dress threw similar caution to the wind, making the casual observer wonder if she was wearing any underwear at all.

I'd have assumed such an outfit would be only ever worn by the kind of attention-seeking celebrity as Miley Cyrus — but this was Izzie, my wife, someone who just wasn't like that. And yet there she was, looking as comfortable in a dress as she possibly could, and comfortable in how much attention it got her.

Looking at Marie's outfit, which wasn't quite so shocking by comparison, but still drew admiring glances, I was given the impression that Izzie had been influenced in her choice of attire. Newly single, Marie wanted her friend to match her status.

The men seemed drawn to both of them like bears to a honeypot — and the women seemed to enjoy it, judging by their wide smiles, bright eyes and willingness to talk to anyone who felt the need to stop by and maybe buy them drinks along the way.

From a darkened corner, a safe distance away, I just couldn't have predicted how exhilarating it would be to watch my pretty wife batting her eyelids at the predatory alpha males roaming the bar. A thrill to see how obviously Izzie was excited by the good-looking guys pursuing her. Many of them seemed younger — mid-twenties, if that — and I guess in that dress, with the new sense of availability about her, Izzie did appear younger than her 32 years.

A thrill to see those guys hoping to win her, hoping to attract her, hoping to bed her. I couldn't believe it — from where I watched, I was actively willing some of them to succeed.

But while many seemed to try to prize Izzie and Marie way from the bar, none of the men managed it. The women appeared content to sit where they were, chatting and flirting, leaving their options open until later in the evening.

At last I saw the two women slip off their bar stools and retire to the cloakroom to retrieve their jackets, then leave the establishment.

I followed them up the street, to where they ducked into another place — a dance club I'd never heard of. The two of them waltzed in while I myself as a lowly guy had to wait in a line to get in. Waiting was agonizing. After spending so long watching her flirting with guys, I was getting desperate for her to make a move on someone, and waiting outside the club my paranoia made me certain she had to be now it was getting late into the night.

Inside, however, I quickly located Izzie and Marie near the bar, checking out the dance floor with cocktails in their hands and a few male

admirers close by attempting conversation despite the loud thumping music. I felt relief that nothing significant had happened, although as it transpired, the two women were never intending to move quickly. I had to wait a while, clutching a iced water to keep me alert, milling around the edges of the dance floor, nervously breathing in the thick air scented by sweat and dry ice.

It was a while before any of the men enticed them onto the dance floor. The successful men were a couple of young black guys I recognized from the previous bar. I was trembling to watch them dancing increasingly closely, Izzie seemingly unafraid to drape her hands all over her new friend, who frequently leaned down for her to whisper in his ear.

I have to admit being shaken when I first saw her hand on his shoulder, to see that she'd taken off her wedding ring. After a few moments, however, it all just fed into the exhilaration I felt at setting my wife free to play as she liked — and toy with the dangerous prospect of actually going home with someone.

Jesus. The music went slow, and my wife was holding onto her guy, her hands behind his neck, his hands around her waist, her chest pressed to his, her cheek touching his.

The pace of the music picked up, and she was twirling and jiving — and occasionally grinding up against him, and wearing that dress, she had to be feeling how hard he was for her.

The guy seemed like a clean-cut, wholesome white-collar male, probably late twenties in a tidy shirt and pants. Like thousands of guys around here, he could have worked on The Hill or in any white collar job either linked to the world of politics or completely detached. I watched him holding her, I watched him touching her, I watched him fondling her butt, even her breasts later on in the night.

And at one point, I did catch Izzie's eye. The connection was explosive. She broke out into the most dazzling, exquisite smile, her eyes telling me how wild all this was to her, and how she could hardly believe I was letting her do this.

And after she saw me, and apparently how much I was enjoying seeing her playing the Game, her hands moved up to her new friend's jaw, and she was kissing him right there on the dance floor.

"Hey, I thought that was you, Oscar!"

I whirled around to find Marie there behind me — I'm not sure at what point my focus had concentrated on Izzie so much that I'd lost track of her friend, but it was so intense watching her dancing with another man, I wasn't surprised that Marie had been able to sneak up on me.

“Uh... hey, Marie. How’s things?”

I was a trifle embarrassed at standing there next to her sporting a huge hard-on, and felt more than a little flustered at being ‘caught’ watching my wife misbehaving on the dance floor. It was so dark, there was no way Marie could even have seen me blush, but that didn’t help the awkwardness.

“Not so terrible,” she said, her body language conceding that her marriage had broken down, though she was clearly having a good time out with Izzie. “Izzie’s having a whale of a time,” she added, turning to stand by my side, watching my wife as I was.

“She is,” I agreed.

For a few moments we just watched her kissing her dance partner. Sucking on his lips, slipping her tongue in his mouth, her breasts crushed against his chest, her hands sprawling over his body, his hands squeezing her behind.

Then Marie said in my ear, “I can’t believe you guys are doing this.”

“Uh-huh,” was all I could think of to say.

“It’s so... naughty.”

“I guess so.”

“I still don’t really get what you get out of it.”

I shrugged — a fairly meaningless gesture in that dark dance club. “I like seeing her happy,” I said, feeling the whole complexity of my feelings about Izzie and the Game crumple into some simplistic half-sentence. It was hardly the place to talk intricacy.

“No wonder you guys are still together - you have to be the best husband in the world.”

I smiled nervously. My heart was palpitating. Izzie’s friend had slipped his hand into her dress, to stroke and squeeze her breasts directly. I didn’t feel like the best husband in the world. I felt like I was letting my wife go, losing complete control over my relationship with her, as though I’d untied a boat from the dock in a storm.

“You’d really let her sleep with him?” Marie asked me.

“If she wanted to.”

Marie looked shocked but intrigued.

I felt my hard cock throbbing in my pants at the mere thought that Izzie could go home to another man’s bed that night.

After a while, however, Izzie broke away from her dance partner, giving him a playful pat on the cheek, then turned to walk away, toward Marie and I.

Her guy seemed disappointed, and I have to admit a slight buzz from feeling her reject him in favor of me — and yet there was also some disappointment on my part that it was apparently over.

Her forehead a touch shiny with perspiration, her face glowing with suppressed excitement, Izzie stepped up to me and hugged me, kissed my cheek, whispered in my ear, “Take me home.”

I could smell the cologne from her dance partner on her. It only enhanced the craving I had to strip that dress off her and take her for myself.

*

We dropped Marie off at her little house in Brookland before returning home. The benefits of me driving down there, and drinking iced water all night.

“He would have let you sleep with the guy, you know,” I heard Marie saying to her as Izzie saw her friend to the doorstep.

“I didn’t feel ready,” Izzie replied. As often happened, she impressed me.

“You could have gone home with him.”

Izzie said, “You could have gone with yours.”

“I had a little too much to drink. Wouldn’t have enjoyed it.”

“Next time. Next time, we’ll both be ready.”

I felt my heart skip a beat to hear that.

Back home, I couldn’t wait to tear that dress from her body. As soon as that front door closed behind us, it was languishing on the floor like fancy wrapping paper, and with Izzie in nothing but a pair of soaking white lace thong panties, I lifted her up onto the small side table by the front door, to kiss her sweet mouth and cup her phenomenal breasts in my hands.

“You could’ve had him,” I said, and she was smiling ear-to-ear.

“I know.”

“You could have gone home with him.”

Izzie unfastened the buttons on my shirt. “I was enjoying having you there,” she said, kissing me again. “If I went with him, you wouldn’t be.”

She peeled off my shirt. I said, “Marie thinks I’m nuts, doesn’t she?”

Izzie laughed. “She just doesn’t understand what you get out of the deal. I guess it isn’t easy, understanding.”

I stooped to kiss between her breasts, tasting the gentle salt of perspiration, recalling the way she had let another man put his hands all over her breasts that night.

“I can see that,” I said. Her nipples were little pebbles, begging for my mouth. She sighed as I sucked on each one, as I crushed them between my lips.

“It turns you on,” she said, stroking my head, one hand reaching and just about finding its way to confirm how hard I was in my pants. “That’s all I need to understand.”

She lost touch of my hardness as I kissed my way down her stomach, the scent of her arousal growing strong as I neared the waistband of her wet panties.

She said, “Marie thinks this is about you getting permission to see someone else.”

“You know it’s not.”

I lifted one of her legs, propping her foot up on the edge of the table, opening her thighs. I nudged aside the small triangle of damn white lace and cotton, ducked down to taste her — taste her pussy, all juicy with thoughts of possible infidelity.

She moaned as I licked her, as I massaged around her clit with a couple of careful fingers, as I released the sexual tension that had built up in her petite frame throughout the evening.

I peeled off her panties before carrying her over to the couch, dropping her gently down before kneeling between her thighs, eating her as I contemplated the possibility of another man actually penetrating her here.

“You think you’ll go dancing with Marie again, like that?” I asked her.

“Maybe,” she said, now sitting forward, reaching for me, for my pants, unbuckling me, setting my hardness free.

“Should’ve got that guy’s number,” I smiled.

She circled her fingers around my stiff shaft, kissed the tip of my hard cock. “Who told you I didn’t?” she grinned.

I nearly came in her mouth at that. I only just managed to hold on, until she sat back in the couch again, opened her legs for me to slide into her dripping pussy.

We came together there on the couch, and then once again in the shower, before collapsing into bed together.

The incredible sexual satisfaction I felt as I slipped steadily off to sleep beside her only went to encourage the feelings I had deep down,

that I wanted my wife to do it for real — to sleep with another man. Even if it meant going home with him rather than me.

Chapter Seven

It was a couple of days later that Marie demanded lunch with me via a very brief and to-the-point text message. Normally when I had lunch with Marie, we went to the National Press Club, and it would always involve Izzie as well. This time, it was just the two of us, and Marie instructed me toward a little Italian restaurant on Q street, which I'd never heard of but did a fantastic calamari.

"What if someone sees us?" I joked with her as we took our seats. "The scandal!"

She grinned. "You'd be fine," she said. "In this town, adultery improves a guy's reputation. And I'm divorced — or as close to."

"Right."

"Izzie's going to have to be careful, though."

"Of course."

"And if anyone knew you were allowing her..."

As we settled into our seats, Marie looked closely at me, her large, dark eyes penetrating mine without mercy. She was normally a chirpy, cheerful person, not much different from the perky, unserious college girl Izzie knew in college. For a moment, though, I knew how her interviewees must feel sometimes when she was in the mood to grill someone. She was very effective at her job.

"You really are going to let her, aren't you?" she said. I thought we'd confirmed that the other night when she'd been out with Izzie. But I saw now that this was what this little secret lunch was right now. Marie wanted to know if Izzie and I were really serious about this.

"I am," I said.

She gave a half-smile. Quizzical, interested, puzzled. "You honestly think your marriage would grind to a halt if you don't let her see other men?"

I shook my head. "I don't think our marriage would grind to a halt for any reason," I insisted.

"Why, then? Why do this?"

I refrained from answering her as the waiter approached to take our order. Then, "I want to," I said.

"I don't understand."

I shrugged. "I don't think I fully understand myself," I said. "I just like the idea of Izzie being free to date other guys."

"But it's not just having her be free to date other guys," Marie pointed out, insightfully. "The other night you were actively wanting her to be with other guys."

Another shrug from yours truly. "It just... you know... gets me going. To think of her going out, having fun. Being naughty."

"Cheating on you."

"Uh-huh," I sipped my water. Gone were the days of journalists having boozy lunches and then rolling back into the newsroom to finish an article fueled up on alcohol. "Only, I wouldn't really call it cheating if she knows she's allowed to."

Marie bit the end off a breadstick and crunched it. "But what is it that actually... gets you going... about her cheating on you? You'd want to be there when it happens?"

"I don't know. I guess so. But I wouldn't have to be."

"Jesus, I was horrified to even think that Gerry might be plugging someone else, but to catch him in the act... I just felt sick. And so angry..."

"I like the idea that she gets to have fun with other people," I said. "She's not doing it behind my back, she's not doing anything malicious. If she has the hots for some guy, she can have some fun with it... and in my eyes... I don't know, it just kind of enhances her attractiveness."

"You are crazy," Marie said. "I always thought so."

"You think she'll do it?" I asked Marie.

She thought for a moment or two, those large, soulful eyes of hers flicking all over my face, constantly trying to read me, trying to search for any clues that I might be trying to trick her, trying to lead Izzie into some strange kind of trap in order to win some kind of divorce settlement.

Then she said, "I think she would, if she was a hundred per cent certain you were really wanting it to happen."

"How can she not be?"

She shrugged. "It's a weird concept, you have to admit. There will probably always be doubts. She just needs a little reassurance. And maybe for the right guy to come along..."

She grinned, and I returned it.

“Is there a right guy out there?” I asked her. “Someone interested in her?”

Marie rolled her eyes. “Now you want me to be your spy, huh?”

“Don’t you want to be?”

“Of course, but aren’t you supposed to be working off clues she provides you? Isn’t that the whole point of your Game thing?”

The waiter brought our food out, and we got stuck in for a few moments, allowing time for our privacy to resume.

I said, “If she tells you anything, she’s got to suspect you might tip me off from time to time. So it’s a kind of clue.”

“I’ve been her friend for ten years and more,” Marie declared. “I would never...”

“You would,” I said. “You love a bit of gossip. And in our Game, I’m supposed to find out about what Izzie’s up to — otherwise she starts feeling guilty about what she’s doing.”

“I guess so.”

“So tell me what you know,” I demanded.

She glanced around us, checking we were not being monitored, in a very melodramatic way. Playing the spy. “It’s fairly early days,” she said. “There’s a couple of guys she knows... who might be... interesting.”

“Who are they?”

“Guys from her past.”

“From college?”

Marie nodded. “They were always just Facebook friends, you know? And I always said it was a bad idea to friend your exes...”

“They’re exes, then?”

For a moment, Marie looked awkward, guilty, perhaps. As though she’d said too much. Then she took a deep breath, accepting that if she was going to be a spy, she was going to spy on her friend, and that was part and parcel of it all. “Yeah,” she said. “She told me she doesn’t really like the idea of dating a complete stranger — not at first. I keep telling her it’s safer.”

“I guess it probably is — in terms of keeping the secret, anyway.”

Marie nodded. “I’m going to take her out again tomorrow night, you know that?”

My heart skipped another beat. “Again?”

She grinned. “I’ll make sure she flirts with some hot guys,” she insisted. “And since you want it, I’ll make sure she gets laid...”

My manhood throbbed into life at that assertion.

“If she wants to,” I said, but something in her assertion posed questions in my mind. I asked, “You’re against her seeing any of her exes?”

She swallowed a mouthful of pasta. “I love you guys too much as a couple...”

I raised my eyebrows at that. “You think they’d be a threat to our marriage?”

Marie shrugged. “Back then... Izzie liked a different kind of guy,” she said.

“What do you mean? What kind of guy?”

Again, Marie glanced this way and that, making sure we were safe in our secret conversation. Then she said, in a slightly hushed voice, “She liked guys... powerful.”

“Powerful? What, like athletic? Sporty?”

“Uh-huh. And... large.”

“Large? Big guys?”

Marie nodded, “Big... where it counts, if you know what I mean.”

She flashed her eyes, emphasizing the wickedness of what she was saying. The caution in her voice made me feel she hadn’t really wanted to tell me any of this, to avoid embarrassment on my behalf. It made me wonder how much Izzie had talked to Marie about my particular size.

Hey, I was average size, perhaps a little larger. I’d never had reason to feel small.

“She went with a lot of guys... like that... in college?” I asked Marie.

She nodded. I’m not sure why, but I had to shuffle in my seat a little, to give room for the burgeoning erection in my pants. It was hot to think of my Izzie having a sexual past, to think of her dating a string of guys back in college — and, strangely, that she had gone for guys with big dicks.

“But those guys weren’t exactly good for her,” Marie said. “Trust me, I know. It’s why I’ve always been so in love with you two guys as a couple.”

“She never said anything about being into... big guys... when we were dating,” I said.

“You really think she would?” Marie laughed. “You’d have run a mile.”

“Why weren’t they good for her?” I asked. “They hit her?”

The petite dark-haired woman shrugged again. “Sometimes. But it was more like how they treated her. Like property. And she was into that. Back then, at least.”

“So now you don’t think it’s a good idea for her to see any of her exes again?”

“No. If we can avoid it.”

“I’m not sure it’s my place to tell her who to date,” I said.

Marie’s eyes widened. “You’re her husband!”

“That’s not really how the Game works. It’s not for me to tell her who to see...”

“And if she fucks somebody you don’t like?”

I sighed, quietly. “If she likes him, that’s the main thing, right?”

Marie rolled her eyes. “So it’s up to me,” she said, nodding like the most responsible woman in the world. “I guess someone has to do it.”

“You are her best friend.”

She nodded. “Then I’d better make sure she gets hit on by lots of cute guys next time, huh?”

Chapter Eight

I was busy for a few days — a major corporate scandal and a large merger took up most of my time, leaving me almost camped out of the office. I hardly saw Izzie, except when I got home in the dead of night, and even then she was asleep.

The pressure to succeed at work, with the feeling that job cuts were on the way, even pushed Izzie's new social life out of my mind.

And then I got home on the Saturday night — at 9pm, comparatively early after that intense period — to find Marie's car parked in our driveway behind Izzie's, but when I went inside the house, it was empty, silent, dark. It suddenly all came back to me with a thump.

Izzie and Marie had gone out.

They must have taken a taxi, and that meant they were both planning on drinking and having a good time.

Standing there in an ominously quiet house, I felt a touch of nausea. It felt like I'd missed the boat, or that I was late for the most important meeting ever. And yet as I forced myself to calm down, doing my utmost to relax and let the maelstrom inside my head — and the butterflies in my stomach — peter out, I told myself that this was simply the way it was going to be.

Marie and Izzie weren't going to invite me on their girls' night out. They were both heading to God knew where to party and have a good time — and, I had to face it, to get laid — and it wasn't really place for a husband to be.

I hadn't really missed anything other than sitting around our house wondering what Izzie was up to for a few hours. And it wasn't as though anything much would happen before 9pm anyway.

I slumped on the couch, I flipped on CNN, I tried to tell myself to relax. I couldn't concentrate on the TV, but at least I reconnected with the idea that this was, after all, what I wanted. I wanted Izzie to be like a single girl again, free to go out and party with Marie or whoever she liked, so long as she came back to me.

I wanted her to be naughty and sassy and sexy and perhaps even meet somebody who would sweep her off her feet, and tempt her home with him.

Some day — maybe not today, maybe not tomorrow, but soon — Izzie would want to go home with someone, and she wouldn't come back to me until the morning. I had to deal with that if it happened, I knew that. If I was giving her free rein to do as she pleased, she wasn't just going to bed guys and then sneak off home late at night.

I was curious, though, to know as much as possible about how it was going down. She was, by the rules of The Game, supposed to leave me some clues.

So. Firstly, there were two glasses on the kitchen counter, both bearing traces of lipstick on the rims, along with a nearly-empty bottle of Chablis and an almost-finished bowl of kettle chips. Izzie and Marie had warmed up nicely before grabbing their taxi out of here, it seemed. There was hint of perfume in the air, even this long after they must have left in their taxi.

Upstairs, there were a couple of black dresses laid out across the bed, and numerous items of lingerie on the bed and on the floor. It looked to me as though Izzie had been having some kind of fashion show. Perhaps Marie had been helping her decide on what to wear for the evening.

All of the panties that she'd taken out of her drawers were thongs or g-strings. The dresses lying out on the bed were both fairly tiny. I got the gist of what Izzie — and presumably Marie — were looking for.

It was also clear she'd been trying on a few different pairs of shoes before choosing the right pair for the night. It didn't take me long to realize she must have been wearing the black stilettos. She hadn't worn those in a while — since I teased her about them being 'fuck me' shoes. But she was no doubt rocking them right now.

I tidied her clothes away — I'd have to sleep in that bed later anyway. The various items of make-up strewn over the chest of drawers, and our window sill, and the bathroom sink, I left for the most part — noting that she'd obviously paid attention to making herself up for the evening.

In the bathroom, five condoms were missing from the box in the cabinet. It horrified me at first, since the first conclusion that sprang to mind was that she must have used some of the condoms she'd already taken from the box. But I knew Izzie hadn't been with anyone yet — if anything from the way she'd been when I'd witnessed her night out with Marie. Maybe Marie had urged Izzie to be more optimistic for the

evening, though five was stretching things in my mind. Maybe Marie had taken a couple of condoms for her own use.

It was actually hot to sit there on the bed a moment or two, imagining the two of them getting ready for their big night out, Izzie busy asking Marie her opinion on these panties or those panties, on this dress or that dress. My beautiful wife preparing herself to go out and seduce other men.

As I was sitting there, my phone buzzed in my pocket - a text message.

I was a little surprised to find it was from Marie.

>Having a fantastic time — it's just like we're in college again! Lot of credit to you, hubby ;-)

If my cock had been semi-hard as I'd casually imagined my wife getting ready for her night out, it was suddenly at full strength. I sent an immediate message back to Marie:

>Tell me what's going on. Where are you guys?

But then she replied:

>Think you have a few more clues to find, sweetie xx

I sighed at that. What was the point of having her as my spy if she wasn't going to spy for me? I did have to accept that she had double responsibilities, however. And her priority was more likely to be for Izzie to get what she needed, not for me to get what I wanted.

I headed back downstairs, searching for something I'd overlooked. Izzie didn't have her "Find My iPhone" app on at that particular moment, so I had to look for some other clue as to her whereabouts.

In the recycling box in the kitchen I found a cardboard box that I was fairly sure hadn't been there that morning. The shipping note was still inside it: two carnival masks, which had been shipped to Marie's house. So they were headed for some kind of masked ball?

The butterflies stirred up in my stomach. Wearing masks would only boost their confidence in flirting and dancing with men, I figured.

There was nothing else obvious for me to find. I was getting to the point of sending another text to Marie when I laid eyes on our desktop computer. I'd failed to check up on any of Izzie's emails or messages online recently. I'd been busy. But I could hardly beg Marie for more insight without doing the basics myself.

When I came to fire up the Dell, I found it was already on — it was just asleep. Waking it up, I found another clue sitting ready for me. At some point prior to leaving the house, Izzie and Marie had printed off tickets for their masked ball. So here it was, all the details. It wasn't just

any masked ball, either. It was a masked ball at the US Naval Academy, Annapolis.

I did think about printing off a ticket for myself. It was only an hour or even 45 minutes up to Annapolis, after all. It only took a moment for me to picture what might happen, though. I'd get there, only to find everyone wearing masks — duh. How was I going to identify my wife, let alone monitor her progress?

I could have begged the assistance of Marie, but I felt certain Marie would prefer me not to be there. And if she didn't want me there, she wouldn't help me in any shape or form. And perhaps she would sour to the whole thing of being my spy.

I did text Marie, just to show her my progress:

>So you happen to like Navy boys, huh?

It took five minutes for her to reply:

>God, yeah. Who wouldn't? And your wife seems quite taken with them... ;-)

I felt flames stoked up in my stomach. The thought of Izzie dancing with college guys — and military ones at that. She could pass as a college girl, even at 32.

Thinking about her dancing with a Navy guy also felt strangely reassuring. If anything happened, it seemed to me that Izzie would at least be safe. Those guys were honorable, had to be.

Nevertheless, that didn't stop the nerves. I sent Marie a text stating firmly:

>If she looks too drunk, or tired, or she's not looking entirely safe, you will pull her out of there, won't you?

She wrote back:

>Don't worry, sweetie, I'm keeping a firm eye on her.

She sent a slightly blurred photo taken from her phone, which showed various dark-clothed people dancing in a large ballroom. It took a moment for me to realize that the auburn haired girl in the center was Izzie.

Jesus. A thunderbolt shot through me.

Izzie was dancing close with a young black guy dressed in uniform — as most of the guys around them were, also. He was a powerful guy, seemed like he could pull off Izzie's tiny dark blue dress with one of his pinkies. Izzie was holding one of his hands as they danced, while his other hand encircled her waist. It seemed perfectly civil, but she was grinning from ear to ear, and clearly having a lot of fun with the midshipman, whoever he was.

Naturally I had visions of Izzie sneaking back to the guy's dorm room later that night. I did half wonder if Navy guys could do that with girls, however. Seemed to me security at a Naval Academy would be tight.

After Marie sent that picture to me, I felt more relaxed, for some reason. I was less scared about losing her, about her coming to harm, and more hopeful that she would find the courage to stay out, to enjoy herself fully. To go home with someone, perhaps. I couldn't just watch TV, though.

I sat back at our desktop computer, and found myself logging into Izzie's Facebook account. I wasn't sure what I wanted to find, but after lunch with Marie, I did wonder if I might be able to work out who her exes were from college.

I'm no expert with Facebook, but it was easy enough to click through to the list of her friends from college. She had a lot of male friends from college, it appeared. Marie said Izzie had only recently started friending her exes, but I couldn't find a way for Facebook to tell me when she'd friended people.

In her messages, though, were exchanges with two guys listed among her college friends, Ben and Anthony. Both exchanges seemed fairly lengthy, having started with Izzie declaring that she didn't realize they were on Facebook — a little white lie if ever there was one.

I skipped through the messages as Izzie caught up with the two guys. Ben had been with Izzie on the college newspaper back in the day, and had since become a photojournalist — a fairly impressive one judging by the shot he'd posted on Facebook. Anthony had his own car dealership in Buffalo, and was now twice divorced. Ben was single, but from what he wrote, traveled too much for his work in order to settle down and actually date anyone.

I was just getting to a message where Ben mentioned to Izzie that he would be in the DC area soon, to meet with a publication that wanted to do a special feature on his work, when my phone buzzed again, to signal another text message.

My heart rate picked up decidedly as I drew the thing out of my pocket. Silently, I prayed for another picture from Marie.

Surprisingly, however, the text was from Izzie herself.

>Hey sweetie, you home from work yet? I'm out having a great time with Marie xxx

I replied:

>Home not so late tonight, thankfully. Hope you're enjoying all those Navy guys ;-)

I could at least tell her I'd found her clues.

She replied:

>They're all very polite! Lot of fun, though ;-)

Winking emoticon. Here we were, and she was just about to sleep with (I hoped) the first man other than myself since we'd started dating, and we could only really use winking emoticons with each other. I wanted to come straight out and tell her if she wanted to spend the night with someone, it was fine with me. But I didn't want to remind her I was waiting on her, I didn't want to put any pressure on her. I didn't want to seem like I was trying to pry information from her.

So we signed off —

>Have fun, sweetie, love you xx

>Love you too, sweetie, you're the best! Xxx

And that was it.

I went back to checking out Facebook, and how excited Izzie had apparently been that Ben was dropping by the DC area in the next few weeks.

Ben: We could see each other... you know... for old time's sake.

Izzie: I'd love that.

Ben: You could... get away from your husband for a while?

Izzie: He's a busy guy. We could find some time.

God, Marie had been right about Izzie wanting an ex. However, further investigation was cut short by Marie sending me a furtively caught phone camera picture of Izzie in the arms of a Navy man, apparently doing her best to suck his face off.

It could have been her dance partner from before, I wasn't able to see enough of him.

Well, I'd seen Izzie kissing some other guy the last time she'd been out with Marie. Didn't mean anything else would happen. This time, though, I was 45 minutes to an hour away. I was more nervous than ever.

Marie sent me a text message:

>Just so you know, they're talking about going to find a hotel somewhere.

Jesus, Jesus, Jesus.

I felt like someone was squeezing my insides, trying to keep me from breathing properly. And yet I was aroused like you wouldn't believe.

I texted Marie:

>You think she's okay? She's safe with him?

Marie replied:

>Seems like a nice guy. Wish he wanted to take me somewhere.

I replied:

>I thought this was supposed to be about Izzie taking you out to get you someone?

Marie said:

>You don't get it. What Izzie and you have it way too interesting for my relationship troubles to get in the way.

It was typical Marie. Typical journalist, I would say. You catch a whiff of an interesting story, you want to see how it runs — and everything else can pale into insignificance. Marie had front row seats on a weird and wonderful soap opera, and she had no idea how it would all turn out.

I sent Marie another text asking her to keep me informed, then moved myself upstairs. She didn't send through anything else for a while, so I took a cold shower and got ready for bed.

Then, finally, as I lay back attempting to watch North by Northwest on TV, I received an email into my phone from Marie, attached to which was a short video clip. I opened it up on my phone.

It wasn't long. It showed a pleasant Annapolis street in the darkness, with streetlamp highlighting old brick buildings and curbside trees, an old church in the background. There was a fairly striking-looking black guy in naval uniform stepping out of the entrance to a large building or hall, hailing a taxi. Then the clip jumped to the same guy opening the door of a taxi, for Izzie to climb inside. Then he joined her, and off drove the taxi.

I was shaking a little as I watched it over and over. My wife had gone to a hotel with another man.

Marie sent me a text message:

>So that's it from Annapolis. I guess you'll see your wife some time tomorrow. You still okay about all this, hon?

Okay, so the anxiety levels I hadn't entirely expected, but so long as I thought about how much Izzie and I had talked about all this, and how damned turned on I was, I could just about calm myself down.

I felt kind of numb, but not in an entirely bad way, if that makes sense.

I texted back to Marie:

>Very pleased. You didn't have any luck yourself with a nice young Navy guy?

Marie replied:

>Not this time. I can wait. You need me to go stake out her hotel? Or can I head home now?

I got the feeling Marie was tired and preferred to head home. Even though Izzie was in the company of a stranger, I felt reassured enough

that she knew what she was doing, she could handle herself. She and Marie used to do this when they were in college, and now Izzie was older and wiser.

I replied:

>You can head home. But you could remind her to let me have some clues as to what's going on.

>Will do.

And that was it from Marie for the night. It wasn't it for me. I was well past the point when I'd be able to sleep. I just lay there, exhausted but awake, in a kind of purgatory watching late night movies as I waited for something from Izzie. And my mind could hardly concentrate on movies while I thought about what Izzie might be getting up to in Annapolis.

The trouble was, even if Marie persuaded my wife to let me have a clue or two, I wouldn't necessarily know where to find the clue. This Game of ours was a little frustrating.

At some point past 2am, Izzie's "Find My iPhone" application was activated. Zooming in on the map showed her to be at a Westin hotel a short way away from the Academy. A nice place.

Ten minutes or so later, my phone buzzed as something came in from Izzie.

Another shock, as it turned out to be a selfie, showing Izzie with her new guy. He was standing behind her, and had clearly taken off his jacket. They kind of looked like a couple, but I think if the picture ever leaked out, you could probably just about argue that this was simply Izzie taking a selfie with a fan, someone who knew her from her occasional TV appearances — it did happen occasionally.

Still. I knew what it really was. This was the man who was about to sleep with my wife. He had a nice smile, I had to admit. Izzie looked delighted — and so beautiful. I guess she might have seemed more desirable to me because she was about to sleep with someone else.

Wow. I felt out of breath, just sitting there staring at my phone. I stood up, and it felt as though my stomach remained where it was, dropping as I stood. I was giddy, my head was whirling.

Frankly, I was terrified. But at the same time, it was the biggest rush I could remember.

My wife was about to lose her infidelity virginity. I'd wanted to see it happen, of course, but I knew how awkward she could be with me regarding sex. I also realized how strange it had to be for her, to have a husband who loved her so much, and yet fantasized about her seeing other guys. There were plenty of barriers to her doing this. If she had to

take the first steps on her own, in privacy, then I'd far rather it happened, even if I couldn't watch, than for it not to happen at all.

I flopped down on the bed, gazing at that picture, and felt just how hard my cock was from thinking about what was going on over in Annapolis. I might not get to watch this monumental thing happening, but my imagination could fill in the gaps.

I thought of them together, naked, writhing on a bed — touching, kissing, caressing, licking. Fucking. Their flesh glistening with perspiration — his smooth dark skin contrasting with her soft pale body, a man so different from her husband. Izzie opening herself up to him, her man overpowering her, overwhelming her, muscles tensing as he took her.

I thought of Izzie marveling over the size of his cock, toying with it, experiencing it, taking it inside her mouth, her wet pussy.

I thought of her screaming and whimpering as he filled her, as he stretched her, as he fucked her hard.

I touched myself — sure, how could I resist? But when I came to the end, I stopped before I came. It wasn't that I was tired, or that the idea of Izzie sleeping with her military man wasn't still highly arousing to me — no, suddenly the fear hit me.

What if Izzie had such good sex with another man that she wouldn't want it when she came back to me? What if she decided sex with her new lover was so good, it wasn't even worth staying married to me any more? What if she decided I was a freak for allowing this, for encouraging this — and she didn't want to risk being married to a freak?

What if she fell head over heels for her new lover — accidentally, completely unexpectedly, with no intention of ever doing so, but unavoidably and incontrovertibly, something that she just could not do anything about other than leave me?

For a while, I lay there feeling some kind of panic attack wash over me. It's hard to describe exactly how it was — I felt hot and cold flushes, I felt the room spinning around me, I felt nausea in my stomach.

I breathed deeply, slowly, trying to calm myself down. When I thought about what I was going through, what I was feeling, the main thing seemed to me that I had a completely lack of control over everything. It was a rush, it was still exciting, but I felt a sudden paranoid fear that I was suddenly falling headlong — that I'd get badly hurt, and there was nothing I could do to avoid it.

It was like bungee jumping over and over, feeling the rush as I faced the risk — only after a while, somebody cuts the bungee cord loose, and

I plunge headlong into the abyss.

I had to force myself to think about how much Izzie and I loved each other, and about how much I trusted her. I had to stare at my wedding ring and remember the commitment we'd promised each other, the seriousness of our bond.

I'm not sure how long my attack lasted, but eventually I seemed to bring it under control. I felt myself warming up inside, remembering just why I'd wanted this in the first place.

My beautiful wife was having a wonderful experience, a host of fun, and then she'd come back to me refreshed and content. My Izzie was being naughty and breaking convention, she was living out a fantasy and doing something she'd always believed was closed off to her now she was married.

My sweetheart was living life, and I was the one making it possible for her. Why would she give up the possibility of enjoying as many men as she wanted for the rest of her life, and the support of a loving husband, to commit to one man she barely knew, who merely gave her good sex for a night?

Logic was my friend, I could reason out the truth that I was not going to lose Izzie, no matter how good the sex with this new man.

I slipped off to sleep for a while after that, exhausted.

When I woke again, it was 4am, and I was suddenly very awake again, unable to even contemplate going back to sleep. I had a feeling that Izzie had done something, that we had graduated to the next step in this Game of ours. And feeling that certainty turned me on no end.

It was almost a relief that I felt turned on, not angry or sick or horrified.

Now, I felt a strong need for confirmation. I wanted to text Izzie, ask her if it happened. I even picked up my phone and tried to tap out a message. It just felt wrong. Awkward. This was not us. This was not me. The reason we were playing the Game was because we found it so difficult to communicate directly about this stuff.

I would have to wait for clues, wait for evidence.

Chapter Nine

I could wait only so long.

Watching Netflix movies at 4am, 5am, was hardly easy when my wife was somewhere lying in another man's bed. Maybe she wasn't sleeping at all, just having constant sex.

I needed confirmation she was safe. I needed evidence that she'd actually done it, that she had been faithfully unfaithful.

I jumped back onto our desktop computer and looked up Izzie's Facebook page, as though I'd find anything there, and her email account. Then I remembered to check the site where I could see the text messages sent and received from her phone.

And here was something.

At 2.37, Izzie had sent Marie the very same selfie she'd sent me, of herself standing with her Navy man, in the hotel room. Marie had texted back almost immediately:

>Very nice. Now go enjoy! And as soon as something happens, I want to know about it. And know that I'm gonna bug you until you tell me EVERYTHING! Lol :-)

I felt envious of Marie being able to order my wife to tell her everything. But my guess was that if I'd made any demand for Izzie to tell me everything about any guy she slept with, she would never sleep with any other guy. I had to take what I could get. In this case, I could eavesdrop Izzie and Marie's text messages.

At about 3.45am, Izzie sent another text message to her BFF. And it was quite clear that although I had slumped into sleep, Marie had been on the edge of her seat waiting for news from her friend.

Izzie: He's asleep now. How about you, Marie? Did you end up with that Lieutenant guy?

Marie: No, he turned out to be a loser. Never mind me. WHAT HAPPENED WITH YOU?

Izzie: It was... nice ;-)

Of course, my eyes did not stop moving at that point, I didn't stop reading the text conversation. But my heart nearly stopped, my cock was

so erect it was very nearly painfully so.

Jesus, Jesus, Jesus.

I was fortunate I had Marie there to coax more information out of her, though.

Marie: Okay, so spill. You know I'll get what I want eventually, so DETAILS PLEASE.

Izzie: What do you want to know? He's a very nice guy, and we had a very nice time at the ball, and then when we got to this hotel, we had a really lovely time together ;-)

Izzie was teasing her friend, but at the same time she was driving me crazy.

Marie: Are you kidding me? Back in college you used to tell me everything, down to how big his cock was, how many times he slammed it into you, and in what position. So what happened to you, girl?

Izzie: I'm a married woman now :-)

Marie: But I'm not your husband, I don't have a fantasy that means I can get by with hints and suggestions of what you get up to. Besides, you owe me for taking you to Annapolis!

Izzie: What do you want to know?

Marie: What did you do? Did you go all the way with him? What was he like??!!

Izzie: He's like ten years younger than me. Very fit, gorgeous when we'd gotten his uniform off. Heavenly.

Marie: So what did you do?

Izzie: Just... you know... lots of kissing and touching. Lots of talking, too.

Marie: Talking, talking. Did you SLEEP with him?

Izzie: He's sleeping now, didn't I tell you? ;-)

Marie: Do I need to spell out my questions? Did he put his HEAVENLY penis in your va-doo-da?

Izzie: Almost.

Marie: ALMOST?!!

I'm not going to lie, I was a touch disappointed at this point. I felt for Marie. I felt for the guy with whom Izzie had spent the night.

Izzie: We did pretty much everything but.

Well, there was some reward. My heart rate picked up again, my softening cock thickened once again. Izzie might not have quite gone all the way with her new lover, but I could picture her lying with him, embracing his naked form, kissing him, taking him in her mouth.

Marie: Was he big?

Izzie: Fairly.

Marie: What does that mean?

Izzie: He had a nice one.

Marie: So not huge.

Izzie I enjoyed it.

I thought of that selfie she'd sent me, and had visions of her enjoying the guy's cock. It was good enough for me for now.

Marie: So why didn't it happen? He fall asleep before it could?

Izzie: He wanted different things out of this.

Marie: Different things?

Izzie: He wanted to see me again.

Marie: Doesn't sound so bad.

Izzie: He also wanted to introduce me to his friends, his parents, and he wanted me to divorce my husband.

Marie: Ah.

Izzie: He's a sweetheart, he said such lovely things about me. But then he just went too far.

Marie: Young guys sometimes do

Izzie: We had a nice time, but I said maybe he'd feel bad if we went all the way, and then I have to leave in the morning.

Marie: So you're going home right now?

Izzie: I'll probably wait until he wakes up. Maybe see if he wants a final... you know...

Marie: No, I don't know, because you're NOT TELLING ME. Fume.

That was the end of their text conversation. Despite the limitations on Izzie's night, at least I had the warmth inside from knowing my Izzie had misbehaved to some degree. She'd gone part of the way, and it seemed a good step toward going all the way with someone.

I savored over that text message exchange, reading it and re-reading it and re-reading it again. More and more, I was thrilled by the situation. Izzie really had gone out there and had fun with another guy. Too bad he'd turned into too much of a romantic, but you couldn't have anything. And I was pleased by the way Izzie had reacted to that: what if she'd fallen for him, and had started lapping up his adulation, and she could even have gone for his meet-the-parents long-term relationship plans. But she hadn't. She'd wanted a fun night, and she'd wanted no-strings sex.

I was rock-hard reading over those words from Izzie.

Then, finally, I heard her taxi pulling up outside our house.

Chapter Ten

I didn't get up. I lay in bed and listened to the quiet sound of the taxi pulling away, and the door being unlocked and opened as Izzie let herself into the house in the early hours of the morning.

My naughty wife was home.

I was feeling nervous, afraid that she'd come upstairs and I'd be horrified about what she'd done, I'd feel everything but the excitement and arousal that had so gripped me all night. I was afraid the fear would win.

For a moment or two, I thought about feigning sleep, of letting her come in, take a shower, slump down on the bed next to me and sleep herself, giving myself more time to think about how I really felt now that Izzie had fooled around with another guy — even if she hadn't gone all the way.

But as I heard her cautiously climbing the stairs, then pad into the bedroom, then duck into the en suite to turn on the shower, I felt the fear trounced by the craving I felt for her.

I heard the soft, silky sigh of her removing her clothing. She was undressing in the bedroom, not the bathroom. I felt her eyes on me, though I couldn't see her.

"Hey," I said, acting as though I'd just woken up.

"Hey," she said. "You get much sleep?"

"A little."

I rolled over onto my back. It was still dark outside, but the soft orange street lighting crept around the curtains to highlight her beautiful silhouette. She was stood still, wearing only a pair of panties, seeming a little anxious about how I would react to her.

"Do you hate me?" she asked.

I was a little taken aback by her question, particularly considering how encouraging I had been for us to play this Game. But I could understand that normal guys, even many who believed they harbored this fantasy, would react to her with revulsion, with outrage.

"Course not. I love you. More than ever."

I couldn't see much of her, but I could see her smile. I could see relief on her features.

"I'm just going to hop in the shower," she said.

"Don't," I replied, surprising myself.

She stopped, uncertain.

I could smell her. Only faintly, but there was her perfume in the air — and something more. A musty, earthy suggestion of her misbehavior. It made my hardness throb under the sheets.

"If you can't tell me what happened, you have to leave me clues, remember?" I said. I felt myself flushing, embarrassed. This was how it was when I tried to say anything risqué to my wife, my constant companion, my best friend.

"I remember," she said, warily. "But..."

"Come here," I demanded.

To be honest, I was nervous as well. I wanted to experience her fresh from her transgressions, I wanted the evidence that might still linger on her body, to confirm that something had happened. I wanted to appreciate the glory of her naked form before she did her best to wash away her sins. But what if it disgusted me, what if it shocked me, what if it turned me off the fantasy once and for all?

She cautiously climbed onto the bed, moving on all fours over me.

I gazed up into her eyes, and hoped that as she gazed into mine, she registered the adoration, the celebration at what she had done. She grinned, relieved and delighted by my response, by my embrace, by the hardness on which she now rested her weight.

I kissed her soft lips, breathing in the sweet scent of her perfume, which had been applied recently to cover up whatever else might be detected. Yet I could still recognize the traces of a man's cologne — a young man who wore too much — and the mustiness of her post-coital body.

I could see the hint of old perspiration in her long, auburn hair. I could feel the delicate clamminess of her skin as I swept my hands down her back, the signs of sweat as her body had melded with his.

There was even the hint of her arousal, and perhaps even his, if that was possible, as I kissed her mouth, as I kissed her neck.

"You still like the idea of it, then?" she asked quietly.

"The idea?" I grabbed her and rolled her, almost threw her over onto her back. "It's not really just an idea any more, is it?"

She was beaming, ear-to-ear, loving the obvious hunger imprinted on my features. I guess I hadn't been this hungry for her since we'd started

dating. Not quite to this degree. A woman could tell, Izzie could tell. She was gently surprised at just how powerful my hunger for her turned out to be.

She opened her legs for me, and I kissed my way down her inner thigh, taking in the sight of her sex, hidden only by white lace panties, which seemed almost bridal, reminding me of how we were stretching the meaning of our wedding vows with the Game.

The scent of her arousal was so intense the closer I came to her panties — she must have been so wet for him. So excited by taking a new lover.

Her hands encouraged me up, to kiss my way up her stomach, to taste the faint saltiness over her breasts, to take her stiff nipples in my mouth.

“So what kind of clues are you hoping for?” she asked me.

I looked up at her face, mirrored her broad smile. “I can smell him on you,” I said, moving up to kiss her mouth again, to suck on her lips. Lips that I was certain had stretched around another man’s cock earlier, perhaps many times.

“And it doesn’t freak you out?” she asked.

“No.”

It was almost as unexpected for me as it was for her, I think. But it didn’t freak me out. It was more like confirmation of what Izzie had been doing with someone else, signs of how wicked she’d been. I got the sense that she’d probably swallowed him, that perhaps he’d sprayed his come all over her face and her chest at one point.

I kissed my way down her chest, down her stomach, and she was almost laughing with delight at how I was with her now, how I was embracing her depravity. She’d had a great night, a fantastic date, and she didn’t even have to come back to face the anger of her husband — very much the opposite, in fact.

I peeled off her panties, feeling in my hands how damp they were, pressing them up to my nose to breathe in that thick, spicy scent.

I kissed the top of her sex, and she caught her breath. I breathed her in, I tasted her like a connoisseur, appreciating how well she’d groomed herself for her date, how tidy she’d left her little patch of soft auburn curls, and how insanely wet she was.

I smelled him on her flesh, I knew he’d been there, I knew he’d touched her there, he’d licked her there. There was no flavor from a condom, though, there was no tang of latex. I believed what she’d said to Marie about not going all the way with him.

I kissed away from her pussy, along her inner thigh, my fingers taking up where my mouth had been, stroking her, dancing circles around her

clit, stretching open her pink labia as I considered how another man had gone down on her not so long ago.

“Did you enjoy it?” I asked her.

“Uh-huh,” she nodded, grinning, almost purring as she moaned to indicate her feelings about her date. “Once I got past feeling that you might not want me to do it, after all, anyway.”

“How long did it take you to feel that?”

“A couple of rum-and-cokes.” She smiled.

I licked along the length of her groove, and sucked gently on her soaking lips. Then I asked her, “You liked him, then?”

“He was very nice.”

“Will you see him again?” Well, the Game didn’t preclude me from asking her direct questions about her plans. It was supposed to be there in the absence of our communication, after all. If our communication was there, if it improved to the point where we could talk about her infidelity without resorting to snooping for clues, then all the better for it.

She said, “No. I think he wants more than I’m willing to give.”

She panted and groaned as I flicked my tongue gently over her sensitive lips, and the hood of her clit, as I sucked on her, as I drew in her wetness, my hot mouth pressing against her.

“He wanted a relationship?” I asked.

She nodded.

I lifted my head, toyed with her precious flower with my fingers, gently teasing her, stretching her, drawing her slick moisture all over her sex, thinking about how her young Navy admirer must have enjoyed her, and how some time soon, perhaps, she would take another man’s full hardness.

I slid my fingers inside her, kissing her thigh, inhaling the intoxicating scent of her rumble with a military man. Her chest rose and fell as she breathed deeply, her nipples seeming impossibly hard as they moved with her chest. Izzie closing her eyes as I fingered her, her sighs turning to higher-pitched cries.

“Oh my God that’s so good...” she murmured. I could tell she’d missed not having the guy’s cock inside her. She needed one now.

“I can tell you didn’t fuck him,” I said, the heat and the musk in the air pushing me to say things I might not ordinarily say to her.

“No,” she yelled.

I dropped down onto her pussy again, sucking her flesh, supping at her juices, fucking her with my tongue, stirring her whole body with my mouth, my hands reaching up to grab her breasts, to squeeze her nipples.

I got the sense that her Navy man had gone down on her also, but the way she responded to me made me certain that his attempts had been merely amateurish fumblings compared to the experience of a husband. She came, hard, but the way she looked down at me afterward, propping herself up on her elbows as I cooled down between her thighs, made me sure she had come not only because of what I was doing to her, but because I was the second man to lie between her legs that night.

And because the reality of this strange fantasy had presented itself: Izzie had a husband who would let her sleep with other men.

She pushed herself further up on her elbows drawing me up to meet her face, her mouth. To kiss her there despite the fact my face and my mouth were slick with her wetness.

Then I went back to feasting on her, my hands sweeping all over her delicious naked body as I fed on her tangy nectar, obsessed with her unfaithful pussy, her gorgeous curves, the lingering signs of her night of adulterous passion all over her writhing, rocking form.

Eventually, she pushed me away. She urged me over onto my back, she lay between my legs and took my shaft in her hands, stroking me, kissing my tip, stretching her lips around my girth. The way she licked me, the way she focused on my cock, the way she inspected it — it was so obvious that she was taking in the fact that this was the second cock of the night for her.

It only made the experience more intense for me, making me picture her tending to someone else's cock, perhaps that of an African-American man with a military bearing.

She looked me in the eye as she sucked on me, and I blurted out a question, "Did you like his...?"

"Uh-huh," she said.

She might not offer me more detail than that, but the truthful manner in which she said it was seriously hot. And the way she slipped a hand between her legs as she sucked on me, touching herself while she appreciated her wanton depravity going down on two guys in one night.

She couldn't go down on me for as long as I went down on her, though. She was too in need of my hardness filling her, going where her Navy man had not. She pulled herself up my body, straddled my hips, dropped her sex down onto my shaft, stroking herself against my length.

She stroked a few rogue strands of her hair back behind her ear, then smiled lovingly at me as she slowly sank onto my hardness, taking the tip then the top half of my cock inside her irresistible tightness.

“God, I needed this,” she grinned as she rode me, her hair falling down to form a little private chamber for our faces as she kissed me, and as she fucked me.

“I bet he’s regretting not doing this with you,” I said.

She swept her hair back over her shoulder. “Maybe... Maybe not... We had a nice... time. He just... wanted someone... he could bond with. Oh God...”

As she fucked me, she sat up, and it was as though every muscle in her body was tensing up. I held her tightly around the waist, and took on more of the effort of thrusting into her. She came again, easily. Shaking, trembling, crying out.

I managed to hold on, not wanting to finish, wanting to prolong things, stretch out this feeling of reconnecting with her, of appreciating her beautiful infidelity. We lay side by side, spooning together, my hardness filling her up once again, only this time we moved slowly together. Tenderly. Gently.

I held her cute behind, or her breasts, or her waist, and for the longest time just cherished our togetherness, the feeling of her body next to me, the glory of my cock sliding in and out of her slippery pussy.

It was so slow, and yet so incredibly intense. Then finally, she rolled onto her front, and I mounted her like some uncontrolled beast, pounding her, rocking her whole body, making her mine again.

“Oh fuck... oh fuck...” she yelled, over and over.

Slumping down reaching forward to kiss the back of her neck, my lungs were briefly filled, once more, with the syrupy smell of another man’s cologne, which triggered the primal sense in me that another man had mated with my woman, that I had to inseminate her, to take her back as my own.

With that, I was exploding deep inside her, shooting my thick cream within her unfaithful body, my cock throbbing and jumping and pumping inside her, as the orgasm swept through me.

Chapter Eleven

I came back to the office from a late Monday late afternoon interview to find Marie camped out at my desk.

“Aren’t the Messenger and the Times meant to be competitors?”

She grinned, and pushed out her chest to give me a good flash of cleavage. “Your security guards are easy to distract.”

I put my notepad and tape recorder down on the desk. “If I start seeing lousy little stories in the New York Times about any struggling DC businesses, I’m coming for you.”

“So where you taking me for dinner?”

I laughed at that. Round our way, Times reporters had a reputation for being tight with expenses. “I’m taking you for dinner?”

She shrugged, “I figured you owe me since I set your wife up with —

“Okay, okay, okay,” I interrupted her, shooting her a glare that told her not to whisper a word in this place concerning what my wife and I were doing.

Marie chuckled, feeling the gentle power she had over me considering her knowledge.

I said, “Barnet’s?”

“That will do nicely.”

K Street, not far from the office, was hardly the most discreet place for what Marie clearly wanted to talk about, but Barnet’s wasn’t too bad, I knew we could get a table relatively protected from casual ears.

Somehow, Marie managed to hold out until our food was actually in front of us, and the waitress departed, before she blurted out: “So how’re you feeling now, knowing that she actually slept with someone else?”

I shrugged, though the words she used to describe my Izzie did warm me up decidedly. “You know they didn’t go all the way, don’t you?” I told her. Of course she knew. I got that information from her own text messaging with Izzie.

She said, “They went pretty far, though, wouldn’t you say?”

“I guess.” I took a huge bite of my chicken sandwich. Barnet’s does a great chicken sandwich.

Marie said, “Most married men, if they heard their wives did that... well, there’d be a large proportion headed to the divorce courts.”

“Maybe.”

“You’re okay, though?”

“Of course. Couldn’t be happier,” I said. “You spoken to Izzie since it happened?”

She grinned, and took a bite of her pasta. “Of course.”

“And?”

“She couldn’t be happier.” I felt my chest fill with warm honey at that. Marie went on, “She loves how this turns you on, she loves that it makes you want her even more, want to have sex with her even more.”

“Good.”

“Jesus, she won the lottery, right? She’s married to a great guy who loves her and treats her right — and not only does he let her go out and date other guys, he actually gets off on it, too.”

“In a nutshell,” I said. It was good to hear that this whole fantasy wasn’t just my individual desire. “What did she say to you?”

“She said how nice he was, but after a while she stopped worrying about how you would react to all of it, and started worrying more about how he was going to feel.”

“Because he was falling for her?” I prompted. “He wanted an actual relationship?”

Marie nodded. “He was young, I guess. Impressionable. You know how sex can bond someone to you.”

“And vice versa.”

Marie said, “You worry about that? About her falling for someone else?”

“I worry about it,” I said, taking a gulp of ice water. “I don’t think it’ll happen.”

“You don’t think it’ll happen? But there’s a possibility, right?”

I shrugged. “I guess it could happen. It’s all part of the fear, you know? This fantasy... it’s not just some reckless voyeurism. There’s a genuine fear that something bad might happen...”

“So why d’you do it?”

“I don’t know... it just adds to the excitement, somehow. Like, if there wasn’t risk, and if it wasn’t so taboo... maybe it would be less exciting. Or different, anyway.”

“I don’t get why you want that risk, though.”

I sighed. I could hardly explain it myself. I couldn't entirely understand what I felt. "Something I read," I attempted, "suggested guys get more stirred up knowing their women are with other guys, because they need to be ready to mate, in case she's mated with someone else. You know, sperm competition."

Marie nodded. "So it's just biological."

"But... I don't know. When I was waiting for her, Saturday night, there were so many moments where I felt... you know... scared, despondent. I started feeling I'd made a horrific decision to let this fantasy become real. But then I'd turn around and feel the most unbelievable high. And it was like, the fear made the high even stronger."

It was strange to me, that with a little time passing, I could be a little more crystal about how I'd really been feeling that night. But when it came down to it, on that night itself, the sensory inputs had been so strong — even while I'd been doing very little physically — that it had kind of numbed my mind.

"So you do feel bad, sometimes?"

I shook my head, "It was a rough ride. I wouldn't change it, though. I want her to do it again, I want her to date other guys. It's like some extreme sport, you know? Danger just makes it more of a buzz."

"You are crazy. But you know there's a ton of other guys that are into this kind of thing?"

"Never really thought about it," I said.

Marie waved a few pieces of pasta on her fork gently over her plate as she spoke. "I did some digging around online. There's whole chat forums devoted to this kind of thing."

"Uh-huh?"

"I'm thinking of writing a piece about it. You know... everyone's talking about the fluid nature of sexuality these days, especially among the millennials. Maybe the concept of marriage is becoming just as fluid."

I chuckled. "Don't let the GOP see you talking like that," I said. "They'd probably have a fit."

"From what I've read, and the people I've messaged, there's quite a variety in how guys... you know... appreciate their wives fooling around."

"I'm not sure I'd be comfortable being an interviewee," I warned her.

"No," she shook her head. "I wouldn't have asked you, either. But your experiences can give me a certain... you know... background."

I finished up the last bite of my sandwich. “Are you surprised?” I asked her. “At us, I mean? Or at Izzie. You know, for trying this?”

She sighed. “I’m surprised at you, sweetie,” she said. “I was surprised at what you said back at that dinner party. Wasn’t that where all this started?”

“Uh-huh. But what’re you saying, you’re less surprised at Izzie?”

She smiled, shrugged. “Any woman says she never fantasizes about sleeping with someone other than her partner is a liar. Izzie... well, you have to know how she was in college.”

“And how was she?”

Marie paused. “You really want to know?”

“I already have some ideas.”

“I don’t think I should tell you. Not if she won’t.”

Jesus, the mystery. It only made me want to know even more. In this case, I suspected Marie was leaving me hanging on her story for a reason. And as our dinner came to a close, and she still refused to talk more about how Izzie was in college, came her reason.

“Why don’t you give me a lift home, and maybe I’ll tell you?” she suggested.

I rolled my eyes. “I would have given you a lift anyway, Marie.”

Marie being Marie, of course the chance to gossip overwhelmed her need for caution in dealing with a friend’s relationship. As we drove home to her apartment in Brookland area in the north-east of DC, she opened up.

“In college... I guess we discovered that we could get guys really easily,” she said. “Only, you know, I ended up meeting Barney fairly early on, and I didn’t want anyone else. Izzie... well, she didn’t want to settle on a single guy.”

“She dated a lot of guys in college?”

“Uh-huh,” Marie said, widening her eyes and nodding slowly, emphasizing the point.

It was funny how I’d never got that impression about Izzie, not when we started dating, not really even until this point. When you’re a guy, and you start seeing someone new, you just want to block out everything that came before — unless you already have some kind of sharing fantasy, of course. It’s not that you have to believe she’s a card-carrying virgin, but you kind of want to view your new relationship as the first time she’s really been that way with a guy.

“I swear, she was with someone new virtually every week,” Marie said. “I never even bothered finding out their names after a while.”

I was feeling good. That buzzing inside, that warmth. The blood flow quickening, the manhood thickening. I liked that Izzie had played around in college. I even found myself regretting that it had taken this long for me to discover the fantasy I possessed. I guess I was a fully paid-up member of the twisted kink club.

“And since then?” I pushed Marie.

She laughed. “Oh, don’t worry,” she said. “She didn’t ever cheat on you, Oscar. At least, not until you started letting her..”

“So what were her guys like in college?”

“Big,” she said. “Mostly. Very big, if she could get them. It’s why I was surprised you swept her off her feet.” Marie gave me a wink.

“Thanks,” I said, but felt even more of a stirring to hear of Izzie’s thing for big cocks. I liked to think of her playing with guys who were different than me. But I said, “I think she’s happy enough with my size.”

“Well, it doesn’t even matter now, does it?” Marie pointed out. “If she does like big cocks, she can go out there and get some, right?”

“Right,” I agreed.

“Well, this is me,” she declared as we drew up outside her little two-up, two-down detached house in a fairly leafy, hilly part of DC suburbia.

“Have a good one,” I said.

Then, as she was clambering out of the vehicle, she exclaimed, “Oh my God!”

“What?”

She leaned into the vehicle — giving me a gaping view down her shirt, if I wanted it. She did have some nice cleavage in there. Even a guy obsessed with his wife is going to notice that.

“Mr Thomas is selling his house!” she said.

“Mr Thomas?”

She pointed across the road. The houses on the other side of the street were built up on the hillside — their driveways sloped upwards quite dramatically. The house immediately opposite Marie’s was one of the few on the street to have no lights in the windows. A ‘for sale’ real estate sign was standing at the end of its driveway.

“You know, from that house you get a great view of my bedroom,” Marie said with a wicked grin.

“Is that right?”

“You should buy it,” she said. “It’s a terrific house.”

“You know, I don’t think you’d get to see what Izzie was up to by looking up from your house,” I told her.

“No, but I could give you a little show at night when you were waiting for her to come home from a date,” she said. “You really do get a superb view from up there.”

I laughed at that idea, even if Marie herself was very easy on the eye and the thought of watching her undressing through her bedroom window did tickle the interest a little.

Marie had been talking to Izzie for a while about moving to her neighborhood. As close as Silver Spring was, she’d always wanted Izzie to be closer. I guess these days she liked the idea of being close enough to monitor Izzie’s dating life.

“Good night, Marie,” I said. “I guess you’ll just have to do your little strip shows for whoever buys the place.”

“Spoil sport!”

Chapter Twelve

The evening it happened, I'd been speaking at a local business conference down in Alexandria — not too far away from home, but they'd given me a room for the night in the luxury hotel, so the plan was to take them up on their offer — and get a little light networking in during the evening.

Only, as I was in the middle of the formal dinner attached to the conference, my phone vibrated in my pocket to alert me to a message — a message from my mole.

> *Tonight's the night.*

She didn't give me anything more than that, to begin with. Marie always had enjoyed generating a little suspense. I had no choice but to play ball.

I replied:

> *Tonight's the night for what?*

It was a few mouthfuls of well-cooked steak and a sip of red wine before Marie replied:

> *She's meeting a friend. And since she has the whole house to herself all night... ;-)*

I felt my stomach fold up. Was she really suggesting that Izzie was on a date that evening? While I was away at a conference? I felt suddenly cold inside. Well, this was the game, wasn't it? She didn't have to tell me she was dating someone. She didn't have to give me explicit details of what was going on. She just had to give me enough clues to know what was going on.

I texted Marie:

> *Who's the guy?*

Marie was quicker with her reply this time:

> *Thought you were supposed to be monitoring her every move?*

Well, that made my insides just about freeze solid. I felt nauseous. Had I been missing all Izzie's clues? Pride kept me from fessing up to my inadequacies. I replied:

> *Just wanted to know what you know.*

Marie said:

>All I know is, she's on a date tonight, and she's intending on bringing him home. She doesn't tell me everything, you know.

"Everything okay?" I looked up to find the guy sitting to my right at the dinner table peering at me, concerned. I guess I must have come across as a little rude, ignoring him to stare at my phone.

"Uh... yeah..." I said, mentally scratching for some kind of excuse or explanation. "Just had a message from work... I think I'm going to have to head back to the office, I'm afraid."

I put down my napkin on the table beside my plate of half-eaten steak. My stomach was going to regret not finishing up — but my thumping heart needed me to get out of there, to head home and hope to find out what my sweet wife was up to.

I managed to say a few goodbyes to the various people I'd met at the conference and hoped to keep in contact with — not to mention the conference organizers — before shooting upstairs to my room to pick up my things. It was while I was hurling the few items I'd unpacked back into the suitcase that my phone beeped to indicate an email was being sent through.

I was a little surprised to find that Izzie had emailed a video to me. It took a little while to download it even through the hotel's decent Wi-Fi facility. What had she sent me?

Once it was fully downloaded, I slumped down on the bed to watch a video she must have taken from her iPad, judging by the quality, showing our very own living room.

The camera had been placed in a good position to catch much of the room. I saw Izzie at the front door, greeting and then inviting a guy in. He'd brought her flowers, which she loved, going all smiley and kissing his cheek as he gave them to her.

I recognized him from his mugshot on Facebook. Ben. The ex that Izzie had been chatting up online.

The guy was bald — or at least, shaven-headed — and about our age. He was wearing nice clothes — date clothes — an expensive green shirt, nice dark pants, solid dark shoes. Izzie, on the other hand, was wearing fairly casual stuff — her faded pink denim jacket, a floral print skirt underneath. I guessed it could be a first date outfit, but it could also have been what she might wear to work if she wasn't intending to appear on TV.

"I'm sorry I'm running so late," she said, inviting him in to sit down on the couch.

“Hey, it’s okay,” her date replied. “We’re not in any rush, are we?”

“No, we’ve got as much time as we want. But I need to change before we head out.”

“You don’t need to change — you look fantastic.”

“Well, thank you, I guess!”

Izzie was so bright and giggly, and though she was clearly excited, clearly buzzed by this whole date thing, as her husband I could also tell that she was trying to make an impression for her date.

“You want a drink while you’re waiting?” she asked, and I saw her at the fringes of my vision, in the kitchen opening the refrigerator door.

“Sure, whatever you got.”

She brought a beer over to him, and perched on the edge of the couch to give it to him.

“You are looking seriously good, Iz,” Ben was saying. “I don’t think you’ve changed at all since school.”

My insides felt cold, and yet at the same time burning. Had this guy fucked her before we met? He had to have. Did she feel comfortable, as a result, to date him now I’d given her her freedom? How far was she planning on going with him?

My guess was that after her Navy man, she needed more of a sure thing. She wanted a man she could guarantee would go for straight sex, without strings attached. Perhaps even a man who knew she was married.

“You’re so sweet,” I heard her say, beaming ear to ear, tilting her head a little, flirtatious and yet modest.

“And your husband...?”

“He’s out of town.” She put her hand on his, patting it and then stroking it while he kept it inoffensively on his thigh. I couldn’t see the guy’s face, from the camera angle, but he had to be responding to Izzie’s clear suggestion.

Sipping his beer, he said, “Never thought you’d be the type, Iz.”

She laughed. “The type?”

“You know what I mean. Thought you’d be more the responsible wife type.”

Another laugh. “I’m not sure I’d want to be described like that!”

“You’re a big-time journalist these days, I guess you’re responsible in a different way.”

“You’re not doing so badly yourself,” she said. “You made the cover of the New York Times last fall, right? I saw that.”

“Yeah. It doesn’t happen all the time...”

“Still. Impressive.”

“I never got married,” Ben said.

“I never thought you would.”

“It’s working out for you?”

She paused, and I knew she was still figuring out how much to tell him. Then she said, “It’s great. He’s great.”

“Does he know... you’re seeing me tonight?”

She flashed a naughty grin — and I could tell, even without seeing his face, that her date was in to that. “He doesn’t have to know everything about me,” she said, avoiding a lie.

She brushed her hair out of her face, behind an ear, and now leaned forward to stroke his knee. “I’d better get changed,” she said quietly, seductively, as though at any moment he could stop her and persuade her to spend their date right there on the couch.

“Whatever you want,” her date said, and she rose to her feet.

“Won’t be a minute,” she said, and walked toward the camera — toward the iPad. From where he was sitting, he couldn’t see the thing that must have been propped up on the bookshelf somehow. He couldn’t see her pick it up, either, and take it with her upstairs.

I did. I saw her carrying it, I saw her set it down in the bedroom upstairs — on her bedside table.

She picked her phone out of her bag on the dresser, and I saw her tapping out a message. She was smiling as she texted whoever it was — and I know she hadn’t been texting me. Was this when she’d told Marie about her date?

Replacing the phone in her bag, she stared into the mirror just to the side of the camera, and now removed her jacket and the white tank top she’d been wearing underneath, leaving her in just a bra and that floral skirt.

Now I saw her opening her underwear drawer in the dresser, and retrieve various items of black lace. My heart skipped a beat or two at that, and it suddenly seemed a little more difficult to breathe in there. God, she had such a purposeful look in her eyes, it sent a shiver down my spine, and a warm throbbing in my manhood.

She was going to wear special lingerie for this guy, whoever he was?

Izzie stooped to remove her shoes, then off came her bra. Her nipples were like bullets — she was really aroused by all this, it was clear enough. Down came her floral skirt, which she carefully folded up and dropped on the chair in the corner of the room. Then down came her black cotton panties, which she dropped in the laundry basket.

I watched her dress in her new underwear, the fancy black lace panties, matching bra. When she started putting on a suspender belt, and pulled her panties up over it — for easy removal, I knew — I stopped the video.

Jesus. I had to get home.

I grabbed my things and rushed out of the room, checking out as rapidly as I could — and issuing the hotel receptionist with some story about my wife being taken ill back at home. Then I was out of there, a screech of tires as I pulled out of the parking lot for the journey back to Silver Spring.

*

I guess part of me was frightened, as I drove home, that she was really doing this. That my wife was dating one of her exes, and I couldn't control any of it. She was dressing up all sexy, she was going out to flirt with the guy, in the knowledge that I was safely packed away in Alexandria. She was fully intending to bring Ben home with her after dinner, and cheat on me.

Was it cheating? Not if I'd given her permission. But I'd given her permission to see guys even if I didn't pick up on her clues. That was nearer to cheating. Still, there was a dark excitement in that thought, for me at least.

I was almost out of breath as I drove home — and I was really just sitting there squeezing the gas pedal with my foot, not exactly exerting myself.

At the same time, I was hard as a rock as I sat there. It was an incredible thrill to think that Izzie might really do this. That she would have the excitement of dating somebody different, of flirting with him, of having him lusting after her.

I really did want her to do this, to go all the way, after so many months — years — of thinking about it.

When the traffic snarled up, and I was locked bumper-to-bumper at a frustrating standstill, I pressed the play button on the video on my iPad, watching Izzie rolling one black stocking and then the other up her shapely legs, fixing them in place mid-thigh, then attach the garter belts.

She looked incredible.

She put a pair of breathtakingly high heels on — black, naturally — then a black necklace around her neck. I watched her spritz with perfume, I watched her twirl for the benefit of the camera — for her watching husband — and finally touch up her make-up.

Only then did she finish the outfit by pulling on her little black dress, as though she wanted to give me the maximum amount of exposure time, watching her in that extravagant lingerie.

And that was the end of the video.

Chapter Thirteen

I broke a few speed limits by a fair amount on the way home. I was careful, but it wasn't very responsible of me. I parked the car down the street, around a corner, safely out of sight for anyone else who might be arriving at our house later that evening.

As I let myself in through our front door, my heart was thumping in my chest. I think the first thing I laid my eyes on when I got inside was the flowers that Izzie's date had given her, which had ended up on the kitchen counter.

The sight of those flowers made my chest burn a little. It was confirmation that the video Izzie had made and sent me was not faked, and though my head knew all along it had to be real, my heart was a little slower on the uptake. Glancing around, I saw the bottle of beer that Izzie's date had been drinking.

I felt a rising sense of panic. My wife was out on a hot date with another guy. Various thoughts were whirling around my head — what if they didn't come back here, what if they got a room in a hotel? What if Izzie wasn't safe with the guy?

My heart seemed to lead the paranoia, but my head kept a grip on things. I knew Izzie had chosen this first time to be with an ex, because she knew him, she felt safe with him, it was someone she'd been with before. It was infidelity, but in a way, it was only light infidelity, soft infidelity, because Izzie had already slept with this guy, some while before she'd started dating me.

What if they did go to a hotel somewhere? If I hadn't looked at Izzie's message, her video, immediately this evening, I wouldn't have come back home in time to see them anyway, if they came home. At least now I had a chance.

But how could I possibly see them if they came back here?

Nervous, a little panic still in my chest as I tried to think where I ought to hide when they did come back from their date, I scouted around upstairs. Izzie's clothes were where she'd left them, as per the video she'd sent me. Her floral skirt folded up on the chair, the pink denim

jacket. Her black panties in the laundry, which still contained the unmistakable scent of her arousal.

Izzie was already wet for him, her date.

So. First of all, I determined that if I was lucky and they left the bedroom door open, I might just about see from the spare bedroom across the hallway. What if they merely stayed downstairs, fooling around on the couch? I had to believe Izzie would at least want to end up on the bed, knowing her as I did.

I didn't like the risk that they might close the door — even partially — and block my line of sight from the spare room. The answer came pretty quickly, though again presented some risk. I could hide my iPhone in the small pot plant on the dresser. If you weren't actively looking for it, you wouldn't notice it there. The iPhone could broadcast an image straight to my iPad via FaceTime easily enough.

I had to charge my iPhone battery a little more before Izzie and her date returned home. Thankfully, there was enough time to do so, and while I waited I had a bite to eat — and made sure there was no evidence anywhere that I was present at the house.

When I heard the car pull up in the driveway, it was really late. Watching from the spare room, which had a window overlooking the street and our driveway, I was jolted awake, having almost drifted off to sleep while I waited.

I had to quickly set up my iPhone in the bedroom, then hide away in the spare room.

My heart was nearly beating its way out of my chest as I heard the front door open, and the two of them return from their dinner. There in the dark, I could hear them talking, flirting. It sent little pulses of sexual energy through my system.

“You know, I could take some pictures of you, Izzie. It'd be more beautiful than anything else I've ever taken.”

“You're so sweet, Ben.”

“I should have brought my camera tonight. You look incredible.”

“Perhaps another time. Or I could come by your studio some time, model a few outfits for you.”

*

She left him sitting on the bed as she slipped into the bathroom. I was pleasantly surprised by how much of the bedroom my iPhone camera was able to view from between the leaves of the pot plant.

When she emerged from the bathroom a few moments later, her dress was gone and I had to stifle a gasp to see her walking toward Ben in her sexy underwear.

“Wow,” he said, as she came to a halt in front of him, allowing him to sweep his eyes all over her.

“You like?”

He sighed. “I’ve missed you, Iz.”

She giggled, and climbed onto the bed on her hands and knees, Ben twisting as he sat on the end of the mattress, to gaze at her.

“You had to run off to Africa,” Izzie said. “Or Asia, or Australia or wherever.”

He smiled as she crawled over to him on the bed, her hand sliding over his thigh to find the bulge in between his legs.

“You were just starting your career,” he said. “You wouldn’t have wanted to come with me.”

“No, probably not.”

“High-tailing it all over the world.”

“Wherever there were species under threat.” Izzie was rubbing another man’s cock through his pants. My stomach felt squeezed by some invisible vice.

“I wish you had come with me,” he said.

I felt a few pangs of jealousy, sure. But it was nice to know other men wanted my Izzie, yet I got to have her as my wife. I knew Izzie wasn’t tempted to leave me for this guy — from her tone, if anything.

“I would have distracted you from your endangered wildlife,” she smiled, and moved back on the bed, sitting for him as though posing for one of his pictures.

“Maybe,” he nodded.

She was sitting up against the pillows, her knees drawn up but her thighs parted. I could see her from the spare room, through the open bedroom door — but the high resolution image from the iPhone offered an incredible view. Izzie’s new panties were semi-transparent, offering Ben a hint of what she was offering him.

“Show me,” I heard the guy say, and it sounded oddly commanding.

Her hands had been gently stroking her knees through the black nylon stockings, but now moved between her thighs, covering her panties. She began caressing herself there, through her semi-sheer underwear. So hot

— and yet the way she looked at him, compliant, obedient, submissive, seemed so very strange to me. I guess because we'd never been that way.

Perhaps Izzie was just slightly different with the other men she'd dated. There was something sexy in that thought.

"How is it?" I heard him ask.

"Growing wet," she said. Her candor shocked me. This was my wife, my Izzie, who found it difficult to talk about sex, even while we were doing it.

Maybe she found it easier to talk about it with other men. It was just me that made her feel awkward.

She was more than just casually stroking herself down there, she was masturbating for him. The way she did it made me certain this was something they'd done while they were together — this was part of their old relationship re-emerging.

I guess we men come to a relationship and kind of blank out what our women might have done before us. We imagine them as near-virgins when they come to us, without a sexual past. Oh, maybe they had some oral sex here, some penetrative sex there, a little fumble here and there with some faceless guy. But here, Izzie was showing me her past, and rather than freak me out and stoke the jealousy inside me, it was hotter than hot.

"Take off your bra," Ben told her.

She sat up — knelt up. "Yes sir," she grinned, reaching back to flip the catch on her bra, then slip the straps off her shoulders. Her bare breasts were revealed to him, her nipples stiff as could be.

"Squeeze them," he commanded, and she squeezed her nipples, sighing as she did so.

"Harder."

And she squeezed harder.

"Good girl."

"Good girl?" she laughed. "My husband would probably beg to differ."

"What he doesn't know can't hurt him," said Ben, then twirled his fingers. "Turn around."

"Yes, sir."

She did as he ordered her, turning to face the bedstead, showing him her ass, framed beautifully by her stockings and suspenders.

Ben leaned toward her, reaching to touch her buttocks, stroke them, fondle them. I held my breath as he touched her. As he slapped her. Izzie sighed and quietly moaned.

“I always loved your nice, round ass.”

“Thank you.”

He ran his finger along — and underneath — the thin band of material that formed the back of her panties. Thong, I guess. It was almost a g-string. I could see him pull on it, stretch it, dig it into the slit of her pussy.

“Very nice,” he said quietly, stretching her underwear aside to reveal her sex in its full glory.

He began slowly touching her there, running the tip of his middle finger along the slippery folds of her pussy. Izzie sighed as the touch of his digit became penetration.

“You’re seriously wet,” he said to her. “Must’ve been looking forward to our date, huh?”

“Ever since you told me you were coming to town,” she said. I wondered when that might have been. I had access to her email, to her text messages. I guess it could have been via Skype, or even a traditional phone call.

I was so hard watching another man sliding two fingers inside my wife’s soaking pussy. I could just about see from the spare room, but the iPhone was a better viewpoint.

He slapped her a couple times as he fingered her, and she only moaned in response. I didn’t think he was hitting her hard, but it made a crack. I had to trust that Izzie knew what she was doing — she had to know what this guy was like well enough, and she had invited him into her bed.

I’d never been entirely comfortable with the whole spanking thing, though. Even if I had to accept that some women appear to enjoy it.

He was saying something to her, which I couldn’t hear. Izzie was quietly moaning in reply. He kissed her on the behind, and then peeled her panties down off her hips, over her thighs. She lifted her knees to allow him to remove them completely.

Then he was off the bed, kneeling on the floor, pulling her to him like a lion dragging a gazelle. She lay on her back for him, opening her legs for him, groaning as he touched his mouth to her sex, as he began licking her there.

I couldn’t see much, but it was hot enough to see how she panted, how she sighed and caught her breath, as he lapped at her, and pushed his fingers inside her.

I was so turned on by her staccato breath as he took her on a sexual thrill ride.

And how her little cries subtly changed, becoming pleading — pleading for him to allow her to come. He murmured, and moved up to

kiss her mouth, but it seemed to me he was not allowing her to come, not until he wanted her to.

Ben had her move off the bed, and as he removed his shirt, she unfastened his belt, his pants. She pulled his hard cock out of his underwear, and I had to stifle another gasp as I watched my own wife licking another man's hardness.

The guy did have a fairly impressive physique — lean and strong, his muscles well defined though not built by gym time. The body of an outdoorsman, a man who made his living roaming the wilderness in search of the perfect image of animals in their own habitats.

The way Izzie was kneeling, I could watch through the bedroom door as she took him into her mouth, as she slowly sank on his shaft, as she coaxed his length with her lips. Was he larger than me? I guess it was an inevitable question for a guy watching another guy performing with his wife. I didn't think so. Similar, at any rate.

He held her hair out of the way of her face, and led her motion, fucking her face right there not more than a dozen yards away from me. She seemed to enjoy it, though, moaning as she serviced him, as she played with this manhood that was not her husband's.

I was just about handling the sight of my wife going down on another man when he had her get up, lay on the bed once again, part her legs for him, and he was there between her thighs, stroking her pussy with his cock, patting the thing against her flesh as though it were a whip.

Slipping on a condom and then sliding it straight into her dripping wet pussy.

I gasped, and had the two of them not been in there fucking, they might well have heard me.

Another man was fucking my wife.

*

I was burning inside to watch them — and yet my cock was harder than it had ever been. I was experiencing the sharp acid of jealousy, at what she had with Ben, and perhaps of what she'd had when she'd been with him before me. There was a sense of fear and paranoia inside me that she wanted him more than me.

And yet the exhilaration was beyond any of that. The sight of her being so naughty, of her gaining sensational sexual gratification — and

under the terms of our Game, it was me allowing her to have this.

I could appreciate the beauty of my wife as a sexual creature, from an independent viewpoint, a viewpoint I'd never have if it was me involved.

And the taboo nature of this, just how wrong it was in society's eyes, made the sex as exciting as it had been when I'd first started out as an inexperienced teenager.

When I embraced the trust I had for my wife, I found I could lessen the negative side of watching her with him, muffle the pain, cut out the jealousy. And seeing her mating with another male drove a primordial instinct within me to want to claim her for myself.

My desire for Izzie had never been stronger.

She moved her knees down, stretching her legs apart further, and via the iPhone I could see his cock thrusting into her. My God, it took my breath away.

"Touch it," I heard Ben grunt, and Izzie's hand came down to cover the tidy little patch of hair over her mound, to stroke her clit as he fucked her.

She gasped and cried out as he pounded her, and then she was pleading for permission to come again, only this time more desperate than before.

Ben held her by the neck and fucked her hard. And I guess he did give her permission to come, because she did so explosively. Ben himself had longer to go, and it wasn't until he was taking her from behind, like an animal, before he allowed himself to come, tearing off the condom and spraying his white cream over Izzie's back.

*

I watched as Ben dressed himself, and I felt just plain stunned. Izzie had done it. Though I'd allowed her to do it, I had myself an unfaithful wife.

I think I'd always been curious what that would feel like — a curiosity that had fed into the original conversation that had given rise to the Game in the first place. I was a writer, a creative, I saw people around me with flawed relationships, and I naturally wondered what that felt like. I had now engineered the experience for myself, only it wasn't a classical flawed relationships. The infidelity was consensual. I had wanted my wife to fool around.

“You gonna be in the city again any time soon?” Amplified by the microphone of the iPhone, to be broadcast to my iPad, Izzie’s voice cut through my daze.

“Not planning on it,” Ben responded.

Izzie was lying there on the bed, half-covered by a white sheet. “You could come round,” she said. “Have a little fun for old times’ sake.”

Ben smiled. “And you’d be able to get hubby out of the way?”

She shrugged. “He’s a very busy man.”

Finishing up buttoning his shirt, the photographer leaned forward to stroke Izzie’s chin. “I’ll let you know,” he said.

I felt a little tremble at the thought that this ex of hers could spring up any time in the future, and Izzie would take him to her bed at the drop of a hat.

I had unleashed this in her now, I had opened Pandora’s box.

“We could go to a hotel, if you prefer,” she said.

“Maybe,” he nodded, “maybe.”

I watched him leave her, leave the house. I didn’t feel bad about it. It seemed to me there was no way Ben was any kind of threat to our marriage — he was a wild animal, he couldn’t be caged, couldn’t be tamed by the commitment of an actual relationship.

It seemed to me, after watching them, that the one fear that really burned through me watching my wife with another man was the fear that she would prefer her time with that other man — and want to be with him rather than me.

As I sat by the spare bedroom window, watching as Ben left the house, got in his car, drove quietly away from our serene and highly civilized neighborhood, I figured he was the perfect kind of lay for my wife in this new Game of ours. Someone who really wasn’t out to win her — just bed her.

*

She was in the bathroom as I came into the bedroom, though the door was open. I went in. The shower was running, but she wasn’t under the flow of the water yet, she was peering at some of the pink marks on her behind left by Ben’s little swats.

“Still love me?” she asked, apparently unsurprised I was here.

“More than ever,” I said, and I wasn’t kidding.

Seeing her in there, naked now, my cock was throbbing, I was filled with a craving for her body. I touched her behind, gently applying one finger to the pink blush on her cheek.

“He was a little rough,” I said.

“Uh-huh.” She leaned into the mirror behind the sink to apparently check on the state of her make-up. Or else she was just giving me a better view of her butt.

“You like that?”

“I did with him, I guess.”

“But not with me?”

She shrugged. “It’s different with you.”

I nodded. She turned, and her fingers brushed over the bulge in my pants. “Does that make you mad?”

I paused. “No,” I shook my head. “I guess it’s part of it, isn’t it? That it’s different with other guys.”

“That turns you on?” she stroked my hard shaft through my pants, amused as much as she was excited by its presence.

“I guess. I’m not sure I like him hitting you, though.”

“It wasn’t hard. Not much more than a pat.”

She moved to the shower, sticking her hand under the flow of the water to test its temperature. I grabbed her other hand and pulled her back to me, making her squeal. She giggled as I held her close to me, her back to my chest, kissing her neck, breathing in the strange scent of the sex she’d had with another man.

“Wait, I’ll take a shower,” she said.

“I can’t wait,” I insisted, turning her, kissing her mouth — a mouth that had sucked on another man’s cock that very evening.

God, it was so wrong to think of her like that — used, taken, violated by another man — and yet such a buzz. The wicked harlot, my pretty wife. I pushed her back, so her butt rested against the edge of the sink, or I should say the counter. I kissed her breasts, sucked on her nipples. I could sense the other man on her, and it pushed my buttons, drove me to reclaim her for myself.

I lifted her hips, making her squeal again, sitting her up on the counter by the sink, standing to kiss her unfaithful mouth, her hard nipples, her stomach. She seemed uncertain as I ventured between her legs, as I approached the small triangular patch of bronze hair over her mound. It was like when we were first dating, and she couldn’t be sure whether I did truly enjoy going down on her, or whether I was going to do it purely as a means to please her. No though, it was because another man’s hard

cock had been inside her, had thrust into her pussy. Did I see it as polluting her? No. There was something deeply thrilling about her pussy being sullied, used by another. And kissing around it, stroking it with my fingers, feeling how wet she was, breathing in the aroma of sex and female arousal and a hint of the condom they used — it was all part of the taboo, the wrongness that made Izzie so damn desirable.

For a while I just gazed upon her flower, gently parting her petals with my hands, seeing how puffy and red she was from her time with her ex-boyfriend. Taking in the splendor and the strange wonder of her sex after what I'd just seen in the bedroom.

I began flicking the tip of my tongue lightly over the rosy petals, and gradually strengthened the pressure of my attention on her, tasting her profuse wetness as I inhaled the strong smell of sex. I moaned as I ate her, showing her how much I wanted this, how I loved to, even after she'd been with another.

I sucked gently on her clit, and slipped a finger inside her, stirring her there, stronger and stronger the more she responded to it.

"You knew him in college?" I asked her.

"Uh-huh," she said, though now she was panting so much it was difficult for her to answer me.

"He was in your year?"

"Post-grad," she said, groaning as I fingered her. "Older than us."

Sensing she was uncomfortable on the edge of the sink, I lifted her again, making her laugh as I carried her out of the bathroom to dump her on the bed before I resumed feasting on the center of her infidelity.

More comfortable, she lost herself in my attention, gripping my head firmly, her hips bucking under me, fucking my mouth as I ate her. Pink-faced, perspiration mottling her brow, she came vociferously — much more quickly than I'd ever made her come before.

"I didn't think you'd come home," she said as I lay on the bed. "I didn't think you'd watch."

"I was in Alexandria, not far," I said. "You must have thought it possible, emailing me that video."

Looming over me, she wrestled to remove my clothes, almost purring as she removed my boxer shorts to expose the full hardness of my cock.

"You liked watching me, then?" she asked.

"Uh-huh."

"Was it all you hoped it would be?"

"And more."

Straddling my naked form, she curled her hand around my shaft, feeling out how hard I was for her, the pressing it up against her body, her mound.

“So this Game of ours,” she said, lifting her pussy, stroking the tip of my cock against the wet groove of her sex. “You think it should continue?”

“Definitely,” I said.

She was beaming from ear to ear as she sank down, taking my hardness deep inside her.

Warmed up by the evening’s depravity, it wasn’t long before I came inside her — and she came once again along with me.

Later, in the middle of the night, I woke up for some reason, and I was hard once again. The thoughts of my Izzie fucking someone else revolved around my mind. I lay there, thinking I would have to get up, sneak out to tend to my erection if I ever wanted to get back to sleep.

Izzie’s hand moved over my lap, and her fingers were quick to locate my solid pole.

She was as awake as I was — and pretty soon, she was riding me for a second time that night. I’d say if it ever had waned, suddenly our sex life had been seriously reinvigorated.

Chapter Fourteen

To be honest, in those early days, it was difficult to find enough time to devote to The Game. Izzie wasn't in any kind of rush to sleep around, despite how she'd been in college — and despite a constant encouragement from Marie.

I think things settled for a while after Izzie's night with Ben. It left me with so much fuel for the fire to work out with Izzie in the bedroom, she was happy enough. But we also needed some time to get our heads around the feelings, and how things might be in the future.

We also were both fairly busy at work, of course.

Then one morning, I arrived in the office for another day's striving, only to discover a certain pink piece of paper sitting there on my desk.

For a moment, I had no idea what it was, and my eyes didn't seem to focus properly on the words printed on the form. I also didn't initially connect it with the unusual atmosphere that appeared to be pervading the newsroom that morning.

"Notice of termination of employment".

I just held it, for a long while, before it seemed to filter into my brain what this really meant. As it slowly dawned on me what it was, I felt my body go cold, my insides seem to disappear leaving an empty cavern in my chest.

"Jesus," I said finally, "it really is pink."

I looked up, mainly to find someone with whom I might share the news of my sudden termination as a Washington Messenger reporter — and it was then it became clear that I wasn't the only one to receive this particular paperwork that morning. There were guys around the newsroom just sitting at their desks staring at their pink slips. There were folks quietly sobbing in their cubicles. There were some people even diligently clearing their desks, just plain getting on with it. Plenty of empty desks within my sight bore pink slips that hadn't even been picked up yet. There were even a couple of shouters, although a couple of security staff with advance warning soon made light work of

encouraging those guys to make their way out of the building in good time.

“Oscar.”

I turned to find Martin Townsend, who I guessed was technically no longer my boss, standing there looking dejected — and completely exhausted. I suspected a lack of sleep the previous night, though since he appeared to be still in receipt of a job here, I didn’t feel much pity for him.

“Mart. Looks like a scene of devastation right here,” I said, gesturing to the desperate state of the newsroom. The last time the newsroom felt like this was probably when one of our colleagues was confirmed dead, killed by Islamic extremists in Syria.

He nodded. “I’m sorry,” he said. “I was up all night fighting for you.”

“How many?”

“They’ve got to can half the paper,” he said. “Half.”

“Half. Jesus.” Somehow, I felt less cold toward Mart himself. Wasn’t his fault the money men were doing what they were doing.

“They’re giving our local business patch to the national business desk. There’ll be plenty of freelance work around in the transition.”

I nodded. “I guess I’m available,” I said.

“This is only the first phase of layoffs. They’ve got to find as many again.”

“What about you?” I asked him.

He shrugged. “They keep me six months, then I get early retirement,” he said. “I tell you, this paper will never be the same.”

I found myself looking forlornly around the office, my mind reeling. Did I even possess a box in which I could put my stuff? Where did everyone get their damn boxes?

“Well, everyone reads the news for free now, huh,” I said dejectedly.

Mart said, “They’re going to cut the size of the paper down an unbelievable amount. Cut the revenue, but cut the costs more. Start from scratch, basically.”

I couldn’t see the part of the floor where the political guys hung out, where Izzie worked. I pulled my mobile out of my pocket and fired off a text to her:

>Just lost my job. Hope they’re keeping you, sweetie xx

“What’s happening to the Capitol Hill desk?” I asked my former boss.

Mart shrugged, “They’ll be in phase two. Six months down the line. Cutbacks, not complete closure like us. Some will survive, some will go.”

I could see he knew to whom I was referring. In one foul swoop, this whole thing could have our little household facing a zero income. Well, I guess it wouldn't be zero — we'd find something. But for a time it would be nothing.

A text came back:

>So sorry to hear it, sweetie. I'm safe for now — but they'll be looking for people to go in the next phase.

I felt some small measure of relief at that. We'd have some income coming in over the next six months at least, to help pay the bills. But what then?

*

I did get some work via the grapevine — editors I'd worked with before, and some who had been rivals and knew of my capabilities well enough. Martin from the Messenger was fairly supportive, although I knew much of his commissions would be part of the transition to the new company structure. I even did some reporting for the Times, via our friend Marie's recommendations.

I worked hard, and I knew Izzie was working hard, too, at the Messenger. She still had a good chance of keeping her job, we were certain.

Meanwhile, we were both able to distract ourselves from the doom and gloom by thinking about our Game — I could spend quiet moments checking up on Izzie's communications with some of her male friends, and take some delight in her flirtatious manner.

It was difficult to tell if there was someone she was really interested in, since she was flirty with most guys around her, but it seemed to me that there were a few she might have her eye on. There were guys in her office dropping her little messages to ask if she wanted a coffee, or to go for lunch, or to say she "looked nice today", or similar, and it was hardly the most appropriate thing for the workplace — but Izzie seemed to lap it up, and give it back.

When she got home after work, we would often head for the bedroom even before fixing dinner, the memory of her tryst with her ex-boyfriend, Ben, still firmly in our minds.

When she was late home from work, I'd find myself hoping she had gone out for an impromptu date, though I couldn't find any clues

supporting such an idea. Often it was just that work had overrun, pushing her gym session later as well. A few times she had dinner with contacts, or even drinks with a group of co-workers after work — but again, there was no signs of her dating.

She even had a couple of nights away from home, covering the early campaign trail for the Presidential nominations, and that led me to hope that something might happen, even if I didn't get to see it with my own eyes.

On those nights, I found myself preparing for the stresses and strains that would come from having her seeing other guys when I couldn't be around to witness it or its aftermath.

It wasn't until she flew out to San Francisco to cover a Democratic rally — a trip that would take her away from home for three nights — that I was given concrete proof that something might happen.

Chapter Fifteen

It wasn't just that a few of the condoms from the box in the bathroom went missing. When I checked, a few hours after she'd left for the airport, the whole box was gone. Further investigation suggested that she'd packed some saucy underwear for her trip. So who was going to be the lucky so-and-so?

My heart aflame, my cock thick with the hope that my pretty wife was planning some wicked encounter while away from home, I scoured her messages, her email, whatever I could get my hands on. It seemed that a group of reporters — including Marie — were planning on getting together for a meal and cocktails in San Francisco once everything was wrapped up with the rally itself. Nothing unusual about that, but it got me wondering whether she had her eye on anyone.

That night, she called from the hotel via FaceTime, since whenever either of us was away from home, it was standard practice to call each other before bedtime. This time, though, she definitely wasn't ready for bed when she called. The time difference meant that bedtime for me was dinner time for her. She had her make-up on, a delicate necklace and matching earrings, and was wearing an elegant long black dress.

"You been out already?" was my first question.

She smiled. "Not yet. Late night dinner with someone."

"Someone?"

She blushed. Even after everything I'd seen her do with Ben, and she was blushing. "A man," she said.

She shifted in her seat, and I saw a little more of her dress. The neckline plunged to a stylish buckle that connected the two sides of the dress between her breasts. And as she shifted further in the seat, it seemed to me that that buckle was really the only thing keeping the dress together. Any breeze could have opened the thing up like some loosely tied bathrobe.

The way she was sitting now, I could see her stomach, her midriff — even her black panties, semi-sheer ones.

"You'll be cold wearing that out to dinner," I warned her.

“I have a jacket,” she smiled.

I felt jealousy singeing my insides, but my thumping heart was pumping the blood into my thigh erection, I couldn’t deny.

“Who is he?” I asked her. I wanted to ask if she was planning on sex, if there was any way I’d get to watch her if it happened. It just felt a trifle too awkward — and not wanting to risk discouraging her by being too needy.

“A journalist,” she said.

“Does he know the deal between us?”

“I don’t think so.”

So, that meant whoever it was would be under the impression that Izzie was cheating on her husband. Something in that notion appealed to me, made me want Izzie that much more.

“You know him well?” I asked her.

She shrugged. “We talk on the phone sometimes. We have lunch when he’s in DC.”

I nodded. I felt too proud, too strange about all this, to ask her to let me watch.

I said only, “Well, have fun. Don’t stay up too late — you have to cover the rally tomorrow.”

She smiled. “I know. It’s a school night. I love you.”

There was that excitement in her eyes just then — and it seemed to me linked to the fact that I hadn’t stepped in and prevented her from going on this date tonight. There was gratitude — and love — in her eyes, in her expression, too. That gave me a buzz and a half.

“I love you too,” I said.

I think she was just about to end our call, then she suddenly blurted out: “It’s possible... it’s possible I might not be back here... tonight.”

I hesitated. My cock strained inside my pants, but I didn’t quite know what to say. She was perhaps concerned that I hadn’t caught the full implications of the evidence I was being presented with. That she was looking to score tonight.

Well, it was still early days in our Game.

“I figured that might be the case,” I said finally, with a warm smile I hoped to be supportive, encouraging.

I did want her to date, after all. Even if I didn’t get to see all of it. My excitement stemmed from her excitement, the thought of her misbehaving — not just from the visual stimulus of watching her having sex with someone.

“Right,” she said, a touch awkward, perhaps concerned I would be hurt by knowing what she was up to, and being unable to control it.

I said, “This is the way the Game is going to be sometimes. You’re free to play, even if I can’t be physically with you at the time.”

She smiled. “Don’t forget how much I love you,” she said.

“No, I won’t ever do that.”

I was hard as a rock as we ended the call. I went for a drive, obtained some drive-thru to help distract me from it all. I lay in bed imagining what she might be doing. Dinner, then drinks, then a taxi ride back to the hotel. Sneaking into one or other of their rooms to ensure none of the other reporters in town to cover the rally would see them playing the couple.

There was no way I was going to sleep.

I am, Izzie sent a text message:

>Hope you’re asleep! Love you ;-)

There was a picture attached to her text message — a selfie Izzie had taken with the assistance of a bathroom mirror. Izzie wearing that scandalous dress, the thing flapping open to show me so much of her pale skin. Her panties were just transparent enough to make out the shape of the little triangular patch of fuzz about her sex.

Jesus. There were toiletries around the bathroom sink, visible in the picture — but they weren’t Izzie’s, they were distinctly male-oriented. A bottle of aftershave, a male shaving razor. She was in a guy’s bathroom, a guy’s hotel room.

I shivered.

But that was it for the night. No more texts. No more clues. I made myself come — it was the only way I’d be able to get any sleep at all, with that tension inside me.

*

The next morning I received another text message, though no image, from Izzie:

>Hey sweetie! I hope you got some sleep. I promise I did, too. Might not be able to call you tonight because it will be quite busy. Have a great day tho! Xxx

I took the meaning from her “promise” that she’d got some sleep as suggesting she did also sleep with her date the previous night. It actually

made me feel great all day. While I missed her — my heart was hurting from her absence more than it ever had before we'd started playing the game — and I wished I'd got the chance to watch her with her date, I clung onto the thought that very soon, Izzie would be back, and I would have her to myself.

And all day I had to keep adjusting my pants to account for the warm state of arousal I felt knowing that my wife was out there, getting laid. I would never have thought it would be like this to have Izzie away from me and seeing other guys, where I couldn't watch what was happening. I guess the imagination filled in the blanks, and quietly built the picture in my mind of my wife as a sexy, scandalous nymph.

The next evening, there were items about the San Francisco rally on CNN, but I found myself peering at the coverage trying to see if any other reporters would be picked up on camera — if I might catch sight of Izzie, and see who she was hanging out with while reporting on the gathering of Democrats.

I knew it was a slim hope. I never got to see her on that broadcast, with or without someone by her side.

That night as I was going to bed, I received another text from Izzie:

>Still at the rally — have a good sleep, sweetie, I love you so much!!!
Xxxx

I took heart from her remembering to text me before I went to bed, and from the clear excitement in the tone of her message.

My constant state of arousal while Izzie was away seemed to tire me out — I was asleep easily this time. At some point in the middle of the night, though, my iPhone woke me with a sudden buzz as the vibrate feature trembled against the hard surface of my bedside table.

Izzie had sent a message.

>A clue for you ;-)

Our wi-fi was having a moment, because it could a couple of seconds more to load the image she'd sent along with her text message. I had to shake the fuzziness of sleep from my head before I could quite work out what she was showing me.

I caught my breath as it became clear to me that it was showing a close-up view looking down between her legs, her pussy only just covered by a skimpy pink thong. The faint but clear dark patch in the material suggested that she was already wet. The unopened condom packet tucked mischievously into the waistband of her underwear suggested she was about to do something to release her tension.

Wow, that was some turn-on. I might not get to watch, if it was difficult for her to set up the capability — but I could lie there knowing that at that precise moment, nearly three thousand miles away, my wife was fucking another man.

*

Izzie called me in the morning — about eight-thirty my time, so it had to be about 5.30 in San Francisco.

“Early,” I said to her, wanting to see her face, but the video on FaceTime was taking an age to load up. “Sleep much?”

“A little,” she said. “I wanted to get out of his room... you know... while there was nobody around.”

“Walk of shame,” I grinned.

“Something like that.”

The video came on, and the first thing I saw was a pair of perky, delectable breasts. Her nipples were stiff, but what struck me most were the streaks of wetness here and there over her chest, which caught the light. That wasn't sweat.

She held up the phone so I could see her face. She was glowing, her satisfaction clear from her bright eyes, wide smile, rosy cheeks. Her make-up was all smeared — her mascara was running down to her cheeks, while her lipstick seemed to me that she'd chosen a brand that would show me plainly that she'd just gone down on someone.

“You see me now?” she asked.

“I do. You had fun?”

“Uh-huh. You can tell?”

She was in her bathroom, it seemed to me. It was confirmed as she put her iPhone down on the counter beside the sink, and I could see the bathtub/shower behind her. From there by the sink, I was also afforded a nice view of her midriff and her bare pussy until she turned to open the shower door and turn on the water.

Some other guy had fucked that sweet pussy all night. I was so hard. I felt such a burning desire to take her back — frustrating that I couldn't.

“I assume you didn't walk back to your room like that,” I said.

“No,” she laughed. “What do you think hotel bathrobes are for?”

That made me chuckle. “Unfaithful wives, apparently.”

She smirked. “You love it,” she said, turning back toward the phone.

“Uh-huh.”

“Show me?”

I blanked for a moment, not sure what she meant — but then I understood what she meant. It was easy to show her how hard I was, since I was still in my PJs.

“Mmm...” she said, beaming, almost purring as she stooped to show me her face again. “One more night, then I’m taking that for myself.”

“One more night,” I agreed.

I watched her stand by the sink, that stunning well-used pussy of hers filling my iPad screen, as she pulled out some of her face wipes, peering into the mirror to remove her remaining make-up.

“So you’re all right?” she asked me. “You don’t want to stop playing the Game?”

“I’m fine,” I insisted. “And no, I don’t want to stop.”

After a pause, I added, “You’re okay? You want to stop?”

She laughed. “Oh, I am great. I don’t want to stop if you don’t.”

“Great.”

“It just seems so one-sided, that’s all.”

“One-sided?”

She stood up, turned to the shower again. “I’m sleeping with whoever I want to like some wild single girl — and you’re stuck at home waiting for me. Just seems unfair.”

“Oh, right.”

Izzie tested the water, then stepped into the bathtub. “Don’t get me wrong — I’m not saying I’d want you to start dating. It’s just... well, I guess we’ve talked about this.”

“We have,” I said. “I’m getting just as much out of this as you are.”

I watched her washing herself, running her hands over her breasts, her chest, her stomach, between her legs. Cleaning away the evidence of her adultery ready for another day of reporting work.

I said, “I get to enjoy my sexy wife. I have you to turn me on by... well, you know.”

I couldn’t quite say it. I was impressed with how much the two of us had been able to talk about sex, about Izzie’s new dating life, ever since we’d started playing this game. We were improving in this area, in sharing intimate details. But that didn’t stop it being a little awkward sometimes.

“You’re a voyeur,” she said. “You like to watch.”

“Uh-huh.”

“But what about when you can’t watch? If I can’t let you — or if you miss my clues?”

“If I know it’s happening, then I can imagine how it is,” I said. “It turns me on just knowing you’re out there... dating. And if I don’t find out until after... well, it’s still pretty hot, I think, knowing you just did it.”

“You are crazy, you know that?”

“I think I must be.”

Crazy or not, waiting another night for her to come back from San Francisco wasn’t easy, even if it was ultimately pleasurable.

That third night, she sent me another image of her getting ready for her night out — looking sensational in a set of crimson-and-black lace lingerie that I assume she was wearing under a dress of some kind, although I didn’t get a picture of her full ensemble. Then in the middle of the night she sent me a picture of herself naked, or at least wearing only stockings, blowing me a kiss. The state of her told me in no uncertain terms that she’d been freshly fucked.

I think the inability to see anything that had really gone on while she’d been in San Francisco gave me motivation to make sure when the chance came, I would see everything.

The next day I took some time out of my work day — most of the day, as it turned out — and worked on hiding away various cameras and microphones around our house, setting up quite a sophisticated surveillance system, if I did say so myself. The Internet — and Radio Shack for the hardware — proved to offer what I needed to set it all up. Our unfinished basement, where nobody was ever going to think to visit, would offer me somewhere to be when Izzie decided to bring home a date.

She would still date guys out of town, and she would no doubt go back to their places from time to time. But when she brought any guy back home for the night, I was going to be able to watch everything.

*

Then she was home again, and I naturally had to pick her up from the airport. I was so desperate for her, I almost hustled her into a public bathroom to take her in a stall.

I resisted, though, until we got home.

“Am I going to find out who he was?” I asked her as we pulled out of the parking lot at Dulles.

“Maybe,” she said with a cryptic smile.

“Are you going to see him again?”

Another smile. “I hope so.”

“Does he live around here? In the DC area?”

“No,” she shook her head. “He’s quite far away. I think that’s why it felt safe to... well... have a little fun together while we were on the West Coast.”

“A little fun?” I laughed. “Seems to me you had a lot of fun.”

“Oh we did,” she said, wide-eyed and seeming to be glowing. Sexual satisfaction looked good on Izzie. Very good. “He fucked me so hard, I could hardly walk after it.”

I nearly blew a gasket at that.

Izzie didn’t usually talk so dirty with me. I liked it.

“Okay, I need to concentrate on the driving for a while,” I warned her. I didn’t want to cause a major incident on the Beltway just because I was listening to my wife talk about her recent infidelity.

We got home and she pleaded to be allowed to go up and have a shower, to clean up from her long day of travel. I had to let her, but suggested joining her in the shower.

“Just wait for me,” she said. “I like it when you wait for me.”

Was there a streak of cruelty in her? I slumped on the sofa down in the living room as she went upstairs. I’d waited three nights for her, I could wait a little longer. While she was in the shower, though, every minute of waiting seemed interminable.

Then there she was, a goddess floating down the stairs wearing a long-sleeve bodysuit made of luxurious black lace, with thigh-high black stockings.

“Hi,” she smiled, walking down the steps like some supermodel on the catwalk.

“Hi,” I said.

“I wore this for him,” she said. “Or something like it, anyway.”

“Is that so?”

“Thought you’d like to see.”

She walked around me, around the couch to stand in front of me, moving, turning, posing for me. Showing off her exquisite body. The butterflies fluttered in my stomach to think that she’d dressed up like this for another man during her time away from me.

“It’s beautiful,” I said. “I bet he couldn’t resist you in that.”

She smiled, and slowly walked toward me, lifting one foot up onto the couch beside me, her hands running all over her body, one stroking over her lace-clad pussy.

“As soon as he saw it, he was tearing it off me,” she said. “Almost not worth wearing it.”

Izzie pulled at the crotch of her body suit, and the material parted to reveal her pussy, already gently glistening with her moisture. She stroked it, and dipped a couple of fingers inside herself, before withdrawing them to touch them against my lips.

I sucked on her fingers, tasting her.

“I’m sorry you couldn’t see me with him,” she said, smiling broadly at my obvious enjoyment of her flavor. “There really was nowhere I could hide my iPhone, not where it wasn’t obvious what I would be doing.”

“It’s okay,” I said, pulling myself up to my feet now. Kissing her mouth. “It’s going to be like that, isn’t it? Sometimes.”

“Probably.”

“The important thing is, you’re back here with me now.”

I took hold of her and threw her playfully down onto the couch, as though she were my property. Izzie squealed with delight. I started stripping off my clothes for her — well, my smart casual attire was hardly a match for her drop-dead gorgeous sex goddess attire.

She sat there and bit her lip, playing with her long auburn hair flirtatiously as she watched me from the couch, before her hands dropped down to her lap, and she was stroking her pussy while she saw me removing my clothes.

“It felt very naughty, being away from home,” she said. “Seducing some guy thousands of miles away from you.”

“Uh-huh.”

She grinned wickedly. “I can see why some women like to cheat. Even though I knew you were okay with it... it seemed wrong. And so exciting because of that.”

“Good,” I said, crouching wearing only my boxers now. Watching her touching herself as I held one of her stocking-clad feet, stroking her gently. She was so stunning, it was so beautiful watching her taking care of herself like that. I could smell her arousal, I could hear the wet sounds of her fingers playing with her slippery folds, along with the soft sighs as she responded to the feelings.

But I could wait and watch for only so long. I craved her body.

“Did you like it more than the time you knew I was watching you?” I asked her, kissing my way up her leg.

“No,” she said, then tempered her thought, “I don’t know. I love it when you’re watching. But when you’re not... it’s different.”

As I neared her pussy, the spicy scent of her arousal was strong. I was buzzing all over at the knowledge of her infidelity as I touched the tip of my tongue there, as I tasted her tangy goodness.

“Different?” I prompted her.

She caught her breath as I engulfed her clit in my hot mouth, sucking very gently on it.

Then she said, “It is. It’s a different high, one way or the other.”

She sighed as I pressed my face against her, my tongue wedging itself into her soaking groove. “When you’re watching,” she said, “I feel like I’m performing for you. I’m turning you on, directly. I love it. But when I’m not with you... I guess it feels even more... naughty.”

“Uh-huh,” I smiled, and she gasped as I slid two fingers inside her.

“I guess I... get the sense... that I’m cheating...”

“And you like that? Cheating?” I was smiling at her, kind of turned on that she got a buzz from cheating on me. There I was again, twisted. I couldn’t help it.

“I think a lot of women probably do,” she said. “Most women, even.”

I removed my fingers and sucked her juices from them, before returning to lap at her wetness from the source. Her sighs turned to panting, her body writhing under me as I ate her. She lay back, along the couch, her hands moving to hold my head, encouraging me, guiding me, pulling me against her.

Her moans became cries as I pressed my face firmly against her, feeling her wetness all over my mouth, my cheeks, my chin, my every breath saturate with the scent of her excitement.

Was it cheating or not if she didn’t let me watch her with other men? I don’t know. But just then I couldn’t get enough of her cheating pussy.

Infidelity just added to the fascination I had for my wife. Over the years we’d been married, that fascination had tempered into familiarity, and while our sex life had always been pretty good, it had settled into something akin to a routine before we’d started playing this Game.

Now, my Izzie was as intriguing to me again as any woman could be. It was, I think, a significant part of the reason why this whole sharing thing did not involve any hint of me wanting to have other women as well.

Izzie was her own woman, free and independent. Able to go out there and do whatever she wanted, see whoever she wanted. Sleep with

whoever she wanted — within reason, of course. Within the rules of our Game.

There on the couch she fucked my face and I loved every moment of it, and it seemed to me that I had given her the experience of adultery, and that I adored her after it, worshipping her body in part because of it — that made her come as much as the physical touching of my mouth on her sweet pussy.

She pushed me back on the couch, and now she was stroking my hardness with her stockinged feet through my boxer shorts. Loving how turned on I was by her promiscuity. She crawled over to me, kissed my mouth, licked her way down my chest and stomach.

She pulled my cock out of my underwear, sucking it into her hot mouth.

I groaned, and watching her bob down on my shaft, her pretty face framed by her dark auburn hair, I found myself imagining that in the last few days, she'd been doing this with some other cock, some other man.

The wicked nymph.

I burned inside to think of it — but it only enhanced the sensations as she sucked on me.

After a while, I had to wriggle out from her clutches. I was about to explode in her mouth, but what I wanted — what I needed — was to reclaim her sex.

I pulled myself up, and she was smiling, enjoying playing the sex siren again. Wiping her mouth on her arm as she lay there on her front, waiting for me to show her what I wanted from her next.

I stroked her bare behind, marveling at its shape, and she pushed it up to offer me better access. God, her shape seemed designed specifically to drive men crazy. She pushed her butt up so that I could duck down and steal another taste of her juicy pussy.

I slid my fingers inside her, and she let out a gasp. It was as though the whole weekend — and her first climax with me here — had set her body into easy orgasm mode. She was just so sensitive to my touch there.

I parted her buttocks and sucked on her pussy, making her come again like that — if she was in easy orgasm mode, I was going to do it as I liked best, and it was just plain beautiful in my eyes to make a woman come with my mouth.

She didn't seem to object that afterwards, I pressed my hard cock between her buttocks, and moved to enter her like that. She moaned and raised her hips for me to stroke the tip of my cock over her slippery channel, then ease myself slowly inside her.

Inside her, I lay over her, supporting my body on my elbows as I drove my cock deep inside her. I held her head, kissing her, owning her. She was writhing and shaking and panting under me, and it seemed to me that she enjoyed the whole air of her husband looming over her, holding her, taking her for his own.

It was a kind of dominance, you might say, though I'd never been a dominant man.

It pushed buttons in Izzie that hadn't really been pushed before, at least not by me.

I felt spurred on by her reaction to it. I turned her over, slid back inside her, thrust into her harder and harder and harder, making her body rock, her face and chest blush as she panted for breath.

When it came time for me to reach my climax, sinking deep into her to pump my hot seed into her, Izzie was just shaking and whimpering.

"Jesus," she whispered after getting some of her breath back, as we lay there on the couch together, unable to move our entangled bodies. "Where did that come from?"

Chapter Sixteen

Saturday.

During the late morning, Izzie had to go down to the MSNBC Washington Bureau to take part in a panel discussion on the current state of the Presidential campaigns. I ended up lounging around home that afternoon in my sweatpants, watching her on the broadcast. She did well in the show — and the TV cameras seemed to love her, but then as husband I guess I was a little biased.

When she came back home wearing the same trim business suit she'd sported on TV, I just wanted to tear it off her and take her to the bedroom. However, she stopped me.

"I have to get ready," she said, smiling broadly as she batted away my hands as I attempted to have my way with her.

"Huh?"

"I have a date."

I hadn't been expecting that. I have to say, the way that we'd been playing the Game, Izzie had tended to get ready for dates while I was out. I guess we were both quite busy people, and I had often been away doing things when she scheduled her dates. It was just the way it was: I came home to find evidence that she had prepared herself for a date with another man, and that in itself was quite a thrill to me.

Now, though, Izzie rather flirtatiously brushed one hand through her hair and said, "Why don't you come talk to me while I get ready?"

The thought of watching her getting dressed up for her date with some other guy seemed seriously hot to me. I guess I was a little surprised the opportunity hadn't really come up before — but such was the nature of our approach to Izzie's dating.

I followed her upstairs and into the bedroom, answering her question about how good she'd been on TV that afternoon.

"Your job at the Messenger has to be pretty secure," I was telling her as I flopped onto the bed to watch her taking off her clothes.

"If it's not, there's probably plenty of places I could go," she said in a sing-song tone that seemed fairly confident she wasn't going to get the

same kind of pink slip treatment I had.

“They do love you on TV. The Messenger would be idiots to get rid of you now.”

She smiled, and shimmied out of her tight black pencil skirt, revealing a plain but nevertheless sexy white thong underneath. I had to really curb my instincts to just grab hold of her and take her right there on the bed.

“So are you going to be giving me any clues about tonight?” I said.

“Maybe,” she grinned.

To be honest, I’d been slipping a little on the Game front. Working so hard to get my freelance career up and running, I’d failed to learn about this date of hers. It was kind of nice she felt able to be so open about it, getting all dolled up in front of me.

For now, I’d just have to play catch-up if she allowed it.

“Somebody from work?”

“Nope.”

“But somebody you know, you knew before. Not a stranger.”

“Not a stranger.”

“An ex?”

She shook her head. “Okay, that’s enough clues for now.”

Hmm. Somebody she knew, but not someone from work, and not an ex. I’m assuming she wasn’t going to date one of our friends... someone from her gym?

Jesus. The thought that some buff guy from the gym might be the next man to enjoy her... It almost made me boil inside — in a good way, I guess.

I think Izzie noticed me wrestling with my feelings as I watched her strip down to her underwear. She said, “And what are you going to be doing while I’m out tonight?”

I shrugged. “I don’t know. I’ll probably just chill. You think you might come back here, after?”

She looked concerned. I guess she wasn’t used to getting ready for a date in front of me, either. “I don’t know. I don’t know what Marie’s gonna want to do...:

“Marie?”

Izzie’s eyes flashed with mischief. But then she laughed. “I’m not dating Marie,” she said wryly. Off came her bra, and I could see she enjoyed teasing me.

“Would have been a thought,” I grinned, a trifle sheepish at even considering Izzie dating her long-time best friend.

“It’s a double date,” she said. “Because Marie’s been far too interested in what’s going on with me to tend to her own love life.”

“You’re forcing her into it, huh?”

“But you should get out of the house, too, tonight. Enjoy yourself.”

“I’m okay with not doing much,” I said, watching her closely as she slipped off her panties.

My God, she was beautiful. It never ceased to amaze me.

“You could hang out with your buddies,” she said. “I don’t know... go to the movies.”

“While you’re out with another guy?” I laughed. “There’s no way I could do something meaningful while that happens.”

She grinned, and turned to pad through into the en suite, and turn on the shower.

“I worry about you, that’s all,” she said.

“Then don’t.”

“You won’t feel bad, being all alone?”

“No. Really,” I said, leaning in the doorway of the bathroom. “I get to think about you being on a date. That whole thing is part of the buzz for me.”

She felt for the temperature of the water, then once satisfied, stepped under the flow of the water.

“Maybe Marie’s right,” she said, dribbling body wash all over her breasts — in a such a suggestive manner, I knew she wouldn’t do that if I wasn’t watching. “I should just get over the whole jealousy thing I have about you. Let you see other people, too.”

I felt a funny feeling in my stomach as she said that. I didn’t want another woman. Sure, it was hot to think of sleeping with someone different, but I was more interested in what was going on with Izzie. What would my date think if most of my mind was perpetually thinking about what was happening with my wife?

“It’s never been about that, I’ve told you before,” I said, reflecting her smile as she rubbed the white creamy body wash over her breasts, her stomach, and over the rest of her body.

“I know, I know...” she said. “But don’t you think it’s strange? Me doing all this... and you’re stuck at home...”

“Just because I have a thing about you being with other guys, doesn’t mean it has to work the other way.”

“You know, Marie’s always liked you,” Izzie said, her hands swooping down to wash the soap from between her legs. Touching herself under the flow of the water, I guess to further tease me, but also perhaps as she

thought about her upcoming date. “Perhaps it wouldn’t so bad if you... you know... dated someone like Marie. Someone I trust.”

“No.”

“Just for fun, nothing heavy.”

“Marie’s great,” I said, “but I’m happy with just you, honey. I swear.”

I don’t know, it was interesting to me that Izzie was having these thoughts of trying to pair me off with someone else. Perhaps if she’d voiced such thoughts early on, it might have made me feel insecure, paranoid. I might have imagined she wanted me to see other women so that she would feel better about leaving me. I guess this was something a wife would be nervous about if her husband suddenly revealed his desire to share her. But right now, I knew nothing was going to shake the foundations of our marriage, even Izzie getting curious about how it would feel if I was dating, too.

“I don’t know...” she grinned and gave a coquettish shrug. “Maybe it would be fun some day. God knows Marie could do with a good lay...”

I laughed at that. Marie hadn’t had much luck in the dating world since she’d split from her husband. She was just a little too obsessed with Izzie’s dating life, though, to spend enough attention to her own.

“Who’s she seeing at the moment?” I asked, trying to divert Izzie from thoughts of setting me up with her friend. “Who’s she taking out tonight?”

“I don’t know,” Izzie said. “Some guy from CNN. I think the Hudsons set her up with him.”

I watched her wash her hair, and rinse off her body, and it seemed to me she was dancing for me, somehow. Performing. She was so sexy. Then she was drying off with a towel, stepping up to kiss me, to let me touch her damp breasts.

As much as I loved her new confidence after playing the Game, I think she loved how I made my obsession with her more clear through the playing of it. She was my goddess, and now more than ever she knew full well.

I lay back on the bed and watched as she dried her hair with her hairdryer, but she pointed in the direction of the chest of drawers, and the bottom drawer therein.

“Why don’t you pick something out for me to wear?” she grinned.

I didn’t need much persuading. In the drawer were a few new little bags from a certain well-known lingerie store. White lace... pink satin... red and black lace... they were all sizzling hot. I chose red and black,

and it made me feel slightly giddy to be selecting the underwear for another guy to peel off my wife, I can tell you.

Izzie's nipples were rock-hard as I handed her the lingerie I'd chosen. Was it as arousing for her, for me to help her get ready for a date with another man? It seemed so.

She pulled on the suspender belt first. There was no practical need for such an item — and it was hot because there was no other reason for her to wear it, except for seducing someone.

"You going to go home with him tonight?" I asked her. "Whoever he is?"

I was trembling a little, once again. It was fun to talk with her about her date, though. I think the Game downplayed that particular joy.

"I don't know, maybe," she said, putting on a matching red and black lace bra. "Maybe I'll bring him here."

"Just give me fair warning," I smiled.

"Oh, you don't need to worry about that," she grinned, and stepped into the tiniest pair of matching panties. Virtually a g-string, I'd say.

"He knows you're married?" I asked.

She nodded. "I told him you were out tonight."

"He likes married women?"

Izzie laughed, and sat on the bottom of the bed to put on her stockings. "I'm sure he does. No-strings sex, huh?"

It took some will power to keep my hands off my wife, dressed like that. Especially as she now stood and had me help her attach her stockings to her suspender belt.

My God. She was sex personified. Infidelity personified.

Before she could pick out a dress, however, her phone started buzzing on the top of the chest of drawers. Izzie answered it, and almost immediately her face dropped.

"Oh," she said, disappointed.

Imagining it was her date bailing on the date, I felt disappointed, too.

Still on the phone, she looked up at me. "Marie's date was just called into the studio," she said.

"That's a shame," I said, though in fact I was feeling hopeful, that Izzie would go on her date anyway.

"He can't get someone else to do it?" Izzie was saying to Marie as she sifted through the wardrobe for a dress. "Well, that's not fair."

My wife looked at me and rolled her eyes about something Marie was saying. I was beginning to think that if she wasn't going out tonight after

all, that I might just get to take her in that sexy lingerie myself. So it was probably win-win for yours truly.

But Izzie's face lit up as an idea came to her.

She said to Marie, "We can still do it. Oscar can be your date instead."

I had to do a double-take on that one. Izzie just grinned like a devil, and it seemed that Marie was on board with her suggestion.

"Hey — hit the shower, buddy," Izzie told me, like I had no choice in the matter.

Now the tables were turned — Izzie came to stand in the doorway of the bathroom, watching me shower. She was wearing a gray dress that I'd never seen before. It wasn't the shortest dress she'd ever worn, and it didn't have the lowest neckline she'd ever worn, but the way it clung to her every curve, both revealing and flattering, made it just about take my breath away.

"So you're talking to me about how maybe you'd be curious about me dating Marie," I was saying to her as I scrubbed myself. "And then a little later, it turns out her CNN guy has flaked on her."

"Uh-huh," Izzie said. She wasn't just standing there watching me by now. She had make-up to apply.

"Tell me: was there ever an actual CNN guy?"

Izzie laughed. "I really didn't make that up," she said. "She really was going to bring that guy out tonight."

I sighed. "Well, I guess I don't mind sitting next to Marie while you flirt with... well, I suppose you have to tell me who your date is, now, right?"

"I guess so."

"Someone from your gym?"

She laughed, and I felt impressed with myself for guessing correctly. "Mason. He's my yoga instructor, actually."

I felt hot lead being poured into my stomach. Yoga guy. I'll admit to a hint of jealousy creeping over me there. The thought of her asking out the yoga instructor after so many weeks of her classes. They must have been flirting during class. After class, maybe.

Under the warm water, Izzie snapped me out of my drifting thoughts, and I realized I'd missed what she'd just been saying.

"Don't you like Marie?" she asked. "You've always thought she was cute, right?"

"I just don't think this is really what you want," I said. "Even if you're curious, I'm not sure I believe you feel the same way about me that I do about you."

Staring at herself in the mirror as she applied eyeliner, Izzie said, “Would you at least let me find out?”

I chuckled at that. “I think my point is,” I said, “if I sleep with someone else — even if it’s Marie — I can’t un-sleep with them. You know, if you find out you didn’t like it.”

Izzie groaned. “You guys are all alike, you know that?” she said. “I’m not saying you just take her aside when we get to the restaurant and fuck her in the bathroom.”

“I suppose not.”

She said, “Date her, for heaven’s sake. Chat with her, smile at her, flirt with her, and then maybe I’ll see how I feel about it.”

I shut off the water and stepped out of the shower. Izzie presented me with my towel, and kissed me gently on the cheek so that she wouldn’t mess up her lipstick. Then as I started to dry off my hair, I felt her hands close around my semi-erect cock.

“See, I knew you were interested in her,” she said.

“You’re holding it!” I protested. “Of course it’s going to get a little excited!”

Chapter Seventeen

I had mixed feelings going along with it all. I donned a nice shirt, some nice pants, a smartish dark gray jacket — as smart as a lowly hack can achieve, I suppose — and didn't look a patch on my glamorous wife.

We all rendezvoused at the restaurant the women had picked out — an Italian place in Silver Spring, as it happened, rather than somewhere downtown.

Marie was looking stunning in a blue dress that showed off her petite frame to perfection. I wouldn't say that she was intimidating, but the way she amped up her beauty and the fact that Izzie was there to encourage me to flirt with her, did put a certain pressure on me.

And Mason — well. I guess I'd had certain preconceptions of what a yoga guy would look like — serene, fit, handsome, perhaps, but also on the slender side, perhaps something of a hippy — but Mason blew them all out of the water.

"Hi, nice to meet you," he had a warm handshake, but a powerful one. Much like his physique.

"Nice to meet you."

I'd say the first thing he reminded me of was Izzie's date from the masked ball in Annapolis. A powerful, bright black guy with a dress sense that once again flagged up my slightly shabby appearance.

"You know Izzie from the paper?" he asked me.

"Oh... uh... yeah," I said, feeling a little stupid to have forgotten the fact that Mason would not know me as Izzie's husband, even if he did know Izzie was married. "But it's really Marie here... Izzie and Marie are friends from college."

"Right," he nodded.

"Oscar's just my date," Marie said, grabbing my arm and giving me a squeeze. Izzie gave her a gently dirty look, as though warning her not to give the game away to Mason, the poor innocent.

So here it was. I had to flirt with Marie all night, under the watchful eyes of my wife, while in the presence of a man who could honestly be described as Olympian. Or least, he could probably be described that

way if kickboxing had been an Olympic sport. Kickboxing, it appeared, was Mason's main gig. He taught yoga classes on the side, in particular because it seemed yoga classes paid the bills.

I don't know. I was slightly in awe of the man all night. Partly because of his physical presence, partly because he was actually quite a charming guy — I could see how he might find it easy to take his pick from some of the women who attended his yoga classes — and partly because this fine specimen was on course to sleep with my wife later that night.

I hadn't spent time with one of Izzie's dates before. It was a strange experience.

I enjoyed watching him flirting with Izzie — and how she flirted with him. For my wife, there was a lot of smiling, a lot of stroking of her hair, the occasional surreptitious touch about her cleavage as though attempting to point his eyes to the prize. Mason was a little more subtle, but the way he carried himself, almost puffed up with pride, as he talked about his kickboxing, and so on — and the way his eyes feasted over Izzie — made me feel a little buzz of excitement.

That my beautiful wife would have her way with him. That he would physically dominate her, overwhelming her pixyish form.

So, while I did have a good time with Marie — and she did look very attractive — it was difficult for me to play this date quite as I probably should have.

And then once our entrees were out of the way, the women excused themselves to pay a visit to the restroom, leaving me in the sole custody of my wife's new date.

Now I felt intimidated.

But Mason did have quite an ability to make me feel at ease. He gave me a warm smile and said, "I've never been on a double date before."

"Me neither," I said, offering him a smile in return. "I kind of thought it was something that went out in the seventies."

He laughed. "So what're you supposed to do on a double date?"

"Not sure."

"Is it like some kind of competition?"

"Might be. I never really thought about it."

"I guess I'm just competitively-minded," he said. "We're both on first dates, right?"

"Uh-huh," I said.

"So what, the winner is the one who scores first?"

"I guess so." I had visions of Mason making out with my wife after yoga class. In his little competition, he already had a head start — just as

he probably had a head start in his kickboxing matches, since he was so powerful a guy.

“You think you can beat me?” he cracked another smile, and it was hard to tell entirely whether he was serious or not.

“I doubt it,” I said, and my honesty only made him laugh more, though in a kind-hearted manner. “I think you’ve got a good chance with Izzie,” I told him. “From the way she looks at you.”

“You just have to be a little more forward with Marie.”

“They’re in there talking about us, aren’t they?” I asked him.

“Of course. That’s the way it works, isn’t it?”

“I’m not sure Marie is really looking for anything... you know... serious. Tonight, I mean,” I said, trying to downplay expectations.

“Hey, I’ll suggest a dance club I know — it’s not far from here. You’ll have her grinding up against you before you know it.”

Izzie and Marie returned from the bathroom giggling like schoolgirls, and I tried looking at Izzie to see if she might give anything away about what they had been saying to each other. I wasn’t getting any help from her, though.

She wasn’t at the point of warning me off from Marie, though.

Our next stop was a bar nearby, where a few more drinks helped warm up the conversation a little. It seemed quite clear that Mason was getting on with Izzie like a house on fire, but things between Marie and I were stuck in limbo land. I’m not sure — it was just awkward for me, because Marie was Izzie’s best friend, and I’d seen her in a certain light for as long as I’d known her. Like a little sister, almost, or perhaps a mischievous cousin.

After the bar, Mason made his suggestion to go to the dance club he knew, and the clincher was the fact the place was walkable from where we were.

On our way over there, I ended up walking with Izzie behind Marie and Mason.

“So how’re you doing?” I asked her.

“I am doing great,” she said. “But you are not really trying so hard with Marie, huh?”

I felt a little aggrieved — what was I supposed to do? Pull her into a kiss right there at the dinner table?

But then Izzie added, “You have to spend a little less time watching me, and a little more time picking up Marie’s signals, you know that?”

The way she said it, the way she looked, I could tell Izzie was quietly pleased that I had spent too much time watching her.

“I did warn you,” I said. “I’m in this because I want to see how much fun you get out of dating, not because I want to date someone else myself.”

Izzie smiled warmly, and linked her arm in mine affectionately. “But she’s giving you all these signals, sweetie!”

“She’s your BFF. You don’t think it would get a bit weird in future — you know, if this doesn’t work out? Even if it does work out...”

“You don’t know her the way I do,” Izzie said. “And anyway, she already knows enough about our weird dating arrangements. I don’t think she’d feel any weirder about me — or you.”

I wondered what Mason was saying to Marie all the way there. He wasn’t making any attempt to switch with me, to walk with Izzie. I guess he was pacing himself, not appearing too desperate to impress his date. Being sociable. All those things I had no idea about.

We got to the dance club, dropped our coats with the cloak room guy, and after one last drink, it was time to find some space on the dance floor. It was a busy place, a basement club with thumping dance music that had couples dancing close, but not slow like some ballroom ballad. It was sweaty in there. It almost felt as though people were making love on the dance floor, rather than just moving to the music.

Izzie grabbed Mason, and was soon matching the people around her. Marie ended up grabbing me. I felt a little sorry for her — she was getting the raw end of this double date.

Izzie and Mason were quite the sight. The way they moved together, the way they held each other, the way they touched. The grinding. It made my heart leap up and down, it made it difficult for me to breathe.

The word exciting hardly seemed to do the whole thing justice. This had been what I’d always wanted for Izzie — to have such an incredible experience, to make the most of her sexuality, her beauty. To embrace being alive.

I hate to admit it, but I almost forgot I was dancing with Marie. I just fell into a kind of autopilot.

Marie leaned up on tip-toes to say in my ear, “They’re good together, aren’t they?”

I nodded.

“How does it feel watching them?” she asked me.

“Pretty incredible,” I said, talking into her ear so she could hear me over the music.

“I can tell...” she smiled. “You seem a little absorbed by it.”

Marie turned her back to me, and began to dance like that, close to me, I thought so that she could see where I was looking more easily, she could see Izzie and Mason.

Then I realized she was pressing her behind against me — against my hard cock.

“Wow,” she said, leaning back into me, then pulled my head down so she could talk in my ear, “You really are into it, aren’t you? It really does get you going.”

I don’t think Marie was annoyed about it. It seemed to me she thought I had every right to be more interested in my wife.

“I’m sorry,” I said. Bellowed, more like it, the way that music was. “You probably would have had more fun with your guy from CNN.”

She only smiled. “I’m having lots of fun,” she said, and started pushing back against my hardness once again. “Hey, you want to try something?”

“Sure.”

As we danced, the pretty brunette reached back to grab my hands, bring them forward, and place them firmly onto her breasts.

“Make her jealous!” Marie said, beaming as she held my hands there on her soft, pleasantly round breasts.

For a moment, I wasn’t so sure. And then we saw Izzie glance our way, then react with clear surprise at what she saw. Well, wasn’t this what she’d wanted? She’d told me I hadn’t been picking up on Marie’s signals.

As my wife watched, I danced with Marie, pulling her against me, fondling her breasts as we moved. Marie leaned her head back against my shoulder as though in sexual ecstasy. Izzie nodded at me, attempting to show that she was impressed at me, but I caught something else in her expression. I don’t think she was entirely comfortable with me doing that with Marie.

Marie turned to me, leaned into my ear, and said, “Run your hand over my butt.”

I did as she asked, and we were grinding together. I was hard, and it wasn’t only from watching Izzie with Mason. I couldn’t quite see how Izzie reacted to that. She was all over her date, pushing up against him more than she had before. It suddenly made me feel as though I could get Izzie to be more and more forward with Mason by being more and more forward with Marie.

Marie turned again, pushing her back against me, her butt against my hard cock once again. My hands were on my breasts, and now I was

thrusting my cock against her, my fingers finding their way under her dress, into her bra.

Mason saw us, and gave me a wink.

Izzie looked less impressed, but then launched herself on her date, pulling him into a long, full-on kiss.

I was just awestruck. It was a strange thing — I'd seen my wife do all kinds of wicked things with a few different guys up to that point, but somehow watching her kissing Mason tweaked the jealousy more than anything I'd seen. I don't know if it was because she'd known him — and fantasized about him, flirted with him — for a while before taking the decision to actually date him. Or because out of all of her dates thus far, Mason seemed like the nicest guy, the guy I'd want my sweet wife to date if I was a neutral party wanting what was best for Izzie.

Mentally, I knew he wasn't a threat to our marriage, but watching them together on that dance floor, suddenly he seemed like the biggest threat to our marriage.

But the thing was, that feeling of being threatened, of danger, of jealousy — while it seemed to suck all the air out of me, while squeezing my heart so tight I was risking cardiac arrest, it also stoked up my arousal to similar proportions, almost as though my body was trying to counteract the negativity.

It was shocking, it was so entrancing. And as I watched, I completely lost track of myself — it was almost like an out-of-body experience.

I have no idea how long it lasted. A while. A long while. When the two of them finally came up for air, and the spell was broken sufficiently for me to realize where I was, what I was doing, I found Marie grinding up against me, writhing, moaning, with one of my hands cupping a breast under her dress, my thumb tucked inside her bra to stroke her hard nipple, while my other hand was lodged between her thighs — again, under her dress — stroking her through her decidedly wet panties.

I'd been watching my wife, and acting out my need to touch her by doing it with Marie.

Startled by such intimacy, I pulled my hands away from her, as the focus of my gaze now pulled herself back from Mason. Marie, though, whirled on her feet, and facing me, pulled my head down before crushing my lips with hers.

Wow.

Marie was a good kisser. I've always been a believer in chemistry — in my experience, you either have it or you don't. You might find some women attractive, desirable, interesting, funny, whatever. But that

doesn't mean you automatically have chemistry with her, and I'd dated women before Izzie with whom I'd shared no chemistry whatsoever, and even the pretty ones had meant nothing to me after a kiss where there was no spark, no buzz.

With Marie, I was a little surprised to find there was chemistry. Lots of it. It was kind of shocking, actually. For someone who had always been there, as Izzie's best friend, and always been so off-limits I'd viewed her almost as a relative instead of a friend, it was jaw-dropping.

Pressing against me, she was so sweet, so warm, so sexy. Her lips were so soft, her body so hot up against me, my hands slipping up under her dress to hold her pert behind as she gently stroked herself up against my hard cock.

I wasn't supposed to be attracted to her. I was supposed to be all about my wife, all about Izzie, all about watching my beloved misbehaving with other guys.

Both Marie and I looked at each other with wide eyes and open mouths, dumbstruck, when at last that kiss was over.

Did I want to take her home with me? Of course. And Izzie couldn't have been mad at me for feeling that way, because she had shoved the two of us together, and had even been put out earlier in the evening that I apparently hadn't been making the effort with Marie.

Now, though, as my gaze drifted inevitably across the dance floor to where my wife was standing with her new date, I saw that Izzie appeared to be somewhat horrified by what was going on. It was only for a moment or two, and she hid it well from Mason, but to me it was unmistakable.

Marie took a step back and mouthed the word "wow" at me as she continued to gaze at me in some kind of wonder.

Then without me even noticing her weaving her way through the other people on the dance floor, suddenly Izzie was right there, grasping her best friend by the hand before leading her away — presumably to the restroom.

I watched them go for a minute, stunned, before I felt a big hand pat me gently on the shoulder, and Mason was there, flicking his head toward the bar.

I followed his lead, and allowed him to buy the drinks — he was served almost immediately, I noticed, which kinda figured.

"Doing well, doing well," he said, clinking his chilled beer bottle against mine, that broad smile showing plenty of perfect white teeth.

"I suppose so," I said, or shouted to be heard over the music.

“Might even agree you were a touch ahead of me by now,” he said, reminding me of his competition theory concerning double dates.

“I wouldn’t go that far.”

He nodded, but could have been just moving his head to the music a little. “I’d say you’ve closed the deal, though,” he said.

“You think?”

I felt myself blush furiously, which seemed faintly ridiculous, but in the uneven light of the dance club, I don’t think anyone was going to notice. I was a little horrified, all of a sudden. I mean, sure, underneath there was that warm, creamy, sugary feeling I hadn’t really felt since starting to date Izzie — the sense that I was successful in getting the girl. But it also made me feel a strange loss of control, as though I was getting caught up in an undertow, a current that could drag me God knew where, and might even drown me if I wasn’t careful.

He said, “They’re in the restroom, and my date is telling your date to make sure she has protection before she takes you home.”

I felt a jolt of shock at that, and how confident he seemed to be in making his assessment of the situation.

I don’t know. Somehow the idea of successfully hooking up with Marie — or any other woman who wasn’t my wife, I would say — suddenly seemed disturbing. I could deal with the idea of Izzie going with other guys, but it felt to me that if I went with Marie, it would undermine the remaining support for my marriage. Somehow, I’d been keeping a firm handle on my relationship with Izzie, but if this whole thing transpired, perhaps I would be distracted, or Izzie would start to think differently about our relationship, and she would feel more comfortable giving more of herself to Mason.

Ultimately, it was a loss of control thing. Making out with Marie made me feel just too helpless in the face of the feelings it provoked in me.

The tension in me — as those feelings of doubt ran up against the powerful arousal I had after kissing and touching such a beautiful woman as Marie — was substantial.

“Trust me,” Mason said. “They’ll come back out, and she’s going to drag you right out of here.”

And then we saw the two women returning, threading their way through the packed dance club toward us. My heart was threatening to hammer its way out of my chest cavity.

Izzie glanced at me as they approached, and for the first time in a long time, I really couldn’t read her. What did she want from me? What was

she expecting? She almost seemed impressed at me, and yet at the same time there was more than a hint of disapproval in her eyes.

“Back to it, huh?” Mason smiled, heaving a sigh as though he were being called back to some tedious hard work.

I nodded and smiled as my wife took him by the hand and dragged him back to the dance floor leaving me with Marie. She looked like a cute, vulnerable bunny rabbit, somehow, not quite sure what was going on.

Was she about to ask me to take her home?

“Shall we?” I nodded toward the dance floor, attempting to delay, and distract from a decision I didn’t feel comfortable making because I wasn’t in receipt of all the facts.

Marie seemed a trifle relieved at my suggestion, too. We followed Izzie and Mason onto the dance floor, although as before, stood a little distance away from them as if concerned they might overhear our conversation.

This time, we weren’t grinding up against each other. Marie put her arms up over my shoulders, clasping her hands together behind my neck, and we moved as if the music were coming from a gentle string quartet rather than a pumping dance hall DJ.

“I wasn’t really expecting that,” she said, leaning up to my ear so I could hear her over the thumping beat.

“Me neither,” I agreed.

“I was just going to fool around with you a little, and... you know... let you watch Izzie getting it on with her date.”

“Uh-huh.”

She smiled sweetly as she gazed into my eyes, showing real desire, real affection. But also a strong dose of something that seemed like regret.

I didn’t really know what to say.

Marie said, “Izzie wants me to take you home with me.”

I felt my cock thicken, despite my reservations. Yet I also felt the hot stab of astonishment and consternation at what she said.

“She said that?” I asked.

Marie nodded. “She even told me to make sure I had protection.”

I was almost amused by how correct Mason had been in predicting what the women had been talking about in the restroom.

“Wow,” I said.

“Right?”

We swayed slowly together a moment or two, as though dancing, though our movement bore little relation to the music.

Then Marie said, “Do you want to get a drink and... I don’t know... go somewhere we can talk?”

I nodded, and led her off the dance floor. We grabbed a couple of drinks — bottle of Heineken for myself, rum and coke for her — and did as best we could to walk as far from the dance floor as we could. The music was still loud, but we could hear each other without jamming our lips in each others’ ears.

Marie said, “It’s not that I don’t want to...”

“Of course,” I nodded, and felt a surge of relief to hear Marie voicing reluctance.

“I mean, seriously. I don’t think I’ve wanted anyone more...” she blurted out before suddenly regretting sharing too much information. I smiled back at her, reassuring her that I didn’t think she’d just humiliated herself. “...But Izzie seems kinda torn up inside about it all.”

“I get that feeling,” I said.

“I think part of her is like this hardcore journalist, she just wants to find out firsthand how it would really be, how it would feel for you to do what she’s been doing. But part of her is a wife who loves her husband and even after everything that’s happened... just isn’t comfortable giving him up to anybody.”

“Nobody asked her to,” I said. “This has never been about an open relationship.”

“No, I get that. But it’s just curiosity on her part, right?”

I nodded. I was feeling a little more relaxed now, a weight had been lifted from my shoulders.

Marie said, “I could go home with you right now, I could take you into my bedroom and tear off all your clothes. And... well... I seriously want to...”

“Okay...”

“I mean, with my track record. I feel like I deserve time with a guy like you, even if it’s only one night.” She smiled, and I knew she didn’t really mean we should go back to her place. She went on, “And Izzie couldn’t be mad at me — at either of us. I mean, Jesus, she told me to make sure you wear a condom when we... well, you know.”

“Maybe she’s a little... misguided... because you’re her best friend,” I suggested.

Marie nodded. “We were close in college. Okay, sometimes we even dated the same guy, and it wasn’t such a big deal.”

I was a little surprised at that one, but now wasn't the time to comment on that. The impressions I was getting of how Izzie must have been in college were seriously hot. But I wonder if I'd been a guy in college at the time, dating her, it probably would have disturbed me knowing too much.

"I think maybe she feels bad that you've had such tough luck with guys," I suggested.

"You're probably right."

She smiled at me again, and I felt the puff of pride that she apparently liked me so much, and also her gratitude that I understood where she was coming from.

"God damn it, it's so unfair," she laughed.

"I'm sorry."

She nodded. "I'm going to have dirty dreams about you, Oscar MacDonald."

We hugged, and I breathed in the gentle sweetness of her perfume, and I couldn't help but feel the temptation to suggest we say to hell with it, and take Izzie at her word before heading back to Marie's place to fool around.

"I think I might head home," I said.

"You're sure?"

"I don't know... I think it might be for the best. If we get a little drunker... we dance a little more... well, maybe we'll change our minds."

"And that probably wouldn't be for the best," she nodded.

"Izzie might even have more time to persuade us to do it. But deep down, she's not comfortable with it really happening."

"No."

"I... I don't know... maybe I should just slip away before she can say anything," I said.

"Sure."

"You could tell them I'm not feeling so well any more."

"I will."

Chapter Eighteen

I was so full of regret in the back of the taxi on the way home. I could smell Marie's perfume on my clothes — and her arousal on my hand.

At least I had time and separation to think things through. During the journey back to Silver Spring, I returned to the conclusion that I'd come to the right decision — I didn't want Izzie to feel pressured to try lending me out to her friend, even if it was her own curiosity pressuring her. At least, not when she had big reservations as well.

I figured that in reality, I'd been expecting nothing to happen with Marie from the beginning, so I couldn't feel bad. Izzie might feel disappointed in one way, but I'm sure a part of her was happy I wasn't going through with it.

Then as I got closer and closer to our little neighborhood, I started to remember what, for me, was the main point of the evening — Izzie was still out there with Mason. Instead of dwelling on what had happened with Marie, I realized I ought to be devoting more of my attention to the potential for Izzie to sleep with her yoga-slash-kickboxing guy.

Were they going to go back to his place, or would she bring them here?

As soon as I got home, I tidied up the house a little more — it was already in a good shape — in the hope that Izzie and Mason might come here once their dancing was done. I remembered to conceal any family photographs that showed me, since Mason was of the opinion that I was just some random friend from the Messenger Izzie had tried to set up with her friend.

After that, I grabbed some soda and a bag of popcorn to watch a movie on Netflix. Camped out on the couch, I pulled out my phone to see if I could see where Izzie was, based on her iPhone-tracking app. I saw that I'd missed a text from her:

> *Hey sweetie, you really feeling bad? You want me to come home take care of you?*

I groaned to see that she'd sent the text almost immediately I'd left the club, though it was nice she was concerned. I hoped she hadn't been

anxious about me in the meantime. I responded to her:

>Feeling okay — just needed to get out of there. Not sure what to think about Marie, and I didn't want it to spoil anything you had going with Mason.

Izzie's reply didn't take long to come through.

>I'm sorry if you felt pressured to go with Marie. I just thought you guys really liked each other, so it might be fun to play around. You know, nothing serious ;-)

I texted her back:

>I do like Marie, I just worry about messing up a friendship, and what you would really think about it all.

Then Izzie fired back:

>I don't think it would mess anything up. She knows all our secrets anyway, if you two didn't hit it off, she wouldn't worry about it.

Then another text from her:

>Only, from what I can see, there's no way you two wouldn't hit it off :-P Ah well, maybe another time :-)

I was surprised she was still apparently pushing for it to happen between me and Marie. Both Marie and I had been fairly certain she'd been concealing some doubts, some insecurities about it happening, though. It hadn't just been me being paranoid.

After those messages, there was no way I was going to be able to concentrate on the movie I had been watching, popcorn or no popcorn. I can't even tell you now which movie it was. I was up on my feet, pacing, my thoughts turning to how Izzie must have looked, dancing with Mason. I imagined him doing as I had with Marie, her body pressed against him, his hands all over her, touching her breasts, perhaps even slipping under her dress to stroke her between the thighs.

Now, I regretted leaving early. It had been a stupid move. I could still have passed the time with Marie, danced with her, perhaps even teasing Izzie by touching her as I had done before. I had half a mind to call a cab and head on back down there. Maybe I could even simply conceal myself somewhere in the club, away from the three of them, watching what happened.

It was getting late, though. My feeling was that I'd probably get back to the dance club only to find they'd gone.

A little later, Izzie sent me a text stating:

>Mason wants to get out of here, but Marie wants to party some more. Not sure what we're going to do, but don't think we'll end up coming back there, sweetie.

Then she added:

>Anyway, you really should get some sleep xxx

Should I have been surprised that Marie was still out with them? I guess I'd assumed that when I'd gone home, Marie wouldn't have stuck around to interfere in Izzie's date with Mason. I actually felt a little guilty — perhaps I'd upset Marie by suggesting I needed to go home. Perhaps I'd misread her signals, and while she'd been playing Devil's Advocate in arguing that it wasn't a good idea for the two of us to do anything overly NC-17, she'd actually wanted me to argue the case for going home with her.

I won't deny that interpreting female signals was a difficult job, even when you'd known them for years.

I had to be happy that Izzie was intending on spending the night somewhere else, even if it meant I wasn't going to get to see anything of her night with Mason. It did mean she was anticipating a successful conclusion to her date. At least I'd get her back in the morning.

I texted her back:

>That's fine. Have fun, honey. Not sure I'll sleep much anyway, but can't wait to see you after your date ;-)

She texted me a quick 'love you', to which I replied in kind. Then there was nothing for a while.

It wasn't long before another text came in from Izzie:

>Okay, sweetie. We're taking Marie home. Time to start thinking of me and Mason being naughty ;-) xxxxxx

I was instantly hard.

How long was it going to take them to get to Marie's house, drop her off, and then head on to Mason's house? I had no idea where Mason even lived. I assumed somewhere locally, but what was to say he didn't commute to the gym where he taught Izzie's yoga class?

Was Izzie going to give me any more hints that night concerning what was happening between her and Mason? I really hoped so. Just then, I felt strangely distant from her, even if she was only in a cab heading from a club in Silver Spring to Marie's house in Brookland, five or six miles away at most.

She'd kept so much from me when she'd been with C, I had no guarantee I'd get anything else out of her until she was finished with Mason, until she was home with me. This might be the first time with Mason, but she'd seen enough guys by now that she might assume it was nothing new for me.

Whereas, I almost felt as nervous as I had before her first time. It didn't get old, this whole infidelity thing. This was the first time I knew her date well enough to feel intimidated by his dating my wife. It was totally different from what had come before.

I had to plan for the worst. I went upstairs to begin getting ready for bed. Sleep might be my best ally.

Then I received a text message. It was from Marie this time:

>Hey Oscar, hope you got home safely! Sorry it all got a little weird tonight xxx

I texted her back:

>Home safe, thanks. Really enjoyed the night, you have nothing to apologize for!

My guess, she was sitting in the back of the taxi while Mason and Izzie were making out, and she had nothing else to do but exchange text messages with me.

Marie: You should have stayed! We could still have had a little fun, even if you didn't take me home ;-)

Oscar: Maybe another time.

Marie: I'm going to hold you to that. You know Izzie wanted our cab to drop me off at your house?

Oscar: But it didn't, right? Because you know she has doubts, too.

Marie: I'll just wait until she has no more doubts :-P

Oscar: If it's what she wants, I'll look forward to it :-)

Marie: I'll be dreaming about you tonight. Might not be awake when I am, either ;-)

That made me laugh, made me certain Marie had had a few extra drinks since I'd left the club. Meanwhile I was sitting there on the bed feeling stone-cold sober. I hadn't had much to drink all night, to be honest. I'd been too on edge about Mason, and then about Marie, to really let go.

I thought our little conversation was over, but then Marie sent another text:

>Has Izzie sent you any clues yet?

I thought about Izzie's last message, when she'd told me to start thinking about her and Mason, as though I hadn't been already. I guess that was a clue.

Nevertheless, I texted back to Marie:

>Not really, no.

Well, she was supposed to be my inside source on the Izzie story. And telling Marie I was content with the hints Izzie had sent me so far was no

way to get her to help me discover more.

Marie replied:

>I'll get her to send you something. Or else maybe I'll send you a clue myself.

Now she was talking! I'd take anything I could get. If Marie could snap a picture with her phone showing Izzie with Mason, and send it to me, that would definitely be a start.

I waited ten minutes, and nothing came through from Marie or Izzie. Disappointed.

Then just as I was giving up hope, Marie sent me a text:

> Nobody bought Mr Thomas's house yet ;-)

I made the assumption she'd been having a text conversation with somebody else at the same time, and had sent the wrong message to me. But that winking emoji was a little too telling, a little too suggestive. Was this some kind of cryptic clue she was trying to deliver?

I looked at my watch, and guessed that about now, the taxi would be pulling up at Marie's house. It brought to mind the last time I'd been there, dropping Marie off after our dinner. Something clicked in my head.

The empty house across the street from Marie's house — she'd said it was Mr Thomas that was selling it. And the house in question had a “superb” view into Marie's own bedroom — she'd told me that clearly enough.

Like a flash, I was throwing on clothes — jeans and a sweatshirt went straight on over my PJs — and dashing down to the car. Before I left the house, however, I located the binoculars a great aunt had once bought us while under the impression we were interested in ornithology.

My sobriety was finally paying off: I could drive down to Marie's house. Izzie had stayed over at Marie's house often enough over the last few years. My guess concerning Marie's clue was that she was letting Izzie and Mason sleep in her bedroom for the night, so they wouldn't have to go all the way to wherever Mason lived. They could have come back to our place, of course, except that Izzie had suggested I get some sleep.

It took me 20 minutes to drive down there, with almost no traffic at that time of night.

I drove slowly down Marie's street, then switched off my headlamps as I turned in to the driveway of Mr Thomas's house. The driveway climbed up the slope, and curled around in front of the house. I could

park outside the building, and from my car enjoy the great view of Marie's house.

She'd been right to say it was a superb view. The light was on in Marie's bedroom, and I could see everything. It was a nice spacious room, and she had a very large bed. With the binoculars, it was as though I was right there by the glass, gazing in. I didn't even have to leave the warm confines of my battered old Celica. Okay, so I felt like a stalker — but hey, we were playing the Game again.

Mason was standing by the windows, still fully dressed, holding his phone as though texting someone. There was no sign of Izzie, but I got the feeling she was in the bathroom, getting ready to take things to the next stage with him.

I was shivering a little as I waited there, and I wasn't cold at all.

I checked my phone, made sure it was on silent. Marie hadn't sent any more texts, so I guess she was assuming I'd made sense of her clue. I suppose if I really hadn't got the gist of it, I would have complained to her.

Then, Izzie emerged from the en suite bathroom — and somewhere along the way she'd lost her dress. She looked incredible in that black-and-red lace lingerie.

The surprise came when Marie stepped out of the bathroom with her, holding her hand, having also lost her dress. She was wearing black lace underwear, not too different from Izzie's, other than its color, including stockings and suspenders.

Wow. Marie looked good. It only compounded the sense of regret I had after turning down the invitation to take her home.

The two sirens walked hand-in-hand over to Mason, and I think he received as big a surprise as I did as he turned to see them.

Chapter Nineteen

Izzie presented Marie to her yoga instructor as though she was a gift to him. They were all smiling, ear to ear. Marie laughed and at Izzie's beckoning, gave Mason a little twirl to show off her fine body.

I wish I knew what they were saying. Marie fiddled with her hair, slightly nervous, while Izzie stood there hand on hips, brazenly confident in her own body — helped by her time with all those other men, it appeared. Although I knew she had made out with Mason before, after yoga class. Probably multiple times.

For a while they were just standing there, flirtatiously, sure, but they could have been at a cocktail party. I guessed they were breaking the ice, the whole unexpected thing about inviting Marie to join them.

But was Mason really going to sleep with both of them? From the way they were dressed, from the way they acted, I had to assume he was.

Had Marie sent me that clue to make sure I was watching her as they did this?

Mason had his hand on Izzie's back, stroking her as she seemed to be trying to persuade Marie to do something. Marie was playing coy, but as Mason's hand slipped down to stroke Izzie between her thighs, the petite brunette leaned up to kiss his mouth.

More laughing and giggling after that kiss. Marie put her hand to Mason's crotch, cupping his equipment, and then she was slowly descending, crouching, her hands working to undo Mason's belt and his fly.

I sat up as the man's huge cock emerged in Marie's hands, as though it would give me a better view. No wonder the man had attracted interest from my wife in their yoga classes. He was very gifted.

Marie knelt down, and Izzie was brushing her hair back out of her face, helping her as she leaned in to take the man's hardness in her mouth. I would say she could only take half of it in her mouth, but it looked as though she was giving him sensational attention.

Three of us were watching her bob down on him, and the way Izzie was looking at her friend sucking on her date made me feel certain she

must have already done this with him herself. Had it gone that far after their yoga classes? Surely she would have given me better hints if it had.

Perhaps something had happened at the night club, or in the taxi to Marie's house.

I watched Mason calmly taking off his shirt, and step out of his pants, before laying down on Marie's bed. I'll bet he'd had threesomes before. I found that I envied him that, even if I didn't want to cheat on my wife myself. The way two such beautiful, graceful women paid him such attention. Lying down either side of him, both licking his long shaft, kissing its tip, taking it in turns to take that huge thing in their mouths.

After a while, Izzie was moving back, ushering her friend up onto Mason so that she straddled his hips. At some point she had lost her panties. I saw glimpses of Marie's pink pussy, as hairless as Izzie's, as was the trend these days, I supposed. Marie being a single girl now as well.

Izzie was sucking on Mason's cock as her friend pushed her bare behind toward it. Getting him ready for her.

It was Izzie who rolled the condom down Mason's shaft, and then Izzie who grasped hold of the man's cock and positioned it at her friend's entrance, so that Marie could ease back and take the man inside her.

The bliss was all over Marie's face as the man filled her, stretched her, his dark hands, his huge cock striking in their contrast with her pale flesh. Izzie watched closely as Marie rode him, and my wife was even stroking the base of the man's cock as he entered her best friend.

I was on fire as I watched them. Marie, who could have been mine that night, riding the powerful man like a wild cowgirl. Izzie shuffling around on her knees to Mason's head, before lifting a leg to climb over his face, pressing her sex down on his eager mouth while Marie continued to writhe on his pole.

The two gorgeous women were grinning wickedly at each other as they both rode the leviathan. I got the sense that they'd done this before, probably in college. They weren't intimate with each other, but they weren't squeamish about fucking this man in the presence of each other.

I watched them using him like some kind of a sex toy, giggling as they switched places, and Izzie squeezed his great beast inside her willing pussy. It was energetic, athletic sex, and watching them I felt sure I wouldn't have kept up. My fitness levels weren't exactly tip-top. The women were pink-cheeked with perspiration soon evident in their hair. Mason was soon glistening with sweat, particularly as he got up on his knees to enter my wife from behind, pounding into her doggy-style.

The women hugged as he fucked them in turn, though they weren't kissing each other. The expressions on Marie's and Izzie's faces as he shoved that enormous cock inside their tight pussies was priceless. The hardness of their nipples once their bras came off, the look of sheer ecstasy on their faces as he filled them, as he pistoned into them.

I had the strange feeling of being faintly jealous that he was fucking Marie, as well as his fucking of my wife herself. It doubled the intensity of watching them play, after an evening in which Izzie had been trying to set me up with her friend.

I watched him fucking Marie and then Izzie missionary-style, the way both women shuddered to formidable orgasms as he took them like that, kissing the mouth of the woman he wasn't penetrating.

I saw him return to give Marie another dose of his beast, to turn her orgasm multiple, and then he was pulling out of her, and Izzie was pulling off his condom, enveloping his bare cock with her mouth.

I saw the man pumping his come into my wife's mouth — so much of it, it seemed, that Izzie couldn't quite contain all of it, with some dribbling out of her mouth and down onto her breasts.

What an incredible sight I received through those binoculars. The usual conflicted emotions heightened because of what had gone on that evening with Marie. I didn't want to come myself as I sat there in the car. It wasn't necessarily just about the mess I would create — I worried about the come-down afterward. How I would feel once my orgasm was through, and Izzie and Marie remained lying in that bed with Mason.

I watched them lying with him, stroking him, kissing him as he softened, as he prepared for round two, and I tried to calm down. It wasn't easy. Watching Izzie gently rubbing his come into her breasts, her fingers dipping down to touch herself between the legs.

Maybe I'd have some kind of a stroke if they went at it again and I reacted as I had done the first time.

I noted how firmly Marie was wrapped against Mason's body, and then Izzie was pulling herself up from the bed, saying something to them before disappearing off to the bathroom.

I cooled down, wondered if it was probably time to head on back home. The three of them might wake in the night for more, or hook up again in the morning, but I was getting tired, it wasn't worth staying awake on the off chance I caught something, and sleeping in the car was going to kill my back. I watched Marie snuggling with Mason, and fully expected her to lean over to turn out the bedside lamp, and that would be that.

I was about to turn the key in the ignition, to fire up the engine for the ride home.

Then there was a knock on my window. God, it scared the bejesus out of me.

Naturally, my panicking paranoid brain jumped to the assumption that it was the cops, a quiet neighborhood patrol happening by, checking out the guy in the car parked in front of a house nobody lived in.

It was Izzie.

She walked around to open the passenger side door and climb in.

“Hey, what’re you doing here?”

“I could probably ask you the same question,” she was all smiles as she sat down. She was wearing her coat, but as she sat it flapped open and I could see she was naked underneath, aside from her stockings.

Door closed, she shivered, but appreciated the heat inside my car.

“Just thought I’d stroll on over, check on my sweetheart.”

She leaned over to kiss me, and it was such a thrill to have her there, so soon after what I’d just witnessed. I could smell him on her, I could smell sex. I kissed her pretty mouth, the lips that had stretched around Mason’s huge cock, it was so wrong it had me straight back up to full hardness.

Her hand was in my lap, quick in finding just how hard I was.

“Been enjoying the show, then?” she smiled, breathless as she broke away from our kiss.

“Uh-huh,” I said, sitting back as she fumbled with my fly. My hand found its way to her bare breast, feeling her soft skin, her stiff nipples. “I never thought you were going to bring Marie in on the action.”

Izzie grinned, and brushed her long auburn hair back behind her shoulder, out of her face. “You must have, you’re here, aren’t you? You figured out her clue.”

I shook my head. “Thought she was going to give you guys her bedroom. You know, sleep on the couch.”

She laughed, stroking my cock through my pants. “We used to do this all the time in college. Does that shock you?”

“I wouldn’t use the word ‘shock’,” I smiled, reaching for another kiss, reveling in her depravity, the intoxicating scent of sex about her.

She pulled my hardness out from my pants, her hands cool but warming up quickly as she held my full girth, slowly pumped.

I glanced to the side, down to Marie’s house. Even without the binoculars, I could see fairly clearly that things were warming up again between Mason and Marie. They were kissing, but she was now lying on

her back, and he had one hand between her thighs, warming her up for a little more fun.

“You’re going to miss out on the next round with your kick-boxer,” I warned my wife.

She smiled, and briefly ducked down to kiss the tip of my cock. Then she said, “I think I’ll let Marie handle this one.”

Izzie kissed my tip once again, licked it. She moaned, almost purring contentedly, then it was my turn to moan as I felt my hardness engulfed by the wet heat of her mouth. There wasn’t a lot of light in there to see what she was doing, since we were up the hill above the streetlight, the trees overhead blocking out the light from the moon. My gaze fell naturally to the side, toward the light of Marie’s house.

“What are they doing?” Izzie asked in between bobs down on my hardness.

“Probably making out like teenagers,” I said, trying to indicate that I hadn’t really been trying to watch, that my focus was on her.

But she handed me the binoculars. “I don’t want ‘probably’,” she said with a grin, then sank back down on my manhood.

I put the spy glasses to my eyes and peered across the street. Mason was now kneeling between Marie’s thighs, kissing his way down her stomach, pulling her legs wide apart.

“He’s... he’s going down on her...” I said.

“Wonderful...” Izzie said between mouthfuls. “She needs a man... like that...he enjoying it?”

“They both are.”

Marie was lying back clutching her breasts, her eyes closing, her mouth opening as the huge guy covered her sex with his mouth.

“Good...” Izzie said, breaking off to lick and kiss around the tip of my cock. “She’s missed out on that... I mean, I’ve always had you... to do that for me...”

“You sound as though you’re giving him to her,” I said.

She laughed. “I think that’s what this has all been about,” she said. “I tried to give her you, but that didn’t work out.”

“You had too many hang-ups,” I said. “I could see it, Marie could see it.”

“I did not.”

“You weren’t 100% sure you could handle seeing me with her.”

“Maybe not 100%... but Marie needs someone. She’s been too distracted by what we’re up to, to sort herself out.”

For a big guy with a huge cock that could make women sing by itself, Mason sure did seem to enjoy the taste between Marie's thighs. He was lapping at her, sucking on her pussy, a man possessed. She was writhing and panting for breath as though she'd just run a 200m sprint.

"You know, you guys would have been good together," Izzie said, pushing herself up.

I kissed her mouth, then offered her the binoculars so she could see Marie and Mason for herself.

"And if it had happened, and we had been really good together, you wouldn't have been blown apart by jealousy?" I asked her.

"I don't know if I have the right to be any more."

"Of course you do. Even I still get jealous."

"Seriously? I didn't think you did."

I shrugged. "It all just adds to the fun for me."

She laughed, "My God, my husband's so kinky."

She handed the binoculars back to me, then sank down on my cock once again. After a few moments enjoying her attention, I turned to see how Marie was getting on. She was doing almost the same to Mason as Izzie was to me. Except that Marie had a tougher time getting Mason in her mouth.

"He's a big guy," I said. "You're really just going to hand him over to someone else?"

"I'm sure... she won't mind... sharing... sometimes..."

"Right..." I said.

Leisurely licking my shaft, she said, "You know we did it a lot in college."

"Must have been some happy guys at college."

"I can share anything with her."

"Anything?"

Izzie grinned. "Anything. You know, some day it is going to happen."

"Uh-huh?"

"I want to see it. Even if I have to tie you down."

I laughed. "I thought you preferred to be the one tied down."

"I'm flexible."

I glanced over at the house. Mason pulled Marie up his body — he had the easy strength to grab her biceps and just haul her up there. They kissed, gazing into each others' eyes. They were a good match. Marie wiggled her butt, stroking his cock with her sex.

"What're they doing?" Izzie asked.

“She’s just about to... take him inside her...” If talking about sex with my wife had always been slightly awkward, I would have thought discussing someone else’s sex would be far worse. I guess we really were progressing on the communication.

“Inside her pussy?”

The word seemed strange in my wife’s mouth. Kinda hot, though.

“Uh-huh.”

“Say it,” Izzie suddenly demanded. “Say you’re watching a man slide his cock inside my best friend’s pussy.”

“I’m watching a man slide his cock inside your best friend’s pussy,” I said.

Izzie giggled. “See? We are getting better at talking about this stuff.”

“Right.”

Izzie pulled up, and seemed to watch me as I peered across at Mason rolling Marie over onto the bed — to slide back inside her as he spooned up against her. It was slow, affectionate, as opposed to the more rampant, physical sex he’d enjoyed when Izzie had been there as well.

Maybe the two of them really were right for more than just a one night stand.

Still slowly pumping me in her hands, Izzie took the binoculars from me. I reached inside her coat, swept my hand over her smooth, warm skin, tried to tuck my hand down between her thighs, though she wasn’t in a position to facilitate it.

Izzie said, “Let’s go home. I want you to fuck me, and we’ll break something if we do it in here.”

“You’re not going back in there?” I was a little surprised at her change of strategy.

“I have all I need here,” she said. “And I think those two need a little alone time...”

She sat back in the passenger seat, and now I was able to reach over and slide my hand down over her thigh, and up to find the warm wetness between her legs.

Izzie moaned as I touched her there, as I drew a finger along her slippery folds, then dipped it inside her.

Then she said, “What’re you waiting for? Drive. I need your big, hard cock inside me, right now.”

She added, “I can do that myself, on the way home.”

“Right,” I said, withdrawing my hand and briefly touching my fingers to my mouth to taste her tangy flavor.

And she did. It was seriously hot driving home as she sat there next to me touching herself, gently writhing, moaning, filling the car with the spicy aroma of her arousal. Nevertheless, I drove home as fast as I was able. Not much traffic on the roads, but one trucker we overtook did get himself quite a view as we passed him.

He gave us a long blast on his horn for that one, making Izzie burst into laughter.

Then we got home, and couldn't get inside and up to the bedroom fast enough; clothes off, Izzie throwing herself back on the mattress, yours truly pulling aside her legs to slide my hard cock straight inside her soaking pussy.

It was pretty intense, after the night we'd had. Izzie felt so good, and I could tell that she'd had a huge prick inside her shortly before me. He'd stretched her a little.

Then she was on top of me, riding me through to her ultimately conclusion, telling me things like,

“Oh God... I've been such a bad girl...”

And,

“I love your cock so much...”

And,

“I still can't believe... I get to fuck... two guys in one night...”

And I was just holding on until she came.

Part Three:
Power Play

Chapter Twenty

Izzie was invited to the Montessori Ball every year, and always liked to dress up smart to impress the dignitaries when she went.

It was mainly a fundraising event, dedicated to research and development of new approaches to education, held in the Hyatt in downtown Washington. Usually there were very few journalists invited, but Izzie had been education correspondent on the Messenger for a while before she'd been offered the chance to move into more political coverage, so she still received the standard gold envelope from the organizers each year.

I did accompany my beautiful wife to a couple of the evenings, but as a local industry hack, I'd no real connection to the subject area — and certainly no income to allow any kind of donations — so I'd felt out of sorts each time I'd attended. Even as a political reporter, Izzie had been in her element whirling around the dinner tables and the casino tables and even the dance floor to consort with the movers and shakers in the education sector.

In the last few years I'd found myself organizing an annual reunion of my college buddies in Philadelphia, to coincide with the date of the Ball.

This year, however, I came at the evening with a different mindset. We were playing the Game now. Izzie had a few different men interested in her, I knew. And this was an occasion where she was going to be dressing up and socializing without me, with the intention that I would be driving up to Philly for the night.

It would be a great opportunity for my wife to make the most of her single status, if she found any of her male admirers worthy.

I'd spent the day interviewing the new chief executive of a major pharmaceutical company over in Baltimore, and as far as Izzie was concerned, the plan was for me to simply drive on up to Philly from there.

Unknown to Izzie was the fact that a week previously, my college buddies and I had agreed to move our little annual soiree by a month, since three of us had conflicting commitments on the original date.

So once I was done in Baltimore, I quietly returned home to Silver Spring, hoping that I might find some signs that Izzie was going to do something naughty that night.

It was about 8pm as I pulled into our driveway behind my wife's VW — about half an hour after the Montessori Ball was due to start. Entering the house, I acted like I normally would when arriving home — in case she was, for some reason, still there. She wasn't, though. Everything was quiet, the lights all switched off.

"Izzie?"

I even called her name, just in case she was in the bathroom or somewhere not immediately obvious. But really, in a house that size, there weren't many places she could be.

I took off my jacket and headed upstairs, my pulse quickening even though I had no guarantee anything special was happening whatsoever. The mere potential for something to happen was exciting enough to get my heart rate going, it seemed.

I started my investigation upstairs in the en suite bathroom.

Everything was completely neat and tidy — that was my first impression. I suppose we were fairly tidy people, but normally when we were going out to some event, there would be clothes strewn around in the bedroom or the bathroom after we'd changed into our formalwear. This evening, there was none of that. In fact, even the various clutter from our day-to-day existence had been put away. Had Izzie tidied up in case she brought someone home with her?

My second impression was the lingering trace of perfume in the air — which gave me the picture of Izzie really preparing to dazzle the guys at the Ball.

In the bathroom, I went straight to the medical cabinet. Her brand new box of condoms was in there, and on first sight appeared unopened. My heart quivered. Maybe if she was intending on coming back here with someone, she didn't feel the need to take protection with her.

Then I looked closer. The clear plastic wrap around the box was gone. The box had been opened — she'd just closed it again after taking off the plastic and retrieving three condoms, by my count.

Now the blood was beginning to flow down toward my loins.

Back in the bedroom, I opened the bottom drawer in the chest opposite the end of the bed. The drawer wasn't even open by the time my eyes fell on the empty bag from which she had taken some of her special lingerie. From the receipt in the bag, I could tell she was wearing black lace — bra, panties, stockings and suspenders.

My cock thickened further. She wouldn't wear fancy underwear like that just to attend a ball, not unless she seriously intended some guy to see it. She'd probably wear a thong, something to keep the VPL at bay, and then probably hose as well. Stockings and suspenders were usually too much hassle for her to bother with.

Maybe now she was effectively a single girl, it seemed less of a hassle when weighed against the benefits of impressing someone who might be interested in her.

Closing the drawer, I glanced around the rest of the bedroom. Everything was spotless. She'd even put clean linen on the bed. I was beginning to pray she'd go through with the idea to bring someone back here tonight.

I pulled my iPhone out of my pocket and drew up the website that allowed me to check Izzie's messages. Were there any clues who she might be intending to meet at the Ball?

The text loaded up in the browser, and I saw a few recent messages:

C: You are looking lovely tonight.

Izzie: You're here? I can't see you anywhere.

C: Of course I'm here. But you know why I can't come over and say hello

Izzie: Maybe they'll be an opportunity for you to brush past me later ;-)

C: Sounds like an invitation. I do so hate to decline an invitation.

I looked at the time the messages were sent — just minutes previously. I'd keep my phone close by, the app on. Perhaps there would be a little more to- and fro- between Izzie and this "C" whoever that was.

For a few moments I just sat on the bed and stared at my iPhone, gazing at those messages. My mind was reeling a little — the question whirling round my head over and over: was this really happening? Was Izzie really looking to make a play tonight?

I was so buzzed, so completely aroused as I sat there, holding my phone in a shaking hand. And yet at the same time, I felt the eerie, unnerving sense that I was in danger, and I was losing control — as I might feel when leaning out over a high cliff, perhaps.

What if Izzie did go through with it tonight? Would I be able to handle it?

It seemed like a two-sided coin I was flipping. Maybe it would be the most exciting experience of my life. But maybe it would be the darkest day, full of despair. I had to cling to the bright side of the possibilities.

With a deep breath, I picked myself up from the bed. I had to get ready. I had to hope that Izzie would try to make the most of having an empty house all to herself that night.

*

About half an hour later, when the next message came through into Izzie's phone, I had moved my car around the block to conceal my presence at the house, and had finished setting up my surveillance system throughout the house. The tiny microphones were all easy enough to hide — the creativity came in secreting a number of small cameras around the house, most notably in the living room and the bedroom. I'd managed it, though, with some fairly clever hiding places.

I'd also set myself up in the basement, which might have been an unfinished basement, but offered me the best place to stow away while anything might happen in the rest of the house — if I didn't want to decamp to a nearby motel room, anyway.

It was warm enough, and with an old armchair that had never quite fit in with our interiors upstairs, and some suitable cushions, I could make myself comfortable with an iPad to monitor the cameras upstairs.

Sitting there, all I had to monitor for a while was that phone application. I perked up when another message came through from Izzie, and it was almost immediately replied by "C".

Izzie: Roquette says the schools bill will be shot down next week.

C: Don't count on it.

Izzie: You saying you have the votes?

I was impressed. It sounded to me as though this was somebody with an eye on the Hill — and perhaps more than an eye. Was it that Jacob guy? He was a Congressman's aide. But why would she abbreviate him as "C" in her phone? I didn't get the sense that it was Jacob.

C: I wouldn't show my face here tonight if I didn't.

Izzie: And that would make it an awfully drab affair.

C: They certainly wouldn't raise as much through these casino tables.

Izzie: Sounds like you need lady luck tonight.

C: Good idea. Come stand at my table. At the very least I'll get to enjoy you in that dress.

Izzie: I know somewhere else you could enjoy me in that dress ;-)

So, it couldn't just be a staffer from some Congressional committee or some Congressman's aide. "C" was wealthy enough to be playing the casino that night, and raising money for the cause.

I could imagine her going over to C's table in the casino area of the ballroom. Flirting with him, whoever he was. Enjoying his powerful presence. They wouldn't be talking about the schools bill, not out in the open. Looking back on her text conversation with him, something struck me about the under-stated nature of his communications. He didn't need to show off how powerful he was. He didn't need to tell her everything he knew — he just dropped hints.

He sounded big league.

Was Izzie flirting with a Congressman?

Jesus. I felt my insides go cold. I guess when she'd been fooling around with ex-boyfriends and other reporters, it hadn't seemed quite so serious — and I hadn't really felt threatened. Ex-boyfriends were exes for a reason. And why would she end our marriage just to start seeing another reporter?

But a Congressman. A rich, powerful Congressman. It wasn't that I didn't entirely trust Izzie — but a woman could change her whole lifestyle by dating, and perhaps ultimately marrying, someone like that.

Whether or not she was bringing "C" luck in the casino, the communications between them stopped. Monitoring the situation, I found the radio silence frustrating. But what could you do when they were just talking, out in real life, without the help of technology.

Later — much later, I was shaken awake by my phone.

Izzie.

My heart spun, my stomach filled with molten lead. Something major must have happened for her to interrupt her evening to actually call me.

"Hey, everything all right?" I said, doing my best to keep calm.

"Yes," she said, "fine."

Her voice was hushed, she was speaking to me to avoid anyone overhearing.

"You remember how this all started?" she said.

"Sure." Was this some kind of pop quiz, to check my memory was still ticking over? "Dinner at the Hudsons'."

Izzie said, "It was about whether we would sleep with a source if it meant getting a seriously good story out of it."

"Right," I said, and chuckled a little. "I remember. You were pretty straight-up about cheating on me for a scoop."

"Only..." she paused. "Well... what if it really happened?"

I found myself heaving a big sigh. “You know I’m okay about... well... with whoever you wanted to... see.”

Awkwardness tied my tongue in knots.

I tried to force through the barrier. “You know how the Game works,” I said. The Game aiding our communication, as it was designed to, I guess. “You’re free to see who you like.”

“But for a story,” she said. “Would you think less of me if this wasn’t just about the sex?”

My rock-hard cock didn’t think any less of her if this wasn’t just about the sex. My mind was reeling a little, though.

“I’d have concerns about your safety,” I said. “And any risks... you know... to your professional reputation.”

“If anyone found out, you mean?”

“Exactly.”

“But you wouldn’t hate me for sleeping with someone who’d make a good... well, a good source.”

“Of course not.”

I was probably overly influenced by my arousal, but hey. It was hot, the thought of my gorgeous wife sleeping with a powerful man who would feed her sensational tip-offs. Kind of hit on the part of me that obviously enjoyed sharing my wife, while also engaging with that part of me that had always been fascinated by the world of journalism, politics and Washington circles.

“Okay,” she said, warily. “I’m not sure anything will happen. Or if it does, it anything will happen tonight.”

“Whatever you need.”

“I’ll let you know.”

“Good luck.”

I was shaking a little as she rang off.

Two hours later, I received a text message:

>I might need you to leave the house. Or at least get completely out of sight.

Jesus. Jesus. Jesus.

I replied:

>No problem.

I wasn’t going to leave the house. I’d tidy it up a little — make sure there was no evidence to suggest Izzie’s husband was at home, and had been all night. But once that was all done, I was headed into the bedroom to test out my new surveillance system, which hadn’t been used in earnest so far.

Was Izzie really going to sleep with a Congressman? Who was this man who could become an invaluable source?

And my paranoia wanted to know: was he a threat to our marriage?

Chapter Twenty-One

I was disappointed to see from the camera in the porch that Izzie stepped out of a taxi alone. For a few moments after Izzie entered the house upstairs, I sat in that armchair in the basement and wondered how I was going to emerge from my hiding place with any form of dignity. Izzie would no doubt laugh at me for hoping so fervently that tonight would be the night.

But then a large black Lincoln Town Car pulled up in the street outside our house. Hardly the most subtle place for a large chaffer-driven vehicle to stop, but then our neighbors knew Izzie was a reporter, and perhaps might imagine she was interviewing someone important at her home.

I didn't particularly care if our neighbors looked out their windows and wondered what a big black limousine was doing in our street. Just now, a man stepped out of the vehicle who I recognized straight off.

Senator Carter Billingford.

Wow. Was this seriously "C"?

My initial reaction was one of surprise. Billingford was a rising star on Capitol Hill — but he was a Republican. Physically, I could see that Izzie might view him as quite a catch — but though we aimed to keep our own personal politics out of the stories we reported, both my wife and I were Democrats. Privately, Izzie had always scorned the GOP — was she really about to sleep with one of them?

My heart was pounding in my chest as I scrolled through the various camera views to see where Izzie was. I couldn't immediately locate her — then from the bedroom, I saw that she was in the bathroom, touching up her lipstick in the mirror.

Senator Billingford — "C" — walked up the little path across our front lawn, then up the few steps to the front door. Quietly, he glanced around at the neighborhood, to see if he was observed — but as far as I could tell from my little camera on the porch, no one was looking out their window at what was going on.

C didn't stop to ring the doorbell, or even knock. He simply turned the handle and stepped into our house. Izzie had left the door unlocked for

him. Inside, he took off his jacket and hung it up on the hatstand, then briefly scanned the living room, checking out his surroundings, before turning to climb the stairs.

He had a neutral expression on his face — concealing any thrill he might have for what he was there to do. He just mounted the stairs, and kept on going, up to our landing and through to our bedroom.

It seemed bizarre to me that this man, who chaired the Senate Committee on Health, Education, Labor & Pensions, was here in our modest abode. But he was here for Izzie, and Izzie had looked gorgeous all evening, I was certain.

I watched C open the bedroom door, and allow it to swing back slowly to reveal the room. For a moment it was empty. Then Izzie stepped forward from the unlit bathroom, and both of the men in this house caught our breaths.

She was wearing black stockings, suspenders, panties — and nothing else.

“I thought I was going to enjoy seeing you in that dress,” the Senator said.

“I can put it back on if you like,” she said calmly.

Izzie walked confidently toward him, her bare breasts no doubt stunning him where he stood, just as they stunned me via the camera I’d stowed in her jewelry box on the chest of drawers. God, now that she was giving herself to someone else, it seemed to me that she’d never seemed more attractive to me. She stood with the poise of a dancer, her pretty face perfectly made up, her hair tied up neatly in a ponytail. Her nipples were rock hard.

“Out of the dress is fine,” C said.

He sat on the bed, and Izzie stepped in front of him. She was carrying something — I couldn’t quite see what it was in the low light from the bedside tables.

I saw her straddle his lap, climbing onto him, putting whatever it was around his neck. A cord, perhaps. A rope, but black. She used it to pull his head gently to hers, so that she kiss him, lightly at first before becoming more passionate.

A shiver ran down my spine. My beautiful wife was sucking on the face of another man. An older man. A powerful man. C was on the young side for a Senator of his stature, but he was still around 50. His hair was dark for the most part, flecked with enough silver to give him gravitas in Washington circles. I hoped I looked that good when I reached 50.

Izzie stepped off his lap, then turned around to stand facing away from him. What was this? She put her arms behind her back, but just stood there at attention, waiting for C to make the next move.

The Senator stood. I saw he had the rope in his hands. What was going on?

He threaded the rope under her arms, behind her back, and then round her body, under her breasts, around them... it was expertly done, and when he was done it was as though he'd made a rudimentary bra for her out of rope — except that her arms were bound in place behind her back.

“Good,” he said quietly, his hands skirting over her breasts, those seriously-hard nipples, and down to her stomach.

She stood still, demure for him, but seeming happy enough as he stood behind her, and gently fondled her breasts while kissing her cheek.

Down in my basement lair, I was frozen still — startled at what Izzie was doing. She'd never mentioned the desire to try anything like this with me. I guess when you let another man into your marriage, you had to expect there might be new ideas introduced as well.

I watched C step around my bound wife as though he were inspecting her on some military parade. He touched her face, ran a finger over her lips — and she just let him, completely compliant.

“Beautiful,” he said calmly.

He put his hands on her shoulders, and she slowly sat down on the bed at his bidding.

After that, he unfastened his pants, and pulled them down along with his undershorts, to expose an impressively proportioned manhood. I saw surprise on Izzie's face at its sheer size, followed quickly by an expression of pure desire.

Her excitement seemed to translate to my own: I wasn't afraid just now, it seemed to me, I wasn't even really jealous. I was thrilled that my sweet wife was having this adventure, that she was having the kind of experience she'd thought would be closed off to her forever.

C stroked it a couple times, and it grew even harder if that was possible. He held it up to Izzie, stroking its tip over her chin and her cheeks. Then he left it hanging for her, and Izzie leaned forward to kiss around its base, and then down its immense shaft.

She had to position herself just right, not having the use of her hands — but then oh God, my wife was sucking on another man's cock.

She stretched her lips around it, and took it inside her mouth, bobbing her head to stroke him with the inside of her cheeks and her tongue,

before withdrawing to lick around the great head. C stroked her head gently as she sucked on him, as though she were merely his pet.

I watched her sucking on him from a few different angles. Far from horrifying me, it actually made me want to go out there and take her from him, and reclaim her for myself. But though my heart and my swollen cock craved her, my head kept me sat still in that chair, needing to see more.

At last, he reached between her legs to touch her sex, and by touching her there, urged her up onto her feet. Of course she did as he wanted, silently standing then turning around as he took her place sitting on the edge of the bed.

He removed her panties, and she allowed them to drop to the floor. I switched views to confirm what I thought was a mistake of the light: she had shaven her pussy fully for him. It was something she'd never done for me, though I'd never really asked her to. I liked a tidy patch of her red down over her mound, but the fact she'd removed it for the purposes of sex with some other man just packed a punch I couldn't deny in terms of her pure sexual attraction.

Izzie stood there in front of him, her arms bound, her body naked other than those black stockings that reached up to mid-thigh, and waited patiently as her Senator lover sat inspecting her. I watched him draw a condom from God-knew-where, tearing open the packet before placing the thing on the tip of his enormous pole before unfurling it.

I caught my breath as I saw him give her a nod, and have her climb onto him, straddling his thighs as he lay back against the mattress, and I watched from behind my wife as she pushed out her glorious behind, and perched so that the tip of his cock edged into her eager pussy.

I heard myself gasp, and my heart skipped a couple of beats as I saw her sink onto him. The air in our basement seemed starved of oxygen all of a sudden.

God. My Izzie had another man deep inside her.

He held her buttocks firmly in both hands and guided her as she rose and fell on that enormous column, finding it slightly awkward since she did not have her arms to balance her.

I couldn't help but pull my own manhood from my fly as I watched her fucking him, holding my shaft tightly as I saw her wetness on his shaft. She was doing it. I was elated to feel the reality meeting and surpassing the fantasy. I still wanted this, I still enjoyed it, I still found the buzz from Izzie's pleasure at the hands of another man.

It seemed tough going at first as she was stretched by his huge cock, though he took it slowly and she did seem to relish the way that thing felt as it filled her up completely.

The bugs I'd implanted were good enough that I could hear their deep breathing as she fucked him. As she leaned forward to press her breasts against his chest, I could see her wedding ring glint her finger on a hand bound behind her back.

Izzie was in total ecstasy, it was clear to see. The opportunity to fuck a man other than her husband, to take such a large cock inside her, to ride such a power man — it all appeared a touch overwhelming for her. I watched him hold her body tight against him, and plunge that great thing inside her sex, and it wasn't long before she was crying out, shuddering as the evening's first climax swept through her.

I had to stop myself from reacting to the sight of my wife coming hard like that, or else I would have failed to appreciate the rest of the evening.

C removed her binding to allow her to kneel on all fours on the bed, then he was sliding that great thing into her again from behind, his impressive shaft glistening with her juices as he squeezed it into her entrance. It was easier going this time, she was more accustomed to his size. With her hands free, she could reach between her legs to stroke her clit while he fucked her.

He certainly had stamina for a 50-year-old guy. Eventually, she turned at his prompting, to lie on her back on the bed before him, her stocking-clad legs parting to expose her sweet flower for him, her nipples still as hard as they were all evening. There was sweat on her brow now, and in her hair, her cheeks and her upper chest were flushed. But C was still hard as a rock as he reached around her thighs to pull her body to the edge of the bed, so he could slide that massive organ back inside her.

I found myself wondering if a certain little blue pill might be at work here.

I had to admit he was in great shape, though. He might have a touch of gray in the hair on his chest, but his frame showed defined muscles — he had to work out like crazy.

Izzie groaned as he pushed into her time after time, propping herself up on her elbows to watch him fucking her, to see this man who was not her husband taking her like this. I could see from her expression that it was still a strange thing for her, to be in such intimate embrace with a man who wasn't me. When we'd been married, she'd never expected this kind of thing to happen. Even when we'd started talking about the Game, she'd never believed this would actually ever happen.

But now it was happening — did she believe I was away in Baltimore? What if I had been in another city when this was happening?

If I didn't know about her infidelity, was it cheating? Yes. But the rules of our game only required her to leave sufficient clues to allow me to know what was going on — not necessarily to watch her.

I was here to watch, because I'd been monitoring her closely. She had to have known that I would be. Perhaps she did know I'd be watching this. I liked to think she did. At the same time, I guess if I came home and never picked up on the clues, the spirit of our game would require her to alert me in some other way.

I don't know. I knew I would just have to keep a close eye on her — that was the only guarantee I could enjoy this as much as she would.

The two of them were getting fairly sweaty by now, and from the sound of it Izzie was close to another orgasm. Yet more to be impressed about regarding the Senator — though I did believe that it wasn't merely his skills and stamina that were giving her such a good time. It was also the forbidden nature of this sex, the spark of adultery, and the status of the powerful man who was thrusting into her.

Grunting and groaning, C said, "I'm coming..."

And Izzie merely sighed and said, "Please... please... please..."

The Senator groaned, but seemed calmly in control of the situation. He withdrew from her, and I watched in horror and fascination as he slipped the condom off his cock. Then thanks to the quality of the camera I'd set up to look from the bedside table I caught the sight of his shaft throbbing as he shot streak after streak of his cream over her pussy, her stomach and her breasts — as though marking her as his territory.

Chapter Twenty-Two

They lay there for a while on their backs, up against the headboard and the pillows, the Senator lighting up a cigarette which he duly offered to Izzie. It surprised me that she accepted it, of course. She was a lifelong non-smoker, after all. But this was about making her new lover completely comfortable in her presence, sharing a new trust with him.

Still, she seemed to know how to handle a cigarette.

But then again, she seemed to know how to handle a man who had wanted to dominate her. That was a surprise, too. She'd even seemed to get off on that, though she'd never raised the point with me before.

"When are they sending the bill to the floor?" Izzie said as she exhaled a long plume of smoke.

The corners of my mouth curled up at the sheer businesslike efficiency of my sweet wife. She'd given the Congressman what he'd wanted. Now it was time for him to be forthcoming.

Senator Billingsford also smiled, though he knew the score.

"Tuesday week," he said calmly, taking the cigarette back before reaching over to tip the ash into the small pot plant sitting on my bedside table — a plant that actually held one of my hidden cameras.

"And they're going to water down Clause 4 to get the Republicans on board?"

"You didn't hear it from me. But we'll need help from the other side of the aisle to get this one through."

Izzie was soon sat there with her laptop, tapping away. I just sat in my armchair and stared for a while — just amazed at what she had just done. And how the two of them were sitting there like familiar lovers — like a couple — and unless I was mistaken, Izzie imagined me to be in Baltimore somewhere.

Was it cheating if she thought I was in another city when this happened?

Sure, I'd been clever, and I'd been able to watch. Perhaps that was all part of her plan. Was it cheating? I was allowing her to do it. I'd encouraged her. I didn't even demand to watch her do it — I'd just

wanted enough clues to know it was happening. Knowing she was sleeping with someone else was hot enough to placate my weird libido. I'd just won a little bonus experience for myself.

No, she was playing by the rules. I was happy enough. I just wanted to go up there and take her back right now.

I did manage to curb my powerful urge, however. I quietly left the dark confines of the basement, and leaving the two of them up there in bed, talking shop, I managed to get out of the house without making a sound. I knew where all the creaky floorboards were, I avoided them perfectly.

I left via the back entrance, however, in case the Senator's chauffeur saw me leaving from the front door. I could clamber over a few low fences to get through our neighbors' properties and wind my way around the other side of the block to collect my car.

Then I drove slowly around until I could park where I could just about see that big black Lincoln Town Car, so I'd know when the Senator left. There, I waited, hoping that the Senator would feel the need to leave as soon as possible.

My feeling was that the man would want to stay only so long as he could give Izzie what she wanted. He wouldn't want to stay the night — he'd want to be out of there so that there was the minimum chance of anyone discovering that his car was parked just outside our house.

It was only 15 minutes wait, and then I saw the chauffeur exit the vehicle to open the door for the Senator, who was now immaculately dressed once again. I watched the vehicle drive slowly away — past me, in fact, so that I had to scootch down in my chair to avoid detection — and leave the neighborhood.

After a short pause, I fired up my engine and pulled slowly away, to crawl around the corner then swing into our driveway.

I wasn't particularly quiet re-entering the house. Closing the front door behind me as normal, walking upstairs without bothering to dodge the creaky step. My wife would have warning of my approach, but not that much warning.

Up in the bedroom, I found her lying on the bed, touching herself. Perhaps she hadn't noticed my approach after all. I stood in the doorway a few moments, watching. She was so graceful, so exquisite in her movement. Since I'd been out of the house, she'd put her panties back on and a thin white chemise that showed off her breasts and her hard nipples to perfection despite covering her up. She was still wearing those black stockings, though.

I watched her caressing her breasts, squeezing them, pinching her nipples through the thin white material. I watched her hands slide down over her stomach to between her thighs, over her panties to coax her pussy through the black lace. I watched her body undulating as she responded to her own touches, I took in the silky sounds of her breathing as she got off to the memory of being unfaithful to me. Of fucking a US Senator in our marital bed.

I watched her, eyes closed, tear off her chemise, and then a little later peel off her panties to give her fingers free reign to glide over her smooth skin.

A floorboard creaked as I stepped into the room.

“That you, honey?” she sighed, seeming less than surprised that I might be there.

I said, “So you put your clothes back on for five, ten minutes — only to take them off again?”

She opened her eyes and grinned as I started to remove my own clothing. “I couldn’t be sure you weren’t in Baltimore,” she said. “I thought maybe if you were, you might like some clues to find in the morning — so you could tell I’d been a bad girl tonight.”

Leaving my boxer shorts on, bulge fairly prominent, I picked up one of her feet, stroking her leg through her stocking.

“I guess they’d be good clues,” I said. “But if I came back here in the morning, it would be a whole day before I saw you again.”

“Uh-huh?” she said, sighing as I started kissing my way up her leg, breathing in the strong scent of sex and female arousal as I went.

Jesus, I could smell that another man had been here. It was strange, a little disturbing, but at the same time so thrilling to me — the pure confirmation that my Izzie had played the Game, that she’d been naughty and sexy and enjoyed every minute of it.

“So what would you spend all day wanting to do to me after you found clues like that?” she said, as I pulled myself over her to kiss her cheek, her jaw, her neck, breathing in that strange smell that lingered on her skin — infidelity.

“Something like this,” I said, squeezing her breasts in my hands as I sucked on her lips, picturing in my mind how she’d knelt before another man and stretched these lips around his cock earlier that evening.

It didn’t freak me out to imagine I was sucking on her cheating mouth. I could taste the cigarette smoke on her breath, and though I normally disliked the smoking thing, this time it seemed to enhance the sense that

my Izzie had misbehaved, rebelled, done as she'd pleased, and that only drove my lust further.

I kissed my way down her soft neck, her warm breasts, and I could taste the salt from her perspiration, and perhaps something from their sexual connection.

I wouldn't ever want to be with a man, there was no attraction for me — but a woman sullied by a man did not put me off, it seemed. I took Izzie's stiff buds in my mouth one by one, and drew sweet sighs from her lips as her body gently writhed under me, her hips lifting in an attempt to urge me to pay more attention down there.

"You want me to shower?" she asked, craning her neck to watch me kissing my way down and around her stomach, which she'd wiped off with her chemise, yet left lingering hints of the man who'd fucked her not so long before.

"No," I said, trailing my lips all over her velvet skin, inhaling deep breaths saturated with her adultery.

"It doesn't put you off?"

"No."

"But you can... you can tell what happened?"

"Of course," I slipped down further, kissing my way down her abdomen, and the V-shape formed by the top of her legs, the scent of her infidelity strengthening as I went.

She wasn't stopping me. She was watching me now, amazed at what I was doing, at what I wanted from her. I slowly kissed my way down her mound, making myself familiar with the smoothness of her flesh down there, the complete lack of hair. Acquainting myself with the strange smell of sex that had nothing to do with me. Getting used to the idea that my wife's pussy had been stretched by another man's huge cock.

"You don't have to, you know," she said, as though worried I was feeling the pressure to impress her.

"I want to," I said, locking my arms around her thighs to pull her to the edge of the bed, so that I could kneel on the floor to better access those reddened, puffy lips of her well-used sex.

She lay back, closing her eyes, as I covered the apex of her pussy with my hot mouth, and as I pressed my tongue against her, tasting the strangeness of her unfaithful sex, she let out a long moan that seemed relieved as well as satiated.

She was wetter than I ever remembered, and as I lapped at her juices there was no end to it. Though her tangy flavor was mild and pleasant enough — but the real pleasure for me came in connecting with her like

that, after she'd been such a bad girl earlier, and in pleasing her with my mouth.

It felt wrong, stroking her slippery folds with my tongue, sucking gently on her lips — and yet the sense of the taboo only made it more of a thrill as she arched her back and emitted soft, breathy cries.

When she came, it was a slow, almost relaxed orgasm that appeared almost as though she was simply having a wet dream. After a few moments, she sat up on the edge of the bed, and I kissed her mouth, brushing her silky red hair back over her shoulders, then cradling her head as I kissed her.

“Stand up,” she whispered, breathless, as we finally parted.

I did as she asked, and the sight of my rock-solid cock straining against the thin material of my boxer shorts was bordering on the comical — but I was seriously hard for my unfaithful wife.

“My God,” she smirked, running her hands over my thick staff through my underwear, the stretching up to kiss my stomach, pressing her bare breasts against my hardness instead.

“It doesn't quite compare to your new friend, I guess,” I said, though I wasn't particularly worried that I didn't stack up against her Senatorial lover. It was actually nice that she got to experience someone different to me, someone bigger.

Fingers curling around my shaft through my underwear, she gave me a sudden sharp look. “Where were you when... it happened?”

I smiled. “Does it matter?” I said.

“You have a camera somewhere?” stroking me in her hands, she sounded quietly impressed. I was glad it didn't anger her. “So you saw the whole thing?”

“You left me enough clues to tell it was coming.”

She smiled warmly and kissed her way down my lower stomach to the edge of my boxer shorts. “I was kinda hoping you might get to watch,” she said.

She peeled down my boxer shorts, allowing my hard cock to spring free. Sure, it wasn't the largest she'd seen tonight, but I was confident I was above average — and the delight on her face came from the fact that her husband was so very obviously aroused at everything that had happened that night, and that this was the second cock she got to play with in one evening.

She was a bad girl.

Shaking her hair out of her way, she kissed my stomach again, letting my hardness press against the soft skin of her bare breasts and upper

chest, then slid her fingers down my shaft, gripping the base as she opened her mouth and gently licked the underside of my tip.

I couldn't help but groan as she took me into her hot, wet mouth, inch by inch, stroking me with those velvet lips, sucking on me, withdrawing to swirl her tongue around my glans. I held the back of her head gently, holding back her silky red hair, helping her rhythm as she bobbed down on my shaft, and she seemed to enjoy it like that.

Did Izzie want me to be like her new lover? Had she always wished I'd been more dominant in the bedroom? It wasn't really my nature — I was liberal to the core, in tune with feminism and equality, seeing male dominance of women as a thing to be railed against — and I'd always seen Izzie as being cut by the same jib.

But there could be no doubt she'd been quite taken by the forcefulness of her Senator.

I sighed as she gripped the base of my shaft tighter in her hand, and sucked on my cock more forcefully, sinking down as far as she could on my length. After a while, I had to stop her — cradling her head in my hands, pulling her back from me — but again, she seemed to like my control. She grinned mischievously, loving being the wanton harlot. I kissed her mouth, and it tickled my sense of the taboo that her mouth had taken two men that evening.

“Lie back,” I said, trying out a little light authority over her. She did as I asked.

I stepped out of my boxer shorts and knelt between her thighs on the bed, pushing up her legs to expose her glistening slit, a fresh wave of her wicked scent filling my nostrils before I leaned in and slid inside her. She was so wet, I glided straight in — but she was also stretched, it seemed to me. She'd accommodated a large cock just recently, and it made the experience a touch different from usual.

Kind of hot, that I could tell my beautiful wife had been freshly fucked by another. I concede I was a little envious that he had been able to stretch her so much, to take her to orgasm almost merely by being inside her, by filling her.

But as I squeezed my hips and stroked her pussy from the inside, lying over her to press my body to hers, it seemed that she was enjoying me for different reasons than her Senator: because I was her husband, because I had given her the gift of sexual liberation, because I was the second man she was fucking that night. Because I was quite obviously harder, and more vigorous tonight for the expressed reason that I had watched her with another man just before.

She moaned quietly as I thrust inside her, and pulled her legs up over my shoulders. Her scent, the scent of her previous liaison seemed intoxicating, almost overwhelming. It almost seemed to be a dream, that she'd done that, that I'd watched her — and yet now I was reclaiming her as my own, every clue pointed to the reality of the experience.

My wife had cheated on me under my own roof. And I loved it.

The thought motivated me, drove me on to pound into her, tasting her unfaithful mouth as I pushed into her, her legs there between our bodies, her calves locking around my neck. As I squeezed my hard cock inside her, the memory was so vibrant in my mind of another man's cock splitting her, penetrating her, making her squeal.

Adrenaline boosted my strength, allowing me to encircle her with my arms and lift her bodily from the bed. Now it was my turn to make her squeal as I pulled her up, turned and sat on the edge of the bed, somehow keeping my hardness inside her until she was sitting on my lap, bouncing on me.

"You cheated on me," I grunted, and for a flash I saw fear filling her brown eyes.

"I did," she said meekly, full of uncertainty. Worried I was changing my mind about it all.

I squeezed her in my arms, and bucked under her, slamming as best I could inside her. I kissed her pretty mouth, said, "I watched all of it. Every minute."

The uncertainty in her was thawing. She said, "You wanted me to cheat on you."

"I did."

"So was it everything you hoped it would be?"

"He tied you up," I said, not quite knowing what to say. "He controlled you."

"Uh-huh," she smiled, apparently reveling in my surprise at what had happened. "It's what he's like. It's what he's into."

I was sitting there still as I tried to get my head around what I really wanted to say to her, while she flexed her hips to continue moving on my hardness.

I said, "We never did that. You never... seemed to want to..."

She shrugged. "We never really talked about it."

"I... I guess I'm not just very good at talking about... that sort of thing."

Izzie froze a moment, looked me in the eye and gave me a sugary sweet smile of the warmest affection. "Me neither," she said. "But the

Senator... well, he's just a different kind of person from us."

She put her hands on my shoulders and urged me down to lie flat against the bed, so she could straddle my hips and ride me. It felt good, and as she rode me I felt the muscles in her pussy squeezing my shaft — something she'd never really done before.

"You wish it was like that between us?" I asked her. "Me tying you up, ordering you around?"

"Not particularly," she said, her breathing deepening as she accelerated her pace on me. She leaned down to me, brushed her hair out of her face behind her ear and kissed my mouth. "We have something different going," she explained. "And you're not really like that."

"You wish I was?"

I gripped her behind firmly in my hands, thrust into her more forcibly as though to show her I could dominate if that was what she really wanted.

She shook her head, "No, that's not your thing," she said. "Your thing's entirely different."

"My thing?"

She grinned, "You have a thing about me cheating on you."

The words seemed to burn through my chest. They were both hurtful and yet deeply thrilling. I felt there was probably something wrong with me, though I couldn't deny she was right.

"It's not really cheating if I know about it," I said.

But she shook her head. "Oh, it's cheating. If you don't play the Game right, you won't know about it."

Chapter Twenty-Three

Three days later, Izzie had a front-page exclusive about one of the front-runners in the race for the Republican nomination, and his previously unknown ties to the oil industry. The guy in question, former Georgia Governor Rory McLanahan, was well known as a climate change denier in Washington circles, but the manner in which the oil industry had channeled funding his way over the years was not well known at all.

Izzie's story sparked a shift in the news cycle, and by the end of the day the pundits were almost unanimous in their belief that McLanahan's campaign was hanging by a thread.

Sitting there on our couch, a copy of that morning's Messenger on the coffee table in front of me, and CNN in front of my on the flatscreen rolling constant coverage of the sudden decline of a Republican star, I had to hand it to Izzie — she hadn't been kidding when she'd suggested that offering her new source what he wanted might win her an important story.

A few things made me uncomfortable, though. The first thing was that her source, her new lover, "C", not exactly politically the kind of guy Izzie or I would support. Funnily enough, part of that whole deal came as a positive to me — Izzie had slept with a guy she had fundamental political differences with, and that reassured that part of me that was afraid of losing her now that I'd given her free rein to sleep with other men. There was no way she could fall in love with Billingford, went my theory.

Yet at the same time, as I spent the day monitoring the fall-out from Izzie's morning scoop, I was concerned that the arrangement between my wife and her secret lover had to give Billingford more than just the opportunity to sleep with the beautiful Izzie. I mean sure, any guy would probably want to sleep with her if she let them — but this was Washington. There was always some ulterior motive in Washington.

So what did "C" want from Izzie? Taking down a prominent member of the GOP was not something a Senator would do purely for sex. Even great sex. My assumption was that Billingford had his own desires about

who would win the Presidency, and would use Izzie to that end — and yet a whole day of research online produced no signs that he'd ever gone out and expressed support for any of the current line-up.

I looked into the guy's past, and he'd never been one to step forward and publicly back someone running for the top job.

I liked the idea of my wife sleeping with someone she wouldn't normally give the time of day to, personally at least, and the idea that he was giving her the kind of experienced she'd never have otherwise. But it irked me that in pursuing her adventure in adultery and exclusive reporting, Izzie might be doing political heavy lifting for any politicians, whichever ones Billingsford had aligned himself to, even secretly.

*

I had a busy day to take my mind off things, as the business world reacted to the latest employment figures and their ramifications for the economy as a whole. I had a couple of businesses to visit in Northern Virginia, partly for a color piece for Martin, my old boss at the Messenger.

Then on my way home, I receive a call from Marie.

"Hey Marie, how's tricks?"

"Oh, same old, same old. The Times is probably gonna lay off just as many staff as the Messenger, but hasn't happened yet."

"You never know," I laughed, trying to scratch around for some kind of optimism. "You've got a bigger digital presence over there."

"So I get to be shunted into digital? Huh."

I was driving through thick traffic on the I-95 at the time, so Marie on hands free was a welcome distraction. That is, until she got to her reason for calling.

"How's Mason?"

"Great. He's got me going to yoga class now, of course. Jesus. Never cared for lycra. So what's the latest with you and Izzie?"

I felt heat spreading through the back of my neck. The sensitive nature of Izzie's latest fling suddenly made me regret drawing Marie into things in the first place.

"Not much," I said, trying to sound relaxed, casual, but entirely failing to stem the sudden iciness that crept into our conversation.

“I know she’s with someone new now. Someone different. She won’t tell me anything, all of a sudden.”

“She doesn’t tell me everything either,” I said, which was true, but hardly likely to satisfy Marie’s curiosity.

God. Being a journalist myself, I hated having to conceal the truth from another journalist — but I had inside knowledge of how dangerous it could be to slip sensitive information to someone like Marie. I’d hope that if she did find out, she’d keep the secret to herself for the benefit of our friendship — but you could never guarantee anything. If Marie was facing the same kind of career oblivion as I was, with newspapers letting so many people go, she could feel forced to expose the story.

“But you’re supposed to find out, aren’t you? I mean, as I understand it, your little Game isn’t just about letting her sleep with whoever she wants — you have to be in on it, somehow.” She was sharp.

“She saw someone out in San Francisco,” I said — again, relying on what truth I could muster, to maintain the credibility of my speaking voice. “I didn’t get to be there, but I know she saw someone.”

“Sam Bradford,” she said.

“The quarterback?”

“No. Same name. Works for the Miami Herald. I think she knew him in college.”

“An ex-boyfriend?”

“No. Could’ve been, but no. They’ve always been on friendly terms.”

“What’s he like?”

I heard Marie breathe out long and slow through the phone. She said, “Nice enough. I guess he’s her type.”

“Her type?”

“Tall. Very big dick.”

I know, we’d talked about Izzie in college. I just liked it when Marie told me that my Izzie had a thing for those kind of guys. I don’t know. I guess it was strangely interesting to hear she liked guys with big dicks. That it was something that drove her, that got her wet. I guess I was taller than the average American male, and in the personal anatomy department I was doing okay — but it was just hot to think of her craving another type of guy.

“Isn’t that all women’s type?” I asked Marie. “If they can get them, I mean.”

“Not like Izzie,” Marie laughed.

“So why are you so interested in all this, in Izzie’s sex life?” I demanded, an edge in my voice all of a sudden.

It seemed to me almost that Marie was trying to play the Game. She was doing damn near as much as me to investigate Izzie's infidelity.

Marie said brightly, "Because she's living the dream, right? She gets all the perks of being married to a wonderful, reliable guy who would do anything to make sure she's happy — and she gets to date any other man she feels like dating."

I liked her flattery, I'll admit it got me back on side.

"I'm still reeling from a failed marriage, so I like to live vicariously sometimes," she said. "So tell me who she's with now."

"I can't do that."

"Anything. Just a hint. Lives in the DC area? Must do. In the business? Or is he more interesting than that..."

"Marie, I can't tell you. You'll have to get it from Izzie, if she wants you to know."

Marie sighed. "We have got to have a fairer deal than this, Oscar. I tell you what I know, you tell me what you know, right?"

I said, "I've got to go, Marie."

"Come on. She's out with him right now, isn't she?"

"Speak soon, Marie."

"Spoil sport."

*

I had to admit to being tempted to divulge a little of what was going on to Marie. She was one of Izzie's best friends, after all. She already knew a lot, she'd already done me quite a few favors. I nearly slept with her, for God's sake. I had to think she would never want to do anything to hurt my wife.

At the same time, Marie was a journalist. I couldn't ignore that.

I returned to an empty house. Was it late for Izzie to be out, at work, at the gym, wherever? Yes, I thought it was. Marie had suggested that Izzie was out with her new man tonight — which led me to believe that my wife may have let slip that she was, indeed, doing something with C, even if she didn't let Marie know who C was.

It made me suspicious enough to treat our empty house as a clue within our Game, anyway.

There was a slight hint of Izzie's perfume in the air — perfume that made me even unconsciously think of her going out for something

special. She'd been home recently, I was sure of it.

Upstairs, the bathroom light was on, the extractor fan humming quietly. That was all I needed to be sure that Izzie had showered recently, leaving the fan on to help clear the post-shower condensation. But I could also smell her shampoo in the air, I could see the damp patches where her wet feet had stood on the mat outside the shower, and there were still some water droplets on the glass door.

I felt a little cold — she hadn't given me any indications before that she was going out with someone tonight. C, or otherwise.

I guess I had clues here, now. I didn't feel entirely comfortable about it — but wasn't that the nature of our Game? We'd talked about the possibility of me missing her clues, of failing to realize when she was out dating someone. That was part and parcel of the Game.

The Game wasn't simply wife-sharing, after all. It straddled the boundaries of actual cheating. Flirted with the dark side.

And I have to admit, part of me did like straddling that boundary. In that moment, it seemed like I'd always wanted to know how it would feel to have my spouse cheat on me. The curiosity inside me that had once pushed me to become a journalist had railed against the cozy stability of my relationship with Izzie, the security of our marriage. It wanted to know how it would feel to be spurned, betrayed, cheated.

Izzie had been here, within the last hour, to shower and change before another date. It was consensual, because I had basically allowed her to date who she liked, when she liked. But I had only spotted her clues now, as the date was mostly likely already beginning.

Here in the laundry basket were the clothes she'd worn to work. Her plain-ordinary blue cotton panties were still damp with her arousal. It really couldn't have been long since she'd gone. I might even have driven past her taxi.

It made me feel giddy to see how wet she must have gotten on her way home, anticipating another evening with C.

She had put on some special lingerie, too, I could tell that much, though I couldn't tell what she might be wearing over it.

In some ways, Izzie had left me clues, as per the rules of our Game. But she hadn't really given me any warning to let me stop her from doing it, to let me support her or object to her liaison. To let me enjoy the doing, rather than just the aftermath.

So did I stay at home and wait for her? My heart was thumping fourteen-to-the-dozen. I craved her physically. I felt genuine fear that she had dropped everything to go out with C tonight because she might feel

stronger attraction to him than me, and that it would ultimately result in her rejecting me in favor of him.

Yet I did want her to be doing this, ultimately. To me, it was hot to have a straying wife, to have her operating independently almost like a single woman, although she would have to come back to me afterward.

I checked her messages, and the only thing she'd received that day from C was a text containing three numbers.

>32 1967 1930

What was that?

Izzie's "Find my iPhone" application wasn't on, so I couldn't just track her. Had she turned her relationship with C secret?

I sat and stared at that text message for a while. My belief was that this had to be some instruction to her about where and when to meet C. The last four digits could have been the time for her to arrive, I figured. The middle cluster of numbers couldn't have been a time.

I tried to watch TV. I tried to play video games. I tried to distract myself, but I was really beginning to worry. I really felt all over the place — that strange mix of fear and arousal really went into overdrive.

I took a shower, hoping it would relax me. I was so hard thinking about what she might be doing, though. I stood there under the flow of the water, and just from washing myself, I soon found myself mentally drifting off — and in no time I was coming in my hands.

I guess that did make me calm down. In the same way that guys who have just had sex feel a compulsion to just turn over and fall asleep in bed, I did relax after that shower. That was, until something clicked in my head about Izzie's text message. What if 32 1967 referred to an address? That was what was needed, wasn't it, apart from the time? It couldn't refer to a zip code in the DC area, I believed, but what if it was simply a street name and a house number? More specifically, 1967 was too large for a street number, but could be a house number. So house number 1967, on 32nd street?

I Googled it, and 32nd Street NW was in Georgetown. I could even see the elegant townhouse thanks to Google's Streetview. Was that where Senator Billingsford lived while he was in DC?

My theory was good enough for me. I put on some clothes and hurried down to my car.

It was pretty stupid. I don't know what I expected to find. It was late. I pulled up outside the address, and there was nothing I could see from there. Some lights were on, but I sure couldn't see anything through the windows. Was she fucking him in there? Something about that thought

did excite me. But the lack of evidence was frustrating. There wasn't even any sign of C's black limousine, but then I guess that sort of vehicle wasn't just parked outside private residences.

I tried checking Izzie's iPhone tracking application, and of course there was nothing.

I parked a while. What did I hope, that she would come running out the front door? She didn't know I was there. Perhaps she'd be with C all night. Was I even doing any good for Izzie's security if she didn't know that I was parked there outside?

I was about to text her to say I was there on 32nd Street if she needed me, or if she needed a ride home.

Then a police car crawled around the corner and slowly drove up the street toward me, stopping right by my vehicle. My God. The fear that shot through me.

Right next to mine, the driver's window slowly rolled down. It was a clear signal for me to do likewise. Jesus. My heart was thumping like a jackhammer.

Without bothering to remove his sunglasses, the cop peered at me.

Then he said, "Some reason that you're stopped here, sir?"

I was shaking a little. I never did react well to people in uniform. I stammered, "Uh... no... I just needed somewhere to stop for a while. Didn't think there were any parking restrictions just here."

The cop gave a slight nod. "This is not the place for your little stop, sir," he said.

"Of course," I said. It felt like I was betraying my kind, stabbing all journalists around the world in the back by crumpling in the face of this challenge from authority. There really weren't any signs around here to state that I could not park right here.

But I stammered, "I'll find somewhere else... better..."

"There's a lot down on Prospect," the man said. "Good restaurant, too."

"Great. Thanks so much for the recommendation."

"It's just a little too residential round here," he said as though it was some kind of explanation. "Folks get a little jumpy, they see someone lurking."

I drove away. I drove home. It had really freaked me out. Of course, it could have been simply that it was a wealthy neighborhood. Rich people could get the police to do as they wished. I wondered if police cars ever drifted around poor neighborhoods and worried themselves about where cars were parked. I doubted it.

At the same time, it felt to me that I'd been told to scram because a notable US Senator was there in that house nearby, sleeping with someone else's wife.

Chapter Twenty-Four

“Where were you?” I said as she came in, at last.

“You know where I was.”

She was wearing a light gray dress, fairly loose but for the way it held her breasts. It looked as though it could simply fall to the ground if she wasn’t careful, or be torn away from her body by a single finger.

“Georgetown. That where he lives?”

“It’s his pied à terre in the city,” she said. “One of them, anyway.”

“One of them,” I nodded. In truth, I felt a touch insecure the way she spoke of him. This man was wealthy beyond our dreams.

She smiled, and leaned against the door in such a way as to accentuate the shape of her breasts in that dress. “His secret one,” she said quietly, conspiratorially.

“He must have a lot of money if he can afford a secret hideaway like that one.”

“You saw it? You came by?” She seemed mildly surprised that I’d go to the trouble.

“You slept with him?” I asked her. My heart was thumping in my throat. I wanted her to tell me she’d only visited him, only interviewed him, or some kind of platonic meeting. I didn’t want to miss the sight of her when she actually slept with him.

But at the same time the hardness in my pants wanted her to tell me she’d been wicked, depraved, fucking him every which way but loose.

Yes, cheating on me, if you wanted to call it that.

She ran her hands gently over her body, over her exquisite chest, as though she needed to make sure I noticed. Then she clutched at the hem of her dress, pulling it up to reveal more of her creamy thighs, and the black of her lacy thong.

“You want to find out?” she said, dipping one hand provocatively beneath her underwear.

The sight of her like that tipped the balance of my conflicted feelings in favor of the arousal that so ached between my legs. She’d never been so sexy in my eyes. I wanted it, I wanted her to have slept with him.

I looked up at her, trying to feign calm serenity. As though I could wait to ravish her, I still wanted to finish reading the magazine article open on my lap.

“Is there another one of your clues in there?” I said drily.

She smiled like a siren, her hand still buried in her panties, moving slightly to stir her dangerous sex.

“Could be,” she said, giving me a come hither look I could not resist.

I stood, I went to her. I leaned into her, planting my hands above her head as I closed in for a kiss of her poised lips. As I drew against her I could see the hint of perspiration in her hair as it tumbled down over her shoulders, and I could hardly miss the earthy scent of sex under the fading remnants of her perfume.

She was a bad girl. She’d fucked him over and over.

I felt giddy as my lips touched hers, as I tasted the hint of expensive sherry on her wicked mouth, which perhaps disguised the fact that she’d had something large and masculine in her mouth earlier.

I felt her hand brush lightly over the bulging prominence in my pants, confirming how I was responding to her latest infidelity. My own hand skirted lightly down over the gorgeous swell of her breasts, to rest on her behind as I pulled her in for another kiss.

She was beaming as I kissed her, as I stroked her thigh, as I showed her that I wanted her as much as I ever had, if not more, despite what she’d done that night.

I wanted her to tell me all about it, to leave out no details of what had gone on in that expensive townhouse in Georgetown. But my inability to really talk about it kept me quiet, leaving my imagination to fill in the gaps.

As I kissed her I was picturing her on some lavish four poster bed, perhaps shackled to the headboard as another man engorged himself on her delicate form and penetrated her with his monster of a manhood. This was our Game: she felt awkward about telling me the details of her tryst, and I felt awkward asking.

My fingers did the talking, drifting down to slip the dress off her shoulders, allowing it to drop down to her waist to start the process of uncovering her clues.

Of course I smelled the sex on her, I smelled the hint of a man’s cologne as I kissed her. I tasted the salt of perspiration on the soft, warm skin of her neck as I descended, and between her glorious breasts. Slipping off her bra to reveal unbelievably stiff nipples, I could see faint

marks around her chest, suggesting that her binding had been tighter than the first time her new Master had taken her.

She closed her eyes and moaned as I drew her nipples into my hot mouth, then knelt in front of her to pull her dress the rest of the way down her stunning figure.

The scent of sex and female arousal was powerful as I kissed my way down to the waistband of her black thong, and then over the tops of her thighs. She stroked my shoulders, then reached down to grab my shirt, to pull it up and over my head. I lifted my arms to allow her to remove it, and the way she kissed me seemed to invite me to take this upstairs, right now.

But I knelt there still, wanting only to explore this goddess standing over me. My hands gently taking hold of her remaining underwear, slipping the soaking scrap of black lace and cotton down over her hips and thighs, exposing the incredible sight of her bare, hairless pussy.

She sighed as I moved in to kiss the place where she'd so recently kept a tidy patch of her red down. The place she'd been applying a razor since then, in order to further impress her new lover. Then as I moved down to press my mouth gently over her clit and the upper reaches of her slit, taking in her abundant wetness, I heard Izzie groan long and low, a sound that sent shivers down my whole body — because I knew she'd made that very same sound earlier, in the company of someone else.

I pressed the flat of my thumb against her soft folds, as I flicked the tip of my tongue around the wetness that lay on her flesh around her sex. Izzie pushed out her behind from the door to allow me full access, to lap at her and stroke her flushed, puffy flower, to taste and smell and feel the evidence of her wickedness.

They'd used condoms, then. I could tell that much.

Izzie sighed and moaned as I gorged on her, her body gently rocking and swaying. She was stroking my arm, lovingly, gazing down at me with adoring eyes as I licked her, seeming impressed at me, enthralled with me.

She wasn't going to come standing up like this, though. She urged me up, so she might crouch down herself, and drag down my pants. So she might hold my hard cock in her hands and marvel at my response to her informed adultery.

Watching her lick my shaft, caress it in her hands, then take me in her wonderful mouth put images into my head of her doing this for her new man. Stretching her lips around a larger cock.

But I wanted more from her. She squealed as I picked her up, carried her petite, elvish form over to our couch, and laid her on it exactly where I had watched the news coverage in the wake of the exclusive story she'd cheated on me to get.

She lay back and I knelt on the floor in front of her, parting her thighs to display her reddened petals, her pussy seeming even to my sight to be slightly stretched, still, from her evening being filled by "C".

"Does it feel different, after you've been with him?"

The words blurted from my mouth as I pushed the tip and the upper reaches of my cock inside her. Not something I'd meant to say.

She smiled at the unexpected vocalization of my thoughts.

"Maybe a little," she said, sounding a little unsure of herself.

She was seriously wet, and that only seemed to enhance the sense that I was the second man to enjoy her like this that night, and that the first man had been more of an alpha male. I felt the muscles in her vagina clutching at me, remembering how it had been after that first time. It felt good, but it also seemed that she was compensating for something.

"Because I'm not so large?" I asked her.

"You're plenty large," she insisted.

She was stroking her clit, and somehow the whole feeling of risk, that I might be out-competed by my rival for Izzie's sex, only spurred me on. The knowledge that she'd been taken by another, violated — and that she'd loved every minute — made my heart rate quicken further, adrenalin pumped into my blood. It made me thrust into her harder, deeper, my pace accelerating.

She looked up at me with a note of surprise in her eyes, but as her breathing deepened, her sighs became cries, and her hand fell away from her clit.

I felt a kind of superhuman strength, and somehow it seemed to affect my mood.

As I fucked her, harder and harder, I growled, "He's a Republican. You like fucking a Republican?"

She looked up at me and grinned, naughty, wicked siren that she was. "Uh-huh," she said.

"You like cheating on your husband with someone like that?"

"Oh yeah..." she cried, "he fucks me so good..."

I pulled up from her, stood, then yanked her up by the hand, to turn her around. She complied, kneeling on the edge of the couch, pushing her butt up to expose her rosy, used pussy. Onto my own knees on the floor in front of her, I briefly leaned in to kiss her cheek, and taste that

spectacular pussy of hers, then I stood, put a foot on the couch beside her, and leaned into her, entering her from behind.

“You can fuck him,” I said as I shoved forward, drawing a groan from her as I filled her again, “but I’m not gonna be happy if you start agreeing with him.”

She turned her head, not far enough to look into my eyes, but far enough for me to see her smile. “His views are offensive,” she said. “Thankfully his cock is, too.”

That little comment pressed some kind of button inside me. I grabbed her hips and rammed into her, the beast inside me taking hold, making her whimper under my forceful reclamation.

I lay over her, pushing her down against the couch, encircling her with my arms, kissing her neck, squeezing her breasts in my hands as I mated with her. I pounded her, and as I nuzzled into her neck, I caught another hint of her new lover’s scent, and it tipped me over the edge.

But as I slammed into her once, twice, three last times, my loins throbbing as the hot cream surged up to erupt deep inside her, Izzie was shuddering under me, yelping as she hit a powerful climax of her own.

After that, we both hit the shower together, though while we washed each other under the wonderful warm flow of the water, we were too exhausted for another round of much more.

“You didn’t come very much,” she said as she took care to wash my equipment.

“No?”

“It didn’t feel like much inside me.”

I felt a little shiver pass through me. “Maybe you’re too accustomed to your new man,” I said.

“No,” she said, then asked, “Did you... make yourself come? Earlier?”

I recalled the incident when I’d taken a shower to distract myself from my concerns. “Uh... yeah, actually. When I’d discovered you’d gone with him.”

“Shame,” she said. “I wanted to feel it inside me when I came home. It makes me feel close to you.”

“I’m sorry.”

She smiled, then kissed my lips. “I think we should have a new rule. For our Game.”

“And what rule would that be?”

“When I’m with someone else... or at least, when I’m not with you... you can’t come.”

“Okay...” I wasn’t sure about this rule.

“It’ll be fun,” she grinned. “See if you can handle it. Or not handle it, I suppose you might say. If I’m with someone else, I’ll be back with you in no time anyway.”

“If you’re away for three nights, that’s going to be difficult.”

“So take it as a challenge,” she said. “New rule: you can only come inside me.”

“And if I break the rule?”

She laughed. “If you break the rule, you get punished.”

“Very kinky.”

I wasn’t entirely sure how serious she was, but at the time I figured I could probably abide by her new rule.

Later, as we lay in bed together, I said, “I didn’t enjoy you being alone with him.” It wasn’t entirely the truth, I realized as soon as I’d said it. There had been part of the experience that had proven exciting. The thought that she was in that townhouse, that she was fucking someone else completely free from the restraint of having her husband watching.

The thought that she could be as wicked as she had ever wanted to with her new lover.

“I don’t know if I can avoid it,” she said after a pause. “If I want to keep him... interested.”

I sighed. “I guess so.”

She said, “That is part of the game, you know that?”

“I know.”

“Even if I bring him back here, I can’t be certain you’ve found my clues.”

“I suppose so.”

“You want me to stop it?” She looked at me. The image of her fucking the Senator after the Montessori Ball materialized in my mind.

“No,” I said. “But I do want to know where you are at all times from now on. I can understand why you might need to suddenly be with C — or whoever. But I need to know where you are. It’s not safe otherwise.”

“Okay.”

“Just keep your iPhone on, that’s all you need to do.”

“So you can track it?” she grinned.

“I just want you to be careful.”

“I am being careful,” she insisted. “You know how many condoms we got through tonight?”

Even ready for sleep, my cock thickened at that.

“He might be a good source,” I said, “but you also need to be careful you don’t start writing exactly what he wants you to write.”

Chapter Twenty-Five

Mid-March. C sent Izzie a text message some time before noon, saying:

>I need you, now. Bennett will pick you up from your building in 30 minutes.

I happened to have a slow hour or so that day, and as it often went if I was at a loss, waiting for interviewees to call back or documents to be sent through, I'd make a few little checks on Izzie — perhaps her email, her text messages, her lingerie drawer. I might daydream about finding something, about her going out to see the Senator or some other man.

On this occasion, I happened to check her text messages around 20 minutes after she'd received her latest from C. Even if I'd been watching as the text message had come in, however, I'd never have been able to drive in, lurk around the entrance to the Messenger building, and see where Bennett took her.

I felt a little frustrated until the appointed time came for Izzie to be picked up. Then she switched on her "Find My iPhone" tracking system.

I was off like a flash, fleeing to my car and pulling out of my driveway as though I had a bounty hunter on my tail. I relaxed as I saw that they were driving north-west, not quite toward me, but closer and closer. Potentially, I'd be able to head them off.

By the time they got to the Beltway, I actually had to back-track and wait for them near an exit. But then they didn't get onto the Beltway itself, they kept on driving north-west, out past a couple of large golf courses where the suburbs were chiseled out of the wilderness, and the houses were increasingly huge.

I managed to pick them up as they passed me, following them a healthy distance behind. Where the hell were they going? There were a few turns this way and that, as though Billingford's driver was trying to lose anyone who might be following. He wasn't going to lose me, though, unless Izzie's phone reception failed.

As we drove further and further away from civilization, I had to be more and more careful to avoid being spotted by Bennett. I hung back a fair way, relying on the tracking device to keep me on the trail of the

black Lincoln town car. I was getting a little concerned for Izzie's safety by this point. What was C doing dragging her out here?

I had to be even more careful as they drove slowly down an isolated dirt track in a forest area designated on the map as parkland, close to the River Potomac. I waited until their vehicle stopped, before venturing along the track myself. Watching carefully as I went, to ensure they didn't start moving again, I drove as close as I dared before finding a turn-off, and ultimately somewhere I could park the car where I hoped it wouldn't be found.

Then as I moved on foot toward them, I saw Izzie's iPhone on the move again — though this time, much more slowly, and away from the track. They were on foot. My heart was pounding — I was terrified that Izzie's phone would fail, that her battery would die, that her coverage would fizzle out. I might never find them.

What if Billingford was planning on quietly murdering my wife, to hide her body where nobody would ever find it? If she had done what he needed her to do with her reporting on his tip-offs, and now he had to cover up their affair.

At last, though, carefully I approached the spot where Izzie's tracker said she would be — and there she was. At first, she just seemed to be sitting on a fallen tree trunk in the middle of a small clearing, casually relaxing. Bennett was gone, and I had to be cautious since there was a possibility he was lurking in some bush nearby, watching to make sure no one found Izzie.

I found my own hiding place where I could wait and monitor what was going on. I didn't want to burst out there and demand that Izzie tell me what was going on. I wasn't certain one way or the other whether she was in danger, or playing one of Billingford's games.

She was wearing jeans and a tank top, fairly casual clothes for some kind of meet-up with her Senator lover. But then he'd only given her minutes of warning that she was being picked up. Her hair was loose, flowing down over her shoulders, shining in the spring sunshine.

It took me a few moments before I realized from the way she was sitting on that tree trunk, her hands held behind her back — she was tied up. It wasn't just her hands — her ankles were tied under the tree trunk. She seemed calm, certainly not frightened. The way her hard nipples pressed against the thin material of her top made me feel a hint of arousal.

I waited.

At last, someone approached from the direction of the car that had brought Izzie here. It wasn't long before I saw that it was none other than Billingford himself. The man was fairly casually dressed himself in a gray shirt and dark slacks. He approached from behind her, and lifted a leg to straddle the tree trunk behind her, though still standing.

"Isabella," he said, and though my pretty wife smiled, I also saw her body tense up. She was conflicted: excited by this man, but also wary of him.

He put his arm around her neck, his hand holding her under the chin, lifting her face to his. His other hand reached down and over her chest, to her stomach, pulling up her top to reveal bare breasts. She wasn't wearing a bra, though whether she had been this way at work that morning was uncertain.

I watched him lean into her, kissing her neck as both hands moved to cup and squeeze her pale breasts. She sighed at the feeling of his hands on her bare flesh, but also winced a few times at his rough treatment.

I wasn't comfortable with the thought of him hurting her — but I had to remember she was consenting to this relationship. If there were any hint of her not wanting this, I was ready to spring forward and out into the open. Billingford might be strong and fit, but he had almost two decades on me.

"What if someone sees?" I heard Izzie asking C.

But he merely replied, "We'd better hope they don't."

I watched him pawing at her, manhandling her, and I could tell from her expression and those rock-hard nipples that she was getting off on the vague sense that any hiker might happen upon them at any moment.

Billingford ultimately untied her, then helped her up from the tree trunk, though she was ordered to keep her hands on her head. Standing completely at his command, he slowly unfastened her belt, and pulled down her jeans — then after her jeans, her plain white panties. He stepped around her, enjoying the sight of her exposed out here, in a publicly accessible forest.

Then came her tank top, off over her head, and I saw as Billingford held her close, examining her, assessing her naked form, reveling in her beauty and his power over her.

"Come here," he said at last, and led her a short distance to a slight ridge, and two youngish trees spaced fairly close together.

Again, it took a moment or two before I saw the full picture. The restraints already tied around the tree trunks, which C now quietly began

to connect to Izzie's bare ankles, then her wrists, until she was bound there, spread-eagled and completely naked.

She didn't complain once.

Billingford walked away from her, and I could see the fear in her eyes that he might simply leave her out here, tied to these trees, so far from anyone who might hear her cries. But the man did not leave: he simply circled around, admiring the naked redhead as though she were some elegant sculpture on show in a museum.

After a long while, he returned to her, putting an arm around her, putting his face to hers, breathing her in, inhaling her anxiety.

He was carrying something black, something that had a handle and many short strands of suede or leather protruding from it. Some kind of flogging device, it seemed to me. And then he was gently swatting it against Izzie's bare body, and particularly her behind.

He wasn't striking her hard — again, I was poised to intervene if I started to genuinely fear for her safety — but each time the ends of the leather came in contact with her, she flinched purely from the unexpected impacts. The whipping seemed almost more psychological in effect than physical.

I watched him swirling it around her skin, patting her more than really hitting her. The ends flicking around her legs, around her stomach, curling under her behind and between her thighs, even touching her bare pussy. I saw her buttocks, her breasts shiver as the soft leather struck, I moved quietly around to get a better view, to see how her pale flesh became steadily pinker the more he used that thing.

She moaned and sighed and drew in her breath, but she didn't scream. And when the thing wasn't colliding with her flesh, she was smiling, she was gently panting, she was enjoying the sensations flowing through her shackled frame.

I watched him place one hand over her sex as he used the other to gently pat the leather over her legs. I saw him touching her, I saw him playing with her clit.

I saw the wetness trickling down her inner thigh.

I saw her gritting her teeth, her face and her upper chest blushing as her whole body shook almost uncontrollably, her frame held up only by her bonds as a powerful climax swept through her.

After that he took her down, and the whipping was over, though her bondage was not. He tied her to one of the young trees, her arms around it, her wrists tied together, and stroked her, his hands moving all over her body to feel out the warmth of her flesh.

She groaned as his hands reached between her thighs to stroke her wet pussy, and she pushed out her behind, craving something more than just his fingers.

C wasn't to be rushed, but after a while, I watched him unzip his fly, and withdraw that great monster without pulling down his pants. He stood behind her, and had to be stroking the end of his cock over her soaking pussy, coating it in her abundant wetness. Then he fished a condom from his pocket, unwrapped it and rolled it down his cock.

Then he was sliding slowly inside her from behind, and the rapture on Izzie's face appeared as though someone wandering through the desert had just been given a glass of cool water.

C held her hips and thrust into her, making her body rock, her breasts sway under her as she held the tree between her forearms.

She was panting and gasping as he fucked her, but in the still of the forest I could also hear the wet sounds of his cock inside her. Inside my wife.

Seeing her in such bliss did calm me down. I was reassured, though I wasn't a big fan of the whipping and the bondage. It would take a little time for it to sink in before the strangeness of it all — and the fact that the way this man was fucking my wife was like nothing we'd ever done together — came to be appealing.

It was ultimately a turn-on to see how wet she got from his treatment, to see how hard her nipples were, to hear the moans and sighs from her pleasure.

I watched him untie her from the tree, bind her wrists together again behind her back, and command her to kneel, to take his cock in her mouth. I watched her suck on him, I watched him come in her mouth, a little of his cream leaking out of her lips to dribble down her chin.

I watched from a careful distance as C left her clothes in the forest, and marched my naked wife, her wrists still bound behind her back, through the trees all the way to the parked limousine. From the safety of the undergrowth, I watched the chauffeur, Bennett, open the doors for Izzie and the Senator, then calmly drive away.

I waited until they were gone before I circled back to pick up Izzie's clothes and return to my own hidden vehicle, for the journey back home.

Chapter Twenty-Six

While I drove home, the Billingford limousine arrived back in downtown DC after a 45-minute drive, and I watched somewhat incredulous as Izzie's tracker showed the car pulling up outside the Washington Messenger building — dropping her off at work.

Had Billingford given her new clothes? I had hers with me — the strangely-erotic proof that what I'd just witnessed out in the Maryland wilderness had been real, not some day dream I'd had during a slow patch of the day.

If C was trying to be subtle, it was an odd way of going about things.

I waited a little while, then from the comfort of our living room couch, I phoned Izzie at her desk. She picked up after one ring.

"Hey, it's Izzie."

"Hey, honey," I said, trying to sound calm. "Everything okay?"

There was a brief but noticeable hesitation. "Everything's fine," she said, sounding as though she were halfway through a plate of sweet apple pie. "Why, you worried about me? That is so cute, sweetie."

I said, "It's just that I have those clothes you were wearing this morning. I just wanted to make sure... you know... you didn't need them."

I heard Izzie giggle, and despite the fact that she was in the middle of the newsroom, potentially dozens of co-workers around her, it sounded so dirty to me.

"You found them?" she asked, all innocent. "I wasn't sure where they got to."

"Yeah, I got them," I said, picking up the pair of white panties they'd left in the forest. They smelled strongly of her arousal. She must have been buzzed while she'd sat there on that tree, hands and feet tied, waiting for her lover to show up. "I wasn't sure if you needed them."

She said, "Oh, I had to change into something a little more formal to shoot the podcast this afternoon."

She must have gotten a new outfit from Billingford. My depraved mind pictured Bennett being ordered to go out and shop for female

clothes, to buy my wife a nice suit, blouse, underwear.

“Okay,” I said, “Well, I just thought I’d check. I’ll see you tonight?”

“Of course.”

“I hope you’re not too... sore...”

Another giggle. “I’ll be fine. See you tonight!”

*

When she came home she was wearing black skin-tight leggings, and when she removed her gray hoodie, she was wearing nothing but a sports bra, her shapely midriff on view for all to see.

It still took the breath away to see her like that.

“Guys at the office see you like that before you get to the gym?” I said, eyebrows raised.

“Jealous?” she grinned.

“Probably the complete opposite.”

She came and sat on my lap, slinging an arm around my neck. “You go for a drive today?”

“I might have done,” I replied.

She kissed me, then glanced at the pile of her clothes I’d dropped beside the couch. “You must have done if you found my clothes.”

I shrugged. “I heard the Maryland wilderness is beautiful this time of year.”

“Uh-huh,” she said, and moaned as I kissed her, my hand finding its way over one of her breasts. “And did it live up to expectations?”

She smelled fresh, making me sure she must have showered after her excursion into the woods, before her yoga class and perhaps before her appearance on one of the Washington Post’s podcasts that day.

“I saw a lot of beauty,” I said, and gave in to temptation to draw down the zip on the front of her sports bra, freeing her exquisite breasts. “Not so much from the wilderness itself.”

She moaned as I sucked one of her nipples into my mouth, my hand finding its way between her thighs to find the intense heat lurking beneath her thin leggings. “I was hoping you might be there,” she said.

“I didn’t think you’d go in for that kind of thing,” I said, slipping my hand underneath her leggings to cup her smooth, hairless mound, my fingers gently seeking out her sex, and the wetness just beginning to emerge.

“I didn’t either,” she said. “Just... kind of... went with it...”

She was pulling on the waistband of her leggings to aid my hand. I loved how quickly her tender folds became slippery with her moisture. She’d had an intense day of being turned on.

“It didn’t hurt?”

“No,” she said. “Just startled me a little, I guess.”

My fingers penetrated her, rubbing her, slick with her arousal, brushing up against her clit. She groaned as I thrust two digits inside her.

“But you liked it?”

“Uh-huh,” she said, brushing her hair out of her face before kissing my mouth. She was stroking my hardness through my pants as we kissed.

I wanted to know more, but we were hitting that roadblock, that barrier to talking about sex. I said, “It felt good, though?”

She shrugged. “I can’t really explain... I guess... it was his attention on me... and how exposed I was... and hoping you were watching...”

She stood, and with her leggings now pushed down to mid-thigh, she gave me a good look at her bare behind — and the color given to her by her mild flogging.

“You’re still all pink down here,” I said, gently stroking her cheeks.

“It’s faded a little, I think.”

“It’s like you’re blushing, you’re embarrassed.”

She turned, and knelt on the couch beside me, presenting her rear for me — apparently enjoying my examination.

“When I was back sitting at my desk, it felt all warm as I was sitting there — almost like sunburn,” she said as I held her around the waist with one hand, caressing her buttocks with the other.

I gave her a couple of playful swats with my hand, and she laughed. I said, “I’d feel so wrong doing anything like that. Hitting a girl.”

“It wasn’t really hitting,” she said, kissing me. My fingers found their way between her thighs, to the oily wetness of her sex.

“You don’t wear underwear under these things?” I said, tugging on her leggings.

“Sometimes I do, sometimes I don’t.”

“Today you didn’t, huh.”

“I was feeling a little frisky.”

“Some hot guys wandering around the gym, huh?”

She giggled. “I changed class, to leave Mason to Marie. Made sure the new class had a male instructor, of course.”

“You are a bad girl. Mason’s going to get jealous.”

“He’s all loved up with Marie.”

I ducked down to kiss around her glistening pussy, before running my tongue along her slick groove.

“Mmm...” she moaned. Then, “I guess... I’m less likely to wear underwear to the gym... on days I have my yoga class with the new guy.”

“Naughty girl,” I grinned, feeling my pulse quickening at the thought. “I bet he can tell, too.”

“Sometimes... I get very close to him on purpose,” she said, catching her breath as I forced my tongue inside her, lapping up her tangy nectar.

“Maybe you should try for him instead of your Senator friend,” I suggested, slipping a couple of fingers inside her.

“Maybe...”

I climbed up onto the couch and unfastened my fly to pulled down my pants, just enough to retrieve my hard cock. Izzie let out a cute little squeal. I reached forward and under her chin, gently urging her to turn her head to me. She twisted round, and I guided my cock to her mouth.

“What’s he called, your new guy in yoga?”

She smirked, and for a moment slipped my cock out of her mouth. “Ian,” she said quietly. “In class, sometimes I can see his cock tucked in his tight gym shorts.”

“You’re a naughty girl, staring at his cock in class.”

I groaned as she sucked it back in her mouth, and held her head gently in my hands as she bobbed down on it, guiding her motion — fucking her face.

As she sucked on me, I could reach down to touch her through her leggings, feeling the wetness seeping through. I imagined that sometimes during her yoga class, she would become damp for her instructor, and that he could easily tell as he was around her.

After a while she pulled away. “Won’t you fuck me, Mason?”

I leaned over, grabbed her leggings with my two hands and aided by the adrenalin flowing through my veins, tore the thin material, exposing her soaking flower. I let her bob down on my shaft a few more times before I moved her, grabbing her hips, positioning her so I could kneel between her thighs, and slip the tip of my hardness into her hot, wet pussy.

“I bet this is what he’s thinking about doing when he’s correcting your positions,” I said.

Izzie just turned her head, smiling, and cried out as I began to move inside her, deep and hard.

“Oh... fuck me... fuck me, Ian...”

It felt — and sounded — so wet as I fucked her. Whoever this Mason guy was, she was definitely into him. Her breasts jiggled as I thrust into her, and it became almost the object of my rhythm to make the move.

She moaned as I pounded her, and the hardness of her nipples as I took her made me believe she was imagining her yoga guy in place of me. I didn't have a problem with that. It felt good to stir her imagination, to make her more certain she needed a range of men to deal with the sexual fire inside her.

“Oh Ian...” she cried, “Oh yeah... fuck me, Ian...”

I turned her over, those destroyed leggings still mostly covering her behind, and pushed into her again, mounting her like a beast. She grinned, and I could tell it was easier for her to imagine Mason fucking her like this.

And like that, finally, I came, flooding her with my hot seed.

Chapter Twenty-Seven

She'd see him perhaps once a week, though not consistently so. There were times I knew nothing of her meetings with him until she came home, and the clues to her debauchery came after the fact. Nothing in the rules of the Game to stop her doing that — as long as she did give me the clues so I knew afterwards what had happened.

I had to accept that in all this, a full affair, I wasn't going to get to see them together each time he slept with her. Often she would be at Billingsford's secret townhouse. Sometimes he'd even take her to his mansion in Virginia. She'd go away to cover some Republican campaign event, and I'd know she would be spending the night with him.

Occasionally, I'd have to travel myself, as I fought to keep my own fledgling freelance career on track, and I'd return home to our little house in the Silver Spring suburbs to discover incontrovertible evidence that she'd entertained him at our home while I'd been away.

Strangely, I didn't mind if she went off without a word to do it. I liked exposing her misbehavior when she came back to me. If she came home late because she'd actually been working, it would be a disappointment. I'd wait for her hoping that when she returned, I might peel off her clothes and find her freshly fucked, perhaps her behind rosy red from his rough treatment, her hair slightly mussed, her cheeks flushed, her body reeking of sex, her pussy already wet before I went near it.

I reveled in her misbehavior, in her adventurous spirit, in her nymphomania.

And while she came home all chirpy and content, satisfied like I'd never known her before the Game had begun, she was also kicking ass in her work at the Messenger.

She came up with exclusive stories that affected the whole news cycle for days. She revealed little insights into developing policy, and the policymakers who were shaping it, that opened new doors to the political process, offering a transparency into the marking dealings of Capitol Hill that left Congress mulling over whether to launch an inquiry into where all the leaks were coming from.

C himself remained carefully above it all — he was never suspected, always keeping back from the fray unless forced to comment, in which case he would express cautious concern at what was going on, just like all the other Senators around him.

I'll admit, I was happy to take advantage of the explosive sex provoked by our Game, by Izzie's infidelity. I turned a blind eye to some of the bruises she came home with on occasion, the pinkness of her flesh. She consented to it, she didn't complain about it. She craved sex with me as soon as she came back to me.

And her job, in an era of dwindling fortunes at print newspapers across the country, was safe.

I glossed over the safety concerns of what we were doing.

Then one night in June, I saw a text sent to Izzie's phone offering her a lift home from her yoga class, and as C's black Lincoln town car pulled up in our driveway, from my safe hideaway in the basement, I watched the Senator escort my wife into my house, and up to the bedroom, and what I saw turned me completely against him.

*

Izzie was wearing a neon pink sports bra and black leggings, the kind of thing that drove me crazy, that I couldn't believe might be standard dress for her gym or her yoga class, but which I enjoyed imagining men unable to stop staring at her.

They went into our bedroom, C wearing his usual suit and tie, and they appeared to be talking business.

"This is bigger than anything I've ever given you," C was saying.

"You know you can trust me," Izzie replied, sitting on the edge of the bed.

"I do," he nodded, sitting next to her, putting an arm around her shoulders, his other hand reaching over to toy with the nearest strap of her sports bra.

"I don't give up my sources. Especially not..."

"When it might ruin your marriage?" the Senator grinned.

She looked gravely serious as he exposed most of one of her breasts, and it seemed to me quite an assumption she had led him into: that her husband knew nothing of her adultery, and that this was a key protection

for him as he pursued her and as he leaked her insightful details of the political process.

“I don’t sleep with my sources,” she said quietly. “Not ever. So you know...”

“I know,” C stroked her stiff nipple, apparently satisfied that he was safe with her.

“I’m yours,” she said. “You know that.”

I bristled at that, but at the same time the warm arousal bloomed inside me, my cock throbbing that I might have the opportunity to watch her fuck him once again.

C grabbed her breast in his hand, squeezing it a little more forcefully than I was expecting.

“Mine,” he said, and the way he said it sent a shiver down my spine.

He started pawing at both her breasts, pulling her into him, and his other hand was around her neck. Down came her sports bra as he held her, then he quickly unfastened it, and removed it completely.

I watched him produce a thin rope from one of his pockets, and bind it round and round her wrists, locking them firmly together.

“Mine,” he said, one hand gripping her hair, the other her face. “You’d better not forget that, Isabelle.”

He slapped her cheek — again, not hard, but it didn’t have to be to disturb me. Hard enough to be an audible slap, anyway. Hard enough to make her flinch.

“No, sir,” she said.

“Good,” he said, slapping her again. Her cheek was pink already.

He kissed her mouth, but holding her around the neck. She moaned quietly, apparently sexually, but I was on edge about whether to go up there, to step in, to end this once and for all.

I watched him manhandling her, squeezing and slapping her breasts, holding her hair in a less than gentlemanly manner, and I felt I had to accept that she wanted this, that she’d been with this man enough times now, that this probably wasn’t the first time he’d treated her this way — and she kept coming back for more. It was a turn-on to her.

If I ended things, it might ruin her career. That was how I thought at the time.

“I’m going to give you a few pointers in the coming days,” C said to her.

“Yes sir.”

He pulled around on the edge of the bed, holding her neck, turning her so that she went face down on the mattress, her butt raised where he

could spank it.

“You’re going to write it very carefully for your paper,” the Senator went on, holding her hair in one hand as he spanked her with the other.

“Yes, sir.”

He tore down her leggings, and she was actually wearing underwear on this occasion — a neon pink thong that appeared to match her sports bra, but didn’t offer a whole lot more coverage of her exposed ass than a g-string. Now his spanking cracked down on her bare skin, each impact leaving her behind pinker than before.

“It’s more important than ever before that we get this right,” he said, leaning down to kiss her pink flesh a couple of times, pulling on the back of her thong, forcing the material to split her pussy.

“Of course,” Izzie was quietly moaning at his treatment of her, biting on her lip as she tried to look back at what he was doing.

Kneeling on the floor, he patted her rear a couple more times, then peeled down her thong. I was torn between pure lust for her, pure arousal at how she was totally giving herself to this other man, and anxiety that whatever this was might go too far — or that it already was going too far.

He jammed his fingers inside her, his other hand prising apart her butt cheeks. It only made her moan louder.

“I can’t just leave this to trust,” he said, pulling himself up, pulling one foot up on the bed next to her so he could reach her hair, holding her by it again as his other hand manipulated her pussy.

“Mmm-hmm...” Izzie was panting, her whole body seeming pink to me, not just the areas he’d slapped.

“You’re going to submit your stories to me when they’re written — before you sent them to your editors.”

Her eyes closed, her mouth open, she cried out, “Oh fuck...” as he fingered her.

But then she opened her eyes, looked back at him, said, “If my editors change anything, there’s nothing I can do.”

C slapped her rear a few more times. “You’ll just have to make your copy so watertight they won’t change anything,” he said. “You’ll have to say any deviation might get the paper in trouble.”

He put the fingers that had been inside her into her mouth, and she licked off her juices obediently. My mind was reeling a little — I felt a total lack of control here. Was Izzie really into this kind of thing? Was she taking this treatment for fear that it would affect her career if she didn’t?

And yet I wanted to see him fuck her. My need to see him drive his huge cock into her eager pussy was overwhelming the alarm bells that were beginning to sound in my head.

C wrenched off her thong, then sat with her, parting her legs, his hand coming down to pat her pussy now — still, not really hard impacts, but it still seemed so wrong. He rubbed her there, and I couldn't deny how wet she obviously was from his touch, how much she was moaning from pleasure.

He lay beside her, holding her tight in one arm, as he took one of her nipples in his mouth and with his other hand resumed fingering her, rapidly and as deep inside her as he could manage.

“Oh fuck...” she moaned, her clear enjoyment of this keeping me seated, holding me back from intrusion.

“Oh fuck... oh fuck...”

Her moans became cries, her body shaking almost as though she were having a seizure — I couldn't believe she was coming from this, from his rough fingering, from everything that had come before.

Her climax was another factor to tip the balance in favor of me allowing this to go ahead. I sat back and watched as he had her kneel on the floor, as he unfastened his belt and gently patted it against her pink cheeks before unzipping his pants, withdrawing his hard cock before slapping that against her face.

I watched as she sucked on that huge thing, as he took it out and slapped it against her mouth, her tongue. As he held her hair and fucked her face with it.

She moaned as she sucked on him, and when he allowed her to lick his shaft, and when he rubbed it all over her face. She moaned even as he forced it as far down her throat as she would have it.

I sat and watched as he shoved her back onto the bed, as he removed his clothes and climbed on with her, as she raised her reddened behind to him so he could enter her, stretch her with that great pole.

“Oh my God...” she panted as he pounded her, slapping her behind with his hands as well as his body.

I watched as he gripped her by the hair to fuck her when she was on all fours. I watched him put her on top of him, her hands still tied as she bounced on his cock. I watched him take her missionary style, and then force up her legs, pulling her knees together so her pussy was even tighter around his huge manhood while he fucked her.

I watched him stuff her thong in her mouth, and fuck her until she was screaming and yelping such that she would have woken the neighbors

without her impromptu gag.

I watched him come in her mouth, her face all pink, her make-up smeared and streaming, his white cream leaking out over her lips, her chin, her cheeks.

I watched him pick up his clothes and leave her there, her wrists still tied, as he dressed, then walked out of the room, left the house, drove away in his big black limousine.

I watched, and as though to distract myself from the concern at the Senator's abusive behavior toward my wife, I found myself mentally focusing on the fact that the two of them were not using condoms any more.

*

"He wears protection if he's with anyone else," she said as I raised the matter.

She was lying naked on the bed, watching CNN on the small TV sitting on the chest at the end of our bed.

"How can you be so sure?" I asked, as I cut into the rope binding her wrists, using a knife from the kitchen.

"I know. And he's been tested recently."

I was breaking a sweat as I finally got through that rope — it was tough stuff. She gave me a grateful smile for freeing her, but remained there, lying on her front, her body pale or pink all over, the smell of sex strong around her.

I quietly removed my clothes and returned to her, surveying her naked form, relishing her recent adultery, but tentative about touching her after the rough treatment she'd received.

"It's okay," she said, her head turned to see my caution. "It doesn't hurt."

I gently stroked her back, feeling the hint of dried perspiration there. I touched my hands delicately down on her raised buttocks, which almost glowed they were so pink.

"I'm fine," she insisted.

I squeezed her behind a little more firmly, and dropped down to kiss her there, inhaling the heady scent of sex, of her arousal, along with her sweet perfume.

"I don't like it, Izzie," I said. "You shouldn't let him hit you."

"It's okay," she insisted. "Really. It doesn't feel like much more than stroking. It's not really hitting."

I pulled her buttocks apart, revealing the pink flower between. She was wet, either from her recent fucking, or from anticipation that I might

want to reclaim her. I kissed further down, closer to her sex. My hands massaged her behind — testing her, I suppose, to see if it made her wince, or flinch, or react in any way that she might if she were actually hurt.

I said, “If you’re doing this just because you’re waiting for the promise of some big scoop...”

“I’m not,” she said. “Or at least, not only because of that.”

I moved around, edged apart her legs, and pushed on her hips to urge her to raise her rear. She did as I wanted, and the full glory of her unfaithful pussy was revealed to me. It didn’t freak me out that she’d had him in there bareback. Quite the opposite, actually. It seemed to tickle that dark side of me, that wanted her tainted, despoiled. Interesting.

She did flinch as I pushed my face into her, touching my mouth to her sex, but then relaxed, her initial gasp turning to a long, low moan as I tasted her and the subtle flavor of her recent bout of infidelity.

“You like him hitting you?” I asked between mouthfuls.

She whimpered a little as I lapped at her fragrant flower, though not because it was hurting her. “I like that he commands me,” she said. “I like that he does as he wants with me.”

Her body rocked gently under me as I teased her slippery pussy with my tongue. I could hear her sighs, her deep breathing, as I feasted on her.

After a while, I sat up, placed my hands on her hips and turned her. “It doesn’t hurt, to lie on it?” I asked her.

“No,” she grinned, opening her legs for me.

I dropped down on her to resume my oral exploration of her swollen pussy, her reddened pussy lips, her clit. She stroked my head as I lapped at her, and as her moaning became louder, more breathy, her fingers tensed on my scalp, then fell away completely. It seemed to me much easier to make her come after she’d been with C. Another added perk, I guess. He warmed her up for me.

“You’ll stop seeing him if I tell you to, won’t you?” I said, picking myself up, feeling the coolness of the air conditioning since my face was so wet with her juices.

“Just give me a little longer,” she pleaded. “I just need a little more time.”

I knelt up, and dipped the end of my cock into her soaking pussy, her lips already parted from the actions of another man’s larger organ.

“You can have the summer,” I said. “But no more than that.”

“Okay,” she said, and groaned as I sank down, and into her.

“And if he hurts you. If I think he’s going too far, it ends immediately.”

“Of course.”

She turned on all fours again for the final exertion of the night, her behind on display for me as I penetrated her, teasing me with its redness, reminding me how he’d spanked her as he had fucked her, something I’d never feel comfortable doing, making her come like crazy in the process.

I groaned as my own climax hit, the force that had been building all night as I’d watched another man fucking my wife exploding into a gush of hot come pumping out deep inside her.

I felt good that she had agreed to a term limit on her relationship with C. And with my warning that I’d end it all if I thought it was getting out of hand.

If only it was as simple as that.

Chapter Twenty-Eight

The thing was, it was getting increasingly difficult to keep up with her, and her liaisons with C.

Sometimes, there was the fact that C would appear to demand sex at a moment's notice. I knew: I had access to her text messages. He'd drop by and pick her up, almost unannounced, in her lunch break, or sometimes at any random time in the day.

It was work for her, she could justify it in her head, and even if a co-worker asked where she was going, as simply meeting up with one of her contacts. All through the summer, she got a steady drip feed of information on what was happening within Congress, and within the Republican nomination campaign, after all.

Sometimes I could track her movements, but still couldn't actively get there in time to witness anything. I could see him taking her to the same place in the Maryland wilderness — or other isolated locations where he could no doubt shackle her, and take her to his heart's delight.

She'd come home to me all horny for me to take her back, so despite my frustration at not seeing her infidelity, I could at least enjoy the reclamation. I'd peel off her clothes to find her flesh invariably pink and occasionally bruised, though she took pains to persuade me it had been fine, harmless, nothing to worry about.

"I just bruise easily," she'd tell me, and I couldn't really argue against her, though I didn't remember many bruises during our married life before.

If I was lucky, she'd have her phone sufficiently close to where it was all happening, and be able to Skype me so that I could at least hear her infidelity — assuming I was at home or in some private place where I could enjoy it.

It was increasingly rare that I'd be able to appreciate her indulgence with the Senator in our own home. "He doesn't like to be here too often," she admitted when I mentioned it. "He doesn't want his car to be seen, or followed. Especially with the Convention coming up — things are getting heated."

“He can’t ride in a taxi?” I asked. “Or a rental car?”

I didn’t like to complain, though. Or sex life had never been better, never been more heated.

And every time I did get to witness my wife with C, it was something special. She just got so turned on by it all, more so than with any other man. The power he exerted over her just did something to her.

I thought, before we started playing the Game, that eventually things might get boring. I’d lose interest, I’d allow her to get on with whatever dating activities she wanted without my need to monitor her. How wrong I was — each time she saw C, or any other man, it just renewed the anxiety and the arousal for me.

And there were still times when they shocked me — when Izzie did something that seemed totally out of character, or something she never did with me. Just like the rare sight of C slipping his largesse inside Izzie’s rear entrance.

Jesus.

I had to look closer just to make sure I was seeing what I thought I was, on that occasion. I happened to have my car in the repair shop because the exhaust had been rattling, ended up getting a taxi home. When Izzie came back with C in tow, in the middle of the afternoon, my car was not in the driveway — so she must have assumed I was out.

She must have felt free to do things I might not approve of, since she thought I was gone.

It wasn’t long before he had her in the armchair we had downstairs in the living room opposite the couch, she faced him, her knees raised, and initially he was driving that great thing into her beautifully wet pussy.

Then moments later, he was pushing her knees up further, and thrusting into her other hole.

I was shocked, as it was something we had never even talked about. I’d never thought she was interested. I guess it had never been much of a turn-on for me. And yet watching someone else do it with her did turn me on — it was like a forbidden act, a taboo being broken.

Had she done this with C before, but I hadn’t been there to witness it?

A little later, as she climbed on him to ride his hardness, I could see her slip it into her rear entrance — and this time it was her clear choice. She panted and moaned just as she did when someone screwed her as normal, and I assumed she wasn’t faking.

I watched her lie on her back on his chest, his hands squeezing her breasts with little mercy, his large cock driving into her ass. Did she really enjoy it? She’d never even hinted at wanting to do such a thing

with me before. I guess it had never been something that particularly interested me, but just seeing her do it with someone else... well. I guess watching my wife break with convention was just plain hot.

They spooned on the couch after that, taking things slow, and it seemed so affectionate a position that it really irked my jealousy. Affection was so much more difficult for me to watch between them than penetration or anything else. It tweaked the paranoid part of me, the part that imagined I could lose Izzie to this Senator.

And finally, as she stared in his eyes, smiling as though besotted, the two of them murmuring to each other so that I couldn't quite catch what they were saying, I saw the base of his large tool pulsating, and Izzie let out a deep sigh as she felt him ejaculate deep inside her — deep inside her ass.

*

On that particular occasion, Izzie had to go back out to work after her encounter with C. In fact, she texted me to let me know she would be on TV that evening, and I sat down to watch her on Vincent Parrega's CNN show. She was talking about the upcoming Republican Convention, and the chances of the various candidates for the Presidential nomination. In particular, Parrega was grilling her over her scoop about the possibility that a new candidate could come forward at the Convention and secure the nomination, since all of the other candidates either had scandal linked to their names — not least because of Izzie's previous stories — or were seen as relative political lightweights.

I was so proud of my wife, and how she had shaped herself into this Washington insider — even if she did have help from a Senator she was sleeping with. She looked gorgeous on TV, and even Vincent Parrega himself appeared to be quite taken with her.

I sat there on our couch watching her closely as she discussed the possibility of the Republicans going through a brokered convention where the GOP could end up with a dark horse winning the nomination. And yet as I watched her, I couldn't shake the memory of seeing her latest rendezvous with C.

It fixed in my head: my wife had just had anal sex with one of the most powerful men in Washington.

My wife had just had anal sex.

Somehow, knowing that made her seem different in my eyes, I can't entirely explain why. Different: more sophisticated, more interesting, more attractive. It wasn't that I now desperately wanted to make love to her in that way, now that I knew that she would. I don't know. I guess it was because she seemed more capable, more open than I'd even imagined.

Had she done it before, with someone before I'd come along?

*

When she came home that night, she came in wearing the same outfit she'd donned on TV, and that proved distraction enough for a while. But as she stripped down to her underwear right in front of me, I was reminded of what she'd been up to with C that afternoon.

"I saw you," I said, standing to greet her, to kiss her lips, to run my hands over her stunning body.

"Was it okay?" she asked me. "I think I kind of babbled."

She was referring to her appearance on CNN, and I think I had been referring to her appearance on my monitor in the basement when I'd expressed wonderment at seeing her.

"It was fantastic," I said. "You were brilliant."

She beamed, and held my jaw as she kissed my lips. "You're just saying that because you're my husband."

I laughed, my hand skipping over her breasts, feeling her stiff nipples poking against her bra. "I'm saying that because I'm a fellow journalist," I insisted.

She flashed a beautiful smile. I stroked her long dark hair out of her face and gazed a moment at her pretty brown eyes before sucking on her bottom lip.

"You were with C this afternoon," I said.

"Uh-huh," she nodded, and there was a glint in her eye, knowing that I'd picked up on whatever clues she'd offered me to suggest she had, indeed, brought C to the house while I had been out, knowing how much it would turn me on to know she'd been with him again.

"I watched," I said. "I was there. Here. Downstairs."

She caught her breath — she hadn't known I was there, then. Was that why she'd allowed anal sex that afternoon?

"You were there?"

Her hand slid down to my crotch, discovering the bulge in my pants. She smirked as she stroked it, amused and also turned on herself by my signs of arousal.

“I saw everything,” I said.

“You’re getting very good at the Game,” she sighed as I kissed her neck, breathing in her exotic perfume — and detecting the hint of shampoo from a shower she must have taken before going on CNN.

“You do that with him a lot?” I asked her, slipping the steps of her bra off her shoulders, popping her breasts out of their confinement so that I could taste them, curl my tongue around her stiff buds. “The mid-afternoon quickie?”

I’d wanted to ask her about the anal sex, of course, but it was difficult for me to bring up.

“Sometimes,” she said. “If he can’t see me during the evening, I’ll go see him during the day.”

“And if you think I’m not home, you’ll bring him here?”

She shrugged, then nodded. I guess she’d been having sex with C a lot more than I’d given her credit for. Cheating, in a way, since I’d missed any clues she’d given me.

I don’t know. It didn’t bother me that there had been times with him that I didn’t know about. That was the point of the Game, wasn’t it? Sometimes I’d fail to spot her clues. It burned inside me that she’d had times with him that I wasn’t aware of — but at the same time, under the terms of our Game, I had given her full permission to do it.

“I guess I’ve missed some of your clues along the way,” I said, trying not to sound too put out.

“I’m sorry,” she said with a pitying smile. “I try to be as plain as I can be.”

“Right.”

“Sometimes I think there are days when you’re not in the mood for it.” She pulled her bra off, then moved to tear off my shirt.

“Not in the mood for it?”

Another shrug. “You’re not always in the mood for sex, are you? No one is.”

“I don’t know. If I knew you’d been with him, I would be.”

“The clues are there,” she insisted. “Maybe it would be more obvious if you happened to want sex with me after...”

“So I should fuck you every night, just in case?”

She grinned. “Not a bad idea. But I guess I can give you stronger hints sometimes.”

I dipped my hand in her panties, felt the heat, the smoothness of her pussy, and how wet she was. “Sometimes you don’t seem like you’re in the mood,” I said, and I’ll admit, it bothered me a little to think that she might have sex with C, and then later that evening appear to me to be not in the mood for sex with me. I’m not saying that happened.

“If I’ve been with him, then I’m definitely in the mood when I see you again,” she insisted, and it did make me feel a little better. “I promise, I’ll make it a little more obvious.”

She unfastened my belt, and pushed one of her hands down inside my pants to hold my erect cock, to stroke it while I stroked her breasts.

“I think you just like cheating on me,” I said, pulling her down onto the bed.

“No,” she smirked, “I’ve told you — I prefer it when you’re there, when you’re watching.”

“But sometimes the illicit thrill of a secret encounter is just too good, right?”

“I swear, I leave you clues!”

I know, most men would have been furious to find out their wife had slept with someone behind their back. Most men would be angry about their wife sleeping with anyone else, period. I wasn’t most men. I liked that this Game of ours kept me on my toes, and that there might be times I might fail to know about her Game-playing.

In the end, it was her who brought up the anal sex.

“You saw... everything... today?” she said, straddling me as I lay back on our bed.

“Everything,” I nodded.

“And it didn’t make you angry, what I did with him?”

“I never said you couldn’t.”

She was stroking the head of my cock over her soft skin between her legs, through the lips of her pussy, coating it in her copious juices.

“You ever do that before?” I asked. “I mean, before C?”

She shrugged, “A few times in college. Never thought much of it.”

“And now?”

“C seems to like it. And if it’s done in the right way...”

She sank down on my pole, and it took me a moment or two to realize what she was doing, and why she seemed extra tight.

My God.

Chapter Twenty-Nine

The game did seem to improve many aspects of our lives, though, at the end of the day.

I flew away on a business trip, and she'd send me little hints of how she was misbehaving while I was gone — and though I itched to be back with her, to reclaim her, every little text message or photo or video I received from her was like the greatest present ever. It made trips away pass by very quickly, although I had to be careful not to lose focus at times when I was interviewing people or covering some event.

I'd get pictures or videos of Izzie as she prepared herself for another date with C. Or perhaps just a text message telling me to look up an outfit or some lingerie on an online store — so I could imagine what she was wearing for another man.

Perhaps I'd get another picture later on of her underwear lying forsaken on somebody else's floor, or even a subtle glimpse of my wife's naked body with a hint that she'd just had sex.

And while the Game gave her a pass from actively telling me the details of her dates, she often liked to FaceTime with me, to talk with me face-to-face so that I would see her just after she'd been with C, and she would see me riding the emotions — from lust to insecurity to love — being so far away from her at such a time.

Despite the torture of seeing Izzie being so sexual while I was away, receiving her little insights made my time away from home pass more quickly, and I'd be burning to get back home and see her again. Whenever I got back home, I'd be into the bedroom like a flash, every time, sensually enjoying every inch of her adulterous body, and I'd be so hungry for her.

Whatever else it did for us, the Game made our marital bond stronger than ever.

One visit I made to Los Angeles saw her sending me a long video, which I was able to download from my hotel but did not have time to watch before having to flee to the airport. Having that video in my phone

all the way through check-in, and the security checks, made me feel like it was burning a hole through my pocket.

The terminal was just too full to find any privacy where I could see the video. Even the restrooms were just too full, giving me no time to sit in a stall and watch it.

On the plane I had a row to myself, and once the in-flight meal was out of the way, I finally had a little time and space to secretly watch what she had sent me.

The video opened with Izzie turning on the video app on her phone. She positioned it in a bedroom that seemed very expensively furnished — the window I could see made it seem to me that this was my first view inside C's very own townhouse in Georgetown.

Izzie gave me a big smile, which did warm my heart, even considering what she was clearly planning to do. She was wearing a suit, rather than evening wear, something she'd wear at work. If it was 10am on the West Coast when she'd sent me her video, it would be 1pm in Washington. Had this been one of her quickies with C? The daylight was still coming in through the window, filtering around the blinds, which would confirm it.

She stepped out of the picture, and for a long while there was nothing but the same view of the empty bedroom. I skipped the video forward until something happened.

Then, there was C. But he wasn't alone. As soon as the Senator stepped into the view of the camera, another man was there as well. Chatting, leisurely, removing their jackets, draping them over two antique chairs by the window, before sitting on the side of the large bed.

Who was that other man?

It took me a while, but I immediately sensed that he was somebody. Not just an old friend of the Senator. Jesus — Joseph Goolden, no less. Current Governor of Ohio. The two men were smoking cigars, and it seemed like some casual meeting or other except for the fact that this was in a bedroom.

Then there was Izzie again, bringing an ashtray for the men to use with their cigars. She stood in front of them, talking as though giving them a presentation at a conference. God she looked good in that suit. And then she removed her jacket, draping it on the same chairs as the men. The top buttons on her shirt were undone, to reveal a hint of cleavage, and that skirt of hers was so short, even if it was smart over her dark pantyhose.

I watched Izzie talking to the men, and then she turned her head to look off-camera, and beckoned to someone.

I caught my breath as a young blonde woman stepped into view, wearing a suit similar to Izzie's. Izzie took the blonde's jacket from her, laying it over the chair behind, and then said something to the two men.

I saw C give a nod to them, but otherwise the men did not seem to stir.

And then I watched as Izzie stripped off the young blonde's clothes right there in front of the two powerful men sitting on the bed, and right in front of the camera — before Izzie removed her own clothes.

The blonde seemed delighted by it all, and it seemed to me fairly clear that whoever she was, she was besotted with Governor Goolden. I guess power corrupts, and all that.

Naked, the two women stood there for the men to appreciate the beauty, the men standing to inspect them, to cast their eyes over every inch of them, to touch them, as though they were fine sculptures in their private art collection.

After a few moments, however, Izzie led the blonde off out of view. What was going to happen?

God. I looked up from my phone to check I was in no danger of being seen by any wandering passengers or flight attendants.

When I looked back at the phone, the men in the video were back sitting on the bed once again. I skipped forward a few minutes as they merely chatted and smoked their cigars. Then I saw the two women return to view — on their hands and knees on the floor, both naked other than the leather collars worn around their necks.

They crawled like animals out onto the floor before the seated men, then turned to face the wall, presenting their butts to their audience. I could see they had something protruding from their behinds: each of them had a string of large beads half-inserted into their asses, looking almost like tails.

It was startling to say the least. I'm not sure if it was humiliating for the women, but it certainly wasn't the kind of thing Izzie would have gone in for ordinarily. But then, I could have said the same about a lot of things, including her recent enjoyment of anal sex.

The two men stood up and approached the women, then crouched to begin examining them. The Senator was paying attention to the blonde, who seemed to me to be perhaps an intern, or a young PA. The Governor, meanwhile, was touching and stroking Izzie, running his hands gently over her, leaning down to pull apart her buttocks to examine the beads protruding from her behind.

There were a few pats on the buttocks for both women, but it was nothing more than a few pats — hardly impacts at all. Still, I started

worrying that this man, the Governor, might be into the whole spanking thing as C was. I just didn't see the attraction, myself.

I watched the men switch, to assess the other women, feeling out their bodies, the breasts, their buttocks, scrutinizing them as though they were buyers at some despicable slave auction.

After a while, they left the blonde girl there on the floor, extending a long silver chain from her neck collar to the base of the radiator to shackle her in place. They had Izzie stand up.

The two men sat on the bed and watched as my wife presented herself to them, her petite, pale body on display as she slowly turned around and around for them, showing herself off, her hands gliding all over her curves as though she were selling herself, those beads hanging between her legs still.

The Senator said something to her — an order, I guessed, and Izzie complied by dropping back down onto all fours, for both men to now crouch by her again, to run their hands all over her. This time, both men held her buttocks as one of them — the Governor — slowly removed the beads from her anus.

The Governor nodded his appreciation of her.

Then without her tail, Izzie was now shackled to the radiator by the window, in place of the blonde girl, who now rose to her feet to be fondled and groped by the two men. Izzie turned to watch as they now restrained the blonde's wrists in black leather cuffs behind her back, then pushed her down onto the bed on her front.

The Governor manhandled her, having her lift her butt on the bed, making it easier when the two men came to stroke her behind — and after a few moments, to spank her.

Their hits were not hard — it did seem to me not unlike the swatting of flies — and the blonde girl did not seem to cry out or even really wince in response. Each time she was struck, her body moved.

Why did the men want to do this?

As they released the blonde girl, only to order her to stand quietly in the corner of the room by the wardrobe, I did have to accept that there was a sexual thrill for me in seeing Izzie exploring her sexuality like this — even if I was unsure of the direction in which she was exploring. The Senator unfastened the end of Izzie's chain from the radiator, and held it like a leash, leading her over to the bed on her hands and knees.

On her past record, I knew Izzie was turned on right now, and after she switched with the blonde girl, her body responded to the rough treatment and the power displayed by the two men. After a light spanking, the two

men fixed black leather restraints around Izzie's wrists, which were bound together and then chained to the bedstead.

Kneeling in the middle of the bed, the Governor moved up behind her, pawing at her exposed flesh. Then suddenly I saw the Senator step back in front of the camera, his pants and underwear gone, kneeling up on the bed in front of Izzie, to present his hard cock to her mouth.

I felt my heart shiver as I watched her stretch her lips around him, and take him inside her mouth. Switching cameras to get a better view, I saw in the background the Governor pull back off the bed, and now he was removing his pants and his underwear.

Naked, the Governor knelt up on the bed behind Izzie again, running his hands over her back, her butt, the backs of her thighs. He held his cock in his hands, and it came as some relief to watch him rolling a condom over it. He was considerably smaller than his Senatorial friend, though most men would be.

I watched him touching Izzie's pussy, stroking her there, spreading her wetness, preparing her. Then he was moving up closer to her, and my stomach felt squeezed as I watched him ease into her. I couldn't see actual entry from Izzie's lone video camera, but from the way he moved, and the way she moved, I could tell he was inside her. Fucking her as she sucked on his friend.

Izzie's nipples were rock hard as the two men used her, and I could see her moaning, particularly when C removed his cock from her mouth to rub it over her face.

After a while, the Governor withdrew, and went to bring his intern to the bed. Without much ceremony, he urged her up onto the mattress on her hands and knees, and had her turn to face him. The Senator withdrew from Izzie to take control of the blonde girl, moving her over to kneel and face Izzie. Though the blonde's wrists were unbound, they were otherwise mirroring each other's position on the bed, and as the men moved in behind them to begin fucking them — the Senator with the blonde, the Governor continuing with Izzie — the intern began kissing my wife on the mouth, and Izzie was not dissuading her from doing so.

The Governor pushed his intern's head down so that she was kissing Izzie's breasts, and then he pulled away from Izzie completely, to move to her side where he could get the intern to suck on his cock while the Senator continued fucking her from behind.

It amused me slightly, the intern's moans at having to accommodate the Senator, a much larger man than she'd perhaps had before.

Then the Senator had her turn on her back on the bed, and before he had reinserted himself into her from the missionary position, he had the girl lie under Izzie, her head between Izzie's thighs where she could lap at my wife's pussy.

It was so hot to watch a woman licking my wife like that, I almost missed the sight of Izzie now turning to suck the Governor's hard cock. She draped her bound wrists over the Senator's shoulders while he fucked the blonde, and turned to bob down on the other man's cock, all while she sat on the intern's face.

At last, I saw C pull out of the intern, and pump his thick, white fluid all over her stomach.

That wasn't to be the end of it, however. As the intern sucked on the Senator, Izzie was moved over to suck on the Senator, to bring his manhood back to life with her mouth. With the intern moved onto her back, I watched my wife kissing and licking her breasts, the Governor returning to slide his cock inside the blonde's pussy.

It was highly erotic to watch the four of them together, though it helped when the restraints came to be abandoned. The Governor was given his fill of Izzie, while the Senator had his share of the pretty blonde graduate, the two women kissing and fondling each other like I'd never imagine my wife doing.

At last, as the two women lay on their sides, pressed together, their lips locked together, their hands delving between thighs to touch each other's clits, the Senator spooned with Izzie, while the Governor spooned with his intern, both men grunting as they finished inside the women.

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I almost regretted watching that video, and then having to get through a five-hour flight. Probably a bad idea getting myself so wound up like that. I spent the rest of the flight imagining that the video Izzie had sent me had only been round one, that the two men had done unspeakable things with my wife after that.

And then everything seemed so very slow when we landed, and I had to take an old mobile lounge transporter into the main terminal before heading out to the parking lot before the drive home.

I was relieved, at least, to find that my wife was home when I got there. It was getting fairly late, but she could have been spending the

night with C. Thankfully, though, there was her car in the driveway, and as I entered the front door, the waft of perfume in the air confirmed that she was there.

She was upstairs, in the bedroom. When I got there I found her standing at the windows facing the street, naked. She'd been watching me pull into the driveway.

"Hey," she said as I came in. The moonlight splashed all over her gorgeous body — over the glorious swell of her breasts, those stiff nipples that cried out for a mouth. Her flat stomach. Her smooth, hairless pussy I just wanted to feast on.

"Hey, you're still awake?"

She smiled. "I missed you."

I stepped up to her, and took her in my arms, kissed her. It struck me that the air in the bedroom was thick from recent sex. Had she been with C again that evening, in this very room?

"I saw your video," I said.

She pressed herself against me, and could feel my hardness. "Are you mad at me?" she said, though I was so hard for her, it had to be clear I wasn't mad.

"Of course not." I caressed her cheek, then kissed her mouth, my hands sliding around her waist as I tasted lips that had serviced two men, who were not me, earlier in the day.

Izzie's hand found its way to the bulge in my pants, and I heard a soft moan, which seemed to me pleased to find I was in a state of arousal.

"You like the thought of me with two men?"

I said, "Yes. But maybe it's nearly time to stop, huh?"

"Stop playing the Game?"

"Stop seeing Billingsford. Or his friends on the Hill."

She put her hands up to my face, gazing into my eyes. "Just a little while longer," she said, and kissed me.

"Someone else," I said. "Anyone else. Just not him."

She shook her head. "I need a little longer. You know this isn't purely about the sex."

I sighed. "Whatever story you're working on, is it worth it?"

"Of course," she smiled.

I kissed her neck, inhaling the clean scent of her body wash from the shower. "You know what kind of danger you're in?" I asked.

"It's fine."

"Sleeping with a Governor. A married one, at that. And some people have labeled Goolden as a future President."

I stooped to kiss her breasts, and lick my way around those stiff nipples of hers.

“This isn’t a movie,” she said. “People don’t really get bumped off for that kind of thing, you know.”

“I wouldn’t entirely agree with you.”

“If I wrote something about this in the paper — or gave details to a colleague — the Republican machine would just deny everything and then probably destroy my career.”

I kissed slowly down her stomach, then turned her to kiss my way around her lower back, her round buttocks, taking in the smell of her arousal, and of the sex that lingered around her.

“You were with C again this evening?” I asked her. “Here in this room?”

She smiled. “The Governor,” she said. “He had his chauffeur drop me off here — but then came inside for one last little adventure.”

It was so wrong, knowing what she’d just got up to, breathing in the evidence of her last liaison with that the man — and yet it was still such a thrill to behold my wife as a naughty nymphomaniac, a wickedly insatiable beauty.

I crouched, and knowing what I craved, she leaned back against the window sill, her thighs parting to reveal her dripping wet pussy to me.

I pressed my face up and between her thighs, just managing a little taste of her nectar. I felt exhilarated, and not just by the intoxicating presence of her wet pussy. She’d confirmed working on a story about Billingsford. Perhaps that would give her some closure on her affair with him.

Nevertheless, I said, “I want you to bring all this to a close as soon as you can. With C.”

“I will,” she promised, turning her body toward me, lifting her leg over my shoulder to bring her exquisite hairless, soaking pussy to my mouth. “But you know, I’m not the only one enjoying this.”

“We’ll find someone else,” I said, and licked her slippery groove, tasting her tangy juices.

“Someone else like that? Like C?” she grinned. “Come on - you love it, I can tell. He’s such a bad boy.”

“We’ll find someone else.”

“You love how he controls me. How he takes what he wants from me. You liked seeing me with that girl, huh? With two guys at once?”

She sighed long and low. “God, I can still feel their hands all over me...” she cooed.

And damn, as I lapped at her, she was wetter than ever.

“It was pretty amazing,” I said at last, slipping my fingers inside her while I licked at her clit. “But you’re going to end it — soon — and we’ll find someone else as good, I swear.”

She came as I ate her — it seemed to me that it was becoming increasingly easy for me to make her come this way after she’d been with another man. She was more confident that I wanted this, that I loved experiencing her this way, and after her rough treatment with C, this tender alternative was the perfect way to come down.

And for me, it was the perfect way to re-connect with her — literally rubbing my face in her infidelity, emphasizing just how wrong this all was, which only made it all the more hot.

We collapsed to the floor right there in front of the window, Izzie reaching over to stroke my hardness through my pants, kissing my mouth despite the fact that I’d been lapping at her wet pussy.

“Do you really like all that?” I asked her as she fumbled with my belt, and drew my pants down to reveal my full hardness. “Being so submissive?”

She shrugged, gave me a half-smile. “I don’t really like it,” she said, “but something about it... well, it gets me pretty wet, can’t you tell?”

“I don’t get it.”

She grinned, and slipped my cock in her mouth, swirling her tongue around its tip. Withdrawing it, she said, “Well you’re conflicted over giving me up to another man, aren’t you?”

“I suppose so.” I groaned as she sank on my pole. It seemed to me that her becoming accustomed to taking a larger cock in her mouth meant she was able to take more of mine in her throat these days.

She came up for air, added: “You have some negative feelings as well as the positive, the excitement.”

“Some, sure.”

“You are a little jealous, especially when you can’t be there to watch me. You’re afraid, too, though you don’t have any reason to be. I can see it in your eyes sometimes.”

I shrugged. “You’re fucking a multi-millionaire who has the biggest cock in Washington. What is there not to be afraid of?”

She grinned again. “So it’s like that,” she said. “I have negative feelings about how C treats me. But I can’t deny he turns me on. And I find myself wanting more of it, even though I know it’s bad.”

She climbed on me, right there as I sat up against the radiator on the floor. She positioned me, then sank down, taking my erect cock into her

hot pussy, a pussy stretched and moistened by two other men earlier that evening.

“Be careful,” I said. “I don’t think you can entirely trust him.”

“I’ll be careful,” she said, cautiously riding me.

As I came deep inside her, though, and later lay with her in the bed, I was unsure how I was going to keep the balance of enjoying her little affair with the Senator while preventing any danger from arising from it all.

Chapter Thirty

I let her keep on seeing him. I hated to admit it, but it was a thrill to see how horny it made her, seeing him then coming back to me. The fact that she had a little fetish about dominant men, and the fact that the man she was seeing was giving her an experience I really could not myself did press my buttons.

And it did provide invaluable insight on Capitol Hill to help with Izzie's work.

Then one day I came home after a client visit out in northern Virginia, I found Izzie lying gingerly on the couch on her front. She was tapping out something on her little laptop computer, but since she was dressed in a tiny little pleated skirt — which made her look not unlike a cheerleader, although the gray t-shirt didn't quite go with the image — it made my thoughts turn dirty.

I sat down on the floor next to her, even though she was watching a re-run of an old episode of America's Top Model. Yet when I laid a hand on her rear, she winced and cried out.

"Hey — what the Hell?"

I shifted up to sit on the couch beside her legs, then gently lifted her skirt. The first thing that struck me was that her ordinarily pale behind was seriously pink — it almost seemed to be glowing.

"It's nothing," she said, not even looking back at me, her attention nailed to the screen of her laptop.

"Nothing, Iz? You can't even sit down, for heaven's sake!"

"It's okay," she stressed.

"C did this to you?" I demanded. The hot bile of anger was welling up inside me.

"A little spanking, that's all," she said, unbelievably casually.

I stroked her butt, very very lightly, but even a faint brush of the back of my fingers was too much for some parts. The color of her flesh was quite something — and was actually hot to the touch.

"Spanked? You can normally sit down after he spansks you."

"I just got a little careless, that's all."

“Careless?”

“Speaking to people I shouldn’t.”

I looked up at her, horrified at her neutral demeanor. “He can’t stop you talking to people,” I said. “Was it for the story?”

“Yes. I just got careless, that’s all.”

I sighed. She was smiling at me, for caring, I guessed. Or for stroking her behind. I could smell her arousal. Now that I looked down there, it was clear her pussy was wet.

“Did you put anything on this?” I asked her, indicating her wounds.

“I took a shower,” she said. “Kinda painful.”

“Wait here.”

I went up to the bathroom, found the healing cream. When I returned to her, she hadn’t moved. She was dutifully waiting for me, as ordered.

She flinched as I started gently dabbing the cold cream over her behind, starting with the worst-looking wounds, gently spreading it as best I could without hurting her.

“Does it hurt?” I asked.

“Not really,” she insisted. I wasn’t sure I believed her. “I like you taking care of me,” she added, and flinched again as I touched a tender spot a little too roughly. “I like you touching me like that.”

“Is that why you keep jumping every time I touch you?”

She smiled.

I squeezed the base of her cheeks, and ducked down to kiss part of her behind unaffected by her spanking. She moaned. The scent of her arousal was getting really strong, I could see the moisture seeping from her pussy there between her thighs.

I gently laid a finger on her soaking groove, and she let out a long, low groan of pleasure.

“I don’t want you seeing him again,” I said. “That’s it.”

“I just need...”

“You don’t need anything like this again. Even if it’s for the most incredible scoop any journalist ever achieved.”

She sighed. “I just need a few more days.”

I shook my head. “I don’t want you seeing him again. Not after this.”

Another sigh. “If you knew what we were working on...”

She seemed confused. She liked the way I was defending her — I suppose she might also have liked the way I was ordering her what to do, taking command.

I applied healing cream to the very last part of her wounds, this time in the middle of her butt, as close as it got to her sex. She shifted as I

touched her there, parting her legs. Exposing her pussy to me.

“Wrap it up with him,” I said. “Do whatever you have to — tell whoever you’re working with that the Senator is cutting off your access. You’ll just have to go with what you have so far.”

“I’ll see what I can do.”

“No, you’ll just do it.”

She seemed a little irritated, and at the same time, she was wiggling her butt, turned on, silently begging for me to touch her sex.

“Did he take you?” I asked her. “Before he punished you — or after. Did he fuck you?”

“Uh-huh,” she said, her voice taking on a slightly dreamy quality. “Before. He fucked me so hard...”

I guess I knew how to flick her buttons now well enough — dominating her seemed to work as good as anything. But she also knew how to flick my buttons. How far we’d come since we’d started playing the Game. I had to admit, it was hot to hear Izzie tell me outright that another man had just fucked her.

I carefully prized apart her legs a little further, and ducked down to wedge my face between her cheeks. I drew my tongue along her dripping pussy, making her moan. I could tell her reddened flower had been recently fucked. She was seriously wet. I ate her like a juicy peach as she sighed and groaned and gasped, jostling her behind as I lapped at her.

After a while, she gave up on her laptop completely, folding it up and placing it on the coffee table before dropping her head down onto a corner cushion, closing her eyes to enjoy her treatment.

“God, that’s so good...” she breathed.

After a while, I turned over to lie on my back on the couch, Izzie lifting her behind so that she could sit on my face. She gently pressed her sweet pussy down over my mouth, riding me carefully so that it wouldn’t hurt her wounds.

What can I say, I always loved going down on her. And when I knew she’d just been a naughty wife, it only drove on my hunger more. She came, sitting up on me, grinding her pussy against my mouth and my nose, gasping and yelling, squeezing her buttocks over me.

That night she asked me to apply healing cream to her wounds three more times. I could go down on her, but I wasn’t allowed to fuck her — that really would have been agony for her.

Eventually, though, my frustration pushed me into demanding that she at least reciprocate. My flash of dominance seemed to get her going. She

played the submissive as she went down on me, and in that frame of mind seemed to enjoy it even more than usual.

I held her head, gently but firmly, leading her rhythm as she sucked on me.

By the end, I had her begging for me to allow her to swallow my come. Well, we all have different fantasies. It worked for her. And I could think of the fact that she'd no doubt been sucking on another man's cock earlier that evening.

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After that night, I decided to take advantage of Izzie's need for a little dominance in her life in order to make sure she did not see the Senator again. It was kind of fun, something different from before. Something to distract her from her need for whatever C did for her.

In the morning I'd choose which clothes she was going to wear that day. Perhaps if there was time I'd have her model for me — different sets of sexy underwear, various suits. She still looked smart when she went out for work, I'd never do anything to damage her professionalism — but underneath a nice suit she'd be wearing fancy lace lingerie, stockings and suspenders. Maybe her skirt would be just a fraction too short, risking the possibility of her male colleagues catching the hint of stockings. Maybe I'd have her wear a blouse that was just a touch too tight.

Maybe her skirt would be modest enough, but she'd go to work wearing no panties whatsoever.

During the afternoons, I'd sent her the occasional text reminding her to be home quickly following work, or following her gym workout or yoga classes, so that she might service me. I'd drop little hints about what I was going to do with her.

She'd get home and I'd have my way with her, ordering her around, shackling her to the bed, blindfolding her. A little light spanking perhaps, though I was never really comfortable with that.

I'd play the dominant lover, but I'd talk to her about loaning her out to men I knew — or requiring her to flirt with certain men from the gym, or even from work. That was role-play really, but we also signed her up to a discreet online dating service, being careful not to give out the kind of personal details that might fall into the hands of hackers.

Two of those dates didn't really come to anything, though it was exciting hoping they would, and we were optimistic that at some point we'd find somebody Izzie liked, or who wouldn't flake out on a date.

The only disturbing thing to me was that while Izzie enjoyed playing the submissive, she also liked to purposefully flout rules and requirements here and there — so that I would be forced to “punish” her. I wasn't much good at the whole punishment thing, that more than anything probably showed up the fabricated nature of my dominance. I could take her over my knee and spank her a little, I could bind her wrists and ankles a little more tightly than usual. The most effective method seemed to be to refuse her sex for periods of time, though that represented punishment for me, too, so that was hardly ideal, and she'd only have to casually prance around the house in her underwear to persuade me to end her temporary chastity.

Sometimes she would tease me about breaking the most important rule of all — not to see Senator Billingsford any more. That more than anything disturbed me.

“C was there today, at the hearing.”

“Is that so?”

“Came over to me afterward.”

“Friendly chat?”

“He wanted me to visit his townhouse.”

“And you said ‘no’, didn't you?”

“I said I wished I could. But...”

“And what did he say to that?”

“He told me to go to the restroom and take off my panties, then come back and give them to him.”

When we got frustrated with the difficulty of finding a suitable male through the online dating service, she'd suggest going to see Billingsford again. She'd start telling me she'd make it only the one visit. For old times' sake. Of course I said ‘no’, and found some mild punishment for her even considering it.

It was getting tiring, however.

Nights when she was late home from work, or from the gym, perhaps even delaying her return just to get me to punish her, I would start imagining she'd been tempted to go somewhere with her favorite Senator.

I'd even start imagining that her Senator might persuade her to run away with him, to quit Washington and walk out on her marriage and shack up with him in secret somewhere.

She always came back, though, and we'd reconnect. She'd enjoy my dominance, whether it was slightly put upon or not.

Only, then there was one night she didn't come back.

Part Four:
Game Over

Chapter Thirty-One

That particular night, I waited and waited.

The time pushed past the moment where she was simply late home from work. Then it pushed past the point where she'd be late home from the gym, if she'd rescheduled her regular workout that week for some reason without telling me.

It pushed on toward midnight, past the point where she might be at the TV studio, or out with some contact having forgotten to let me know she was interviewing someone or simply picking their brains.

I was sitting around, and it was late for me to be going to bed on a weekday night, and Izzie still wasn't back.

This was a big flaw in our Game. Izzie was allowed to go out and see other guys as she wanted to, of course, but if I didn't get the clues I needed to know where she was, I would worry.

On this particular night, I spent the small hours working hard to find some small piece of evidence as to where she might have gone. I naturally called her, texted her, even emailed her. There was nothing in her social media, or in her email, to suggest she had been planning on meeting someone.

I checked her credit card records, I checked her phone tracking application, I examined her appointments diary.

All came to nothing. I felt panic beginning to rise inside me, threatening to squeeze my heart to pulp. God. Was this Izzie actively misbehaving because she wanted to get me to treat her as C had treated her?

At around 4am, I collapsed on our bed, defeated. I couldn't sleep, however. I lay there for a while, figuring that our Game had to change, or end. If Izzie was playing a prank, or goading me somehow, this couldn't happen again. But when you played the Game, how could you force your partner to play by the rules? I could hardly threaten her with divorce — that was precisely the opposite of what I wanted.

I even started thinking about calling the police, though I hardly wanted the authorities involved if there was a chance Izzie was just away being

naughty with some other guy, and had just forgotten to let me in on the adventure.

Two or three hours of sleep eventually came, but I couldn't sleep for long despite my exhaustion. The daylight came, and I was back to scouring Izzie's email for signs I might have missed overnight.

By mid-afternoon, I really was about to call the cops. I was still wavering over whether Izzie was actually missing, or whether she might come back to me in the morning disheveled from a night of wanton sex, an apologetic smile plastered over her wicked face. Part of the point of the Game was that it was supposed to see Izzie as an independent, strong, sexy woman. Okay, so she could date dominant men if she so desired, but she wasn't supposed to be merely an object to play out her husband's fantasies. First and foremost, I wanted her to date as she wanted.

But Izzie wasn't this irresponsible, I was sure of it.

I remembered Marie. I hadn't talked to her for ages — and these days felt awkward for leaving her out of the loop on what was going on with our Game. She'd been a useful source. She was still Izzie's best friend. There was a chance my wife had let her know where she would be that night.

I called her.

"No — I can't get hold of her either," Marie said. "I was going to call to ask you."

"Shit."

"Shit."

The way she said it made my stomach sink into my shoes.

"Stay there, I'll be with you in no time at all," Marie said, and hung up.

Forty minutes later she was pulling up in our driveway and battering down our door.

"I know who she's been seeing," she said, breathless.

"Right..." I stood back to let her into the house, and it seemed like I was letting a whirlwind inside our living room.

"I know who she's been seeing — and you have to stop her seeing him. Jesus, maybe it's too late already."

I glanced out into the street, as though there might be reporters or FBI agents or someone out there, trying to eavesdrop. Then I closed the front door, made sure it was locked.

"I did stop her seeing him," I said. "At least, I thought I did."

"You think she's with him now, though?" Marie asked.

"I have no clue. That's why I called you."

“You know how dangerous this is?” she demanded, claiming a spot on the couch. “Sleeping with someone like that?”

“How did you find out who she’s been seeing?” I asked her, hoping it might shed some light. I wandered through to the kitchen to make coffee. God knew we needed it.

“From Izzie,” she said. “I eventually got it out of her.”

“You just got it out of her?”

Marie sighed. “Okay. Look, she asked me to help her with the article.”

“You’ve been helping her?” I felt irritated, somehow, that I knew nothing of this. “I thought she was going to drop all that.”

“I’ve only started looking at it in the last week or so. She wanted to hand it over to me, because you wanted her to drop it.”

“You’ve been working on it a week, and you’re only now telling me now that she should stop seeing Billingford?” My tone was sharp.

“I’ve only started to see how dangerous it was all getting.”

“She told you what she does — did — with him, with Billingford?”

“Uh-huh,” she said. “Showed me some of the bruises, too.”

“I did let it go too far,” I admitted. “I thought she was in control of what she was doing — I think I was wrong about that. But she said she was writing a story about something to do with him — she had to keep seeing him...”

Marie said, “The final story was going to be about Goolden, you know that? Or at least, the final story Billingford wanted Izzie to write. They were hoping for a brokered convention, if none of the Presidential Candidates get enough of a lead — and Goolden would come out as a neutral candidate.”

“Jesus.”

“It’s been such a polarized campaign. But Goolden would present himself as the sudden consensus choice, untarnished by a full-length campaign.”

I looked up at her, surprised.

Marie looked slightly smug from knowing. “Billingford took her to see Goolden a few times.”

“A few times?”

I felt the ground shake a little under me.

“Oh, she did quite a lot with Billingford that you didn’t know about,” Marie said, looking at me almost with pity. “You know you gave her quite a hall pass when you two devised that whole Game thing.”

“I know, I know.” I felt a little upset. Not that Izzie had cheated on me — I still fervently believed that I’d given her consent, so it wasn’t really

cheating. The upset came from not being a part of it, somehow, of being excluded. I would have wanted to find out about what she'd done, or watched if I could.

I didn't want to miss out on any of my beautiful Izzie being a bad girl.

"Oh, what you saw, what you heard about was only the tip of the iceberg," Marie seemed quietly happy that she knew more about Izzie's recent adventures than I did.

"Seriously?"

I sighed, and headed over to join Marie on the couch, handing her a mug of steaming hot coffee.

"Last week — you were in Toronto chasing some metals company," Marie said.

"Yeah," I agreed. "Chromium Consolidated. It went bust, the executives secreted away a lot of money before everything went caput."

Marie nodded. "Izzie was at Billingford's mansion in Virginia. "The guy wasn't there himself, but Izzie partied with two of his major donors."

"He wasn't there — Billingford?"

Marie shook her head.

"Izzie told me everything," she said. "It was her and two wealthy businessmen. Bald guy, and a guy who was scarily young — made his money in a tech start-up. The guys were wearing nice suits, and she was in a smart cocktail dress. Dinner, Champagne... then they ordered Izzie to strip. They had her walking about on all fours like an animal..."

I raised my eyebrows at this, but having seen what she'd done with Billingford, I couldn't claim to be surprised.

Marie went on, "...they walked through the house to the grand drawing room. Amazing room, amazing view. The young guy pulled his cock out and had Izzie suck on it. Then she was sucking the older guy, the bald guy. The younger guy lay under her, licking her as she sucked on the other guy. Then they took it turns to fuck her — from behind, from in front. In the ass. Sometimes both at once."

I nodded. I shifted in my seat so she wouldn't see my semi-erect bulge. I should have been completely horrified, of course, but I was sure Izzie had enjoyed being used by the men.

"Oh, she enjoyed it," Marie said. "At least, the parts she remembers."

"What happened?"

"They partied on and on, drank more and more. Izzie was being careful not to drink too much to lose track of things, but the guys were just knocking it back."

"Okay..."

“And there were drugs.”

I felt my insides grow cold. Izzie never got involved in drugs. She’d written enough about their pitfalls during her earlier journalistic career.

“Izzie did that?”

“Hard for her to avoid it.”

Jesus fucking Christ.

I felt the bile rise up at that. The thought that Izzie would willingly risk her health taking... well, whatever it was she’d taken. I didn’t feel like giving Billingford or his goons the benefit of the doubt. But I remembered getting back from Toronto, I remembered greeting Izzie that night. She’d been just as turned on by her recent encounter, which I’d assumed had been with C, as any other time. She’d practically jumped me before I’d even got inside the door that night. Had she really been high on coke that night?

“She had bruises all over,” I said. “I just thought she’d had her usual rough night with the Senator.”

“They were kinda rough. But I think she enjoyed it. I don’t think you could threaten Billingford with anything.”

“No, even if there was something cast iron.”

I thought of the cop car that had approached me while I’d waited for Izzie outside C’s townhouse in Georgetown. Which cop in this town would do anything against a senior US Senator? I sighed. I felt a touch of nausea. What could I do if Izzie refused to stop seeing Billingford? I could hardly lock her in the attic like Mr Rochester’s mad wife.

I stood up, the anger searing hot inside me. “This is not acceptable. Even if she is working undercover. And as for a US Senator loaning out my wife to his friends...”

“Oscar, Oscar, Oscar...” Marie said. “Let’s not lose track here: she’s gone, right? We don’t know where she is. There’s no point getting pissed at what happened before.”

“No.”

“If Billingford even suspects that Izzie might be a threat, might be in danger of leaking anything about their relationship or his sexual tendencies... or those of Goolden...”

“I know, he’d destroy her,” I said, trying to be calm about this. At the very least, I didn’t want to spill my coffee.

“He’d probably have her killed.”

“I’m not being overdramatic, Oscar,” Marie stressed.

“No.”

"I know this isn't Hollywood, but sometimes real life goes further than Hollywood, you know?" she said.

"We need to call the cops."

"She's not been gone long enough for a missing person's report."

"If they fed her drugs and then had sex with her..."

"There's no proof anyone forced her," Marie pointed out.

I groaned. We had nothing to go on.

Marie pulled herself up to her feet. "Come on. We'll go check out her desk at the Messenger. Perhaps there's a clue there."

*

In the car I asked her about the article Izzie — and now she — had been working on.

"I guess it's about the women that he sees. Billingford."

"When this all started, I thought Izzie was the only one he was seeing," I said, tapping my fingers on the steering wheel with simmering anger.

"Oh, she's his favorite, there's no doubt about that," Marie said. "The only one he screws without... you know... protection. And it's been rare that he allows others to play with her."

"But not that rare."

Marie shrugged. "So anyway... Billingford is very... influential. That's where the story starts. He has a big network of donors and supporters, and what Izzie found out was that some of his most loyal supporters get... certain benefits..."

"Women?"

She nodded. "And not just any women, either. Married women."

That made me raise my eyebrows. I said, "And these married women... they're like Izzie? I mean, their husbands know about it all?"

"No, not at all. Well, you know that Billingford has no idea that you know about him and Izzie. None of the husbands know about their wives being involved in this. I don't know. Some of the women are volunteers when Billingford or his friends go out campaigning, I'm sure their husbands know about that. But not about the extra-marital stuff."

"Jesus. So they just cheat on their husbands..."

"There's lots of under appreciated wives out there," Marie said. "Wives eager for a little adventure in their lives, a few naughty secrets."

“And this is in Washington, or all over?”

“All over, as far as we’ve seen. It’s a network.”

“A network that procures women for Billingford’s cronies.”

“They seem to like the whole taboo of using married women. And Billingford makes sure the women are in such a position that they’d never want a whiff of public scandal — and they’d never want to damage their marriages.”

“Still,” I said, horrified. “He couldn’t imagine he’d get away with such a thing?”

“Powerful men sometimes think they’re unimpeachable,” Marie said.

“But Izzie’s a reporter, for God’s sake. He had to think she was a bit of a risk?”

She shook her head. “He ran enough checks on her to feel confident she’d never want the truth known about sleeping with him or his friends. About what they got up to behind closed doors. A respected professional woman with a loving husband she could not do without.”

“Still a risk — she writes for the Messenger, for goodness’ sake.”

Marie said, “Izzie says Billingford just took a shine to her. And when the opportunity to have an affair with her presented itself, he couldn’t resist. Only then she slowly found out more and more about his world... No, it seems that you were the big weakness in all of his plans, Oscar.”

“Okay.”

“Izzie could live without her job, even if it is a good one. She couldn’t live without her husband — Billingford knew that, even if she was sleeping with him. But what the Senator didn’t know was that Izzie had her husband’s approval to sleep with him, or whoever else she wanted.”

I sighed. My anger had settled into a sustained feeling of deep unease by now.

We were getting close to the Messenger building.

“Where is she with the story?” I asked Marie. “Is she close to completing?”

Marie said, “It kind of stalled, a while ago. She just can’t get any of the other women to go on the record, to put their names to their testimony.”

“Problem,” I nodded.

“She can’t blame them — she doesn’t want to expose herself as one of the women, either.”

“Right.”

“The thing is,” Marie said, “None of the other women actually want it to stop.”

“He’s clever,” I sighed again. “Billingford. The women are motivated to keep quiet about it all, and the biggest reason is because they actively want to take part.”

Marie nodded. “So where’s the crime? It’s just sordid. If it was all exposed, Billingford and his cronies would all see their reputations ruined — but there wouldn’t be any action against them.”

“Surely there has to be something to get them for? Some kind of corruption, abusing the political donations system...”

She shook her head. “That’s the difficult part of the whole story.”

Chapter Thirty-Two

We parked in a visitor's spot in the Messenger building's subterranean lot, and got into the building itself with no problem. The building security staff all knew me well enough, and a quick call to Marty was enough to get us through and up in the newsroom. Even so, I could see why Marie thought Messenger security was a little puny. I could have been writing for any newspaper by then, and there I was with a New York Times reporter finding our way to Izzie's desk to sift through her things in the hunt for her whereabouts.

Izzie's boss, Theo, told me that he'd been trying to contact Izzie all day as well, with no luck. He knew she was busy with various assignments, however, so he hadn't been too concerned about it.

"Did she have any assignments that would have taken up the previous evening?" I asked him.

"She was dressed up," he said. "Like she was attending some kind of event."

Another of Izzie's co-workers confirmed that she had, at the last minute, been invited to a charity fundraiser down at the Capitol Skyline Hotel. It surprised me that she hadn't sent me a text message to let me know. On our way back down to the parking lot, Marie suggested that Izzie may have been simply late for the event, and hadn't had a chance to think about texting home.

"She could have texted me after the event started."

"Not if there was no phone reception. You know how some of those hotels are, especially their event rooms."

"She could have slipped out of the entrance for a minute or two."

"Maybe she was just busy."

"Busy?"

"I don't know," Marie sighed. "If there were any of Billingford's... you know... women... at the event."

"With their husbands, or with some of Billingford's friends?"

Marie shrugged. "She might have thought she could have one last chance at persuading them to go on the record."

At the hotel, we did get confirmation that Izzie had attended the charity fundraiser, even managed to catch a little CCTV footage of her enjoying herself at the event, thanks to a sympathetic security manager.

We watched the view outside the hotel's front entrance, as Izzie had slipped out into the night, catching a taxi God knew where, disappearing into the night. Nobody at the hotel could say where she might have gone to.

As we left the hotel, we noticed an unmarked black Mercedes following us. I was the one who noticed it first, and immediately put it down to the general air of paranoia that had surrounded us. A few blocks away, the vehicle was still there, always three or four cars back, as though attempting to remain hidden from us.

What made me feel a little queasy was the faint sense that I'd seen the same car driving behind us as we'd driven to the Messenger building.

"If they're following us, they're doing a poor job of keeping hidden," Marie said as I mentioned it to her. I was trying to play down my paranoia, and embrace the idea that coincidence could happen, and that the chances of someone — Billingford, for example — going as far as to put a tail on us had to be slim.

Our next stop was at the offices of the charity that had put on the fundraiser. We were able to get in to see the event manager only after assuring them we weren't investigating the charity or its event. The event manager, a fifty something woman called Stevie, who seemed very pleasant but looked like cast member from the Dallas or Dynasty TV shows, eventually agreed to show us delegate lists for the fundraiser once she accepted the story about Izzie going missing.

Marie recognized a few names of Billingford allies present at the event.

"Here," she said, and the note of excitement in her voice gave me the first faintly optimistic feeling I'd had since calling Marie in the first place.

"Mr and Mrs Chandler Morgan... Mr and Mrs John Haughton... Mr and Mrs Vincent Marshall..."

"They're all Billingford's friends?" I asked her.

"The wives," she said. "Daisy Morgan, Gillian Haughton, Sally Marshall. All part of the network. Izzie must have thought she could get to them..."

We looked at Stevie and her magnificent hair, and decided that our conversation about Billingford would be better held somewhere else.

Thanking her for her trouble, we quietly left, and were soon back in the car headed back to my house.

The black Mercedes, we both noted, was still on our tail. It was chilling to see it there, maintaining its three-or-four car distance from us.

“You think they’re sending us a message?” Marie asked. “They’re being too obvious to be simply surveillance.”

“Should I try to lose them?”

She shook her head. “They’ll only re-group, probably park outside your house. And perhaps we want to avoid seeming... you know... suspicious.”

It was late into the night after Izzie’s disappearance as Marie and I ended up back at my house in Silver Spring, exhausted. When we’d turned into my street, the black Mercedes had continued on past. Either the guys in the Mercedes felt sure they’d intimidated us enough for now, or they had some hiding place in mind, where they might catch up with us in the morning.

Inside, I fixed us some dinner while Marie started ringing round anyone she could think of that might be able to locate the three wives from the delegate list. Marie had tried to talk with two of the women before, as part of her attempts to get wives to go on the record about Billingsford’s activities. As she made the attempt to reconnect with them, and the other wife, her body language was anything but positive.

“I’m hearing the same thing from all of the friends and families,” she said as she perched on a stool at our kitchen island.

“And that is?”

“Nobody knows where they are.”

“Izzie? Or the wives.”

“The wives. All three are missing. Have been since the fundraiser.”

There was that feeling of my stomach dropping again, like a heavy stone being dropped into a dark lake. “Shit. All of them?”

“Uh-huh. No sign of them anywhere. People are getting worried about them — the police are on the case for some of them.”

“Jesus.”

“Maybe that’s our next call, huh? It’s been twenty-four hours, now.”

“I guess so,” I said, running my hands through my hair, feeling the sweat cold in my locks. It was easy to think that going to the police was the obvious answer, but the elephant was still present in the room — the fear that Izzie’s adultery, even if it was consensual, would be publicly exposed in a police investigation.

“You think something might have happened to them because you were talking to them, because Izzie was talking to them?” I asked Marie.

“Maybe. Look, I guess we’d probably have to be careful what we said to the cops.”

“If Billingford’s done anything to her, I’m taking the whole thing public,” I said, feeling the hot anger coursing through my veins.

After a bite to eat, we did some more research into the missing wives, but there wasn’t a lot more we could do. A last check on Izzie’s email and her social media also came up with nothing.

Marie slept the rest of the night in our spare bedroom. In the morning, we woke to the feeling that we hadn’t gotten anywhere with our search. I called the local police force and attempted to file a missing person’s report, before being told the person had to be missing at least 48-hours.

“There’s only one thing left for us to do,” I told Marie as we grabbed a hurried breakfast.

“You think it’s worth trying?”

“It’s the only option.”

Chapter Thirty-Three

“Uh... but you haven’t made an appointment?”

“We sent him an email to let him know we were coming.”

“An email? All his emails come through me, Mr... And I haven’t seen anything that would lead me to believe that he would have changed his schedule for today...”

“I’ll see them now, thank you, Sheila.”

Senator Billingford’s personal assistant was considerably surprised as the man himself ducked his head out of his office door, and gave the consent for her to send Marie and I into his office.

“Can I get you anything?” Billingford said as we entered the room, appearing calm, completely unflustered as he returned to his large mahogany desk.

It felt strange to see him in this environment — the man who had been sleeping with my wife. Billingford had a nice office in the Russell Senate Office Building. High ceilings, lavish decor, paintings on the walls that were probably worth millions. I guess it would have been easy to be intimidated by it all — the whole Capitol Hill thing, the grand office, the fact that this man Billingford was so senior in the establishment, so powerful he could probably have gone all the way to the White House. I tried to embrace my own status as a Messenger reporter, to feel that my status meant I was also Somebody, even if was way down the significance scale. A Messenger reporter shouldn’t be intimidated on Capitol Hill.

And yet, the very grandiose nature of our surroundings made me feel safe. While we were here, no black Mercedes could follow; a Senator nor anyone else could have us quietly bumped off.

“Water, or coffee, or something?” he prompted.

“No, thank you,” I said. Marie shook her head.

Billingford nodded, sat, calmly taking in the two reporters sitting in front of him.

“So what can I do for you, Mr MacDonald?” he said.

I said, “You’ve had a very... close... relationship with my wife for some time.”

“Isabella,” Billingford said, nodding gently again. “She’s a very... interesting... young woman.”

I could see him subtly trying to work out how much I knew — how much we both knew — about what he’d been doing with Izzie. I felt like blurting out everything, and at the same time, wanted to tell him nothing in case we weakened our hand.

“She’s gone missing,” I said. “She didn’t come home after the fundraiser for Leukemia at the Capitol Skyline.”

The Senator nodded gently again, giving little away himself. “Missing, you say. And you’ve contacted the police?”

“We have,” I said.

“And did you tell them... any of your concerns?”

He was digging, digging into the reasons that had brought us to his office — digging for how much we knew about what Izzie had done in his company.

Marie said, “We haven’t told them anything yet. We wanted to follow up all of our leads before we suggested the need for a major police investigation.”

Billingford was quietly nodding again. He looked from Marie to me, and back again. Then asked me, “And I presume that I, myself, am one of your leads?”

“That is correct,” Marie said.

“We know what you were doing with Izzie,” I said.

“Of course you do,” the Senator nodded, but I caught something in his eyes — just for a fraction of a second, and then it was gone. Surprise, perhaps. Uncertainty. He revealed too much of his hand — he had fully trusted Izzie to keep quiet about her affair with him, about everything that had happened to her under his patronage. As he had trusted all the women, no doubt.

“You know that we do, or else you wouldn’t have allowed us in your office,” I said, but now reached forward to put my iPhone onto his desk.

He flinched, and I wonder if he didn’t imagine for a second that I was putting some kind of explosive device there, or some kind of weapon to threaten him. In his eyes, I could be a jealous husband willing to blow all of us up in order to wreak revenge on the man who had slept with my wife.

But instead, there was merely an iPhone playing a video clip, a clip that showed the Senator himself, along with his good friend Joseph

Goolden, enjoying Izzie and the young blonde intern. The video that Izzie had sent me.

“Enough,” the Senator said, and for the first time almost lost his reserve.

“We have footage of you striking her, as well,” I said.

Billingford seemed quietly stunned. He looked at me, and for a moment I could tell that he really had thought his little scheme had been perfect.

“Everything I did with her...” the Senator said quietly, “...it was all consensual.”

“Oh, I know that,” I said. “Why do you think I let it go on for so long?”

Another look of surprise from the Senator, less veiled now. I felt as though I’d landed a good blow in a fist fight. He honestly hadn’t anticipated the husband of one of his women to be aware of what was going on, and to approve of his wife’s infidelity.

“No court of law in the land would...” the Senator said.

I interrupted him, “The court of public opinion doesn’t have much in the way of standards of evidence, though, does it?”

He blanched, visibly.

“So this is it, is it? Blackmail?”

I shook my head. “Not blackmail.”

“What do you want? What are your demands?”

“Only that you return my wife to me,” I said.

“And if I don’t know where your wife is at the moment?”

I’ll hand it to him, he was a good actor. I suppose all politicians have to be performers to some degree, particularly those who get to the top.

I said, “I’m betting that if you don’t know where she is at the moment, you have the resources at your disposal to locate her. Being a United States Senator.”

He nodded. I was pleased at how I’d been able to reign in my anger, because just now I genuinely believed that this man knew where Izzie was, and the other women, too. This man was a nasty piece of work.

“And if I do return her?” he said.

“And the others,” Marie chipped in. A blank look from the Senator prompted her to continue, “Daisy Morgan, Gillian Haughton, Sally Marshall. They’re other women you’ve been involved with. Your network, anyhow. They’ve also gone missing recently.”

“If they return?” the Senator said.

“All this goes away,” I said.

I didn't like saying it. Marie and I had debated — I don't want to say 'argued', because ultimately we both knew we would ultimately have to do what was necessary to get Izzie back — over the making of a promise to the Senator to bury the whole story about his sexual proclivities — and the procurement of women for his political friends.

It didn't seem right to let a men like this get away with anything. But we had little choice just now.

"It goes away," Marie said, "But you would be advised to stop what you've been doing."

The Senator sighed, as though he felt he had some kind of moral high ground. "You pay a blackmailer, and he simply comes back another day with more demands," he said.

"You stop, and that's it," I said. "If we see you continue to earn favors in Washington by exploiting women — even if the women appear to be consenting — then we'll be forced to consider exposing you."

He nodded. "And you really think I believe that reporters from the Washington Messenger and the New York Times would really bury a story like this?"

"You don't have much of a choice but to believe us," Marie said. "And if anything happens to us, or to Izzie, or any of the women involved..."

"... Procedures are already arranged to share what we have with many of our colleagues across the media industry," I finished for Marie.

Senator Billingford sat in his chair, a dejected shadow of his former self. He seemed almost to have deflated, wilted.

He finally said to me, "If your wife, or any of the women you say I'm involved with, are involved in... risky... sexual activities... I cannot be held responsible."

"Unless you are involved," I nodded.

Billingford put his hands together on the desk in front of him, almost as though praying. He paused, considering what we'd put in front of him. Another sigh.

Then, he said, "I will do what I can to find your wife, Mr MacDonald. And the other women. I assure you, I do not know where they are right now. But I will put everything I have toward finding them."

"Thank you," I said.

And that was as much as we were going to get from Senator Billingford.

Chapter Thirty-Four

There was no black Mercedes on our tail as we left Capitol Hill that time.

Marie and I went together back to my house, where we fixed some lunch and made another round of phone calls to our various contacts to see if any had heard anything of Izzie since the previous day.

I would say we both seemed calmer since our meeting with Billingford.

“What do we do?” Marie said once our calls were done.

“Wait,” I said.

“You believe he knows where she is, don’t you?”

“The Senator?” I asked. “Yes, I do.”

Marie nodded.

We waited.

It was about four o’clock in the afternoon that we received a call back from the Montgomery County Police Department — with whom I’d attempted but failed to lodge a missing person’s report earlier in the day.

“Mr MacDonald?”

“Yes, that’s me.”

“Sir, we have a report that a young woman who fits the description of your wife was found an hour ago in northern Virginia.”

My heart leapt. I hadn’t filed a missing person’s report, but somebody in the police department must have remembered how I’d described Izzie, and taken down my number. Unless Billingford had engineered something, of course. I didn’t care how the news came to me.

“Izzie? They found Izzie? Where is she now?”

“She was picked up at a gas station outside Banco, Virginia, Mr MacDonald. She was found without any form of ID, and she was quite weak when they picked her up...”

“She’s going to be okay?”

“She’s been taken to the UVA Culpeper Hospital for checks — “

“UVA Culpeper Hospital. I’m on my way.”

The officer on the end of the line said, “Sir, she was found without any clothes. And she has various bruises about her person. Can you shed any

light on that? They're not serious-looking, but — “

I sighed. Poor Izzie. What had she gotten herself into? Or what had Billingford or his cronies gotten her into? I had to suppose that the Senator had given word for her to be released from wherever she was held. For word to get to us via the police, rather than through the Senator himself.

“I’m afraid she got involved... with some bad people,” I said.

The police officer said, “My colleagues in the Culpeper County Sheriff’s Department will want to ask you some questions.”

“Of course.”

“And we may need you to come down to HQ here in Gaithersburg...”

“Of course,” I said.

Marie and I were straight down to rural Virginia, maybe an hour and a half’s drive from DC. I trembling the whole way — I felt like we’d escaped something desperately awful. Izzie could have disappeared for good. Sure, none of us could go out there and write a Pulitzer Prize-winning series of articles tearing apart the political legacy of Senator Billingford and his friends, but you couldn’t have everything. I had my beloved wife, who was there lying in a clean, comfortable hospital bed, appearing to be in relatively good health despite how she had been found.

I felt strongly that I would have been willing to give up anything to make sure she was safe.

“What happened?” I said, once we were allowed a little time alone, with even Marie leaving the room.

She said, “They were playing a game with us.”

“‘Us’? You were with the other wives? Daisy Morgan, Gillian Haughton, Sally Marshall?”

She nodded. “I wanted to persuade them to go on the record. I was trying so hard... I completely forgot to tell you I was at that fundraiser. And then my phone battery died.”

“You said they were playing a game with you...” I prompted.

“After the fundraiser, a few of C’s friends wanted to take us to some big house somewhere. I don’t know... it was dark... everyone just wanted to party...”

“What happened to the husbands? Daisy, Gillian, Sally’s husbands?”

“Oh, they went back to their hotels after the fundraiser. They were under the impression that their wives were part of the group of volunteers helping clear up after the event...”

“So you were partying all night?”

I felt a little angry at the work that had gone in to track Izzie down, if she had simply been away somewhere having a good time. But perhaps there was more to it than that.

“We had a lot to drink... I guess.... There were drugs, too. I didn’t want to get involved, but I had to try to get some time with those women...”

“What happened?”

“It was really late at night... the men stripped us... they took away our clothes... and everything, phones, too... then we had to run and hide... or just run. They would catch us and... do whatever they wanted with us...”

Jesus. I felt bad feeling a little aroused at my wife engaging in sexual games out in some Virginia backwater. But right now, there was limited time to talk about what had happened to her.

“I think later on, one of the other women accidentally told a guy she was with that I was a reporter, that I had been trying to get her to talk about everything, for a story,” Izzie said.

I nodded.

“So what happened next?”

“They locked me in one of the rooms, in the mansion.”

“Billingford’s mansion?”

“No,” she shook her head. “Not somewhere I’d been.”

What had they been planning on doing with Izzie? I was suddenly relieved that Marie and I had gone to Billingford when we had. Perhaps if we’d delayed a little longer, my wife would have remained missing. Disappeared.

“They beat you?”

“No, these are from before,” she said, referring to her bruises. “Some of the guys were... a little rough... when they were playing with us...”

“They eventually let you go, though?” I said.

“Eventually. I was so scared. And then someone came in and put a blindfold on me — they put me in a car, and then after driving for a while, I was let out. And they drove off without giving me any clothes or anything.”

I held her, and kissed her, and she was shaking a little. I wondered if she was telling me everything, if there were things she was keeping back to avoid shocking me too much.

I told her about our meeting with Billingford, about promising the man that we’d kill the story to get her back. I kind of thought she’d be angry at me for doing that, though there hadn’t been much choice at the time.

“It’s over,” she said. “He knows it. Even if we don’t write the story, it could be written some day. There’s too much risk to him to continue it all, regardless.”

That was about all the time we had alone in that hospital. The trouble was, neither Izzie nor I wanted to press charges against the people who had done this to her. It took a lot of effort to dissuade the local police or sheriff’s department from looking into what had happened to Izzie. And I mean a lot of effort: social services were on the case fairly quickly, sniffing around her out of the genuine concern that she was a victim of domestic violence. Naturally as the husband, I came under some suspicion.

It was all very sensitive, though, and ultimately we were able to show the woman from social services that Izzie’s wounds were related to her own particular sexual tastes — the bondage, the handcuffs, the rope. Izzie had been persuasive in stating her preferences for such things, and in explaining how being dumped naked, miles from anywhere, had all been part of humiliating her, part and parcel of the whole sexual adventure.

“And your husband wasn’t involved in any of this?” the poor social services woman asked my wife, struggling to quite comprehend what had happened.

“My husband lets me do as I want, sexually,” Izzie said.

“With other men?”

The woman looked at me, staggered.

I shrugged. “It’s up to her,” I said.

*

I guess we learned our lesson. If we’d been in a different State, perhaps we would have been in more trouble than we were. If we’d had children, the scary thing was that the authorities might have taken them away from us. The whole time, though, I felt we had Billingford to help smooth things over — and ultimately, he might even have got involved, behind the scenes, in helping everything to go away.

Eventually I got the full story out of Izzie, of what happened. She gave me the details of the game they’d played, of how Billingford’s men had staged a kind of hunt, chasing naked women through a dark forest in the middle of the night.

Until she'd had her cover blown, Izzie had been having a good time. Three or four men had caught her, surrounded her, and used her for their own sexual ends. It had been wild and rough and exhilarating, but ultimately consensual. She even said being taken like that, by perhaps four men, had been a long-held fantasy of hers. It disturbed me what had happened to my wife — the fact that it had essentially turned into a kidnapping, and who knew where it might have ended up if I hadn't forced Billingford to step in. Yet I couldn't help but share Izzie's arousal about the concept of her being taken by four men.

If it was to ever happen again, though, I felt like I'd have to be more in control.

Back home in Silver Spring, Marie came round to our house the next day to check on how Izzie was doing, and she brought the news that the other women who had been with her had also returned to their families.

"They're not going to press charges against anyone, either," Marie said. "God knows what the wives told their husbands, though."

"I doubt they've told them the truth," I said.

"They've probably been paid off," Marie said. "But I think if we hadn't interfered... well, those women would have gone, for good. And Izzie, too, I've no doubt."

*

Things went back to relative normality, you might say. The big surprise for us was that Senator Billingford seemed to take a public step back, and from what Marie told us, it also seemed to result in his friend Joseph Goolden ultimately deciding not to enter the Presidential race, at the Convention or any other time. Later, when Billingford decided not to stand for re-election in the Senate, Marie said she believed the guy probably felt too insecure, with the kind of damaging evidence that was potentially out there concerning his activities.

Meanwhile, Izzie and I didn't really talk too much about the Game for a while, things settled into a cozy monogamy again. I didn't want to push anything, and she seemed to want a break from any bold adventures.

I still liked to remember the times my Izzie had strayed, of how wicked she'd been, of how exciting it had been to discover the clues that led me to finding out about her infidelity, or even to watch it. I regretted the fact that we'd lost our way in the Game, that we had to avoid it now.

Perhaps I should have felt bad, continuing to want my wife to go sleep with other men. I should have just accepted her as the most wonderful, most beautiful wife a guy could ever have.

But I did find myself wanting to show her off. When the two of us went to a dinner or some kind of event together — I wanted her to wear tight, revealing clothes. I wanted her to flirt with the guys around us, and maybe even quietly suggest to one that they should go find a hotel room.

I did find myself hoping she might be tempted by some other guy whenever she was away from home for the night — covering some story far away, attending some journalistic conference, whatever it was.

I let it lie, though. I left it to my fantasy life, I chilled out and simply read about fictional husbands sharing their wives in erotic literature.

That was that, wasn't it? I guess the next thing now we were in our thirties was to think about having kids.

During the winter, I was actually distracted by a new business opportunity.

An old friend from journalism school, Marc Williams, found himself dumped from the New York Times just as I had — another victim of online news shaking up the print newspaper industry. Marc got in touch since I'd managed to just about claw myself a living as a freelancer after receiving my pink slip. Only rather than simply pick my brains about how best to set himself up as a freelancer, Marc also wanted to gauge me on the idea of starting up some kind of specialist online news outlet of our own.

The idea was to set up a center of business news, which would offer the kind of in-depth coverage businesses needed to thrive in their own industries, which they couldn't always guarantee from the increasingly downsized traditional news media available.

Marc had some clever ideas on financing, and on the production side, his idea was to create a platform where trusted freelancers would publish articles covering their own expert areas of business, whenever they had articles ready to publish. They would then receive the advertising revenue generated by their articles, minus a small percentage that would go to cover overheads.

We'd have to get a certain number of fellow freelancers to help us out with the idea, but if we were putting up the kind of quality coverage that businesses would normally expect from writers of the likes of the New York Times, the Washington Messenger and so on, then we would get the kind of readers needed to bring in the online advertising bucks.

Then once we were ready for phase two, there would be the opportunity to put together a premium section for the more in-depth analysis — and we would have the opportunity to sell subscriptions.

It was never going to be easy, but if Marc and I could set up the system while continuing to freelance ourselves, we hoped we might get the kind of momentum to make the business a success.

I was so distracted by the whole thing, but the enormous hope it suddenly gave me for my struggling career, that I almost missed the fact that one day shortly after the New Year, a little box of condoms appeared in the bathroom cabinet.

It almost made my heart stop to see it.

Was Izzie really up for playing the Game again?

Chapter Thirty-Five

You know what they say about absence making the heart grow fonder? Well, the effect is stronger when your wife is away at a conference, or something like that, and she knows she's allowed to enjoy herself with other men while she's away.

Each time Izzie went away, I would fantasize that she might be tempted to try our little Game once again. She'd call me before she went to sleep at night, and I'd be hopeful she might drop some little hints that she was seeing someone while she was away. She didn't, though.

It strengthened the tug on my heartstrings until she got back, and always meant for a fiery reunion in the bedroom — but after C, for a long while she just didn't seem interested in other men.

Then she had some kind of event at a journalism school in Arizona that would take her away from me for four nights. Izzie was a speaker at the event — sharing her experience in the business with an audience of hopeful college students. If anything by then, I was no longer so optimistic, I wasn't expecting anything.

As often happened since I was a flexible freelancer, I was able to drive out to Dulles to pick Izzie up from the airport. This time, though, as I waited for her at the arrivals gate, I almost failed to spot her coming out — because she wasn't alone.

I was stunned. Izzie had her arm locked in that of a young black guy with a shaven head, who seemed very presentable in a smart shirt and tie — businesslike, I'd say. Izzie herself was wearing a short floral summer dress, which might have been appropriate for Arizona, but even with a small blue jacket slung over the top, it wasn't exactly right for DC this time of year. She looked hot in it, though.

She was smiling and laughing as she talked to him coming out of the doors into arrivals, and then her eyes were scouting around looking for me — and she wasn't letting go of her new friend at all. It was as though they were the couple, and I was simply a friend meeting them at the airport.

I felt hopes renewed stirring in my loins, I can tell you.

“Hey honey!”

“Hey, good flight?” I smiled politely at Izzie’s new friend, waiting for some kind of explanation and introduction.

“Terrific,” she said, beaming as she kissed me, then glanced in my eyes before looking to her friend. “Honey, this is Julius.”

“Hi, Julius,” I shook the young man’s hand. He had a strong grip and a pleasant smile to go with it.

“He’s a student at Georgetown,” Izzie explained. “He was at my conference.”

“Journalism major?” I asked him.

“That’s right, sir.”

I flinched a little at being called ‘sir’. “Oh, you don’t have to call me that,” I said. “It’s Oscar, please.”

“Julius heard me speak at the conference — and then there he was, on my flight,” Izzie said.

We were walking toward the nearest long hallway that led down to the parking lot, and Izzie was still holding onto Julius, rather than me. I felt a couple of shivers pass through my body.

“You were sitting next to her on the plane, Julius?” I asked.

“Not to start with,” my wife replied for him. “But there was hardly anyone on the flight, I had a whole row to myself.”

“I recognized her,” Julius said in his warm baritone, “I know her from her articles — and when she’s on TV. I just wanted to say ‘hi’.”

“Great,” I said, feeling things squirming in my stomach, though for all I knew, Izzie had simply offered the guy a ride home.

Izzie squeezed Julius’s arm. Her body language was nothing less than first date lust, I swear. It was hot to see. “We got to talking, and I agreed to mentor him — you know, help him get into the industry,” she said.

“Oh, right,” I felt my heart sink.

We passed out of the doors into the crisp Northern Virginia air, with yours truly leading the way to where I’d parked the car.

“Well that sounds like a fantastic idea,” I said, or something similarly positive.

“He showed me a few things he’d written — he’s very good,” she was proud of him. But why was she clinging onto him like that if she was just going to be a professional mentor?

We got to the car, and as I opened the trunk to put Izzie’s and her friend’s luggage inside, would you believe it, but both of them climbed into the back of the car — as though I was the chauffeur.

It made me tremble a little. If he was just a friend, if he was just a college student to be mentored, surely he would have gone in the back and she would have sat next to me in the front?

I kept calm, climbed into the driver's seat.

"Then we were talking for, like, hours," Izzie said. I glanced in the mirror. She was holding his hand. "Well, it's a four hour flight, so I guess it was three hours or so."

"Uh-huh," I said, reversing out of the space.

"And we were talking about everything," she went on, "and I guess we got to talking about the Game."

"Okay..."

Now my heart was thumping against my chest cavity.

"I kissed him," she said, and would you believe it, I was hard as a rock as I was sitting there up front. "And he asked me if I was breaking the rules of the Game, because I hadn't left any clues for my husband to let him know something might happen."

I glanced in the mirror again, and Julius was looking in the mirror at me, a trifle anxious I thought — trying to read in my eyes how I was responding to the news that he'd been kissing my wife on their flight.

"I don't think it's a hard and fast rule, not if something unexpected crops up," I said, and saw him visibly relax.

"That's what I said," Izzie beamed.

Then she leaned over, and Julius turned his head to her, and the two of them kissed right there in the back of our car. Jesus.

I had to adjust how I was sitting in the driver's seat to give my burgeoning erection room.

"So anything happen on the flight?" I asked, not really wanting to break up the long, lingering kiss, but needing to know everything.

"Not really," Julius said.

Izzie added, "There were flight attendants everywhere. I mean, swarming. I think there were more of them than passengers. We were kissing like teenagers, though."

And there they were, at it again. I noticed Izzie's pale hand sliding over his broad chest, dropping down to his lap, feeling out the bulge in his pants.

Julius was keeping his hands to himself, however, and I sensed he was still a little uncertain. It wasn't an everyday situation, I suppose.

Then she was saying, "We were talking about whether, you know, the guys I was with knew that you allowed me to see them. And I guess maybe it's not entirely ethical, you know, not telling them..."

“Yeah, but they were basically stealing my wife,” I said. “We hardly owed them anything.”

“That’s what I said,” Julius said. “And they know you’re married. They have to at least suspect you still sleep with your husband.”

“I don’t know...” Izzie was saying. “I was thinking maybe guys wouldn’t want to date me, if they knew.”

“If they knew I knew?” I asked. “Or if they knew you were still sleeping with me.”

“Both. Either. I don’t know,” she shrugged. “But Julius said he wouldn’t care if you knew. Or if I was still sleeping with you. He’d still date me.”

“And so here we are,” I said, feeling as though fireworks were going off in my chest. Was she really saying what I thought she was saying? This would be a new dynamic, that was for sure.

“Here we are,” Izzie grinned, and turned to kiss Julius again.

Julius asked me, “So you really don’t mind me... dating your wife, sir?”

“Just so long as you stop calling me ‘sir’,” I said. “Have you two had dinner?”

“On the flight,” Izzie said, and she was back to kissing her new date, her hands crawling all over the sizable presence in his pants. And now his hand was sliding up her thigh.

“Can I drop you anywhere, Julius?” I asked.

But Izzie broke off from him to say, “Oh no, he’s coming home with us tonight.”

*

It was kind of difficult concentrating on driving while the two of them made out like teens in the back row of the movie theater, and a few times I felt like pulling over to check out what was going on.

The deep breathing, the sighs, the quiet moans. The silky sounds of hands gliding over clothing as they explored each other. It was driving me nuts.

I imagined they were going a little further than they’d been able to on the plane, with the flight crew breathing down their necks. In the solid traffic of the Beltway, I was able to glance back and see Izzie’s hand on

his lap, stroking him — and I could see Julius slip his hand up her inner thigh, under the hem of her short dress.

Was he touching her?

Somebody beeped at me for hesitating after the vehicle in front of me began moving away again, and I hit the gas pedal.

They were stroking each other through their clothes, I was sure of that. And along with the cocktail of her perfume and his subtle cologne, I even started to believe I could detect the hint of female arousal in the air.

What was going to happen when we got home? With Izzie dating someone who not only knew that I knew, but didn't seem reluctant to fool around with her in front of me? I tried to imagine how I might feel in Julius's place. I guess when I was a student, if I'd had a chance with someone as beautiful as Izzie, I might have agreed to some no-strings-attached fun even if I knew the husband knew. But in front of him? I wasn't so sure.

I'd never been massively confident when it came to sex. Sex in front of someone else — a husband no less — probably would have made me wilt. Although assuming that Julius was around 10 years younger than me, there was probably less of a risk of performance problems even in front of an assembled audience.

Kind of exciting to think of my Izzie bedding a college guy again. And this one was going to go all the way.

When we did get home, I was the one feeling a little awkward. What was I supposed to do? Leave them to it? Had they actually suggested I was supposed to watch them, or what? I got out of the car to retrieve the luggage from the trunk, and the two of them stayed in there. I ended up taking the cases inside, and then up to the bedroom. Well, I assumed Julius might be staying the night.

I came out at the top of the stairs to see Izzie and Julius walking in, arm-in-arm. Izzie's smile was huge, that flirty smile she used with strangers she wanted to impress.

"Nice place you guys have," Julius said.

"Thanks," Izzie glanced up at me as the front door closed behind them, and it almost seemed to be her thanking me for letting her have this new man right in front of me.

I paused at the top of the stairs, not quite sure where I should be. It was a good vantage point, though, to see Izzie pull Julius to her, place her hands up and around the back of his neck, and pull him into another kiss.

He put his arms around her waist as she slipped her tongue in his mouth, and then as they continued to suck on each other's lips, his hands dropped to her behind, quietly slipping up her dress as he held her round cheeks.

I perched on the top step, not wanting to come downstairs now, fearing my presence might cause interruption.

Julius suddenly turned Izzie, making her let out an excited squeal, though she wasn't going to stop him manhandling her. She put her hands on the back of the couch, pushing out her behind for him so he could push up her dress, exposing her fine ass and her black thong.

He crouched, his hands gripping her cheeks firmly, squeezing them, kneading them as he began kissing her there.

Izzie yelped as he tore off her panties in one blindingly quick motion, then she moaned long and low as he grabbed her hips to pull her wet pussy to his mouth.

Well, she'd always liked dating the domineering types, I thought. Provided a nice counterpoint to my gentle treatment.

Propping herself up on the back of the couch, Izzie pushed up her butt to give him easy access to her sex, and she was panting in no time as he wedged his face between her buttocks to feast on her married pussy.

He was a sizable guy — huge hands sprawling over her pale skin, and as I watched it seemed he had a huge tongue, too, to slide inside her.

"Oh God... that's so good..." she moaned, and from where she was standing, was able to turn her head to look up at me.

It was such a powerful turn-on to gaze into her eyes as another man ate her. To see the arousal and the gratitude and the love in her face as she beamed up at me.

I heard a couple of cracks as Julius slapped her behind. Jesus — was this whole spanking thing that common? Were all other guys slapping their women, and it was just me who didn't see the attraction? Nevertheless, it wasn't hard, just playful really.

Julius allowed her to stand, to turn back to him, to remove his tie and unfasten the buttons on his shirt. She left it to him to pull off his shirt as she released him from his pants, revealing the sizable beast he carried between his legs. Not quite so large as C, I thought, but larger than most guys, larger than me. His girth, in particular, was impressive, with a prominent vein that just seemed to emphasize the sense of power about that thing.

Izzie knelt and kissed his tip, and I was mesmerized to watch her stretch her lips around that thing, and begin to coax his length with her

mouth.

She moaned as she sucked on him, as she stroked his shaft with her hand, enjoying the chance to play with a near-stranger's manhood, and the exoticism of his beautifully dark flesh.

He was groaning as she toyed with him, but then she pulled away, stood up, and grabbed his hand to lead him to the stairs.

"Isn't he beautiful?" she asked me as they climbed the stairs up toward me.

He gave me a respectful nod as they passed me on the landing, and I just let them go on, to the bedroom. Was I really meant to go with them, to watch? Or was I supposed to hang out in the spare room like I had before C came along?

I went along, I hovered in the doorway of the master bedroom to see him lifting her dress up to expose her nudity and lack of a bra, those stiff nipples of hers desperate for attention. I watched them stand and kiss like lovers reunited, Izzie using both hands to caress and gently pump his hard cock.

I watched as he pushed her onto her back on the bed and knelt on the mattress between her thighs. I saw him roll a pale condom down his large member, then part her legs further, and touch his sheathed cock against her glistening pussy. I could smell the musty, spicy scent of her arousal as he patted that thing against her open flower.

"Go on," she moaned as he stroked her soaking lips with the tip of his cock. "Fuck me so my husband can see."

My pulse was racing. I could hardly believe that this guy would so brazenly fuck my wife right in front of me — but that was exactly what he intended to do. I took a few steps into the room, found myself a place perched on the window sill where I could see everything in glorious Technicolor.

The young black guy eased the tip of his huge cock into my wife's dripping wet pussy.

"Oh fuck..." she groaned.

I found myself wondering if she'd ever been with someone like Julius before. Come to think of it, if she'd ever been with anyone who wasn't from the same racial background.

I watched that thing stretching her, and how she gasped when it did. He fucked her with just the tip, holding her ankles as he entered her, delving a fraction deeper with each thrust.

"God you're stretching me..." she whispered, as though she knew saying such a thing would make the hairs rise on the back of my neck.

Izzie had become so much more vocal during sex since we'd started playing the Game.

I watched him sink completely into her, filling her, forcing out the air from her lungs as he did so. He pushed her knees up under her chin as he continued to fuck her, supporting his body on strong arms, his hips moving as though he were doing push-ups in some football practice rather than making love to another man's wife.

"Oh fuck..." Izzie gasped, and I found myself believing she was enjoying this more than she'd ever enjoyed C.

I was just entranced watching that thing sinking into her, glistening with her juices, better than any toy. I had to hope she could have her sexual thrills with other men without resorting to the types who would spank her, who would harm her, who would humiliate her.

He turned her over, and she did as he wanted, pushing her behind up for him, her legs locked together as he knelt up to slide into her tight hole once again.

Izzy turned her head to look over at me, smiling to see me watching her, watching them. It was the biggest thrill to make eye contact with her as she was being fucked, her body rocked with every thrust from her other man. But then she lifted up a hand and gave me a come hither signal. I frowned, uncertain, but she beckoned me again.

I moved up to the bed, and she said: "Take off your clothes, honey."

Now, what was I saying about feeling doubtful about being able to perform in front of another man? But I was so turned on, I don't think I could have made my erection go down even if I'd wanted to. Not without reaching the conclusion of it all.

Julius flashed me a polite smile, but continued rutting with my wife.

Gingerly, I tore off my clothes, and Izzie was beckoning me again, moving over slightly so her head was toward the edge of the bed. I approached, and she reached out to guide my bare cock to her lips.

I moaned as she took me inside her hot mouth, aware that her motion bobbing down on my hardness resulted from the other man thrusting into her pussy. It felt insanely hot, the strong smell of sex swirling around us as the two of us fucked Izzie at once.

Izzie had me climb onto the bed, to sit up against the headboard where she could drop her head down into my lap to continue sucking on my cock while Julius fucked her from behind. But then she was clambering forward, away from him, turning to sit down in my lap, and take my cock inside her pussy as she faced Julius.

Her pussy felt different to me, having just accommodated Julius. An effect I knew well enough from having had her after C. Her vaginal muscles squeezed me, though, so it was hardly as though she was too stretched down there.

Julius stood on the bed to offer his cock to her mouth while I gently thrust inside her pussy. She looked up at him and grinned, and moved to pull the condom from his pole before touching her lips to him.

“We have more,” she smiled. “Plenty more.”

I squeezed her beautifully rounded breasts as she bounced on my cock, and now it was my motion that dictated the rhythm of her mouth on the other man’s cock.

Freshly sheathed, it was his hardness inside her pussy that made her come first that night. But it wasn’t the only time she came that night, and it turned out I could make her do it as much as he could.

It turned out she liked having her husband in on the action, more than she’d enjoyed ever being flogged or bound or shackled. And for a while, Julius became a frequent visitor to our household, even as Izzie did indeed become his mentor in the world of journalism.

And our Game took on a new set of rules. If Izzie wanted to sleep with another man, she’d have to engineer a situation so that I was always present, one way or another. That was fine by me.

#

About the Author

Max Sebastian is a writer, author, occasional journalist and stay-at-home dad who lives in London, England, but has close ties to the United States. He has been writing erotica for more than 10 years, with his first full-length erotic novel, *Anarchy of the Heart*, coming along in 2012. He has recently published wife-sharing novels *What's Mine Is Yours* and *She's a Star*, both through KW Publishing.

You can find more information about Max at his website, **MaxSebastian.net**, or via Twitter (**@MaxSebastian**), Facebook (**facebook.com/writermax**) or GoodReads (**goodreads.com/maxsebastian**), as well as at Amazon itself (**amazon.com/author/maxsebastian**).

Feel free to share your thoughts, about this story or any of his others, with Max by emailing max@maxsebastian.net. And if you'd like to help Max out, jot down a little review of the story where you purchased it.

Also by Max Sebastian

Available via MaxSebastian.net

Novels

Anarchy of the Heart

Submitting to Her

Madeleine Wakes

Madeleine Plays

Madeleine Strays

What's Mine is Yours

What's Yours is Mine

A Killer of a One Night Stand

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Novellas

My Wife, The Seductress

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Part One of the Madeleine Trilogy

His wife flirts with other men. And he likes it.

Hugo and Madeleine Finnell move to New York looking for a way to end her depression — a bleakness so deep it's left their five-year marriage in tatters. The change in scenery helps almost immediately. Madeleine crawls out of the solitude of the past three years a new woman. A sexual woman. The woman Hugo first fell in love with.

But Hugo isn't the only man who notices. He watches from the sidelines as others begin flirting with his wife — and his wife flirts back. Shock, jealousy, and much to his surprise, arousal buffet Hugo as he witnesses this sexy side of Madeleine come alive.

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a wife-sharing romance

Great sex always comes with some kind of risk.

After his marriage collapses, night shift worker Sean Ruskin finds the only friend he has left in the world is his co-worker Henry Robinson. But when Henry offers him his spare room until he can get back on his feet, complication arises in the form of Henry's beautiful wife Michelle.

Michelle likes to flirt with Sean — and strangely, Henry seems to enjoy her doing it, too. After Henry asks him to take Michelle out on a date, Sean discovers their unconventional view on marital fidelity.

But knowing how painful it can be to find your wife in bed with another man, Sean is torn between protecting his last remaining friendship — and his best friend's marriage — and helping him explore a wife-sharing fantasy that could bring untold delights for all.

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a Hollywood Hotwife story

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